



ORGANIC PSYCHOLOGY

(Unedited Manuscript)

**ORGANIC PSYCHOLOGY
(1.2)**

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Preface

Like an old black and white photograph, almost all of what you will find in this book was written many years ago now, when I was still in the early stages of coming to grips with the subject matter it covers. It was never published because that was not the point – it was just a letter of sorts to a friend who had asked me what I was working on with such devotion, and in such secrecy. It is safe to say that I still had no idea of the scope and magnitude of what was unfolding, or where it would inevitably lead me. Truly, if I had known, I'm really not sure I would have done it.

I suppose anyone more experienced with such things may have realised this very early on, but I was a functionally illiterate novice who was already in way over my head, and only getting deeper by the day. I had never even written a school essay – preferring to spend that time in that special invisible spot reserved for dunces and misfits.

And then there was this. It was never going to end well.

In terms of communicating it to others, it has clearly taken me a long time to adjust to what people are capable of integrating on their own – as evidenced in this first attempt. There was always something wrong, and for a long time I thought it was my own fault. But as much as there may be more than enough things that fit that bill, it turns out there was something much deeper at work in this instance, as subsequent revelations would make clear.

Essentially, the idea addressed here is too big to fit in any book, but I didn't realise this back then. I used to think that people didn't 'get it' because I had missed something, or because there was not yet enough detail. And this work is evidence of my own obsessive search to find that elusive missing connection.

Apparently, however, that was the wrong direction. What people actually needed was the simpler version, the breakdown of what is provided here into the more concrete and manageable context of daily experience. It was going over people's heads not for lack of information, but because it is simply too deep in its implications to consciously embrace. It was just too big in terms of its implications, but also in its overall scale and depth, and my unfortunate response to that was at first only to make it even bigger.

In time all things become clear, and capturing its full form has since taken two diverging paths by necessity: there has now emerged a search to find ever simpler and more accessible ways to capture this paradigm in its most broad and practical sense (the simple). And then there is an ongoing exploration of the seemingly endless territory of dynamic complexity it opens up – a combination of simplicity and detail which can apparently only emerge and be captured in the context of engaged dialogue (the complex). A book was never going to cut it in that sphere – it is a vast and open-ended endeavour that has no obvious limits, the full embrace of which no single person was ever going to approach.

This work, then, is where all that began – right in the middle. It therefore embodies one extreme of what is possible when you try to record such a vast emergent structure in written form alone. As indicated, it contains so much logical substructure and interconnected detail that most people couldn't follow it at the time, nor could they extract the broader structures for themselves. It was basically too deep, or perhaps I was simply showing it to the wrong people, this is also something that has become much clearer over time.

So what value does this have now? Of what use is it given that much more accessible territory than what is covered here has subsequently emerged and been captured in later works? The reason is simple: with so much ground to cover, I have not even scratched the surface yet, even after several decades of digging. And this is especially so in written form, which is quickly becoming secondary to dialogue.

Therefore, I suppose this old jalopy is wheeled out now only as an archive of sorts, a record – completely unedited – of a first attempt to capture an idea that had gradually emerged out of my own personal search. It is offered if only because it contains so much more foundational detail than my subsequent introductory works, meaning that the very thing that made it worthless back then may now make it valuable. Such detail – on its own – has no real power to provide much insight, because people get lost in the labyrinth. But now, all this detail may be more accessible perhaps, and more useful, within the context of whatever understanding the more recent works provide. I suppose you might say that the more recent works provide a map for this maze, making it easier to navigate. Implied in this, however, is that you may do well to begin there first, with the simpler maps (freely available at 2EQ.org).

Anyway, my hope now is that in the wake of those various simpler renderings people may now have the frame within which this original picture hangs, and that it might, therefore, now once again be useful to anyone who is seeking more detail in any area. And if it does turn out to be valuable in any sense, I suppose in time it may even be edited and indexed etc, like an old bum being tidied up, shaved, and invited to their own birthday party.

H.R.

INTRODUCTION

Cleaving the Diamond

What is really going on here? Is there a problem with human life? Why, exactly, are we so troubled and unhappy? And, perhaps more importantly, what can we do about it?

Philosophy, psychology, and sociology, in their various forms, could all ultimately be viewed as attempts to answer these great questions, each confronting issues which at first glance seem simple but are in fact immensely and deceptively complex. In the simplest terms, philosophy could be characterised as a quest to understand the world and our place in it; like a collection of lenses through which we might gaze at life to see it more clearly. Psychology, in all its guises, could be defined as something similar, but perhaps more akin to a series of mirrors in that the focus is far more directed toward self-awareness in particular. Leaving sociology lying somewhere in between I suppose. And if you look back through time, charting the emergence of every major advance in our understanding, I believe you can observe each new form as being something like a statement in an ongoing dialogue, an age old conversation humanity has been having with itself in order to get to the bottom of it all. It can all be boiled down to the same basic pursuit - a search for greater understanding - and we can only hope that each new or emergent idea represented some kind of progress.

Where, then, have all these valiant efforts left us? Because it would seem that even after all this time, with all the wisdom we have accrued, we are somehow still left wanting, and are once again faced with the very same question which has vexed so many for so long -

In which direction is true, deep and lasting happiness to be found?

We are supposed to be a wise species. We have learned much. We trust people to show us the way, and to light the path before us. But in light of the burgeoning situation now, it has to be asked – have we been placing trust in the right people? For, if anything, it seems that further insight is required now more than ever before. In spite of all our advancements in culture and technology we appear little closer to any lasting peace or unity of vision. We remain a pretty troubled species, at times absolutely ingenious and sublime, but just as often somehow deeply afflicted.

Some have even called this time the ‘end of history’, in that as we near the apparent exhaustion of our last great hope - science - we appear to be running out of options. Meaning we now have nowhere to turn – that with no more impending breakthroughs looming on the horizon, we are still in the same old mess we were before, or perhaps even worsening, leaving the future in many ways seeming increasingly bleak.

James Lovelock seems to think we’re already beyond redemption – that we’re already essentially screwed, already past the point of no return. Meaning that at some point the fragile ecosystems of the planet will collapse beneath the weight of increased population and consumption, and that this trajectory is already set – that it is now only a matter of time before there is what they call in systems theory a ‘correction’. Which sounds harmless enough eh...

Hundreds of millions of people, perhaps even billions, will die in that event. And it is, by many accounts, now imminent. Of course we don’t hear much about such things, and that is because we don’t like to face them. Panic will only make this situation worse. But those with all the information at their disposal, and who have nothing to protect [James is a very old fart by now] often see things in a more balanced and less biased way. They also know that we will not even try to fix it if we do not at least look.

If you want more info on such things, maybe try – www.dieoff.org, there are many many more.

Best (lowest) estimates put global consumption in 2005 at 25% more than the planet will sustain, and that we have only gone up since then, at an alarming rate. Things are bad. And we try to avoid thinking about it, which only fuels the unconscious suspicion that things are probably even worse than we think. Anyway, the informed consensus is grim. And there would probably be more action if we actually knew what to do about it. But we don’t. We don’t even know what can be done. To control the organic growth of civilization at this point would demand draconian measures, a policed state where lives were defined and consumption controlled. This is never going to happen now. Democracy truly is the best path, but the cost is freedom. And it is a cost, because it cannot be controlled, at least not only.

Play it forward then. We have seen it before, but never at this scale. Populations will continue to spiral out of control, and there will eventually be world wars over scarce resources. Who knows, but it will not look good. And this correction will continue, or be endlessly repeated, until we are restored to a manageable number which the planet can sustain. There is no ‘get out of jail free’ card when you are confronting planetary equilibriums. Gaia doesn’t have a conscience. Or if she does, then we may well be on the wrong side of it at this point. The Permian–Triassic boundary saw 95% of all life on Earth extinguished almost overnight. This has happened many many times before on this planet, we have records of many such events, and if the conditions for such are provided it will simply happen again. And that’s just what the planet’s defences might do to us, let alone what we might do to ourselves. And bear in mind that the fossil energy reserves will be depleted by

this time, or at least be very difficult and costly to extract. Which means the level we will need to be reduced to will actually be lower than we are at present, even by quite a bit.

It's like freefalling into a giant meat grinder, and yelling out –

“...Ok so far...”

Should we be scared? Perhaps, but fear as a function exists to produce action and change, and so in this case it is probably redundant. There is apparently nothing we can do. If everything we know at present is all there is to know, then this is simply going to happen. It is inevitable, unavoidable, absolutely imminent. All the debate now is just about when, not if.

The problems we are now facing, then, both individually and collectively, simply appear too big for anyone to emotionally engage. So much so that to allow them to become a part of everyday consciousness can only lead to powerlessness, despair and resignation. It is, therefore, no surprise that we have come to live in the ‘party generation’, a world full of people living for today because tomorrow may never come. Because, if asked in a moment of solemn reflection, many will quietly confide that they really don't believe we are going to make it; that despite whatever technological breakthroughs yet emerge, we are probably going to be the cause of our own undoing. Perhaps even because of any breakthroughs. And we are not, science is not, reaching these hearts and minds. And this is precisely because it does not have an answer.

I see kids smashing up bus stops, and I believe in time it will be seen quite clearly that their protest was actually valid. Society has in fact failed them, is failing them, profoundly. Common culture is deeply inept, in the most significant sense possible. And it is precisely because of this shortfall that we are facing a very dark time ahead, as the planet buckles under the load.

Whilst this gloomy forecast may seem a little dramatic, there is a lot of very carefully collected evidence to suggest that this is a fairly balanced appraisal of things. Indeed, if the social apprehension this view indicates was only shallow or fleeting then we would probably find it expressed more vocally. But it is a deep and abiding realisation, almost unavoidable, and carries much subjective weight, leaving in its wake a disconnected state, a kind of numb life undermined by deep and creeping anxiety. We are told to recycle, and to fix a dripping tap, and all the while we know that these are just placatory gestures designed to offer some sense of power and security. But we are not that dumb, not really. We all see the writing on the wall, even if we don't want to look. It all comes to naught if we can't stop India and China from developing, which we can't. We are hurtling towards oblivion with our eyes shut. And when this hurtling slows down we do not call that progress, we call it an economic recession. Something's simply got to give, sooner or later, and we know it. The result is that we appear to be losing hope on an increasingly slippery slope. And it is under this growing shadow that we must build our lives.

So what chance is there now, really? Given that this general subject seems to have been a perennial hot topic in our entire recorded history, what of any real significance are we really likely to discover now? Surely we've already sucked the well dry in our pursuit of understanding pertaining to happiness. What can we really hope to say that hasn't already been said? Why even bother with all this, if the situation is so hopeless?

It is in this context that I now offer this work. For this is where I believe we are both extremely fortunate, and unfortunate, at the same time. Because, I will assert, something has indeed been missed, something profoundly significant. Something almost entirely negative as it turns out, which is what's both fortunate and unfortunate. Unfortunate in that it directly confronts us with the existence of a truly epic negativity within ourselves, something we must work to understand and overcome. But fortunate in that it immediately brings to light a previously unnoticed potential – ie life beyond the removal of this massive but unrecognised burden. So the good news here is the bad news. The pain and unhappiness lying beneath the surface of life, or at least a great deal of it, does have a single definable cause. There is definitely something wrong, something big.

Seeing this 'something', however, will remain no mean feat. It's going to take the rest of our time here.

This, then, will be my contribution to this ongoing dialogue, and my central claim will be this: The single greatest hope for humanity, and the planet as a whole, has yet to be introduced into this picture. I am going to demonstrate a connection here, and draw a very long thread, but one I believe cannot be denied. And the connection is dramatic.

There is one distant glimmer of hope here still, one potently redeeming fact. And yes this might sound childishly positive. But the ground of that hope is in fact something so negative that most people cannot even bear to think about it, let alone look at it. Poetic irony. The very darkest fact of our existence may end up being our one saving grace, so dramatic that nobody has even considered it. And so simple to achieve, in relative terms, that it is staggering.

The simple thread is this:

We consume not because we need more than we have, but because we are unhappy, because we are not already deeply satisfied. And because we remain unsatisfied no matter how much we consume, we continue to consume. We consume far

more than natural happiness actually requires, and I believe this is not simply accidental or residual behaviour, but an active and dynamic outflow of something deeper again.

A Fork in the Road

There are in fact two basic views of life in one crucial sense, with two very different practical approaches which result. It should be noted, however, that our present culture conditions us to choose just one of these views so predominantly that you may not be aware that a second option even exists. But two there are, and the essential difference between them relates directly to what you perceive or believe the *basic conditions of happiness* to be. It should also be noted that these two perspectives cannot both be true, but are logically inconsistent with each other. If one is true then the other is, by definition, necessarily false.

- The first view generally sees the basic conditions for happiness as being relatively complicated and apparently varying between people. As quite an enigma in fact. Not easy to simply define, nor to fulfil.
- The second, then, sees them as being actually very simple and quite stable in nature, and consistent between people. Quite an easy mark to define, and also to meet.

It is probably pretty obvious that the view most commonly held at present is the former. And for the purposes of contrasting these two views - in all the discussions which follow - I am going to set the conditions of the second view rather low: at just the fulfilment of basic physical needs for food, clothing/shelter and basic social contact. Approximately the needs we presume for a chimpanzee. And I will take the liberty of presuming them already met in your case, ie that you have eaten today, have had a chat with someone who cares about you, and that your major limbs are not presently in imminent danger of being pulled off by a hundred foot giant squid. Leaving our discussions regarding happiness free to be those of a higher or deeper nature, focused exclusively on those issues which continue to remain problematic well beyond being simply healthy and secure. Because, as we will see, the kind of underlying dissatisfaction most people are dealing with has no obvious reason or overt cause.

As an aside, I'll also start off by presuming several other things as well. That we at least basically agree on the following –

- **We *all* seek to be happy.**
- **That you are *not* presently as consistently happy as you feel or believe you ultimately have the potential to be.**
- **That you are, therefore, confronting some degree of *unhappiness* in your life.**
- **And that from where you stand at present, you will naturally be seeking to *move toward* a happier state of being as time goes by.**

Yes? Yes. If your answer to any of these is *no*, then I wouldn't bother reading any further, for this will really have nothing to offer you.

If we now begin to contrast these two basic views, some obvious differences become apparent: The first view is one which generally sees unhappiness as the absence of something. This seems pretty obvious to most people: that to whatever degree unhappiness is present, then the conditions for happiness must obviously be, to that degree, absent.

This view also naturally tends to look OUTSIDE ourselves, to see what's missing, or for something negative to blame. And the practical orientation it delivers is generally one of manipulating outer circumstances somehow - sometimes involving negation, but mostly acquisition or creation. This is the common approach we already know and love.

So when we examine all the things we tend to think and do in search of happiness, one overriding tendency becomes clear: That if we are unhappy, we generally presume that the real 'conditions' for happiness are not present, and thus set about the task of 'acquiring' them. We automatically tend to assume this position because there is simply no other view available to explain our unhappy state. And whilst this basic presumption has deep practical implications, we almost never stop to question them. Instead, having concluded that something must be missing, we begin a process which inevitably results in a drive for outward acquisition - a kind of chronic 'consumerism' in pursuit of happiness. It is simply presumed that the solution to our problem generally demands activity of some sort. We feel we need to *get* more, *have* more or *become* more somehow if we are going to find true, deep and lasting happiness. Our whole culture and economy has come to be built on this basic conception.

In contrast, then, the other view is left to pick up the opposing proposition. That, generally speaking, the true conditions for happiness are normally already met. That happiness is effectively intrinsic to the human state, and that if some degree of unhappiness remains evident beyond the fulfilment of our physical requirements, then the implication can only be that our subjective capacity to experience such conditions *as* happiness is being actively disturbed or obstructed somehow. Inevitably, then, this view naturally tends to look WITHIN ourselves for the source of the implied disturbance. And the

practical orientation is generally one of negation, rather than creation. To get rid of something subjective, rather than gain something objective. To remove something internal, rather than acquire something external.

I am oversimplifying of course, but please bear with me. All subjective events are generated by us as activity we do inside; as some degree of effort and attention. Meaning that activity, in this case, could even be the source of the problem, and not the solution to it. A very different scenario to the first.

So an obvious contrast here is that these views are completely incompatible in practical terms. So if you act on the basis of one being true, and the other happens to be the case, then you would expect your progress to be very frustrating indeed. Which, incidentally, many people's pursuit of happiness happens to be. Pure coincidence of course!

Happiness, then, according to the first perspective, is something to be worked for and achieved in the same sense we ordinarily view achievement. In fact, due to the prevalence of what could be called 'low grade chronic unhappiness' in our society, many generally conceive it to be quite a significant achievement: the maintenance of a complex and delicate set of changing prerequisites; a relatively sophisticated event. And as the dominant worldview of our culture, this view really needs little introduction. It is the underlying model which human civilization has embodied and embraced as its general *modus operandi* for millennia. And our presumption, then, on the basis of observation and experience, is that happiness must be relatively complex in essence. After all, how can we avoid this conclusion, given that so many very capable people still seem to find it quite elusive.

The basic or underlying presumption of the common view, then, has to be something like this-

We are not naturally happy beings. Happiness is not innate or intrinsic to the human state, or perhaps even any state. It is, necessarily, something which must be added or found or in some way conjured into existence. And that we should, therefore, accept a fair degree of unhappiness as being natural and inevitable.

So what about the second view? Why do we hear so little about it? It has such obvious and serious implications in contrast to the common presumption, surely it's been considered? So why, exactly, has it been so consistently ignored as a possibility, even when the former view fails so blatantly to deliver the kind of outcomes we might desire?

Well, as we will now see, it has a few problems. And these lie in some of its less obvious ramifications. Not least of which are its cultural and philosophical implications, especially in terms of what it supports in the way of broader social values and belief structures. You see - our basic view of happiness deeply affects the form and function of the practical philosophies we adopt, both individually and collectively. Which, put simply, means that what we believe affects the way we act, the decisions we take, and the ways we relate. It has to, obviously. And how this relates to our discussion here is that each of the two views we are discussing, when projected into culture, becomes an alternative answer to the basic question - *Why are people unhappy?* And the nature of that answer deeply affects the kind of worldview members of that culture are likely to hold. Which in turn determines almost everything in life.

In this way, what we see around us is - in almost every respect - a direct reflection of the way we answer that simple question. And here, which is the point I'm getting to, we see our first main reason why society has resisted seriously examining this second view as a realistic alternative to the one we know - *The elements of our culture it brings into question are simply too many*. Which means, essentially, that the threatening cultural and philosophical implications of this second view are too broad and sweeping for it to be even considered. It would be a revolution, because they go right down to very fundamental issues. After all, given that the second view potentially requires little or no outward acquisition at all, we would have to question the entire 'outward focused acquisition based approach' to life, which would then be to question the very symbol of success in our modern world - money.

I mean, think about it- what would it do to the economy if we had *poor* people being *unreasonably happy*?!! It's just too threatening to the status quo when you examine the implications of it possibly being true. It would be a disaster.

Another obvious reason the second view has not been considered is that if we are naturally or innately happy beings, then - logically - there are certain things this would immediately imply about the nature of whatever is creating the supposed disturbance. Things which make it difficult to accept. It just doesn't seem sensible.

I mean, we certainly don't appear to be innately happy. Deep and easy happiness is definitely the exception for a lot of people, a lot of the time. So for such an inner disturbance to be upholding the appearance of innate unhappiness so consistently is difficult to believe. It would have to be very busy! And although the reported experience of happiness would seem to be reasonably consistent between people - the types, forms and apparent origins of common unhappiness would seem to be very disparate, and often quite stable in effect. Meaning that, for a significant proportion of all those various forms to be sourced in a single dynamic process, that process would have to be very complex and somewhat multi-faceted.

I mean, the human system is remarkably adaptive, especially when it comes to finding ways of avoiding unhappiness. Surely we would have 'lapses' of profound happiness as this disturbance faltered occasionally?

So, on the face of it, for an active disturbance to achieve such, so consistently, and on so many levels of such a complex and dynamic system, it would demand such a high degree of integrity and organisation that it would seem to defy all reasonable probability. It would have to be highly polymorphous, its complexity and depth astonishing, its presence universal amongst all people, and its functional invisibility almost seamless. After all, whilst on one hand all this would indicate wide spread amongst people, it simultaneously proposes that it has been entirely overlooked. It just seems entirely unreasonable as a possibility that any active disturbance could display such characteristics, and be so persistent and consistent in doing so. Not to mention, why? What would possibly motivate such? From what origins? Lots and lots of questions. So here we see a second great pitfall: It just doesn't seem to stack up as very likely or probable.

Thirdly, then, even if it seemed probable, we confront the last great obstacle: we simply wouldn't know where to start in defining even the most basic terms required to get a handle on such a presence.

The problem here is very simple: the target of our interest is almost entirely subjective in nature. Which means it cannot be quantified, measured or directly observed in any 'real' or 'objectively verifiable' sense. We can't 'poke' it to see what it is. I mean, who is the happiest person you have ever met? Exactly, how would you know for sure? What is significant about this is that because the inevitable bias of classical science is toward observation and evidence, it has meant the whole issue of subjective experience has ended up falling outside the traditional jurisdiction of what we have come to call the 'hard' sciences. Leaving it prone to endless speculation, interpretation, and debate. And, therefore, mostly ignored by any serious academics looking to advance themselves within an enclosed system.

And ignored not only, it would seem, because subjective experience offers little in the way of empirical evidence or proof, but because the subjective realm also seems to display far less obvious integrity or cohesion than the far more consistent outer realm of experience. There seem to be far fewer laws of governance to be gleaned from inner phenomenon. The inner world simply makes less sense, and is restricted by fewer obvious underlying patterns capable of being extrapolated into general principles. It would appear much more a personal reality than a shared one, undermining a fundamental premise of science itself: That there is, in fact, only one reality.

Science, then, our best defence against ignorance, has predominated in the outer realm where things are less speculative, marginalising the study of the inner realm to the fringes. With few exceptions it has persistently and consistently avoided the inner realm of experience, which has been a great loss. For whilst the emergence of the scientific method rapidly did away with all manner of delusion and misconception regarding the outer world, it has, as yet, allowed many myths pertaining to the inner world to survive and even prosper in its wake. Which is not to say that reason and science cannot apply to our inner experiences, just that they must account for their subjective nature and accommodate that in their modes of conduct. Which is something we already do in many fields of interest when we have to. Where direct evidence is lacking, we can actually rely on logic and reason to bridge the gaps.

In the end, however, the important point is that almost all of our historical scientific development has gone in the other direction - Outwardly. And whilst contemporary psychology has done what it can to bridge this void, we still don't have even the most basic frameworks of understanding required to begin to comprehend the kind of presence I am indicating here, not in meaningful terms anyway. And the theoretical construction required to develop these frameworks would be an overwhelming discouragement to the acceptance of any proposition which would demand such.

So if you put these things together - The practical and philosophical threat it poses, its apparent improbability, and the massive theoretical construction it would require if true, you can begin to see why this path has not often been seriously contemplated. Even though looking for alternatives does still make a certain amount of sense given the very marginal performance of the incumbent view. This one is, quite simply, in the 'way too hard' basket. It threatens the status quo at too many levels, far beyond any immediate practical implications. You could say, in many respects, that if this were true we would have to start civilization again from scratch, and that's obviously not a very appealing prospect.

Nevertheless, you may have already guessed from my opening where I am going to be heading in this work. That in direct contrast to the so-called 'positive' orientation we are perpetually pacified by, I am going to be heading in exactly the opposite direction. I will be asserting that this is exactly the case, paradoxically finding great solace in the most terrible of conclusions: that we are in fact very deeply troubled. And also that this affliction is far worse than we generally consider, or would ever like to accept. That we are all confronting a significant presence which, whilst we feel its effects, has remained almost entirely unrecognised as being separate to our true native state, and therefore undifferentiated from it. A profoundly equilibrating dynamic conflict with clear functional implications, and massive subjective impact. And whilst this seemingly universal presence doesn't necessarily kill you, it can surely stop you from living. For whilst it does not prevent happiness outright, it can certainly make it a whole lot more difficult. By, amongst other things, effectively preventing us from experiencing the native conditions *for* happiness, *as* happiness. Not that this is its only effect by any means, but a particularly significant one from a conscious standpoint.

So really, what I want to do here is try to prepare you for that journey. To somehow indicate the journey we will be taking, and what it will demand.

The problem I face here is that this idea is simply too big, in more ways than one, and that you are very likely not ready for such. Indeed, it is no longer in our culture to even look for such things, except perhaps in fantasy and fiction.

The Greatest Fallacy of All Time –

Every picture ever taken of the human state is actually a picture of two things, not one. Every psychological model, every sociological theory, every behavioural outline, is the story of two quite distinct events unfolding.

This, the fusion of these two, and the presumption that they are one, is the greatest fallacy of all time. It is a confusion so deep, and so pervasive, that it infiltrates every level of society and cultural institution. And please bear in mind here that I am not talking about good and evil, or any other simplistic or mythic concept.

This secondary event is in fact a very serious problem, but one which with understanding also represents the opportunity of providing a very serious solution. Differentiating these two, however, is no mean feat. The relationship between these two ‘organisms’ is a complex and deceptive one. Meaning that the differentiation of these two is one of the few remaining frontiers.

So I am not going to offer you the answer here, as much as I am going to finally deliver to you the problem. What we will find is that the answer we have been searching for, the missing piece, is itself not a solution, but a problem. ‘The’ problem actually, the one we are all faced with solving. We haven't found what we are looking for simply because we have not been able to even define what the real problem is.

We have all the tools required as a society, we are smart enough by miles, it could be we simply haven't picked up the right scent. We've simply been disoriented, looking in the wrong direction. But knowing the real problem can change all this. It stops us barking up the wrong trees in search of answers, which is precisely what we have been doing. The solution, if there is one, is always hidden in the problem itself, in understanding it clearly enough and with enough depth of insight.

And this will be my claim - When you see what the problem really is, what might be done about it becomes completely obvious.

What follows, then, is not the answer you have been seeking. It is, at last, simply the core anatomy of the real problem you have faced for your entire life.

Common human life is a product of these two, then, intertwined at every level in an exquisitely complex dance. And there is great power in just seeing it. To know this, to finally see what is really going on, is to have your dignity restored. When you see the true nature of the adversary you have been confronting, and just how formidable it is, you begin to see courage everywhere, your compassion returns not only for others, but also for yourself.

But most of all, the final thing to know about this secondary event is that it is not intrinsic – it can be removed. It can be pruned and managed, yes, even put to work if desired, but it can also be completely relinquished in its entirety. Not easily, in our present state of understanding, but we are – as a culture – about to open this right up for the first time.

The significance of such a possibility is obviously precisely equal to the gravity of the event which is removed. And the point here is – it is enormous. Only when you see the scale and depth and dynamic impact of this event does the potential of removing it assume its real proportions. It is a staggering possibility, no mean feat, but just the fact that it is possible is like the sun coming up on hope, for us all.

This potential is not new by the way, for as long as we have had this affliction there have been occasional people who have found their way clear of it, very rare, but there nevertheless. This enigmatic occurrence has never been understood, however, nor been able to be transmitted to others for this reason, with the resulting negative social distortions almost always outweighing the benefits the original event bestowed. It has been wildly misrepresented. For whilst the individual impact of such an event is epic subjectively, in that a person's capacity to be simply and freely happy is restored, the real significance of this state is in fact quite practical.

This secondary event is the cause of common unhappiness. Now that's a bold statement, but I will now begin to explain exactly how and even why in more detail again. But just before we do, it is worth glimpsing the bigger picture here and what's at stake –

Human unhappiness is consuming the planet. So the significance of finding a cause of such, and of potentially removing it, is dramatic.

It really could be that the native human state is very simple. That happiness is easy, and doesn't cost much. That, by and large, we have already crossed the finish line by miles, and that this fact is simply being obscured by something completely unnecessary.

Just a clarification then – what we are talking about here are motive agendas, they are the reasons you do what you do. They are the underlying foundations of what you think and feel, and how you act as a result. So most people aren't accustomed to this. Things such as feeling and thoughts and impulses – what you might think of as deep things – are actually the surface level phenomena here, the shallowest level. We will be going much much deeper than that.

At first this basic idea is always too much to take in. What it means is this: there is a part in each of us which has been presumed to be a normal and necessary aspect of being human, but which is actually an unnecessary body of activity based solely on false imagination. The point of which is that an enormous degree of stress and 'apparent need' is generated as a result of this redundant and effortful activity, and that it has never before been differentiated in any clear way from the rest of natural human functioning. It shows us that to the degree this body of activity dominates life then the reason most people are unhappy is not because they cannot find what they want, it is because they are seeking to fulfil needs they do not actually have - needs they are not biologically equipped to fulfil, even if they could be fulfilled. With no foundation in organic reality, these needs are nevertheless felt emotionally, and that emotion is very real.

What this opens up is a potential which has always been there, and one which may well have been realised at times purely by accident – that of removing this surplus activity, and thereby removing all the resulting activity and constant stress. In particular, what it opens up is the possibility of working together to further define and differentiate this activity with a view to allowing people to relinquish this activity strategically.

On an individual scale this whole idea effectively delivers another paradigm, another whole view of life which requires significant re-working of the way we view things in general, and the way we view ourselves. The biggest thing you can 'get' in life is actually to 'un-get' this affliction. And it is free, at least it is once you get there.

The confusion of this secondary event with native humanity is so deep that introducing this possibility into the picture creates a need to redefine nearly every aspect of our view of life and self. The longstanding philosophical nuts this idea cracks are many and great. It effectively forces a fundamental reconsideration of the very nature of human existence as we generally conceive of it from the position of our subjective captivity within this simmering dilemma. But such rude awakening is simply the sun coming up at last, because it also introduces a possibility without equal. In that the negativity such activity might represent in terms of suffering and limitation is obviously exactly equal to the degree of positive emancipation which might be experienced in the wake of its removal. Which from an individual perspective represents a subjective awakening of unparalleled proportions. But, and which is the point, that does not even begin to measure the collective implications of such.

This wider collective potential has remained largely untouched and unnoticed, then, ever since this imposter has been amongst us, probably since before we began sitting around campfires and learning to speak. And this is because the individual potential has remained hidden in plain sight. What we are discussing here is the summary removal of a dilemma that is otherwise functionally intractable if addressed at only a surface level without any perspicacious insight as to its real nature and origins. And so the elucidation of this underlying event – where it came from, how it works, and exactly where the boundaries are between it and natural humanity – stands to ultimately unleash a tide of emancipation. It shows us very clearly why all shallower approaches to addressing the particular stresses this inner conflict creates are ultimately doomed to failure, but also how solving this issue at its root might well make all those other efforts unnecessary. When you see just how deep the conflict is, and how much pain it causes, and how universally it afflicts humanity at this time, the gravity of this whole possibility begins to finally dawn upon you.

As ridiculous as it sounds to say it, of all the advancements in understanding that have ever improved the lives and happiness of people, this might eventually turn out to be the greatest. Perhaps even by some margin. It could even be the originating spark of individual transformation which ignited what we now call religion, but which – because it could not be defined or transmitted – was almost immediately lost, leaving in its wake social structures which are only able to control individuals rather than free them. And if so then it was right in front of us all along, just waiting to be brought to light.

It is not just theory, however, which is I suppose what I am trying to prepare you for here. Adequately defining this event in theory, and thereby allowing collective development to begin, could make this potential increasingly accessible and ultimately unlock a wave of transmission – like a virus going airborne. It could all have very far-reaching consequences as it begins to unfold in practice. And if that happens, then it will only have been because what such understanding defined was accurate, because it was actually already the case. Understanding reality does not create potentials, it only makes existing potentials more accessible. Which means – if this is even broadly accurate – that this potential has always existed, sitting there just waiting to be realised.

If ever there was a time for this to happen, it is now. I for one do not believe it is too late for us, not when you add something like this into the picture.

Muddy Water and Smoke Screens

The situation just defined is why human beings are an enigma, even to themselves. They don't seem to make much sense in the same way as even our closest relatives can be understood. Human behaviour simply does not conform to any model ever devised, none of them are capable of accurately predicting or explaining why we do what we do, or even how.

This is the result of the very confusion I am speaking of. It is the result of there being two quite distinct processes occurring, both extremely complex, and both fused in a perpetual dynamic union. And we ourselves, being the subject of that, never gain an opportunity to step outside it and look back. It is the one thing we can't see, because we are always looking from it and not at it, leaving it permanently invisible to our awareness.

When they produce artificial intelligence, this is why it never acts like a human being, because they don't have the elementary structure right. This is also why people act completely differently in artificial worlds, such as online gaming. It is because those worlds are fair, because there are no fundamental underlying conflicts in the architecture of such situations, because whilst they were designed to be challenging they also make sense. It is possible to win, but in real life the situation I am indicating makes this somewhat more unlikely, no matter how well you play. In some ways it makes it impossible. So such representations don't ultimately look or act like the real world, or like real life, because they have missed the essential thing – a conflict which defines almost the whole picture of how we work, the primary defining fact. And I am certainly not suggesting we try to make games more like real life – I am suggesting that real life can once again be restored to a fair and equitable pattern by removing the underlying conundrum, and that this will only be possible if we can find the capacity to explore such depths. Only the nature of these two, and their relationship, defines the whole picture of human life in great resolution and depth. This detailed anatomy, capturing it fully, is the elusive holy grail not only of philosophy, but also of both psychology and sociology. And we are not going to be able to do that here in this brief introduction, for it is a territory to explore, not just an idea to convey. But we can do our best to track into this realm, and visit at least a few good vantage points from where you can get a pretty good view of what the last great frontier holds in wait for us.

A kind of 'alien view' is required, a view from the outside in. We need to begin to separate the two events, for only then do things begin to change, and the mystery begins to dissolve. Which can be somewhat tricky given that we are sitting right in the middle of it.

In concrete terms, what this requires is the construction of three distinct anatomical models: Firstly: the native system, how it works, its origins and essential nature. Secondly: the added or secondary event, how it works, its origins and essential nature. And then both of them together, their relationship to each other, and the complex interplay which results. I.e. the native agenda, the subversive agenda, and the 'common state'.

It must be noted that even one of these tasks represents a very significant feat. The native or intrinsic human system alone is by far and away the most complex single structure yet encountered in the universe as we know it. Not a jigsaw puzzle, it is a machine, a dynamic and organic event. No wonder perhaps that it still remains somewhat mysterious. The secondary event, as we will see, is equally complex, if not more so in some respects, and equally fluid and dynamic. Leaving the final synthesis of the two dynamic models, in practice, almost unfathomable in its range of potential expressions. It is a mind bender.

Here we see the power of abstraction, but also the demands of such. Some things are simply too complex to think about in any meaningful terms, like global economics for instance. There is just no way to think about global economics without somehow losing the essence of it in the process, it is just too vast and dynamic, for it ultimately includes everything, including what you had for breakfast this morning.

The only option in such circumstances, if you want any meaningful result from your efforts, is to simplify and abstract the essential systems involved into powerful and accessible models. You can go too far however, and lose the essence of what you are studying, so a balance must be sought. Which in this particular case – because we are going to be studying the most complex system ever discovered – means that it is actually not possible to render these models in any terms less than that of dynamic systems. Which means it will not make sense to you unless you can think in these terms. Because no linear model can capture a dynamic event, no matter how hard you try. That is a mismatch of terms, like explaining colours in terms of thickness, or music in terms of weight.

Perhaps an outline of what to expect might be useful: In Section One I'll start off with a closer look at the obvious surface levels of life, to see if we can pick up evidence of the underlying problem I am discussing in terms you will already recognise. As you will hopefully see there, it is already right in front of you, but simply not recognized. Then in Section Two, in order to get beneath the surface to what is really going on, I must begin constructing a deeper view, by first defining the native human condition as it would exist if free of systemic conflict. Then Section Three adds to this the origins and nature of this secondary presence, culminating in a re-definition of the common human state taking both agendas into account. The full-length version of this complex and sophisticated definition is the heart of my work. But what you will get here is merely an outline. Finally, in Section Four, a look at what it all might mean. What - if anything - might be done about this very complex situation, and what that might all mean for the individual, for society, and for the Earth itself.

The implications of the broad concept are staggering once you understand the significance of what is being proposed. This simple idea suggests such a deep error of omission in contemporary views that it literally commands a sweeping

reconsideration of almost every aspect of the human condition as we generally understand it. So I am warning you, it will stretch your understanding of life, and challenge your basic view of yourself.

In the end I'm not going to try to convince you that there is a problem with human life. If you don't already presume this then you are - in my opinion - probably beyond help. In that case put this down and go about your happy life. You will simply not enjoy this journey. Because I can promise you this – following me as I pull this all apart and lay it bare before you will not be the most comfortable experience. This is something we are all deliberately not looking at. It is the primary taboo, both personally and socially; the one thing nobody ever talks about at parties; the thing we are afraid of in ourselves, and which we certainly keep hidden from others. But such is the price of freedom in this case – if we cannot look at it, we will never be able to understand or address it.

In the end my own conviction is this – I believe it is simply not possible to roundly understand the common human condition without first taking this dramatic underlying dilemma into account. It is simply the most important thing to know about the common human state. Which, amongst other things, also makes it the single most important thing to know about being happy. It is, however, no fairytale. We need a deep answer now, more than ever before. But it is dark down there in the deep. Be warned.

SECTION ONE

This book began merely as a series of letters to a friend who wanted to know what I was so obsessed with as I tinkered like some old hermit out in the old shed of my mind. And in the first version to come together from all that, this first section (one of the first things I ever wrote) was eventually reduced to a cursory summary, as a result of it simply being too vast and open-ended as a subject. I essentially edited the entire section out, except for this brief outline. I felt it was distracting in a sense. But it is also a good place to start, if only because what it details is essentially what has been taken from us by the underlying event the rest of this work will be seeking to elucidate – which one the one hand means that it can be valuable if what you are seeking is to restore what was lost, but also that it is basically heading in the opposite direction to the rest of the work.

The problem we will be addressing in the remainder of this work is like having a big pig loose in the vegetable garden – the problem in this instance is that it is an invisible pig. And this means the main answer in this case is not in the answer (the lost positivity), it is in the problem (the active negativity). We first need to see it. But even if you do get to see this disturbing presence, and successfully remove it, you still have to fix up the mess, and if you can't remember what the garden is ideally supposed to look like then this could be difficult.

Essentially: the removal of negativity means nothing if we do not understand the positivity we are seeking to ultimately recover, so we must always have this in mind. But we have been snagged on this branch for so long that even once freed, many may have completely forgotten where they were originally heading, or even how to remember. Our original fire of creativity is often just a dull ember that now needs to be reignited, restoring its natural blaze.

This whole subject, as a definition of ideal positive functioning, is also significant to look at for the reason that some people still seem to manage it, regardless of the underlying forces that might tend to erode such. Some people are simply such good gardeners that even with the pig stomping around they still do a pretty good job.

Conversely, it is worth defining if only because there appear to be quite a few people who have successfully removed this pig, but who do not seem to ever restore what was lost. In which case they have basically wasted their time, not to mention the time and energy of those who see these people as teachers.

Therefore, that short summary version of section one has once again been included directly below. But also, if only because it so comprehensively shines a light on the target of our quest, you will now find the full version – along with its large appendix – published separately, because to include it here would have made this book more than 450 pages. So if you are seeking the full and original form of this section, as it was originally put down, that book is called 'A Sense of Completion', and it is still worth reading prior to this big work, if only because it shows us where we must eventually return once we have eliminated the cause of all the destruction, and, therefore, what that all ultimately means.

The Life You Desire

First a look at the surface of life, and what we already presume about happiness. For the purpose of illustrating certain points, our common pursuit of happiness can be divided into two basic approaches - *inner* and *outer*.

Inner

On the *inner* front, as we see people looking within themselves for answers, we most commonly see people addressing the relationship between their conscious frontal persona and their deeper self: what I will call the 'core', the deeper drives and impulses which define the foundations of our particular character.

A lack of integrity between these two elements of ourselves can certainly be a lasting source of unhappiness. Energetic impulses and influences from the core are designed to be expressed at a surface level. If not integrated and expressed, they wreak havoc and need to be contained somehow. The result of such repression and denial is inner stress. So relaxing and adapting our frontal 'masks' so that they better fit the needs and requirements of our deeper self is perhaps our culture's most travelled path on the inner front. Quite rightly so perhaps. This is a huge subject and there is a whole branch here to be explored, but I will leave it as a stump for the moment and move on.

Beyond this, then, we see that the core itself - in its natural state - is designed to be in a continuous state of change as it adapts to ever changing circumstances. The core of emotive functioning is attachment. Attachment represents relational need and signifies the amount of energy the system will sacrifice to protect its connection to a source of fulfilment. 'Deep emotive processes' maintain and modify attachment so as to always be relevant and appropriate. Deep emotive processes produce change, and make the healthy emotive core the fluid and dynamic thing it is. Not emotional attachments per se, these are the processes which manage such.

These same deep emotive processes also fulfil other vital roles, including our capacity to absorb emotional impacts. They are functions which heal emotional wounds and restore damaged equilibrium. But it would also seem that these processes can become suspended or frozen in a kind of fixated state as a result of trauma or stress, and that our capacity to adapt in a fluid manner can be dramatically affected as a result. This kind of damage can also affect the relationship between frontal and core as discussed above, damaging the overall integrity of that working connection. So we can also see how, in seeking to restore greater integrity to that frontal-core relationship, we may inevitably be led to address some degree of fixation or dysfunction at this deeper level within ourselves.

So here we see the backdrop for the second main path taken on the *inner* front. That of confronting and bringing to 'closure' processes in ourselves which were once started, but never finished. Thus purging ourselves of what might be called heavy and redundant emotional baggage, the residual effects of historical impacts to our emotive core. And there is obviously another whole branch to be added here and expanded, but once again I will move on. There is a lot to cover.

In summary then, a question both of these approaches ask can be boiled down to this -

Should we trust and follow what we feel? Should we submit to our own deeper energies, and allow emotion to flow?

Outer

When it comes to *outward* approaches, our common view is pretty easy to define - Happiness, it is presumed, is simply a matter of *desire* over *satisfaction*. Knowing what you want, and getting it. This is what we presume, but very few of us ever really apply this in practice fully or without reservation. So what does that take? And what would happen if we did?

I will focus here on the 'knowing' part, as this seems to be where we get stuck. Achieving your desires, if they are realistic, can be presumed to be relatively easy. All you require for that is courage and commitment, each of which is simply a decision.

This approach seems basically sound, at least at first glance. A positive orientation in life is clearly better than a negative one. Simply because there are a million and one things in life that we *don't* want, and that by moving away from those we are not necessarily moving toward what we *do* want. If we understand that emotion is energetic tension designed to produce relational action and change, and we apply a positive orientation, then we can see how *desire* might be better than *aversion* as a focus around which to define your life. Ideally then, in terms of the relationship of core to frontal as discussed above, we see the interests of the system being naturally represented in the formation of desire. But we can also see that a positive orientation demands a more proactive approach to life, in contrast to simply waiting around for something to shunt you along. Desire is something we produce and uphold in order to disturb ourselves, and produce action toward a more desirable state.

We can also see how our scattered active desires might be most effective when integrated into a larger vision, rather than dispersed like sled dogs all pulling in different directions. We can never have everything we might want at an outer level of

life, simply because many things are just not possible. There are limitations and conflicts in life. But we should never confuse this fact with not being able to have what we want ultimately, at a core level. We must differentiate these two levels, and come to see that the core level does actually make sense, and that whilst fulfilling such might be complex or sophisticated, a situation can be found to fulfil it. It is simply that we must find a way to translate our core desires into a single outward vision, one which does not conflict with itself, but still fulfils core desires. Desire must be formulated into a larger integrated 'vision', and presumably some resulting plan of action. The formation of this vision, because it integrates all systemic desire, can be defined as the ideal functioning of our system, what those working on the 'inner' front are striving to emancipate. Hidden in your core is your calling, your passion, your unique character and potential. A symptom of having lost touch with your core is that you don't know what you want. And if you don't know what you want, at least in some essential sense, you really don't know who you are.

The question here then, is - 'What do I really want? And it is your capacity to answer this deceptively simple question that defines progress on the path of personal growth. Because an integrated vision of what you truly desire is the point of positive integrity at which all emotive and creative functioning converges.

If we examine this, however, we see that we don't generally adopt this approach fully in practice or apply it in the way we live. So why not? After all, this would seem to be how the system is designed to work.

Well, we can immediately see a few reasons for this. A positive orientation is better than a negative one. An active orientation is better than a passive one. Integrated vision is better than scattered desires. But the shift to each of these involves certain demands and greater levels of active responsibility for the creation of what you desire in life. It is a process we are often not taught, and involves a significant degree of creative energy and self-responsibility. In other words, 'couch potatoes' need not apply.

There are also many other factors which come into play here to influence how fully we embrace our own creative potential. Foremost amongst which must be that powerful and integrated desire is as much a destroyer as it is a creator. It is an agent for change. True and connected desire formulated on the basis of profound emotional self inquiry has its own creating energy. The very process of asking animates processes which are designed to *influence* your conscious will, not to be a *servant* to it. In asking the question you are awakening your own deeper self, and you cannot simply turn it off again if it becomes uncomfortable to the status quo. Thus, to get what you really desire in life you must often be prepared to let go of what you already have. Which for many people, because they are so far removed from what they truly desire, means that the key to finding their true passion lies at least partly in their willingness to *surrender* to what arises, to *go* wherever it leads, and *do* what it takes. Without this willingness, such an inquiry - because of the pointless tension it would create - will always come back blank. Your own deeper system will not allow the formulation of true passion if it will simply not have the room it requires to fly. You must first 'open the gate' before the core will 'whip the bull'.

Another stumbling block is that the creative synthesis of diverse energies and desires an integrated vision often requires also demands a degree of original thinking which we are not generally taught or accustomed to achieving. It often poses a question which the conscious mind has no chance of answering, and which can only be addressed by harnessing the resources of the 'power brain', the unconscious mind. Which is itself another whole topic I will once again leave as a stump.

So we can immediately see some reasons why we may shy away from fully embracing this way of being. There are, however, many processes by which we may actively support this approach. Every motivational guru has another slant. And there is no reason why we cannot take everything above into account and fully apply ourselves to this path: To submit ourselves without reservation to the formulation of our deepest desires into an active and integrated vision of life as we desire it. And to be prepared to follow that dream. In fact if you examine what you already presume about life and happiness you will probably see that this is what you are already doing, if only by degrees.

What, then, is the result of such when this approach is applied without reservation? The optimum fulfilment of desire? - Happiness?

Well, that would be nice, but this is simply not the case. Certainly this dramatic shift can make a huge difference for most people in their lives. The mere shift toward a positive orientation can be a revolution for many. It is movement in the right direction. But what we see here really - once all the wrinkles are ironed out in the practice of defining a life vision - is that a final synthesis almost always remains elusive. It would seem that the very point of integrity this whole approach presumes and relies upon is lacking full integrity. Desire itself seems to be somewhat disturbed or conflicted, which brings this whole approach and philosophy into question.

It can be seen that the process we are examining here is actually nothing more than the natural function of the frontal conscious self. The frontal self is charged with taking impulses and influences from the emotive core and forging them into a relational programme which fulfils the system's underlying interests. The conscious frontal self is merely the tip of an enormous functional iceberg, in which even the deepest desire is still only a surface level event. The frontal self can't see deeper than emotion, and is not supposed to. Which is how it should be. Except that in the event of some kind of fault, the frontal self cannot look deeper than the level of desire in order to understand or address any apparent conflict. And even if it

could see deeper, it is not supposed to question influence from the core, because it would be meddling with its own foundations. The whole frontal system is designed to presume the integrity of the emotive core. To the degree we question, we are supposed to suffer. Which would be okay if the core could not ever suffer from conflict, but apparently - in our case - it can. And this is where we get stuck.

So for the frontal self a conflict in the formation of desire is an irresolvable dilemma. And because desire ultimately represents a summary of all systemic interests, such a conflict strikes to the very heart of life. It either signifies that needs are themselves lacking in integrity, or that needs are somehow being misrepresented. Either way it produces relational demands which are simply impossible for the frontal self to fulfil.

As I mentioned in the introduction, this conflict has historically been presumed to be intrinsic. And in the face of this, some people have responded with the opposite approach the same view of happiness prescribes - That if happiness is a matter of *desire* over *satisfaction*, then instead of seeking satisfaction, why not simply negate *desire*? And here we see the foundations of all the austere and ascetic approaches to human life and happiness. That you can be happy on a bed of nails.

The Buddhists say that attachment is the root of all suffering. Desire is a form of attachment.

So the question here, once again, is whether or not to follow what you feel? In particular - is *desire* valuable? Can we trust our own energies to direct us in life?

By the time I am finished I intend to have comprehensively answered this question, and put this age old bone of contention to rest.

My simple assertion at this point is that what we see here is evidence of a deeper conflict within the system. Desire, as we encounter it within ourselves, is actually neither all good as some would have it, nor all bad, but a dynamic mixture of both. And that it is also not true that this conflict constitutes an inherent conflict between good and evil in man. No, this conflict is not intrinsic to us at all.

This conflict is, however, the real underlying reason we do not embrace desire as an absolute axiom around which to live. Because to do so simply creates suffering. It just doesn't work.

So whilst the common 'fulfilment' based approaches seek to integrate many dysfunctional elements of desire which are not native to us, the 'austere' approaches do the opposite and throw out the baby with the bathwater. To which you might say there is a balance to be found. But to the contrary, I believe there is a differentiation to be made, and that on the basis of such, an entirely different path becomes available.

So this has been as good a place as any to start, with a quick look at the surface of life, and the surface of this conflict. I hope this at least offers you some glimpse of the scope of what I am proposing, and how it is already reflected in your own life. Desire is an appropriate place to start in examining the underlying dilemma because the formation of primary level *desire* comprehensively reflects the integrity of the system as a whole. The conflict in the formation of desire therefore perfectly reflects the underlying conflict. And it is a struggle most people can already relate to, although they often never suspect its profundity, or that it is the result of something far deeper - perhaps because at this shallow level of depth it is impossible to differentiate native from added. We must go deeper again if we wish to examine what really goes on well beneath the surface.

So onward, and into the real stuff. All this has still just been the introduction really. There is nothing here really that new, and you'll find lots of books on this kind of thing in any good bookshop.

We've now got to get beneath the surface of all this mayhem and see if we can't find a bit of order in the apparent chaos. And that's going to take a whole new perspective altogether. So this is as far as common knowledge of life can take us in terms of understanding this conflict and the struggle it produces. We've chased the rabbit of discontent to the very edge of conscious experience, only to watch as it disappears down another deeper hole again. And what we found is very promising in light of there being a deeper causal issue, but it is clearly not deep enough to make any real difference to it. So under we go...

SECTION TWO

Organic Psychology

In this section my job will be to outline the native human state, free of the conflict I am indicating, including all the essential subjective anatomy required to explain that conflict. This, therefore, will be a far deeper view than the common one.

From the typical perspective of the conscious self, desire and emotive tension etc are seen as being deepest level events. But when viewing the underlying functioning of our own system, emotive tension and desire etc are only the surface level. This perspective must go much deeper to examine real primary level functioning.

The main obstacle to defining human functioning is its degree of obvious sophistication and complexity. I must, therefore, resort to being brutally simplistic if I am going to make any headway here at all. A more refined treatment of this beautiful system will have to wait until a later date.

First of all, I can conceive of no way to meaningfully define the essential functioning of the native human system without first defining the context in which it has arisen, and the origins of organic structure in general - evolution. So back to the very start we must go.

The Cosmos

Something is happening. Well, that's probably obvious, but I thought I'd better check that we at least agree on that. *Why* something is happening we may never know, and I will not seek to answer such profound questions here. But there are many things we can know with a fair degree of certainty about *what* is happening. At least as it directly relates to us. We can't know everything, but I believe if we look carefully we can probably know more than enough.

Before I proceed, however, I must first take the time to establish some of the elementary terms of reference I'm going to need in order to explain all this in my very simplistic fashion. Hopefully these will be simple and practical enough to allow you to directly observe them in your own life, and see them in action.

Energy and structure –

- Everything which exists has *structure*. Everything has form, in one way or another, a definite quality which defines it as distinct from every other thing. Structure is universal.
- Everything which exists is - or is reducible to - *energy*. All physical structure [mass] is ultimately composed of energy.¹

Energy and structure are somewhat interchangeable with each other in substance, making them a little slippery to define in a concrete and usable way. So, as I am going to use these terms, my meaning will be somewhat looser than the classical physical meaning. I simply want to use the relationship between energy and structure as a kind of descriptive metaphor in order to explain and define a few points about the way things function and act in reality. So I will therefore use their common meanings.

Structure = The manner in which an organism or other complete whole is constructed.

Energy = A bodies power of doing work by virtue of stresses resulting from its relation to other bodies.

¹ For anyone not familiar: The amount of energy contained in any given structure was what Einstein defined in the equation $E=MC^2$. [Which turned out to be much more than had been previously thought, giving rise to the concept of nuclear power via the conversion of a small amount of matter into its equivalent in energy. As well as giving rise to the bomb].

The Principles of Change –

With these simple terms we can begin to outline a few elementary relationships and principles of change in the known physical universe –

1 –

The first thing to know about everything we observe is relatively simple: The universe moves in pursuit of equilibrium. Tensions resolve, pressures release, vacuums fill. The universe is generally defined as what physicists call a ‘dissipative structure’. The universe as we know it is thus presumed to have begun at some point of ultimate tension - a theory now well confirmed - because it is observably running down, like a wind-up toy.

Tensions resolve over time, and the result of this process is energy.

2 –

Energy, therefore, always flows toward the resolution of tension. And in keeping with this - which is important to remember - energy intrinsically takes the easiest path possible, without exception.

Energy follows the path of least resistance.

3 –

Structural relationships are what provide tension. Whether you are talking macro or micro, structural dynamics not only cause energy, but also direct it. The path energy will take is entirely determined by the structures through which it is passing. Eg, water always flows downhill, but its actual path is determined by the lay of the land over which it must pass.

Structure produces tension, and thus directs energy.

4 –

Structure is affected and altered by the movement of energy. Eg, the river, being *directed* by the land, also *changes* the land as it flows. The movement of energy produces change.

Energy affects structure.

5 –

Summary -

All change, everything we see, and everything we are, is a result of this play between energy and structure. The relationship between structure and energy is what determines the nature of change in the universe. The flow of energy is invariant and constant in relation to tension, it always behaves the same way. It is therefore the form of structure, and the tensions thus presented, which determines the nature of change in any situation.

The form of structure, by directing energy, determines the nature of change.

You can sit there and repeat that a hundred times if you like, because it is worth remembering:

The form of structure, by directing energy, is what determines the nature of change.

6 –

But the most important thing to know about the cosmos, as it relates to us, is this - that with the flow of change, complexity and order are breaking down. Nothing mystical, just look around. The universe slides naturally toward chaos. The general habit of complex structure in response to change is to break up and become simpler. The natural habit of order is to become chaos. With the flow of energy toward equilibrium as defined in principle 1, patterns of structural development are being slowly swept away. Everything, if left to its own devices, is becoming less complex and organised. This principle is defined in Einstein’s second law of thermodynamics: a closed system tends towards increasing disorder or entropy. The ultimate implications of this are still being debated. But - physicists tell us - this applies at every level of scale, from macro to micro, stars to atoms.

Complexity naturally tends to break down over time. Change, it would seem, is generally degenerative to complex order.

So why is this? Why don’t things get more organised and complex over time in response to change?

Well, in the terms I just outlined, change must be predominantly degenerative as prescribed by *form* - by the very way structure is arranged. Structure does not seem to have the particular form or characteristics required to direct energy toward its own greater organisation. Therefore, structure directs energy in a way that is degenerative in effect. It gets worn down rather than built up. It is, in a word, stupid – not very creative or intelligent by nature. Dirt is dumb. Everyone knows that I suppose.

But....

7 –

Some things do get more complex over time. *What? Didn't you just finish saying...?* Yes, well, and there we have it. It would seem that principle 6, the tendency for structure to produce degenerative change is only a dominant habit, and that this is by no means a universal law or constant. That a secondary habit exists, less dominant but real nevertheless. So that whilst things mostly tend to break down over time and become less organised or complex, they occasionally do the opposite as well. Even if only for brief periods or in particular circumstances.

Scientists love to find constants, simple rules that apply universally. And have sought to make principle 6 just such a rule. After all, things just can't be getting simpler *and* more complex at the same time, in the same sense. That is incongruous and illogical. Not possible. But principle 6 is still debated because, in certain circumstances, the opposite is observably happening.

The debate here is broadly between physicists on one side, and biologists on the other. The general exceptions, you see, are the aspects of the universe we call 'life'. Organic structure is observably becoming more sophisticated, varied, and complex over time.

So how can we make sense of this? Who is right? Well, the answer is that *both* of these are true at the same time, but *not* in the same sense. There are many forms of structure which comprise what we see around us. And some of these structures have a greater leaning toward one of these tendencies than others do.

In response to tension, it is the universal tendency toward equilibrium which animates all energy, which is then directed by structure, affecting what we see as change. And the very structure of what exists, by virtue of its form, determines the outcomes of such change.

It would seem, then, as we see it, that structure generally dictates change in a predominantly degenerative direction, but that it also has a very real - if lesser - tendency toward generative change. Both tendencies, as well as the balance between them, are a natural reflection of the form of structure itself. Mere matter, under the right circumstances, may not turn out to be so stupid after all.

Organic Structure

So life, it would seem, has the tendency to get more complex over time, and maintain that complexity, contrary to almost everything else in the universe. Evolution in a sea of devolution. But how exactly? What is its secret? To get an appreciation of how and why it does this, in the simplest of terms, we're probably best to look back to its very origins.

There is literally nothing about the arising of organic structure which conflicts with, or defies, the first five principles of change I defined above. Nothing. It is an ordinary occurrence within a particular circumstance. Complexity simply does arise out of chaos, on the very same basis as we see the opposite occurring.

Structure itself determines this. Disorder is simply dominant, but both arise. You don't notice a lot of the secondary tendency because it happens at a molecular level and is immediately subsumed and undone by the primary tendency. One step forward, two steps back - from a distance, all you see is a slow backward slide. The secondary tendency simply doesn't maintain itself long and is overcome, but countless billions of such events occur every second of time.

Our universe would probably have no discernible features if this were not the case. It is the secondary tendency which puts the brakes on destruction, creating patterns and rhythms in the processes of change we observe. Remarkable order is a natural and common occurrence. And such order is evident at many levels of scale, from the formation of crystals in a snowflake, to the spiralling of galaxies.

In a similar vein, the third major advance in physics last century, after relativity and quantum theories, was devoted to a study of chaos. And the conclusion of 'chaos theory'? - Within apparent chaos lies a profound degree of inherent order, which manifests itself without any interference or coercion whatsoever. You just need to know how to look. When this phenomenon is studied in mathematical terms, and the findings converted into graphical form, what you get are the strange geometric patterns they call fractals. And what do they look like? Well, they look a lot like many forms of organic structure as we know it. Beautiful and immensely complex.

But still, although this is order arising out of chaos, such things as crystals and galaxies and fractals are not essentially 'organic' in the sense we normally understand life. So what about life, what is it that makes it so particularly different to everything else we see?

Organic molecules

Just as some natural structures tend to produce more order than others, so some clusters or combinations of particular structures animate that tendency even more dramatically. In the right circumstances, such clusters will produce high degrees of order every time.

The constituents of organic life as we know it on Earth are an example of such structures. Organic molecules, the building blocks of life, are composed of matter which is extremely common. Carbon, hydrogen, oxygen, nitrogen, sulphur and phosphorus. And not only the constituent elements, the molecules themselves are known to be spread throughout the universe. There may even be other combinations or circumstances which foster such emergence with an even greater efficiency. Perhaps even many. The ones we see are only our 'local' variety, just the ones we know about.

The interesting thing about these particular molecules, however, is that they seem to fit together a bit like Lego blocks or a 'barrel of monkeys' – that in the right circumstances they will arrange themselves into long strings or chains.

It was once thought that Earth's version of life probably began in the great primordial seas as these molecules formed and linked into diverse patterns of complexity. But it is in no way confirmed that such is what happened. Where and how this particular organisation of molecular structure first occurred is still widely debated, but the fact that it did happen is all we really need to know. It is now known that it could have happened on the surface of some crystalline matter such as ice or wet clay, stimulated by sunlight or atmospheric electricity. Or deep within the Earth or beneath the sea. Or on the Earth's surface somewhere in Darwin's "warm little pond". Or even, as is seeming more and more likely, somewhere out in the vastness of space. But wherever and whenever this occurred, it no doubt did so in complete accordance with the natural laws of change in the cosmos. It certainly seems possible, given the tendencies of organic matter, that it could have happened in any of the situations mentioned.

So what defines a living thing then? What is its essential quality as it relates to the terms I defined above?

The essential nature of an organic structure, in the terms I am defining here, is simply a structure which has a form which enables it to effectively take advantage of the secondary tendency of change. And, most importantly, toward the maintenance of such advantage over time. In practice this means any structure which *directs energy towards positive change in its own organisation*, meaning predominantly generative as opposed to predominantly degenerative, thereby resulting in the maintenance or even development of complexity in its own organisation over time. And - perhaps most importantly - the potential to increase its very capacity to continue directing energy in this way.

What we call life is simply an 'event spiral' which produces small islands of rising complex order in a sea of gradual destruction. That, in its raw simplicity, is really all life is. And it can really be very simple. As Carl Sagan had it, the simplest known living things – viroids – are composed of less than 10,000 atoms.

When I first came up with this definition in my own mind, as a side effect of the models I was playing with, I thought I had stumbled onto something new: a new definition for organic structure, for life itself. Certainly a lot simpler than any I had previously heard: just any structure with the capacity to arrange its own organisation over time so as to become more complex, and thus gain some advantage against the ceaseless flow of destruction. It seemed too simple, too obvious. I began looking for ways to expand my terms somehow to make it more complex. For this definition would potentially include many aspects of existence we have not previously thought of as being 'alive' in any real sense, things this model would thus define as elementary forms of organic structure. So whilst I felt it to be right, I thought it just had to be wrong. And was therefore pleased to read this one day –

"A real definition of life was at last proposed by Chilean biologists Humberto Maturana and Francisco Varela in the 1980's. They called it autopoiesis - literally, self composition or self organisation. The definition stated that an entity is alive if it creates and continually renews itself, including its defining boundary. Note that this core definition does not include growth or reproduction, which therefore may or may not be features of a living entity."²

Bugger, too late eh! Oh well, no Nobel prize for me. I should read more and save myself some work. But still I hope the simple relational terms I am using to define this process will turn out to be a bit more useful in our particular quest than those of microbiology, so I'll keep going and see where we end up.

Life, as I am defining it, is simply anything which has the innate capacity, given its form, to adjust its own structure in a positive way over time. The essential factor in this elementary process being the direction of energy. And because complexity is the primary issue, when it first emerges organic structure always begins very simple, on the boundary between organic and inorganic.

² 'A Walk Though Time.' Leibes, Sahtouris, Swimme.

Divide and Conquer

Thus far we've addressed only the primary transition of inorganic structure to the emergence of the simplest self-organising structure. But we all know the story doesn't end there, that this is just the beginning. However it is worth realising the essential difference between inorganic structure and organic at this stage - *nothing*. There is no essential difference in fundamental terms. It is all the same process, the same basic stuff. No magic bells go off when an aspect of existence manages to end up a bit more complex than it started out. Because there is nothing magic about it, it is an ordinary occurrence.

So why don't these little self-spiralling whirlpools of structural development just stay as they are? The answer is: attrition. It's a hard swim against the negative current of change for a simple self-organising structure, and that dominant tendency of change is just busting to sweep them away. Organic structure, as it must first emerge, has only a tenuous foothold, so it must - if it is to continue - find some way to sway the odds in its favour. Almost all such random attempts the universe makes at organising matter are destined to perish.

Like a lottery, simple structural development has only a very small chance of being sustained, of surviving another moment, let alone another day. But circumstances in the cosmos are such that self organisation gets significant opportunity to play. All arbitrary perhaps, but the practical result is akin to a long term process of random experimentation. This is just natural change in keeping with the tendencies and patterning habits intrinsic to organic molecules, but it produces a situation wherein self organisation effectively gets tested and tested and tested for the right combination of numbers - for the particular organisational structure required to gain a better chance of long term sustenance, as defined by the particular environment at the time.

And what was the right combination? Well, as I see it, the circumstance dictated that by far the simplest and most effective way for simple organic structure to achieve a significant advantage was to *replicate*. In the end, self-organising structure won the lottery simply by finding a way to buy lots of tickets. This potential was always there, inherent in the structure of the present matter. But who knows how many attempts at sustained development it took to find it and get it right? Perhaps countless trillions.

All complexity is acquired at random, and is allowed to continue to exist only insofar as it supports itself against the dominant flow of change. Thus, all new emergent developments must serve a useful function to the continuation of the isolated process if they are to survive. Replication, in this case, was such a profound advantage that probably the very first successful parting of the twisted molecules of life became our collective grandparent, and was immortalised in the events which followed. In the entire process of natural experimentation in any particular environment, this probably only has to happen once.

What organic structure requires in order to continue is available energy, and stuff from which to build structure. Fortunately - on Earth - there was both. Water, organic molecules, and the Sun.

Like a spark in a tinderbox, the first replication allowed a literal explosion of life. Tiny life, but lots of it. And with that, the arduous and accidental process of the emergence of self sustaining complexity on this planet was effectively over, at least for as long as those particular conditions would continue. In this contained environment, the balance had then been dramatically tipped in favour of the secondary tendency of change. No individual structure would ever survive, but could, if it was quick enough, give rise to others just like itself before it perished.

Organic structure had won by rigging the game. Divide and conquer. There was simply no way the regular forces of devolution in the primal seas could keep up with such a virulent stride. It just couldn't pick them off quick enough. Like a wildfire out of control, the seas became full, even clogged, with micro-organic structures. Even today, by far the most successful forms of life on the planet are the simple ones, with their capacity to replicate and propagate endlessly and without any loss or erosion of their form. And for a very very long time, there was nothing else.

I'm not going to follow this whole process through every step it must have taken from there, for that would take forever. But it is important to understand at least the essential history of organic development as it must have occurred here, in order to explain our present state.

So, subsequent to its origination and the basic function associated, here we see the next main step in the emergence of organic structure in an environment capable of supporting it. Not complexity, but multiplicity. An advancement which, whilst making little difference to the development of the individual organic structure, offered great advantages to organic structure in general. A necessary prerequisite, as it turns out, for the next and final chapter in the process to date - upward complexity.

Evolution

Whilst replication was remarkably accurate and certainly advantageous, it was not quite perfect. It necessarily involved information exchange, and with faulty transmission came mutation. Any slight changes in organisation which produced some advantage could thus be recorded and selected for further transmittance on the basis of their pure survival value. Unlike before replication, this meant advantages gained at great cost over time could be recorded so as to occur automatically in subsequent generations of individuals. Replication brings genetic memory.

Organic structure, at its bare minimum, maintains its own form. Even better, for long term survival of similar development, it multiplies. But at best, a living structure directs energy towards the development of even more complex structure than it started with. Thus gaining the capacity to accumulate, contain and direct even more energy, and so on....ad infinitum. Or should I say, *ad evolution*. An upward spiralling loop.

So we had a race for survival won by replication, which was good for the species. But with the species now secure, better success for the individual structure lay in the direction of further complexity. And the cosmos itself supports such upward development.

Selection via negation is what drives upward development. The same negative habit which thwarts the emergence of self sustaining complexity - in the right measure - now drives further adaptation. The old adage - 'what doesn't kill you, will make you stronger' literally applies to simple multitudinous organisms. If only because certain types of emergent complexity represent distinct advantages in particular situations.

So for a long time the negative tendency of change simply killed any attempt at long term structural development. But once organic structure, by multiplying, had tipped the scales and could not be so easily toppled, that very same negative effect over time made it stronger and more diverse in nature. And it did this, remember, by ceaselessly continuing to wipe them out by the countless billions. So the paradoxical result of such unabated slaughter is structural development over time.

●

My intention in this part of the section is to outline the most basic principles and characteristics of organic development in general, and higher order complexity in particular. Both of which are directly relevant to us because - whilst some other forms of life are not far behind us - human beings are the most complex and sophisticated single product of the evolutionary process which occurred upon the foundation I have just described. Which means that whatever applies to complexity in general, certainly applies to us in particular. Thus, I do not believe it is possible to gain even a cursory appreciation of the human state without taking these elementary factors into account.

So what is important about higher organic complexity in general? What do you need to know?

The Defining Principles of Structural Development

Why did organic structure need to get more complex? Well actually, it didn't. It was just doing what stuff does, going with the flow. Energy responding to structure naturally. But with replication, self organising structure had found a window of opportunity in which to exist for a time. And it did not need further complexity. 'Simpler the better' is best for fast and efficient replication. 'Lean and mean' spells organic success. But that was overall, species survival. In specific individual terms survival was still an issue.

The sheer scale of unremitting attrition over time applied great pressure, producing gradual selection of the most robust individual mutations. More often allowing them, and less often their weaker companions, to get the chance to replicate. At this stage development is still a very arduous and inefficient process. Extremely wasteful, and excruciatingly slow. So it is lucky for us that evolution had so much time to play, and so many organisms to play with. But complexity did arise, as we know, and did so in keeping with certain defining principles.

We have already established the essential function or fundamental principle of every organic event as the continuing maintenance and development of self-organising structure over time. So what makes more complex organic functioning different? Once again - Nothing! From the smallest to the greatest, this same basic function lies beneath all emergent development. Which becomes more obvious once you understand the particular context in which each different form arose. I hope what follows will help to explain.

Free Energy

Inside the necessary physical boundary which separates the organic structure from the surrounding environment, the primary resources required in order to continue the essential organic process are *available energy* and *elementary particles*. Both of which must be continually sourced and acquired from outside the organism. Thus all organic structure exists in continuous and necessary relational exchange with the environment, a profound symbiotic union. In the relational sense, this transaction defines organic existence completely, for without it organic structure could not exist at all.

An organic structure is a product of its environment. Organic structure is as connected to the environment as a wave is connected to the ocean, there is no real distinction to be made. It cannot really be defined as separate from it in any meaningful sense, and receives everything it needs in the continuous process of relational exchange with it.

Of the two primary resources, acquiring available energy is crucially important to organic structure. The entire process of organic development on Earth has occurred in a singular unbroken spiral of events, an energetic movement which has continued without ceasing since that very first day. It has never stood still, even for a moment, for if it did it would all have ended. Because although we recognise and have been discussing organic development in terms of its evident *structure*, it might just as well be defined as a dynamic energetic *process*, to which structure is merely a party.

Organic existence is, by necessity, a *relationship*. Thus you will hear me say 'relational' a lot in what follows. Because all authentic organic concerns are *relational* ones.

In *energetic* terms it is this: structure which acquires *energy*, which it then directs toward building structure which acquires more *energy*, which it then directs.... all with a certain energetic momentum. Energy ultimately goes toward nothing more than the acquisition of more energy, and structure is simply the by-product.

Organic development, rather than being viewed as an *object*, might in fact most properly be seen as an *action*. Because this energetic momentum - metabolism - is paramount to it. When any individual structure - for whatever reason - ceases to actively direct energy in this way, even though its level of complexity may not have altered in the least, it ceases to be alive.

I mean, just freeze your cat and you will see. No, really, don't do that! But you get my point. A frozen cat is just as complex as a living cat, but they are clearly not the same thing.

It is therefore *not* complexity which defines life, but the active capacity to acquire and direct energy toward the maintenance of complexity. Thus when an organism surrenders or cannot maintain this capacity, it relinquishes its organic status. Its constituent parts are once again submitted naturally to the dominant habit of change, and will degenerate rapidly to join the universal flow. The 'death' of an organism. And what died? Just a certain energetic momentum, it would seem.

So available *energy* is, in intra-organic terms, the very currency of life. All organic functioning is ultimately centred around the acquisition, integration, and direction of energy. Organic structure must sail hard into the prevailing wind of ceaseless destruction in order to develop and maintain its existence over time. And the *only* advantage life has in this sea of destruction is the capacity to acquire and direct available energy. So the first and prime directive or precept of any living system must and can only be this - 'acquire energy!'. For all other functions - including its most fundamental principle - are absolutely contingent on that.

In every operating sense, organic existence *is* this energetic momentum. Not just what it does, but what it is all about. From microbe to global economics.

Within any organic system - more than any other factor - available energy *IS* life.

To understand the realities of organic existence then, you must understand this -

Both the inward *maintenance of complexity*, and outward *relational exchange* - whilst they *provide* essential resources - also *cost* great resources. And it is this fine balance which organic structure must tread as it naturally mutates.

This is the essential factor which defines the parameters for the emergence of new forms of development. Organic structure is literally a small economy. Like any primary economy, it is all centred around the effective management of scarce resources. Everything an organic structure does comes down to a simple equation of cost / gain as defined by its primary resources.

So how does all this relate to the emergence of upward complexity?

Well, it begins to explain the basic concerns of any particular organic structure in relation to its environment. Mutation and change was inevitable, but not always good. The emergence of early complexity would have occurred almost solely on the basis of it offering some advantage to an organic structure in its capacity to stably secure its primary needs. Evolution selected new emergent structures on the basis of this primary transaction - energetic profit over time. Weaker, in organic terms, means less efficient in relation to fulfilling primary needs. And thus closer to extinction. Whereas more free energy, more profit, means more likely to survive. Pure economics, cost/gain, defines organic advantage.

In relation to increasing complexity and organisation (evolution), what must be recognised is that **upward development costs even *more* energy to maintain**. Both internally and relationally. More development, means more running costs.

So here we can see the fine line organic structure had to follow as its complexity emerged. For new complexity to be adopted, it must necessarily offer some overall advantage. Thus it must either add external relational capacity and therefore function to acquire resources more efficiently, or inwardly facilitate a more efficient or effective use of current resources, or both.

It seems clear that not all emergent complexity would have done this, that not all change offers equal advantage. In fact most development on the basis of mutation would have failed to meet this criteria, have represented a burden, and thus been selected for extinction. But it also seems clear that at least some must have done so.

Whilst being an incredibly tedious trial and error process, these constraints at least ensure that any complexity to emerge will do so in alignment with the basic function of organic existence. Because natural selection ensures that only advantageous emergent structures survive, it ensures the integrity of all higher development. And if any aspect of emergent complexity failed to meet this criteria, it simply did not survive.

So in summary -

- The acquisition of resources costs resources.
- More advantages generally means more complexity.
- More complexity means more maintenance costs.
- Increased order arises at random.
- Only advantages are selected for transmission to future generations.
- Emergent complexity hardly ever represents a gain in this equation.
- And selection, by negating everything else, ensures the integrity of higher development, that it is always advantageous to the organism.
- Only good changes in form and function are allowed to be kept and continued. Evolution via selection is a hard task master.

I believe it can be surmised that basic organic structure does not deliberately develop complexity for its own good. That such simply emerges as a by-product of natural mutation, and is selected for extinction in every case except when it fluked an advantage in the economics of survival. And in an arbitrary process, most emergent structures would have failed to meet this criteria. But the few that did made it to the next round, and upward went development. Bear in mind that at this stage we're still only talking about single celled organisms. And the kinds of development we are talking about are not arms and legs, but only slight changes in metabolism or relational exchange - just the difference between big cells and little cells. But upward change nevertheless, heading somewhere, slowly but surely.

And where to? Where is all this heading? Nowhere in particular it would seem. Evolution is not progress toward some preset goal. You could run this whole process ten times over with completely different results each time. Like a crystal growing in a particular solution, you can perhaps predict certain inherent traits, but it will grow differently every time. Evolution is simply increasingly complex organisms. There is no particular destination point.

Organic structure does not require higher development in order to survive over time. That's just a natural potential which, under certain conditions, can be actualised. Natural imperfection simply ensures continual change, and the pure economics of organic existence ensures that what emerges in a sustainable way is always in keeping with the defining principles of organic existence. It is an entirely experimental approach which is often highly conditioned by very small factors in the environment.

Remember that the attrition - and thus selection - I am speaking of is simply the natural force of the dominant habit of change in the cosmos. It is not a force which acts with any malice or intention, but simply acts naturally to do away with complexity and order in general. This tendency was not trying to make life stronger, it was trying to kill it outright. To undo it all. But luckily for us, it hasn't been able to quite keep up (yet!).

So no favouritism, just random experimentation, and better organisms got a chance to transmit their genetic material, becoming the forebears of future generations. And what was the advantage gained? Better and more efficient forms of relational strategy. The most efficient relational strategy means the most gain for the least cost. And on this basis, new developments were gradually selected.

So here we see a kind of blunt process of development, slow, inefficient and arduous. Relational exchanges are still simple at this early stage. Resources are relatively accessible, randomly distributed, and still being sourced directly from the environment. But it is all still defined by the unavoidable principles of upward development. So what happened next?

The Web of Life

My point here is to give you some rough appreciation of how things came to be, as we see them today. Up until this stage the diversity in organic structure was very limited. But with structural development came two things: Greater metabolic

capacity, including the capacity for a more sophisticated and responsive relationship with the environment, and a growing need for resources to feed and maintain all this new structure.

At lower levels of development both energy and elementary particles are acquired directly from the inorganic environment. Thus, with upward complexity, in this mode simple organic structure was on its way to becoming *plants*.

Any plant knows this - Put down roots and grow toward the light (energy and nutrients).

But there were undoubtedly many dead ends pursued in this haphazard process, and there would have been energy crises for many organic structures on the verge of extinction. Some by now would have been lumbering in size next to the smallest ones, and probably began to acquire their resources from the residual mass of semi-decayed organic material floating around.

Thus specialist feeders arose, higher order organic structure dependent on lower order for its survival. And this allowed further development in these aberrant structures, development which would not have been possible otherwise. It saved them from extinction.

However, as structural development increased, along with the internal demands associated, even this kind of exchange would have become too inefficient. What these bigger and more complex structures really needed was for their resources to be delivered to them pre-packaged in little bundles, ready for direct assimilation. And thus the proliferation of simple life set up the conditions for another whole potential - the emergence of organisms which feed directly on other organisms. The most obvious and available source of resources needed for further development in larger structures, was found in the abundance of smaller ones.

What organic structure requires in order to gain advantages, and thus speed up evolution, is *resources* and more *specific selection*. And at this point it had found one. A loophole had been found in the *economic* constraints defining upward development. Organic structure had begun consuming itself. In fact, in a very short time this amounted to a feeding frenzy. And what was being fed? Upward development - complexity.

This occurrence, then, set the stage for another dramatic and very significant potential, the 'web of life'. A food chain was gradually constructed on this foundation from the bottom up, each new emergent representing an opportunity for another even higher form to arise and feed directly on it and others. The relational demands all this produced were becoming more and more sophisticated and complex, as well as shifting more dynamically. Inter-species politics became a defining factor in a delicate web of dependent interaction. Niches opening and closing, species emerging and disappearing again, some adapting to new niches. The result of which is what could be termed '*special selection*' based on special relational environments. And with this we had the other half of what upward development toward complexity required. With abundant *energy* and *special selection* we had a recipe for rapid *evolution*.

Organic structure develops what is demanded of it over time. In this case sophisticated development in one 'branch' supported the same in another. Sophisticated demands produce sophisticated development. Now, not only how to *get food*, but also how to *avoid becoming it*, became more and more sophisticated events.

Organic structures, which by now were fully fledged simple organisms, were no longer relating only to a passive environment, but primarily to other organic structures - both higher and lower than themselves. And it was in this relationship, and the inherent dependency it implies, that organic structure was itself producing the dynamic and very specific selection required for change and higher complexity to emerge more rapidly.

Using specific selection you could change a cocker spaniel into a greyhound if you had enough time and fed the ones you liked with the ones you didn't.

It is also being proposed at present that certain characteristic patterning tendencies of the gene molecules, some 'control genes' in particular, themselves hold some of the keys to the rapid advancement of species traits. Very small changes in structure or timing of genetic influence in the development of an organism may produce very significant changes in the eventual form it takes.

Anyway, the result of the convergence of all these factors was, in historical terms, an event we now call the 'Cambrian explosion'. In evolutionary time, multitudinous diversity appeared almost overnight.

Organic structure had already existed abundantly on Earth for millions of years. But all of a sudden, 3.8 billion years ago on Earth, the blunt stump of organic development grew branches, and the branches grew branches, and those branches grew twigs... organic structure experienced its own 'big bang'.

Much of evolution is now understood to be highly interdependent. Co-evolution of inherently related systems, rather than individual branches evolving in isolation. One branch placing special pressure on another to force adaptation and change.

Special selection, driving special development. Most forms of organic structure thus emerged only subsequent, or contingent, to other forms arising. A co-operative event.

We as Homo Sapiens exist as part of this massive interconnecting web of life, each part absolutely dependent on the whole. And the higher you go, the more dependent you become on subtle balances within the whole, and thus more affected by subtle shifts. Our species evolved in direct and necessary relation to other species, both higher and lower in the food chain. And for 99.9% of our evolution, we were *NOT* at the top of this natural order, but somewhere in the upper-middle. From one niche to another as this bush of evolution grew, we and other species travelled along like riding a wave. And encoded in our collective genetic heritage are remnants of every stage of that history.

Many hurdles would have to be surmounted by this whole ecological process, many stages and random events. But for organic structure, imperfection works well. *Species programs* and *evolutionary baggage* exist in every higher order structure. Things which have little or no relation to individual survival, but which exist either for the benefit of the species as a whole, or as the vestigial remnant of historical adaptations which no longer apply in the present circumstance. Like sex drive, and the appendix respectively.

So at higher levels, we see two sources of selection. Added to the blunt and ever-present universal selection was sharp, specific and shifting selection by the wider organic process itself - the web of life.

The end result of this is an almost infinite variety of forms and processes, each with its own place in this shifting drama, and each with its particular form and relational exchange as defined by its niche. Some are very sophisticated, but all are entirely dependent on the overall process. Organic structure itself fed the process, and provided the selection it required. Another example and reflection of the self sustaining nature of organic structure I guess. Higher order complexity is an unnecessary game organic structure seems predisposed to play with itself. Complex organisms are essentially little more than a colony of micro-organisms which have sort of 'ganged up' because, in some situations, it constituted some kind of collective advantage. United we stand, etc. And the result is a kaleidoscope of interdependent forms.

Which pretty much brings us up to date, I think, at least in terms of the broader context in which we exist. From the relationship between structure and energy we see the emergence of simple organic transactions. From simple organic transactions we see higher order arise. Thus, we see the emergence of the diversity of life - from the basic function of organic existence, right through to the complex structures and relational strategies we see emerging in the greater web of life. From atoms, to molecules, to cells, to tissues, to organs, to organ systems, to organisms, to.... the ecosystem. The entire hierarchy of structure in the living world, it is all doing the same basic dance, in the same basic way.

Amongst other things, DNA research has confirmed what was once only presumed. We all share a single common ancestor. The very same DNA strand encodes all organic structures on Earth.

In almost every sense, organic structure can be seen as a single process, having a single origin, and all being entirely interconnected. Modern ecology generally only hints at this fact, but for the most part doesn't pursue the deeper implications to their obvious end. That life on Earth is literally a *single* process of organic development. One event, not many. The web of life, the ecosystem, in all its majesty and complexity, is effectively a single living organism. The Earth itself, in fact, fits the criteria we examined earlier for defining a 'living thing' - a hypothesis explored in James Lovelock's book 'Gaia'. And the human animal is a natural part of that process. No branch or stage in this process really matters any more than another, and in the end none matter at all. The entire process is a temporary one.

Just as for any species, extinction for the entire process is natural and inevitable. But it is also natural that it will strive toward upward development and diversity until that point. Some may think, by looking around, that life has passed its peak, its 'due by' date. But I believe life on Earth has yet to see its highest potentials realised, that its heyday is still yet to come.

Conclusion

All higher complexity has a functional purpose for existing as it does, and discernible integrity which can be seen and makes sense in light of the primary organic function and its particular evolutionary history.

Thus, for any higher functioning within any organism, there is an underlying functional integrity to which it is subject, and which it must serve. A deeper principle to which it inherently relates. Its very existence denotes this connection, and this relationship. And it is due to the constraints defining development, and integrity thus ensured, that all organic structures are capable of fulfilling the authentic needs associated with their particular form, within the environment in which they evolved. If not, they would not still be here. All higher developments are need fulfilment structures, and the needs all boil down to the same basic principle - Autopoiesis.

All organic development is a means to this very same end. The form of each structure, and their place in the drama, determine the particular relational exchanges involved at any given time. But regardless of the form and apparent

differences, it is all the same basic game. The base principle of existence for a chimpanzee, is exactly the same as that of the amoeba.

If you count up an organism's combined need fulfilment functions and strategies, what you have is effectively what amounts to its authentic or native functional agenda. Which altogether will comprise present organic-relational concerns plus species programs and evolutionary baggage. Its overall behavioural traits and functional tendencies. And all functioning makes sense in light of these three factors. All higher functions fulfil a purpose relative to the organism's primary relational agenda. All higher organic development, structure and functioning displays a necessary integrity which can only be understood relative to the basic principle of organic existence, and the particular organism's special place [and history] in the web of life. And all of it, simple or complex, boils down to the same basic organic purpose. This same basic principle, the self-creative direction of energy, is the central concern of all organic development - without exception.

This broad understanding of the primary or real relational agenda underlying organic behaviour is the foundation for what I call the 'primary-relational view' of human life. And hopefully you can already begin to gain some basic appreciation of yourself in these terms. That you are a body, before you are a mind.

Now this view may seem somewhat mechanistic, but we are in fact just that - machines. Automatic consequences of the way things naturally tend to flow and change. The beauty of a rose, whether you like it or not, is in its structure.

So is this a reductionist view? Reducing life down to the mere expression of natural laws and a few relatively simple principles. Hell yes! Life may be valuable to us, we being part of that process, but it is probably not anything special or unique. And in the bigger picture, it means nothing. At least nothing more than anything else. What we call Life is a natural phenomenon. The matter which comprises organic structure cannot be distinguished in any way from that of inorganic. It is exactly the same. Organic structure is a normal expression of the functioning of physical matter under certain conditions, those conditions being not uncommon in the universe. As we already said, the preconditions for life are common throughout the cosmos.

Organic structure is beautiful, but not special. It no doubt arises wherever and whenever it can.

Organic structure requires the negative universal context in order to arise. Too much destruction and organic structure would never emerge. Too little, and it would never evolve. But the very same common matter gives rise to both tendencies of change, apparently in the perfect balance for the emergence of what we see before us. As I see it, the entire process of organic development, from the emergence of simple structures to the development of the great web, is part of a game the universe seems naturally predisposed to play with itself. An inherent bias by virtue of the very substance of which everything is made.

It may not be trying to be smart. It may simply be so, inherently. It probably can't help it.

Unity Blindness

In light of all this we can see how all organic structure, and every function of such, might be predisposed to act in contrast to its surrounding environment. Because it emerges and evolves in a kind of struggle that physical existence has with itself. This partisan tendency is a natural result of the particular functioning of matter which produces organic structure. But it does not ever define or describe the substance of matter out of which both sides are equally made. In truth there is only one thing happening here. Self, as we generally conceive of it, is merely an idea. A product of the human intellect. It is never a reality, though we will see how it might come to seem like it.

So I hope you can see how it might be natural for organic structure to inherently view inorganic structure as foreign and separate. As the enemy in some sense. Because it functions differently and in direct opposition to it. That upon realising the capacity to 'perceive', organic structure is naturally predisposed to view itself as different and therefore separate from everything else, especially from inorganic structure. As 'not me' essentially, and therefore as being 'something else'.

'Self vs Other' as a conception in thinking organisms is a natural reflection of the underlying reality of 'Organic vs Inorganic'. This prejudice is very deeply rooted, for the organic structure must protect its own physical boundary at all cost in order to survive. And what is beyond that boundary? What is it protecting itself from? The universe, the great other, all others, the 'not self'.

Organic structure is innately biocentric. It is, after all, at war with the universe which is trying to pull it apart constantly. It must take sides simply because in almost all cases to do so represents some advantage. And this is an advantage because in the functional sense, it's true!

This trait is perhaps one of the deepest characteristics of organic structure. It is a tacit assumption with very powerful support. It is built in. For an organism, there are always two things - self and other. Never just one.

We can understand then, how organic structure might remain effectively blind to the most obvious of facts concerning existence, the unity which underlies this war of opposites in which it has taken sides. That beneath the appearance of conflict and separation lies a singularity, a commonality. That the fundamental structure, the very fabric of existence, is the substance and support of both tendencies of change. This natural partisan tendency belies the underlying unity of all things. The two are in fact one. The very same thing. It is not, however, in the nature of organic structure to understand this, it is so fundamental. Life is inherently blind to this unity. Convinced that everything must be either one or the other, and never both at the same time.

So within an organism there is never an understanding of something which goes beyond this duality. Of something deeper. That alive and unalive are not relevant to the underlying substance of both, that deeper reality is neither alive nor unalive. And that it does not take sides in this drama. Like the screen at the movies, deeper reality remains impartial and unaffected by the drama. It is all, and there is nothing else, nothing outside it which might prove to be a threat. It is both sides in this play, and thus cannot lose. All things which exist are ultimately identical to that. The cosmos, existence itself, is the underlying reality of both tendencies of change at the same time.

So what seems to be two, is always only one. However, this is something organic structure will never be able to see, but only ever be. There is no way out. We are already there.

So as human beings, we are somewhat bound to view things in an anthropocentric way. Like all organic structures we miss the most obvious of facts and childishly look for the origins of life in the form of a distinct identity, something like us. As if we were the peak of evolution, or as if it were for us alone. As if we were in some real sense separate or distinct from everything else, special somehow. Or that we were different and somehow distinguishable from the wider universal process.

Well sorry, but we're not. We're a natural thing just like a rock or a planet. Every progressive realisation throughout history seems to have brought with it one common import - the fact that we are not as important as we once thought we were.

We, and organic structure in general, are probably nothing special. Just an ordinary occurrence, under common conditions.

I hesitate to use the word God because it has so many negative connotations. So I will call it That instead. Looking back in time, we've looked everywhere for That in an attempt to explain our place in this cosmic drama. For the particular intelligence which makes things as they are. Never stopping to realise that if anything can claim such status, it is probably just the stuff out of which everything - including us - is made. Just the very fabric or substance of existence itself. And if so, that there is probably nothing but That in existence. For, as I already indicated, there is really no substantial difference between organic structure and the rest of existence. What we see around us in the web of life is no doubt normal behaviour.

So in our fearful search for meaning, I believe we could well be looking off into the distance in search of what is right in front of us. Why do we need to look past what is simply evident to more 'spiritual' explanations for the way things are? The very substance of everything, the physical universe itself, is That. That chair, the sky, this hand. Why not? And that it manifests itself, as it is, not by any intentional doing, but naturally and effortlessly by virtue of its very form and nature, its mere being. Remember principle Five.

The only conclusion I can draw is that if organic structure really is alive and intelligent, then so is the wider universal process which produces it, for there is no distinction to be made. We are a product of this broader intelligence. It must, therefore, always remain beyond our comprehension, making it a futile and ultimately unnecessary search. Always right in front of us, That may always remain mysterious if only because it is a form of intelligence we are not functionally equipped to recognise - that we can never know it, because we are always already being it. Because there is nowhere outside it from which to look back and see. Like a wave looking for the ocean, we are always already home in the only place we never left. That we are already That, and that the seeming identities we manufacture for ourselves, whilst to some degree valid functionally, are perhaps somewhat arbitrary and illusory in reality. There is truly only One thing happening here - That. And we, along with everything else, are That.

But for all That, and That being the case, it is not much consolation is it? A deep sense of yearning still exists, something which tells us that all is not OK. Something which drives us onward to seek something other than what we have, to question and to doubt. We are unhappy. And there is a reason for this. But it is not, I believe, the absence of 'God', or whatever you may conceive That to be. But rather a distinct and very definable presence. Still, we have a little way to go yet before that can be adequately outlined, so we better keep going.

So anyway, that is how things work. And the longer you leave the process of evolution, the more it develops both diversity and complexity. If you go away and leave it running for a few hundred thousand years, you never know what you will find when you return. And we are now going to jump forward a long, long time from the emergence of the web of life in the Cambrian explosion. Three and a half thousand million years actually, give or take a few hundred million.

THE HUMAN SYSTEM

As a species we are the most complex organic structure on this planet so far. However, every element of our functioning reflects the same basic principles of development as any other organism. Such accounts for all of it.

Everything - including what we call happiness - has a functional reason for existing as it does.

As a species we actually hold no special status amongst animals, we were merely the first to reach a certain point and realise capacities which gave us a particular edge.

As we saw – the higher systems and functions of mind etc emerged to serve the interests of the lower organism, and are set up so as to be governed or influenced by the lower and its concerns. The modes of influence are what the ‘executive functions’ of mind and persona experience as ‘emotion’. Emotion is systemic tension designed to produce action and change. The conscious frontal self is a product of many underlying operations moment to moment, and has evolved to be directly subject to the energetic influence of emotion. In contrast to emotive tension, undisturbed emotive energy is intended to feel good. It is via the direction of these polarities that integrity is ensured between higher and lower (between core and surface as we discussed in Section One). Surface is the puppet, core is the puppet master, and emotions are the strings.

The higher, more complex systems of emotion and mind are in some ways deeply connected to the primary system. I mean, this may seem obvious, but I mean this in a very literal sense. It would seem that most or even all of the higher emotive and mental functioning the human organism has developed have been tacitly interwoven with elements of very basic organic functioning. The higher functions have emerged with this primary connection not only so that they will remember who is the servant and who is the master, but also as a functional platform from which to gain the integrity they require merely to operate. Like tying a fragile and spindly tree to a powerful and straight post, it gives the higher functioning its source of strength and resilience. By rooting it in, and connecting it to, the most basic elementary functioning of the organism as a whole.

Without this, the more refined and less ‘physical’ functioning becomes, the more susceptible it would be to losing integrity. But this grounding means that - at least to some degree - to bend the mind and emotions out of shape, you must also inevitably bend the body. And the body, at its most primary level, will assert itself. It knows how to push back.

Thus, the body is both the single beneficiary of all this higher functioning, as well as its primary source of functional integrity. Evolution is nothing if not thorough.

If you examine the primary organic agenda these higher functions and their governing emotions serve, you can imagine that an ideal point of integrity is possible. An optimum relational state which serves the organism best. What I mean is that because all authentic primary level needs are met in a direct relational transaction with the environment, that an ideal transaction can be assumed to be possible. A single transaction which integrates all relational needs into one relational stream, a perfect and seamless symphony of need fulfilment, with energy to spare. And that, if there is integrity between higher and lower, because the higher systems are charged with finding this state, this ideal point can be expected to be reflected at an emotional level as a potential culmination point of all positive emotional states. Which is, I believe, exactly what we see.

At a primary organic level we see a continuum of potential functioning ranging from ideal health and relational wellbeing at one end, to all manner of ‘un-health’ and struggle at the other. And we also see that same continuum reflected at an emotional level, with its own distinct polarities - happiness and unhappiness.

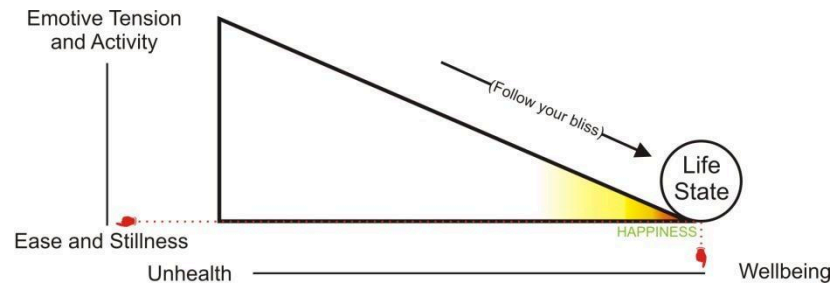
Happiness and unhappiness, in this context, are general terms we use to indicate the overall positive/negative balance produced by many emotive functions - functions which themselves represent a conglomerate of underlying primary level transactional concerns. The primary organic level is the business, happiness-unhappiness is the bank balance.

These two levels, then, are directly associated functionally, and should naturally move together. The positive end of both levels being singular and integrated, whilst the negative polarities being scattered and infinitely diverse.

This concept indicates a singular point of ideal health, that being the highest structural potential, but indicates infinite types of potential un-health. Anything that is not ideal health is, by definition, some degree of un-health.

Likewise with happiness, it can be seen as a singular point of emotive integrity which should naturally represent deeper systemic wellbeing. Unhappiness, accordingly, is infinitely diverse in type and origin. But the important point here is that there is a natural integrity between these levels, and that all the functions of the higher levels do actually make sense from a purely practical and evolutionary perspective - provided you have all the information such a view requires. They all serve a function, and are not just accidental curiosities.

So what we see here is a working relationship which makes sense. If you viewed this relationship in a visual form, with health-unhealth on a horizontal axis, and happiness-unhappiness on a vertical one, you would get a wedge or ramp which functions to ensure ongoing need fulfilment -



From the perspective of frontal awareness, free energy and free attention is the point of integrity at the tip of the wedge - where zero emotive tension converges with ideal physical health and relational wellbeing. Happiness.

The higher functions are charged with managing the relational affairs of the organism, and are motivated/controlled by the emotive core. As already stated, emotional attachment is the primary tension generator within the core, and the functions which manage attachment are ever vigilant so as to allocate it to best represent need. Attachment (at an emotional level) represents need (at a primary relational level). So when established relational fulfilments become disturbed and change is required, deep emotive processes become animated to adjust or recover the emotive attachments associated.

To illustrate this – let's say an object of need fulfilment is lost. Deep emotive processes at the core set in motion higher functions which must either recover relationship with the established fulfilment, or begin the process of establishing another one (frontal awareness experiences this activity as subjective disturbance) whether that be a return to a familiar fulfilment structure from the past, or the acquisition of something entirely new. The first option is usually the easiest and preferred path - emotive tension generated and directed toward protecting the current attachment. This broad function is typified in what we know as frustration, or anger in its extreme expression. The second is generally more costly as it involves more subjective reorganisation and therefore more emotive tension - that of deconstructing an existing attachment and integrating the underlying need into the system in the form of an emotional tension – a tension that disturbs things and sets activity about formulating and establishing a new relational fulfilment over time. The result is the formation of an active desire. Rather than the forceful protection of the old, this represents the transfer to something new, and thereby the continuation of need fulfilment. The most obvious expression of this function is what we generally call grief.

Frustration and grief (in their broadest meanings) both serve exactly the same purpose, but in a different way. And they are very easily interchanged, as we can all probably attest. They both protect need fulfilment by dynamically managing strong emotional attachment. Each is a healthy and adaptive response in the right circumstances, and without them, the system is crippled. But what if primary need fulfilment is threatened seriously, and if neither of these two options is practically available? In this state the system has no real place to go. Need must be fulfilled. Its only functional recourse is to simply apply more and more subjective pressure until one of the two other options finds a way through to re-established fulfilment.

The powerful primary structure simply whips the higher management functions until they find a way out. Such massive emotive tension has the effect of offering the higher functions more resources and more leverage systemically. Many normal functions can become suspended, like a country when at war. And like war, such high tension is also very costly.

This state is what we call fear. Fear has no valid function except to force action down one of the other two paths - frustration or grief. In itself, fear is not a productive emotive tension. And only subsides when one of the other two paths is taken. Fear represents the highest valence emotive tension possible in the human system. Fear is the big guns, a somewhat toxic and very costly emergency response which effectively signifies little more than a stalling of other vital functions within the system.

In a fair situation, then, the frontal systems should be able to do their job as directed by the core, and be rewarded for their efforts with a sense of wellbeing. This is how it should work, this is how the organism functions to meet its needs. And this is how it does tend to work in our natural state. Eventually, in adulthood, stable strategies of fulfilment become established and run almost automatically (unconsciously). Any transaction with a positive emotional outcome is anchored and supported systemically, creating a behavioural preference. The natural integrity of emotion in relation to primary need is simply implied and presumed. It is not generally questioned too much unless problems arise.

So there is an innate and necessary integrity between the lower, middle and higher levels of this system. Tension at a primary level is directly reflected at the frontal higher level. Like the individuals elected to govern a country, stress at a lower level will be reflected in the higher levels. And in the same way as those in positions of power can cut off and ignore the concerns of those they serve, the higher functions within us can do the same. But will inevitably become more and more

distracted and disturbed as other functions arise with the support of the core and move to take power. If activity in the higher systems does not respond to lower level concerns or influences, energies will automatically mobilise to overthrow and replace them. Like the electors in a state, the core ultimately holds the power, and will support whichever functions offer the greatest advantage to the organism as a whole. We have all experienced this kind of overthrow at some time. Except those of us who are severely cut off from our own core, and who operate more like a military dictatorship.

Anyway, what we see here is effectively an unbroken chain of leverage coming from the primary organism, via the emotive core and its dynamic energy management, through the higher functioning of the cognitive systems, and into the world in the form of action and relational exchange. This is how the organism affects the flow of change so as to retain an advantage over the continuous tendency of the universe to pull it apart. When the universe pushes, it is via this chain of leverage that the system pushes back.

The Frontal 'Self'

So what is the frontal self? The frontal operating self is caught between these two, the core and the world. It is the front end of all psycho-emotive functioning, the sum total, the point of interface between system and world. It is the coal face. Not the engine, the frontal persona is where the rubber meets the road. Often unaware of everything going on beneath the surface, it simply responds to pressures in its relations with the world and the core.

Like the executive function within a government, it is subject to many key systemic resources to tell it what's going on. On the basis of which it must take decisions and deliver actions. And like any executive function it is not informed about everything, just the highlights, just what it needs to know. Just the aspects of operations which require executive attention.

So the frontal persona is a sum product of all active systemic functioning at any given point. The appearance of autonomy is an illusion hiding a barrage of functioning beneath the surface.

With the flow of energy and leverage from core to world, the conscious self is the locus at which core energy is finally translated into action and relational exchange. The summary point at which all the functions flowing from the core system are collected and represented as some cohesive idea of the relational transactions desired, with energy attached. The frontal persona is just the mustering point of all higher functioning, emotionally elected by the core to fulfil the primary system's relational agenda moment to moment.

Information Processing

If we examine organic behaviour we can clearly see that some organisms seem to have the capacity to 'push back' and apply leverage in more intelligent and adaptive ways than others. And here we see the other half of the total functional equation we are addressing. Not just energetic leverage, but information processing. This is the second great factor in complex organic functioning. Not only action, but smart action.

The primary level of an organic system is the most powerful, but also the most stupid. So how does this core level know what's going on, when to act, or what actions to take? Just as with the management of complex action, the answer is that it must develop and employ specific functions to manage information for it. That's what higher development boils down to: sense, information processing, and response. Thus sense organs, brain functions, and motor functions always emerge together in necessary symbiotic union.

The central dilemma confronted by any organism in defining the best action in any situation is one which we - with our complex capacities - easily tend to overlook. There is one great stumbling block which we as a species have recently overcome with the emergence of a very sophisticated body of functioning, but we also now take this capacity for granted.

Let me see if I can explain -

The capacity of an organism to act in different ways constitutes its capacity to manage change. And change management is what organic structure is all about. What change management boils down to at any moment is choice. All the energetic systems we have been discussing thus far relate directly to action and therefore the capacity to **choose** different future outcomes for the organism. But the whole concept of choice brings up some interesting issues.

If you examine the higher functioning of an organism, you can, I believe, presume that they are charged with facilitating the system's overall relationship to external reality. A task which must ultimately come down to first becoming aware of the particular future outcomes of any particular action, and secondly to choosing the action associated with the most positive future.

We have so far been looking at the processes by which the organism acts and thus actualises such choices. But what about the first part, that of becoming aware of which actions are going to deliver the best resulting states for the organism?

Future awareness is simple you might say, you just need to look. Well, if only it were really that simple. To start with, if for any moment of time we have infinite choice available to us as to how we act or respond to circumstances, and if each of these different potentials leads to a different future outcome, then the only logical conclusion must be that there are infinite potential futures for every moment in time. What other conclusion can you reach? And which of them is real, if any?

The dilemma for any organic structure is that it is dealing with reality, and that information about reality is limited by the organisms capacity to directly apprehend reality somehow - in other words subject to the system's sense organs. So what we see here is the organism being placed in the position of trying to 'sense the future'. And is this a problem? Yes. It is a big problem because the future, at least as we generally conceive of it, does not actually exist.

This may be hard to accept I know, but the sense of time you currently experience is merely one product of your own complex mental functioning. Although we perceive time as being very real, this perception is almost entirely a product of our very sophisticated intellect. In reality, neither past nor future actually exists, there is only an ever changing present. Time, even upon shallow inspection, is not quite what we generally imagine it to be.

This may all make your mind boggle a bit because we are so accustomed to our casual view of time.

So the dilemma for emerging organic structure is that the future cannot be sensed, in any sense. It does not, in fact, exist. Likewise with the past. Neither past nor future can be experienced directly in any way. And because future awareness is so vital to the formation of behaviour, this is a truly massive obstacle. Most advanced organisms have the physical capacity to do much better for themselves if only they could figure out what to do; what the real potentials are in each moment and which actions would realise each.

So what can be done? How can an organism figure out what to do in any situation? This is the essential puzzle all emerging organic structure has faced, and each has developed a different answer. But it would seem that every form such answers have taken all amount to the same basic thing - to use some form of memory to record patterns of change. Although it cannot be directly aware of past or future as such, an organism can store information about its own previous relational exchanges and rank each according to preference on the basis of pure feedback. Giving each an emotional charge or 'cathexis', either positive or negative.

This is what we generally call conditioned response. Positive or negative responses to familiar situations based on direct experience. But this is obviously limited to things the organism has encountered in its short lifetime. So what if an experience kills an organism? How can it learn from that? Well, it can't, obviously. But the species can. Any organisms with a particular trait which helped to avoid the fatal situation get a higher chance of surviving and procreating, thus transmitting that trait to their descendants.

Genetically transmitted memory - Instinct and reflex.

Instinct, reflex and conditioned response can form complex labyrinthine networks of behavioural tendency, and together account for the behavioural patterns of the vast majority of higher order organisms. We as a species evolved through those states and retain many remnants of those behavioural tendencies and their associated physiological structures. The human brain as we know it today, with its complex frontal cortex, emerged to subsume but include both the mammalian brain structure and the primal reptilian brain at its base.

However, none of these capacities can be said to be any kind of real 'future awareness', if only because it is simply not possible to be aware of something which does not exist. So here we see an outline of the daunting task confronting all emerging organic structures as they struggled to gain some kind of advantage and secure their own survival.

I could go on to explain all the likely stages in the emergence of what we observe in ourselves, but it doesn't really matter in the end. The point is that at some stage we gained the capacity to achieve another far more sophisticated potential in the way information concerning reality is managed. That being the capacity to -

Mentally construct for ourselves a symbolic picture of probable reality beyond the reaches of our direct experience.

The capacity to construct a perpetual picture of 'reality' for the emotive core, including - most importantly - many many aspects of reality which lie firmly beyond the capacity of the organism to directly sense. An immensely complex affair, a truly massive undertaking involving the co-operative activities of countless different cognitive and emotive functions, and a truly great advantage. For if you examine it, you realise that this includes all the past, all the future, and most of the present.

The end result of this very busy cluster of functioning is a dynamic structure of thoughts which symbolically represent reality within the system. There are obviously severe limitations to this because reality is so impossibly complex, but the advantages of even moderate success clearly outweigh the costs. The process amounts to one of memory and deduction, and the production of a kind of pseudo or quasi reality based purely upon probability. But if we can even roughly deduce

only one future potential out of the infinite possibilities each moment provides, we are doing better than any other organism on the planet. The advantages of this potential cannot be overstated.

As I already indicated, we have become so accustomed to doing this that we do not even realise exactly how much of a feat it really is, or what it all involves. We are so good at filling in the gaps that we forget just how little information we really have to go on, or how much of what we think is 'real' is in fact only well intentioned imagination. Just thought.

As I say, the significance of this marvellously complex capacity cannot be overstated. This perpetual reality simulation is the incredible sum product of countless co-operative functions, working continuously and tirelessly to update and maintain it. It is by far the most delicate and sophisticated single function achieved by any species on this particular planet. And the outcome is so convincing that we generally don't even recognise that we are doing it.

It has to be stressed that this capacity does not merely supplement the organism's direct sensory perception of reality. It subsumes and almost consumes meagre sense perception in a vast and dynamic construction of imaginary reality.

Presuming a positive orientation is ideal, the optimum or most creative function of these 'reality manufacturing' capacities would seem to be the discernment of the most advantageous future outcomes for any particular situation, and the actions or choices associated with each. As we have already discussed, it is this discernment of positive future potentials which defines the greatest advantage for the organism in its relationship with the world. So what this amounts to, in the terms we are discussing here, is the creative formulation of entire scenarios based on action and outcome, being updated moment to moment. The more sophisticated, realistic, and positive this discernment of potential future, the more creative and advanced the organism. It is, however, also advantageous for the system to pick out any particularly negative potentials so as to act to avoid such.

The focus of this functioning is necessarily selective in the way it grasps reality, and therefore has a strong tendency to be biased toward the immediate concerns of the organism. It is not some ideal and objective view of reality being sought.

Thus, it is sometimes difficult for the organism to gain a truly balanced view of reality, a view which does not place too much importance on itself. With such limited resources to achieve such an incredible feat, and with such a blindingly complex reality, there is always a conflict between representing reality objectively, in a balanced way, and selecting only what is important to know in order to survive. Very few people seem to have the cognitive resources to do both. There are also many other factors which can negatively affect the way we construct subjective reality, and together I call them 'organic bias'.

Overall, the tricks we have devised in order to overcome our natural bias can be seen reflected in the procedures we loosely call 'science'. To see reality more clearly, you must necessarily transcend your own inherent bias, and to do this you need merely understand and account for it. This process of progressive transcendence and clearer vision is one of the factors which signifies human development as generally defined by evolutionary psychology. And the result - hopefully - is a better and better grip on reality, so that the reality we construct for ourselves from what we observe around us becomes more and more accurate and balanced as we become more objective and capable of adopting many points of reference at once. At the highest levels, it is beautifully integrated and remarkably accurate overall. A veritable symphony of activity in which direct sense perception comes to play only quite a small - though supremely important - part.

So this capacity is an immense one, and signifies the convergence of many functions in a co-operative synthesis of information management. But what use is all this information if the system does not take advantage of it? Well, no use at all, obviously. In order to gain the advantages inherent in complex imagination, the system must be prepared to **act** on it. And, as these functions emerged, it would seem that the most effective way to achieve this was simply not to inform the frontal self of the difference. Because, for our manufactured picture of reality to be powerful and valid, it is not an advantage to insert inevitable doubt by tagging it 'artificial'. On the contrary, it must be made indistinguishable from actual reality. It must be presumed to be reality.

The price, then, of such an advantageous capacity, is submission to it. It is simply presumed to **be** reality. And the result of this is a very curious state of affairs, something rather unique perhaps to our species - the production of what are actually merely mental thoughts, but which are emotionally responded to as reality within the system. A nothing posing as something, and being responded to as such. Such a thought is what we call a Belief. A belief, as I am defining it here, is a thought which produces a systemic response equivalent to a perceived reality. Which is entirely appropriate, because that is its function. It is a thought deliberately intended to accurately represent an aspect of actual reality.

It needs to be made clear that the response of the system to a belief cannot be distinguished from the response it has to actual reality. In fact it could be said that all responses, besides reflexes based on direct sensory stimulus, become based on such thoughts.

Eg - Even if it was not the case, if you truly believed that a jet plane was about to come through your window, you would experience the same level of systemic fear as if you were cornered by a rattlesnake. There is no distinction subjectively. Fear is fear. Likewise, if a jet was in fact about to come through your window - but you were unaware of it - you would

experience nothing of the kind. Until someone informs you, that is, at which point all the human beings would vacate the premises rapidly, leaving the mice and cats and whatever else to die. Because unlike most animals, it is often not actual reality which humans respond to, in the form of direct perception, but rather their own subjective construction of reality. The advantage of which is in being able to know the outcomes of certain things without having to directly experience them first. Mice and cats simply cannot imagine what a jumbo jet is, let alone what it might mean if one came through the window. Thus, in this extremely costly and sophisticated body of functioning, we have gained an equally dramatic advantage.

So in the first half of this section we examined the anatomy of what amounted to an unbroken chain of energetic leverage running from core to world. And here we see the other half - a chain of information running from world to core. Together these two very complex flows of energy and information work hand in hand to govern change. And once again, as with the outward flow, the role of the **frontal self** is central in information management and belief in particular.

Just as all the energetic functions ultimately require a point of synthesis at which to collect moment to moment into action, all the diverse and scattered information functions occurring within the system need some point of reference at which they all converge as a cohesive picture of reality moment to moment. And once again, this point is the conscious frontal self. It is simply that, as the system produces for itself a continuous and sophisticated picture of what is going on, it must likewise muster all functions capable of receiving such information and making sense of it. So, concerning the flow of information entering the system from the senses, this necessary interface or mustering point is the conscious self, or frontal persona. It is simply the 'sum' of all equations relating to perceptions of reality moment to moment, being delivered to whatever functions are deemed most capable of interpreting such to the core in terms of what they mean.

We have now seen that we have two flows of traffic running in different directions simultaneously between the core and the world. The conscious self is like a crossroads for this traffic. A shifting and dynamic nexus or mustering point for all systemic functioning, both energetic and cognitive. It is the printout, the hard copy, the sum product, moment to moment. Like what you see on the screen of your computer, the active front end - just a very small fraction of the total activity happening beneath the surface, but also the ultimate point of all the activity. The frontal persona is the summary point, where information becomes felt reality, and internal impulses are finally converted into action and relational exchange with the environment. And, by the way, this shifting nexus is known to occur at no particular location within the brain. It is merely a continually moving dynamic locus or point of integrity for all systemic functioning.

The terms conscious, subconscious and unconscious then?

Conscious experience, as I see it, is merely the result of active filtering. There is simply too much insignificant information floating around, so anything which is not important or which can be automated happens beneath the level of frontal awareness. Some have asked, how did humans become conscious? But the real question may be - how did we so successfully limit our consciousness? Consciousness is not the trick, unconsciousness is.

Subconscious, then, is a word that has been used by some to help distinguish some of the historical ambiguity related to the word 'unconscious': which has been used to refer to all the processing going on beneath the blinkered and limited conscious level, hidden from view. In which case it may be inferred that much of what is now unconscious (or subconscious if you prefer) was once potentially conscious, or is generally available to conscious awareness if need be. By and large such unconscious activities are simply things we think automatically, mechanically as it were. And all this needs to be clearly differentiated from the collective unconscious, representing any deep pattern or intrinsic predisposition in functioning which is so contextual or deeply imprinted that it is effectively transparent to us and the way we think. Such patterns are determined by the hardware itself. This form of 'unconscious' is never available to frontal awareness directly. We always tend to look through it, or from it, rather than at it.

So that is conscious, and unconscious as I am using them, and I will refrain from the term subconscious even though I believe there are good grounds for its use here. Three levels, then, like a computer -

- Active front end (what you see on the screen).
- Active functioning (what's going on behind the scenes).
- The hardware constraints (which dictate the parameters and limitations of the other two).

Now as far as the 'reality construction' we have been discussing, the information being delivered to the frontal self - across this interface - is the summary product of all systemic functioning. It is the best of the best, being received and interpreted by the best of the best. Thus, it is very simple for the system to stimulate full response on the basis of mere thought. It is simply that whatever is received via this mechanism is perceived by the core system to be fact. Any thought pertaining to reality and **without opposition** from another thought is presumed to **BE** reality.

Reality

The whole capacity we are defining here, the capacity to believe, constitutes what could well be called a secondary human reality almost. It is not actually real, but a vast amount of our emotional experience is actually self generated via this function. And this compound capacity has been a great advantage for our species, but obviously comes with certain potential liabilities. Many of which relate to the fact that we don't generally even recognise we are doing this. We truly do not realise the extent of our dependence on these functions, or that they are - at best - little more than an educated guess. The frontal self, for the most part, is completely ignorant to it all. We simply presume that what we believe is real. That's the point I suppose, that's exactly why it works. But this singular point of misunderstanding has become the origin of much confusion concerning what is actually 'real' in life.

We - as human beings - effectively exist in two realms of experiential reality, not one, and this is not generally recognised. And one of these, although it feels real, is not real at all. Just pure imagination. And it is unfortunately this second 'reality' which constitutes by far the larger part of our emotional experience. A dangerous situation perhaps.

For instance, **everything** you currently experience as past and future, and present beyond direct senses, is via this mechanism. And you don't even realise.

The frontal self is not informed as to which is which. If any thought pertaining to reality is unopposed by any other thought, it is simply presumed to be real and responded to as such. Belief is a 'general' function, in the same sense that the army has 'generals' - it is a very important factor in the way we operate. They are of huge significance.

The construction of this secondary reality is the single most important function in the way we operate as organisms. It is the one unique factor which delivers the most advantage to our species.

With all this in mind, there is a great discussion to be had here about the nature of what is real. And perhaps I should address this briefly, because it is important to understand. The confusion of these two distinct types or sources of human reality, and the functional relationship between them, has been the source of great conflict historically. Both in theory and practice. The simple fact that in studying human experience there are actually two distinct realities to address rather than just one is not recognised. And the result has been much disagreement as to the nature of reality itself, as well as the degree of influence we can have over such.

On one side we can see those who would seek to reduce all experience down to concrete **physical** reality, and who generally assert that if we follow any experience back to its aetiological roots we will finally arrive at some concrete physical structure or state. A view which tends to support practical approaches to change which are based on action and actual relational leverage.

In terms of human experience, this group seeks to reduce everything - including subjective 'reality' - down to the results of concrete biological and physical principles and states. In response to the opposing claim that 'nothing is real', these people would probably say - 'put your head in a concrete mixer and say that!'.

On the other side we see those who quite accurately assert the significance of **thought** in the production of experiential reality, and who declare that if you follow any experience back to its fundamental roots, you will not find a physicality, but rather thought. That all reality begins as thought, and can therefore be influenced by merely changing the ways we tend to think. And in globalising this view, all reality is tarred with this brush, with actual reality being ultimately reduced to some kind of elaborate fantasy.

The primary difference between these views in practical terms is the degree of influence we might have over reality. And when globalised, each side of this argument suffers some degree of ineffectuality and things it cannot account for.

Those who assert the former view suffer from overlooking the massive amount of limitation and experience which results from subjective causes, and the opportunities such understanding might offer. And those who take the second view suffer from having concrete reality confront them in ways they cannot discount or affect via manipulation of thought.

In the end, you have to realise that both sides are absolutely correct within their own fields, within the context of the particular 'reality' they are describing, but that neither is globally correct when applied in practice. There is a complex composition of two realities experienced in the human state, and each must be understood correctly. As I see it however, subjective reality is in fact entirely a product of actual physical reality. But that the vast majority of human experience is now manufactured via these subjective mechanisms. Leading to a somewhat confusing state of affairs.

So what is real, and how do you affect it? Well, this comes down to which reality you are discussing. Which are you talking about? Because the influence you may have on one is dramatically different to what you may have over the other.

Actual physical reality is only affected by influence of a direct relational kind. You have to literally push it to make it move. And if you follow it to its source you will end up looking at a complex and self-existing physical universe with clear and definable integrity and natural limitations. This is the real world, which exists whether there is anyone here to 'experience' it or not. In this reality - actual primary reality - you will confront real restrictions and immutable laws.

The assertion that 'consciousness' is the source and prerequisite of all existence is merely an extension of the way we perceive subjective reality. Because of subjective reality this is true. But fortunately for the universe, it does not require the perception of tiny carbon based organisms in order to exist. Perhaps we are overstating our own importance just a little.

But such assertions are understandable in light of how we operate. Subjectively created elements of experience are entirely the product of the human system's own cognitive and emotive functioning. All elements of 'reality' produced within, for all their apparent power and valence, are truly and merely the result of active thought processes. And thought, like it or not, is merely a product of electro-chemical processes in the physical brain.

It is also important to recognise that the vast majority of what we experience as being real comes into being via this mechanism. Which has great practical significance when it comes to adopting a philosophy of life. Because the potential for affecting change in elements of experience sourced in subjective reality is far greater and more direct in contrast to actual reality. We may, if we have developed the control required to subvert the natural balances which maintain and produce this subjective reality, simply hotwire our own subjective processes to create any effect we may choose. Our power of determination over inner reality is absolute.

So our power to affect each type of reality is seriously different, and this confusion leads to many and varied approaches to change, and to different views of reality itself. But few, if any, recognise the distinction between these two types of reality, nor the functional relationship between them. Thus, nearly all suffer from some profound error.

It is perhaps worth stating this point here as it applies to practical philosophies based on subjective manipulation-

The nature of the two human realities, and of the functional relationship between them, is the essential key to correctly orienting any process which seeks to actively modify the natural formation of belief structures.

Thoughts, and the mind in general, are not real in the sense we generally understand reality. They do not 'exist' in some kind of parallel 'mental universe' or 'noosphere' as Ken Wilber calls it. They are merely - and only - electro-chemical processes in the physical brain, and nothing more. The projector and the screen are real, the movies are not. However, the purpose of subjective reality is to represent actual reality as best it can. That is, after all, its function. So there should be some degree of integrity between these two 'realities'.

In fact, because of their importance systemically, and because of our implicit dependence on them, there tends to be extreme levels of subjective protection concerning the integrity of these systems, to ensure they remain accurate and thus valid systemically. After all, an inaccurate perception of actual reality could obviously result in serious consequences if presumed real and acted upon.

Like emotional attachment - because they are managed by the same kind of energetic systems - the vast majority of belief structures are static and unconscious in nature. Effectively permanent like physical structures, these mental structures create the stable backdrop against which we operate and live. They are just ideas actually, but they function as if they were hard realities in every other sense.

However, beliefs are only one of many functions involved in how this all fits together to produce the sort of dynamic governance we see expressed in our frontal persona at any moment, and in this regard certain other functions are also worth differentiating and taking note of. There are many different classes or types of subjective activity in this regard, each performing a different task. An analogy might be found in the way any government works, and all the various functionaries involved. Some elements can even perform several functions at once, their status being defined by the roles they play.

In this context it always needs to be remembered that I am translating here, and in many cases taking the long way around in order to explain things that for me are relatively simple, except in my case rendered in somewhat more fluid terms. I see all of this in dynamic working terms, rather than broken up like this, and for me none of these elements have names. So this is all very unnatural in a sense, like breaking down an engine and laying all the parts out on the ground, then trying to explain to someone what each part is called.

The point is - every one of these parts may well have a name already, within some other framework or theory. But the whole point here is to gradually construct a new framework that is intentionally constructed right at the boundary of accessible understanding for most, but that nevertheless manages to capture all of the important information required to be powerfully useful to those people. So I am just going to give them my own names here, and not only because you have to call them something, but also to differentiate all of this from historical views.

I will also draw some analogy here to another complex system we all know and live with: your personal computer -

- What I will call '**General beliefs**' are any that are stable over time, representing aspects of reality which do not seem to change. These are effectively invisible to awareness and never questioned under normal circumstances (perhaps the 'windows' you see on the screen of your computer, the fonts, the language..).

- **‘Operating frameworks’** are not beliefs as such, but like general beliefs they are thoughts which are permanent and stable. They are the many mental structures which manage the flow of information or leverage within the system. They are like working mechanical parts. They translate between surface and core, and back again. They are effectively a massive body of ‘this means that’ ideas, and provide the chassis for all the moving parts (the stable and invariant software components you can generally see, which manage the active and varied content).
- **‘Directives’** are what I call thoughts which the emotive core has imbued with a certain amount of attachment because they serve to somehow represent need fulfilment. These are things the system will fight to protect and uphold because to not do so means suffering, or because of the degree of emotional investment they represent (your personal settings perhaps?).
- **‘Core beliefs’** are abstract generalisations about actual reality, attempts by the system to create efficiency by making things very simple. Core beliefs are boiled down and often overly simplistic ideas about reality as a whole. They are very powerful however, because they represent such vast bodies of reality, and because they are simple enough for the core to really feel and understand without too much help (Mac or PC etc. Some core beliefs, even though they are supremely important features, can be extremely maladapted – such as choosing PC!).
- **‘Identities’** are beliefs relating specifically to the nature of self, the organisms own self references (perhaps your computers ‘system info’. Which – if you look – will probably not say: “I am an elephant”. It should be an accurate summary of the nature and capacities of the system; and if not, there is something wrong).

There are many potential crossovers or combination definitions here such as what you might call ‘core identity’ and ‘core directive’ etc. And, depending on their role and nature, some thoughts can hold many titles, and command great power in this overall subjective drama. These might be likened to entire programs, or even computer operating systems.

For instance the thought ‘I don’t deserve to have what I want in life’ can function simultaneously as a general belief, a core belief, an operating framework, a core directive, and a functional identity. Which is one reason why - if you try to change it - you may confront resistance. It is not just an idea. Many important things depend on it. Such a thought will, because of how many keys it is carrying, inevitably be a major player in the subjective politics of power in your own inner world.

It is probably worth recognising at this point that - although all these functions operate automatically and unconsciously - they are all merely thoughts nevertheless. And are all under the direct control of the organism via the frontal persona. After all, if the organism isn’t actively producing them, then who is? But because these thoughts function to direct important energies, almost like mechanical parts, they are often invested with profound degrees of core emotive energy. Which means that they can be remarkably difficult to simply alter. They are, after all, supposed to produce force and coercion, not be affected by such. And some of these functions are so heavily invested with emotional force, given how central they are in the overall maintenance of need fulfilment over time, that for them to fail or be disturbed in any way can have very dramatic consequences. That possibility will, therefore, be deeply resisted by the emotive core.

Overview

Together, all these systems and functions are the mechanism by which the human organism fulfils its native and healthy relational agenda. And that relational programme is - via emotion - ultimately represented in the formation of the active frontal persona.

So frontal awareness is a continuously animated point of reference, seemingly receiving information, feeling something on the basis of such, and acting in response. But it is actually a puppet, being pushed by the world, and the core pulling the strings to make it push back. It has the overt appearance of an autonomous thing, but is in fact merely a functional agency for the massive body of highly dynamic activity beneath. It is not informed as to its own nature and purpose except via its orienting influences - emotions. The core is dumb, and rules by force alone. The frontal persona, being the summary of higher functions, simply does what ‘feels good’ in order to fulfil its function. That’s all it needs to know.

The responsibility for making sure that what feels good is good lies at a deeper level. However, in evolutionary terms, any serious breach of such integrity between core and frontal self would have resulted in failure to meet primary needs, and therefore been selected for extinction. So that integrity has been pretty well established intrinsically at every level.

From the core looking outward, then, we see the underlying process of power and leverage. But from the surface of conscious awareness - unaware of the underlying process - what we experience are simply good or bad ‘feelings’ moment to moment, and we respond accordingly. Thus, we can easily observe the modes of influence by which the emotive core drives the frontal functions into action. In an ideal state, the fulfilment of the system’s real native agenda should feel good to the frontal self.

We can now begin to see how emotion functions to direct the frontal levels into action. To the frontal functions, the body - being the ultimate object of all positive activity - is designed to feel like bliss when its needs are met. The frontal self is deeply anchored in, and connected via ‘feeling’ to, the rest of the organism. And is therefore oriented to experience both feeling depth and feeling stillness as blissful and attractive.

To higher functioning, the 'body feeling' is bliss. So emotion, a deliberate disturbance, contraction and consumption of this 'feeling bubble', is designed to immediately attract frontal attention and generate activity toward the resolution of whatever stimulates such to be produced. In this context, from the point of view of frontal conscious functions, we can say that emotion is something which disturbs the native body feeling. And we can also hope that it does so only when truly required, as defined by the system's healthy native agenda.

I hope this makes sense -

The purpose of the frontal systems is to fulfil the needs of the primary organism - the body. The result of such primary fulfilment is free energy. Thus, free energy is designed to feel good to the frontal systems, to the conscious self.

This connection between frontal and core is what we call 'feeling'. This is the carrot which motivates action. And on the other side of this polarity is the whip. Emotion is a disturbance of the body feeling. Emotion effectively ransoms the still free energy of the body in return for attention and activity. So free energy and free attention is feeling. And feeling, in its undisturbed state, is bliss.

This whole system has evolved to take very hard knocks and bounce back. Normally it runs on automatic with habitualized and established need fulfilment strategies. But when fulfilment is disturbed by negative change, powerful processes are animated to restore balance. It will always push back. This is what all the systems are designed to do, to push back against a universe which is trying to pull everything apart. And the complex body of thoughts which form a major part of this functioning are no exception. They are designed to be highly resistant to 'force from without'. They are upheld by underlying energetic influence, and are only designed to change in response to shifts in their underlying energetic influence. The whole system is naturally oriented to presume the integrity of the primary emotive core. And quite rightly so, it would seem.

In light of all we have outlined here, we can see that the assertions of section one about the value of desire should well apply. That to simply be oriented toward avoiding negativity in life is not as ideal as being focused on being attracted to the positivity; that being active is better than being passive; that having an integrated vision is more effective than merely having scattered desires.

Thus, ideally, the higher systems should be responding to the emotive core in a positive way. If the conscious higher functions of this system feel and forge all the deeper desires of the core into an integrated vision, and then achieve that, it should naturally result in the highest level of potential fulfilment emotionally. And in the process - presuming there is integrity - fulfil all primary level needs.

Which is the point. The relational needs of the primary system make sense and can be fulfilled, so if desire does represent need then the emotional agenda an integrated vision defines should be equally achievable.

This may sound simplistic, even too good to be true, but remember I am explaining only the native state here free of the added conflict. And the native state really is this simple. We will see in the next section why this is not what we generally experience.

Repression

There are also several other things to consider about the native state before we move on to study the complex disturbance which produces the common state.

The first is repression. Repression is generally thought of as something entirely negative, which in a sense it is. But it is also a distinct advantage in certain situations, and has allowed our species to survive when others would perish.

One of the advantages of being so complex is that it offers more points at which aspects of functioning can be suspended temporarily if the need arises. For instance, even to act in a 'reasonable' manner is, in a sense, at least partly a repression of our instinctual tendencies. It is a small example of how repression of aspects of functioning can be healthy and adaptive.

But what about serious repression? Yes, even serious repression has a healthy place in the way we operate. It is part of the native human state. When we are seriously impacted to the degree that our own subjective functioning becomes a further threat to our own survival, our own system can simply shut processes down.

This, of course, must be a temporary thing, as to shut down healthy functioning over the long term would clearly be a disadvantage. It would damage the integrity of the systems involved and obviously affect subsequent functioning. So the organism relies here on its own underlying integrity to protect itself from harm. It 'actively' disturbs its own integrity so as to produce some advantage in the short term, knowing that such integrity will naturally re-assert itself over time and return things to normal. And it must be 'active', because of the tendency of all functioning to resist such disturbance.

Healthy functioning, as we have seen, is protected energetically and will resist being shut down. So the way repression naturally operates is that it is always loaded energetically so as to be difficult to maintain over time. It always costs energy to maintain. It is an emergency coping strategy which always involves stress and imbalance. In the end, as we've seen, the disturbance of higher functioning involves the disturbance and repression of associated elements of primary level functioning in which they are anchored. The body suffers. And with this a degree of happiness and wellbeing are lost. So repression can be an advantage, but it coils a spring and creates pressure. This energetic loading and the disturbance it creates ensures that the artificial distortion will be released as soon as the danger has passed and there is an opportunity to let it go.

For every compression, there must eventually be an associated release.

An easily observable example of overt repression is 'shock'. Memory and certain emotive functions are simply suspended whilst more primary concerns are dealt with. Shock is a stress response, and suspends other functions during its operation. And normal functioning will not resume until this suspension has been relaxed.

There are many other points at which the system can disrupt normal flow - many different functions which can get caught up in active repression, each having a different toll on overall functioning. But they all serve the same end, they are all used as a means of absorbing functional loads which could otherwise collapse the structure irreparably.

The most common is simple misalignment between core and frontal self as we outlined in section one. The system can play tricks on itself in order to delay or modify the impact of stress etc. For instance, it can delay grief by withholding it from the core. It can accumulate it, resulting in the need for a dramatic purge at some point.

Or another form is that the higher functions can effectively cut off from the core and its demands temporarily. But such misalignments will inevitably generate stress like the stretching of a rubber band, and frontal levels will become more and more distracted from the present moment of experience due to pressure from within to address historical imbalances or needs going unmet. Such imbalances create the need for some kind of audit, for things to be straightened out.

There are obviously far more serious forms of potential repression than these, and there is also a clear distinction to be made here between repression and collapse. Impact beyond the capacity of the organism to accommodate and absorb will inevitably produce some kind of functional collapse. Collapse is structural damage, which - unlike repression - will not resolve of its own accord over time without some kind of external assistance. But mostly what we suffer from as a result of trauma are problems relating to natural repression, from having 'suspended processes' that have been left frozen and unresolved.

The point to remember here is that - whilst adaptive and healthy as an emergency response - natural systemic repression is not at all valid as a long term option. The system is simply not physiologically prepared to cope well with such for long periods. It is costly, inherently stressful, and disables other elements of healthy organic functioning by its presence. When viewed from the frontal level, it could be said that the system, in installing repression, effectively ransoms a degree of happiness. In this way it knows that higher functioning will always return to tidy up once the stress or danger has gone. On the surface of it, it seems like a pretty smart trick - another advantage of being so complex.

Cultural Evolution

The other essential factor to understanding the human organism is the strong relationship between the individual and culture. It is not hard to see the way culture and the individual tend to directly reflect each other, and that a profound degree of transmission occurs in both directions. We see the transmission of patterns and structures at every subjective level, both positive and negative.

Almost all of the elements of subjective functioning we display are not self generated, but 'borrowed' from others or culture. We learn them. Positive transmission is absolutely necessary for healthy development to occur. An inept culture can fail to provide the modelling necessary for healthy development, and can also directly force particular dysfunction, distortion or developmental stunting to occur. All cultures are guilty of these in some way. Oppression creates repression.

Every culture contains subcultures, so clear generalisations cannot be made. But just as an individual can be damaged or stunted by circumstance, so a culture can be damaged or stunted by circumstance.

Our primary influence from cultural conditioning obviously comes through our families, from our parents or primary caregivers in particular. It is through their relationship to us that we learn to relate to ourselves, and to others.

Attachment, the root of emotive functioning, begins in infancy as globalised attachment to the primary caregiver, and is only gradually transferred over time by deep emotive processes as we assume responsibility for our own needs and become adults. But in childhood we are literally fused with the functioning of our caregivers, and cannot help but model almost everything off them.

So culture forces us to adhere to certain patterns of behaviour and functioning. Individuals create culture, and culture creates individuals.

It is probably clear that we are currently a long way from realising our ultimate social potential. And the conflict I am indicating within each individual can also be clearly observed at the level of the collective. Culture reflects it directly and exactly, and I will be coming back to this level as we progress.

Three necessary perspectives:

We can now view the entire human state from three distinct perspectives. I believe only these three views together can give us a clear picture of what is really going on, however I will only be outlining them very roughly here.

1. Firstly is the 'native-subjective' view. This is the easy and natural view of life from the perspective of the frontal conscious self. This is the surface view of things, the view you already use and know.

Here we see a conscious 'self' being animated by deeper forces in the organism, but not really understanding its role in the underlying drama. It is existing in the role of intermediary between two worlds, inner and outer. Trying to please both. The frontal self appears, even to itself, to be gratifying its own desires and responding to its own aversions. But in truth it is merely fulfilling a complex relational agenda which is being dictated to it by the system it was built to serve.

2. Secondly there is what I will call the 'primary-relational' view. This addresses any situation from a purely relational perspective, just what is really going on. It is a way of looking **beneath the surface** of our **outer** world to the underlying transactions. This view is primary reality, actual reality in the raw. This is the Mac truck.

Here we see the underlying reality of organic existence, the reason all of the rest exists. We see an organism using highly refined and sophisticated systems in pursuit of its own well being and survival. This view shows us the nuts and bolts of life, the core element. It may seem irreverent to reduce ourselves down to the complex expression of what are actually quite simple principles, but what option is there? This is simply the case. The real world is the physical world. Whatever lies within us is merely the inside of the outside.

3. Thirdly there is the 'core-functional' view. This is the view of what is happening within the operational functioning of the organism's higher management systems. In this sense we are looking **beneath the surface** of our **inner** world.

Here we see all the underlying operations which together function to create and animate the frontal persona and thus act to address the organism's relational concerns. A body of busy activity of incredible integrity, animating many capacities simultaneously so as to produce a kaleidoscope of subjective experience. We see here the creation of a kind of secondary reality, something which serves a valid function, but which is never actually real. It is only real in so far as the body, which is real, responds to it.

If we look at this all at once we can see a marvellous symphony of co-operative activity, all fitting together seamlessly and running almost automatically. The result of all subjective functioning, and the purpose of it all, is the production of a transactional agenda which functions to fulfil the organisms needs and to protect its interests. This agenda is the point, the apex, of all change management functions. There is the unconscious base transaction, there is the unconscious inner functions doing their job, and then the conscious frontal persona being swept along between them like the meat in the sandwich. Altogether acting to fulfil a functional agenda which would seem entirely achievable - being made up mostly of the organism's purely physical requirements, plus a few behavioural tendencies which have little individual value, but which relate to overall species survival, or which are simply remnants of outdated historical adaptations.

All things being equal, this whole system works remarkably well. It is almost unfathomable in its integrity and efficiency. Not to mention obvious complexity.

I guess we can now take a moment to revisit the questions posed in section one concerning the value of emotion and following what you feel. It would certainly seem that the system is hardwired so as to be governed by emotive forces, and that such should - ideally - represent the systems highest integrity at the deepest level. The higher functions are naturally loaded so as to perpetually work toward the most ideal primary level state possible. It should be organically assured that what IS good naturally FEELS good, thus tending all relational transactions in that direction. That yes, we should allow both deep emotive processes to do their work, for such keeps us well adjusted in a changing world. As well as allow ourselves to be governed by the forces which naturally move us. To submit fully to our own core, and learn to dance to the beat of our own music.

As the frontal self, we are in the end, servants, not masters. Perhaps this is where we are going wrong. But is it a fair game? Can we truly abandon ourselves to following what we feel and simply go where our flow takes us in each moment? It

sounds good instinctively, but surely if this worked we would already be doing it? It certainly feels good to follow whatever moves you, but why does it not seem to lead us to where we want to be?

The profound answer to this seemingly simple question lies in the complex dynamic I will seek to briefly outline in the next section.

SECTION THREE

The Fundamental Human Dilemma

With a glimpse of the human system in its native state, and a little of our basic inner anatomy outlined, we can now begin to fill in the rest of the picture to get a view of the common human state as we generally see it. Section Two was a view free of the conflict I am going to define here. I will now broadly sketch what I perceive to be the true nature and origins of common human unhappiness. Not a pretty picture.

This subjective conflict, is it the same for everyone? No. It seems to be universally present, but can vary greatly in form and intensity, although all forms and degrees of this thing share the same basic anatomy. We all suffer from the same basic dis-ease. So for the sake of this outline, I will be describing it in what I perceive to be its core anatomy, common to all.

The human system, like all organisms, is capable of meeting all of its authentic transactional needs within the environment in which it evolved. If not, it would not be here, it would have been selected for extinction. It can be presumed that we evolved in a circumstance of extreme hardship and scarcity. Mere survival would often have been a daily issue, and the average lifespan well under thirty. Thus, in our modern and affluent world, fulfilling our elementary requirements should be very easy and securely achievable by contrast. Likewise for the emotive agenda which represents such concerns. We should, by all accounts, be happy all the time.

If anything, things are too easy. We are getting fat and lazy. Resource overload.

So what's going on? Why are we so unhappy?

We have - in evolutionary time - recently divorced ourselves from our natural continuum, the environment in which we evolved and to which most of our functioning is still adapted. We obviously suffer to some degree as a result of this, from being separated from many things we biologically expect in life. Simple sunshine and fresh air. Natural form and beauty. Nomadic lifestyle, the seasons, a sense of implicit surrender to the wider processes of nature.

Many many things are now absent. Thus, our civilization is a bit like an old fashioned zoo, and like caged animals we go a bit crazy. We are forced to conform to unnatural patterns of functioning and behaviour.

And added to this to some degree, because we have taken the reins of nature, we have also undermined the foundations of our own deeper sense of trust in the greater process of life. There seems to be a deep underlying anxiety implicit in the knowledge that we have recently assumed great power without much obvious understanding concerning the responsibilities which come with such. A sense that we are meddling with things we don't understand, and that we cannot stop ourselves. A sense of being out of control at the helm of the Earth.

Both of these factors are the direct results of our recent advancements in culture and technology. They are both serious issues and are worth addressing. We may even discover creative solutions to them if we are sufficiently prepared to re-examine our relationship to the planet and to the greater web of life of which we are a part. But these are *not* the issues I am going to seek to address here. Whilst the impact of environmental stresses and anxiety about our place here are very real, they are not the primary cause of human unhappiness as I see it. Quite the contrary, I believe human unhappiness to be the primary cause of ecological stress, but that is another matter.

In the end, what I hope to illustrate is that such external stresses pale by comparison to the kinds of stress we can unwittingly inflict on ourselves directly from within. That there is indeed something else at work here.

In our recent development as a species we have realised many extraordinary capacities which have provided equally extraordinary advantages, and given us dominion over all other organisms. These capacities have allowed us to imagine and to communicate and to manipulate our environment. But the recent convergence of functioning which delivered these unprecedented capacities also brought with it certain unforeseen potentials for trouble. And one potential in particular, which I will now begin to introduce.

Inevitable Error

The capacity of the human system to construct 'artificial reality' is clearly a boon for the species. And all the advantages delivered by the capacity to 'believe' have been grasped wholeheartedly by the underlying emotive system out of which this functioning emerged, for it allows us to respond to aspects of reality which are beyond our direct capacity to sense. Things we can - in fact - only imagine are happening. And because this capacity and its many associated operations serve the organism's interests, they remain in full integrity with its overall development. It is a healthy and adaptive capacity. But in the resulting state, it is not generally realised that most of what we presume to be reality is not reality at all, let alone just how prone our subjective reality systems are to error, perhaps because such knowledge would produce too much doubt

to allow us to continue functioning in the ways we do. But such errors are massive and inevitable. And the implications are dramatic.

Significant error in the way beliefs and subjective functioning are structured could be disastrous for the organism, and the system must go to great lengths to avoid such. And if we examine some of the obvious causes of such error we can see exactly what the system is up against in its efforts to retain belief integrity, and why some mistakes are simply unavoidable.

We have already addressed what I call 'organic bias', in that every organic system is very selective in how it perceives any situation. That it always has only a local view, and even then places special importance on aspects of reality which directly pertain to its own interests. The result of this, once it has affected the construction of active belief systems, being a distorted and very parochial appreciation of reality. But there are other even more significant factors to consider.

There is the fact that the whole function of belief itself operates in contrast to the way most organic systems work. That this very function operates in direct conflict to the system's native integrity in one key respect. What we see here - what belief does - is higher level functioning determining the behaviour and response of core levels. Thoughts producing and influencing emotive states. Which sounds OK I suppose, that's what beliefs are for after all. The core is supposed to respond to reality, and these thoughts do represent such.

Well, we hope they do. And here is the problem. What if they don't? So this is backwards to some degree, and has the potential for trouble. Here we see a direct violation to the way organic systems generally operate, we have the servant controlling the master.

Thought, generally, is a direct product of emotive activity. But in this case, emotive activity is the result of thought. And anyone with a knowledge of system dynamics will spot the interesting potentials here. It is the one way flow - the hierarchical nature of organic process - which makes it work, and which ensures integrity. But here we see a two way flow, and the potential for a degenerative cycle.

The core is effectively bouncing its own energy back at itself. Like looking in a mirror.

'What's that?' says the core. 'Ooh, what's that', says the mind. 'What, what did you say, I knew that was something?' says the core. 'Oh my god what, what is it, where, is that it there?' says the mind....

The stupid but powerful core employs processes and keeps them under its control, but is also subject to those functions to a significant degree. And how does the emotive core, which is driving all this, know if what is being reported is correct?

It doesn't! It has no higher authority to which it can appeal than the very processes and functions we are discussing. Beyond direct perception, these are the processes to which the core looks to check reality before it acts. If they are wrong then there is nothing it can do. All it can do is enforce as much integrity as possible, on whatever basis it sees fit.

Error is not only likely in the operation of these functions, but deliberate corruption is highly probable. This backward integrity means that a direct conflict of interests exists in terms of the way power is managed within the system. There is great power being delivered to the higher levels. And the only way the core ensures integrity is by making sure higher levels are subject to influence from the core, by structuring them to act in ways which 'feel' good, and by controlling those emotive influences. But what this cyclic potential effectively does is that it allows the organism the power to make itself feel good by corrupting its own functioning.

The core, the system as a whole, can simply 'make up' its own 'reality' to suit itself. It can sanitise its view of reality, and make reality a bit more 'comfortable'. Very tempting in certain situations. And the implications of such corruption are pretty dire. Like the elected government taking all our taxes and blowing them by shouting everyone to a massive party, it obviously defeats the very purpose for which these systems were developed and adopted in the first place. But there is a strong inbuilt tendency toward such corruption, and it has the potential to invalidate the whole belief system and all the functioning which depends on it.

Then there is what I call 'reality contamination'. It would seem, from what we now understand, that the capacity to see reality clearly is actually made *more* confusing by virtue of the very functioning through which the system is now bound to look. Although the capacity to represent reality mentally was supposed to help the system get a grip on reality, once operating the natural confusion between the resulting *two* realms of human reality actually makes it *harder* to sift fact from fiction.

Belief systems represent *presumed* reality to the emotive core, but do so by representing it *as* reality, thus confusing subsequent perception. The frontal self is the recipient of this subjectively created 'reality', but it is also the system's eyes and ears. The frontal self does not even realise that a secondary reality exists! It presumes that it is all real. But even if it was aware of what was happening, it would be difficult for the frontal self to tease the two kinds of human reality apart. Which means that aspects of 'subjective' reality can potentially become circular and self generating, with no basis in fact at all.

Does this make sense? It is very important. We manufacture a 'false' reality to simulate actual reality in order to relate better to actual reality. But in doing so we obscure our own view of actual reality by not being able to clearly tell the two apart, thus creating the potential for dangerous cyclic or 'enclosed' experiential realities which have no basis in fact whatsoever.

Lastly, we can see the problems posed by the incredible complexity and sophistication of the functions themselves, as well as the gravity of the task they face. The formulation of accurate and appropriate belief structures moment to moment is a monumental achievement. The processes involved in such are so blindingly sophisticated and refined that they defy any comprehensive definition. The sheer complexity begs some degree of error. There are simply so many places it can go a bit wrong.

And the task set before such? Beliefs represent reality beyond the reach of the senses. Simple. But take a look at reality for a moment. In order to accurately frame its local reality, what this simple duty (ideal belief formation) means is the construction of a working model of reality as a whole, of the *entire universe*! Including both past, present and future. Which is obviously not possible, especially inside the tiny head of a bipedal ape. This demand, and the limited resources at the systems disposal, are what cause the 'organic bias' we have already discussed. The system must be highly selective and pick out only the elements of perception which relate to its own direct concerns. Overall, the task is too great.

Cosmology

Even with such a bias - maybe even because of such a bias - there is a need for some kind of bigger picture. In framing its view of local reality, the system must continuously orient that within a wider view of everything in general. General beliefs must often define 'the way things are'. Immutable or unchangeable fact, defining bigger or wider reality. This bigger view we often call Cosmology. This is the part of our total belief systems which purports to define what's going on in general, in life, in existence as a whole. And such information functions to provide the essential backdrop for our everyday existence, it sets the frame within which the picture of our life will be viewed. This framework functions to give meaning to events as they occur, and defines the **significance** of events. And, unlike the changing local picture, this broad frame is effectively permanent. But it is also, unfortunately, the one area of belief formation which is open to severe degrees of error and interpretation. Included in this view, by the way, is our basic understanding of what we call our 'self'.

Our cosmology must necessarily contain our own answers to some of the most important, but perplexing, questions concerning our existence. Ideas which have the power to deeply affect the way circumstances and experiences are interpreted and responded to. Questions like- 'who am I?', 'what is important?', 'why are we here?', and 'what is the universe?'. And remember, all beliefs - including such broader ones - are made up from scratch by the organism in response to its limited experiences.

Thus, when you examine it, it is obvious that many of the wider questions facing the individual system concerning the construction of a comprehensive picture of reality are simply too great to overcome. This broader part of the overall picture is both massively important to our perception of reality, as well as simply massively massive. The part of reality beyond our immediate personal senses is obviously by far the greater part of reality.

So, using only its own senses, an individual organism cannot ever hope to ascertain what is going on in existence overall. There are simply many many questions well beyond the capacity of an individual mind to answer. Error is inevitable if the organism is left to figure it out for itself - to construct its own cosmology.

What can it do then? Well, every individual human system is forced - if such is available to it - to rely heavily on answers, or parts of answers, already figured out by others. It is forced to borrow. Which once again represents a great advantage, but also a very great potential liability.

Beliefs - ideas about reality - can only be based on knowledge of direct 'experience'. And such knowledge can come from only three sources-

1. direct, present or tacit experience [personal now].
2. mental models constructed of experiences you yourself actually had [personal memory].
3. mental models communicated to you in symbolic form of experiences you did not personally have, but which fulfil your own self determined criteria for believability [history, hearsay].

And from these three we must build our own 'reality'. So how trustworthy are these? Of the three, direct experience is the most accurate and trustworthy, although still very subject to contextual misinterpretation as we've seen.

The second is less accurate or reliable, being subject to the same contextual misinterpretation given to the original experience, but also to the internal pressures of systemic functioning ever since. The system basically has the power, and

often the need, to distort, erase from awareness, or even create fictitious memories - and all without informing the frontal self.

The third is the least accurate for obvious reasons, as it does not necessarily pertain to direct experience in any way at all, and can easily contain massive amounts of complete fiction. And - which is the really scary thing - by far the larger portion of everything we believe is sourced from this third origin. Almost everything you know about the wider universe and our place in it you learned indirectly from someone else, who themselves learned it from someone else....

All of this potential for corruption means that the system must work very hard to find and maintain some degree of integrity. It must develop strategies and strict criteria for the formation of accurate belief. After all, if it gets it wrong, the results could be serious. Beliefs are only an advantage in so far as they represent reality accurately, beyond which point they become a very distinct liability. So we have developed some pretty bulletproof systems to protect the integrity of all this.

What, then, can the human system do to overcome such strong and diverse potentials for corruption?

First of all, beliefs - any thoughts which pertain to reality - are seriously protected from 'internal' corruption. They are designed to be reality oriented, and be directly affected by what some have termed 'object referral'. The system has many processes which continually check beliefs against actual reality, probing for changes or errors in the way beliefs are being formulated moment to moment. In keeping with this, even uncomfortable reality - if supported by direct perception - is hardwired so as to take precedence over any emotionally comfortable substitute or preference.

This 'reality check', based upon sensory perception and processes of reason, is what prevents the potential for wild and unbridled spirals of events occurring on the basis of pure emotional corruption.

The same 'reality checks' apply to how the system selects what it will accept as real from the more spurious information available to it. We can see now that great advantages may be gained by an individual if it can make use of things it did not figure out itself, but which it must effectively acquire from others secondhand. But how does an organism sift the wheat from the chaff when selecting what will be taken on, and what will be discarded as fictitious? How can it assess what is likely to be real? To be factual?

Well, the system must try to develop criteria and procedures to facilitate such discernment. Ways of checking such so-called 'reality'. These processes must account for 'reality contamination', 'organic bias', 'backward integrity', and as much 'natural error' resulting from systemic load as possible. And overcoming any one of these factors is a great achievement. Just the procedures which function to eliminate influence from 'subjective' reality are incredible. Being charged with the job of progressively removing the 'reality contamination' belief functions unfortunately produce. Which is no mean feat. After all, subjective reality is designed to merge seamlessly with actual reality and be indistinguishable from it.

So throughout development into adulthood, our own system is forced to seek better ways of handling information and forming more accurate beliefs in the face of extraordinary pressures and demands which would otherwise corrupt such. The construction of an accurate picture of reality therefore requires some degree of good judgement, and good judgement requires functions with integrity and sophistication which can account for the kinds of bias present in a loaded organic system. And like all other aspects of the human system, these functions which manage belief formation go through stages of development throughout life. Each emergent stage represents a better and more objective capacity, capable of constructing more accurate and integrated belief systems. But like software in a computer, these potentials do not simply emerge on their own from the hardware. No, just as many ideas about reality must be taken on from others, so must these patterns of functioning be learned and modelled from others.

A caveman could not think as we do. A caveman could not speak or communicate as we do. A caveman could probably not conceptualise many abstract ideas as we do. Yet there was no distinguishable difference between our brain and that of a human 100,000 yrs ago. A child of that age, raised in our culture, would develop and function exactly as we do. There is no physiological difference. So what is the difference, then?

Once again - as in section two - we see the influence of culture on the individual. Both the development of our overall belief **structures**, and the **systems** which manage belief formation, require cultural support in order to develop. An individual has no chance of figuring it all out for themselves, there is simply too much to possibly account for. Not only mental contents, but also ways of manipulating contents, are able to be transmitted between individuals.

So, modelling themselves on the better and more sophisticated functioning of others, individuals are able to acquire not only ideas, but functional capacities they would never have acquired on their own, advantages resulting from the accumulated experiences of many generations. And not only particular thoughts, but entire ways of thinking can be transmitted. Many functional patterns must, in fact, be transmitted, for without such they will simply never emerge on their own. Much of what we now generally presume to be 'normal cognitive functioning' is actually a cluster of inventions transmitted to us from our forebears. Mental inventions. And it is in this way that culture allows an individual to rapidly acquire functional advancements it would never have gained on its own.

So, for the developing individual, **culture provides both information about reality, as well as the tools required to assess such information properly**. And here we can see the power of culture to affect the development of an individual.

What if those in power within a culture never received such support themselves, what can they offer those they mentor? Well, sadly, you cannot give what you have not got. Just as we can observe the development of stages in an individual, and the kinds of belief formation each stage supports, so we can also look back and see that culture has followed the same path as it emerged.

There was a time when rational thought would get you stoned to death in the street. And just as any individual can become fixated at a particular level of functional development, so an entire culture can do the same. Cultural relativism and political correctness aside for a moment, all cultures are simply not created equal. Of any single determining factor, culture can provide the greatest advantage to an individual, but it can also embody and perpetuate the greatest errors by way of omission, or impose errors by way of oppression. Developmentally stunted cultures produce equally stunted individuals. And developmentally stunted individuals lack the capacity to easily discern fact from fiction, making them susceptible to erroneous and emotionally loaded belief systems.

Anyway, the question has to be asked - How much culture - how much of what people believe and live by as being real - is not real at all in terms of actual reality, but purely the product of belief corruption and subjective need? There is enormous potential here for self-perpetuating cultural belief systems with no basis in fact whatsoever.

All secondary-subjective reality is personally manufactured. We create it all. And all the wider elements of that subjective reality must be taken on from culture, accepted on faith effectively. So all it takes for something to be accepted as fact, is simply not to check it. Checking things - applying reason and constructing an integrated belief structure - requires strategy, effort and deliberate intention: Intellectual rigour. So it is obviously very tempting for higher functions in any system to take the easy path and simply manufacture reality to please. In fact this is inevitable to some degree. And the result of such corruption is reality distortion.

‘Sanitised reality’ is the vice of the weak minded. I suppose we are all weak minded to some degree, and it would seem that great clumps of significant error are an unavoidable reality even in the best of circumstances. And because of the significance of these functions, such error poses great threats to the wellbeing of the organism as a whole in its relationship to actual reality.

It seems amazing, then, given everything we have just seen, that we can achieve any semblance of accurate belief at all. But human cognition is mysterious. Even with all these obstacles, it can achieve marvellous feats of creative ingenuity in constructing scenarios and outcomes to particular actions before they even happen. The potential for natural error and corruption in the way this whole complex is arranged is certainly always present, but the system does a marvellous job in surmounting it all. It overcomes incredible odds to achieve what it does, and displays remarkable integrity in the face of very significant pressure.

But, sadly, one such negative potential is exactly what occurs - and that is the real topic of this entire section. And with everything we have addressed we are now in a position to begin defining it. It is one which slips through the net, and seems to do so universally, perhaps being the natural result of recent changes. A particularly inconspicuous - though deceptively serious - error has occurred, a particular negative factor which even the organism’s best security measures clearly did not control, predict or prepare for.

The Crisis

As we develop in childhood and quickly begin to actualise the convergence of functioning which produced our secondary reality, we begin to overlay what we see with our own conceptions of things as we see them. We expand our world via imagination and gradually construct a working model of the universe in which we exist. We come to live in two realms of reality, although we may not ever realise it as such. And the vast majority of our emotional experience becomes sourced in this dynamic mental simulation of reality. From the frontal subjective perspective of conscious awareness, this construction effectively becomes the organism’s world.

This whole ‘reality’ is produced to support the organism in its relationship to actual reality, and the most important aspect of actual reality for the organism, is obviously the organism itself. Organic bias, natural self-centredness, is innate. Thus, in this imagined world of past and future and widened present, there is an implied need for an imaginary ‘self’ to inhabit it for the organism.

In reproducing the world in its imagination, the organism must also project itself into this mental world. It must simulate everything as accurately as possible. So a mental ‘self’ is created, invested with emotion and then projected into time, and scenarios played out. And emotive leverage generated on the basis of that ‘experience’. In this way the core animates and directs the frontal persona.

The frontal persona is constructed to represent the entire system and its needs, to play a functional role by acting out the most desired scenario at any moment. In this way, via the emotive core and all the functions which combine to produce the frontal persona, the organism meets its needs in a complex relational world.

So the organism manufactures an imaginary world to simulate reality, and must then manufacture an imaginary self to inhabit it. The result of this is the eventual formulation of an active mental self concept - the ego, or subjective self.

What must be recognised is that whilst in actual reality this mental self reference is functionally valid, it is never literally real. However, it is important for healthy functioning. It is a legitimate mental self-reference for the organism in the way it constructs its artificial picture of reality. After all, the very point of building this 'reality' is to help in the organism's relationship with actual reality. So it would be pointless not to include itself in the picture. Quite the contrary, the entire picture is directly built around this imagined self. As it should be. That is, after all, the whole point.

The problem with this whole procedure, however, is that whilst the organism has the capacity to achieve it, it does not have the need to inform itself as to how and why. And as a result, the lines get blurred. As already stated, the system has not ever realised just how much of its experience is based on subjectively manufactured reality, nor how much potential error such implies. The mere fact that not all 'reality' is real is often not even noticed. The frontal self simply presumes that if the deeper system says it is real, then it is real. Which unfortunately includes this functional self reference.

'So what?' you may ask. Well, the point of all this is that at some point the seemingly autonomous **frontal persona**, in concert with this functional **self reference**, becomes entrenched as a formal identity - 'I'.

'I' is in fact a pure abstraction based upon many forms of necessary self-reference, all of which ultimately relate to structures, processes and systems of the base organism which mental functions serve. But what happens is that this abstraction becomes easily accepted at the very root of the emotive core as being fundamentally real.

Perhaps because it is so simple, this idea 'self' becomes a literal reality in emotional terms. Thereby trapping this simple thought in a cycle between mind and emotion, and the system doesn't even notice. It is so close that it cannot see it. Completely transparent.

This active yet transparent idea then comes to operate within this system at a very contextual level. Because of its particular nature, it embeds itself so as to function as both a general belief, a core belief, an operating framework, a core directive... you name it. And does so permanently. Somewhere between the body and the mind, this mental concept 'I' assumes the throne as a literal reality, the source and subject of all functioning.

The difficult thing here is that you are reading these words from the very perspective being discussed. This sense of 'self' is one of the defining characteristics of a healthy and active frontal persona - it is natural and normal. But it must also be recognised as an illusion of mind. It is natural to perceive there is a 'self', and to experience life as if there is one. Which for some people makes it hard to explain, or to give you any clear perspective on this.

But this 'I', the thing you presume yourself to be, is merely a product of complex processes of perception and deduction and emotion. 'I' is, in the end, just a thought. Nothing, in substance, except an electrochemical process in the brain. Always something we are doing, never something we are ever actually being. Which begs the question- 'if I am not this I, then who am I?'. Yes, very profound to be sure, and we will come to this. But suffice it to say that you are not, and cannot be, whoever you think you are.

'I' is the ultimate core belief. Simple but supremely profound. Functionally valid, but not actually true. It is natural but not real, supported by evolution as an idea, but not ever actually the case. 'I' is ultimately an idea which relates to no reality. An idea for which there is no actual referent or truth. There is, in fact, no 'thing' this idea 'I' represents. There is no object- 'I'. There is no self, in the sense that 'I' refers to such. An organism has no 'self', nothing which finally distinguishes it from its environment. Such a distinction is merely a useful but manufactured perception based on very biased information.

Granted, the obvious autonomy every organic structure displays naturally supports the assumption. But the conscious frontal persona is not actually an 'entity', it is just the sum product of a complex functional equation moment to moment. It is part of a wider organic process, which is itself part of a wider universal process.

It is merely supposed to act like an entity. But there is no fundamental separation point at which 'self' ends and everything else begins. 'Self' is, in fact, merely a belief. Just a thought, moment to moment. Something we experience as real emotionally because we believe it, but which has no basis in fact. Which is not at all to say that we don't exist, just that we are not fundamentally separate or distinct in the way we have come to imagine we are.

So this simple idea of self is a central element of the organism's own subjective re-construction of reality, a picture which helps the system function in relation to actual reality. As a presumed reality it is a mistake, never an accurate representation of fact, but because of its radical simplicity, and the lack of object referral to the contrary, the system cannot shake it. This constructed 'self' is in fact something the system is doing, but the system becomes convinced that it is something it is

being. And it remains as a permanent mental assertion. A stable belief, and an emotionally experienced reality. Thus 'I' becomes embedded as a permanent and automatic assertion, a silent and unconscious element of our general belief systems, which are transparent, stable and unchallenged.

So there would seem to be an inherent loophole in the way human functioning has emerged, and this simple yet profound belief appears predisposed to slip through it and become immune to challenge.

'So what?' I hear you say. Never hurt me none! What harm could a simple idea do? After all, it seems to be an advantage for the organism to adopt a stance which promotes its own interests and importance. Well, the effects of this assertion becoming established are far more dramatic than might be presumed. Not just because it is such a persistent belief, but because it functions to have a powerfully modulating effect on many other subjective functions. Why this is and what it means I will now seek to explain.

Back to basics again for a moment -

- The foundations of all functioning in the system are its needs.
- Need underlies attachment, the very root of all emotive activity.
- Needs operate in a kind of hierarchy, higher taking precedence over those lower.
- All the authentic needs of the human system, or any organic system, are what I will call 'conditional'. They are all limited and able to be fulfilled. Finite, because the system is finite.
- The capacities of an organic system are always well fitted to the fulfilment of its needs. They match.
- And every element of higher human functioning finally relates back to this foundational level as its reason for being. Activity only occurs at the higher level when, at the primary level, fulfilment does not match need.

Need / fulfilment = emotive activity. And systemic need is stable over time as defined by the nature of the structure itself.

It is the fulfilment which varies, and which is managed by the system's activities.

The system basically has no evolutionary precedent for radical changes in need, and therefore does not have any mechanisms in place to address or account for such. After all, changes in need only occur very slowly in evolutionary time, accompanying changes in physiology. But with the shift to the way we now operate some interesting potentials became possible. Most significant of which is that one of the things the system was required to do in formulating its own self reference, was to represent its own needs in a balanced way. And this is where we see the problem. 'I' may be an idea which relates to no reality, for which there is no objective fact or truth. But because, via our capacity to believe, we experience it as a reality, and act as such, this idea functions to dramatically modify the way need is represented within the system. And when I say dramatically, I mean it.

The results of this, of 'I' becoming established, is that the entire functional agenda shifts from the wellbeing of the organism to the survival of this new 'abstract self'. The game is the same, but the stakes change. All emotions become the 'I's emotions, all thoughts become the 'I's thoughts. It becomes inserted at the root of all functioning, as the first cause of active functioning, the ultimate subject of all activity. The system itself is duped into operating from this point of reference, and doesn't even realise it has occurred. Always the looker, and never the looked at, this imaginary 'I' becomes the absolute centre of systemic attention. And because the system has no 'I', no real 'self' as such, there is no function in the system to threaten it. This idea 'I' is a natural consequence of our kind of functioning, and because the organism has no actual self, it basically finds no opposition when it inevitably seeks to crown itself emperor.

So the natural communal nature of systemic functioning becomes an immediate dictatorship. Rather than the body having an 'I', the 'I' now has a body. The tale begins to wag the dog.

This is a bit like a person becoming an elected official, and once gaining power immediately declaring themselves King or Queen - that they are master, rather than servant. And the people, being stupid and looking to their leader for insight, simply accepting that.

So the functional agenda of the organism is adjusted so as to accommodate its new 'owner', and processes set in motion to begin to fulfil its requirements. And this is the problem. The entire functioning of the system becomes fitted to the fulfilment of the needs of this imagined 'self'. And the needs of a 'self' are not the same as the needs of a natural organic system.

The primary shift which occurs in this event is the inclusion of 'existential' needs in the functional agenda of a limited organic system. For, rather than being primary to existence itself, this new 'self' would seem to be highly subject to conditional events, and to only 'exist' under certain circumstances. And to 'exist' is perceived as an absolute need.

The result is a dramatic shift in the subjectively embedded sense of need, an unnecessary addition of dramatic proportions.

If natural needs could be ranked on a scale of one to ten, and organised that way, then the needs of a 'self' would come in at eleven. So it happens at a very contextual level. Objectively, nothing has changed. Which seems paradoxical given that almost everything is now different.

If a need was added at three on the scale you would notice it, but because it is off the scale it is like a new frame for the same old picture. All need fulfilment now becomes perceived to be contingent to 'I'. Thus all subsequent functioning leads back to this, to the survival of 'I'. All events feed back to this same nexus.

The organism itself, the substance of the structure and the reality of its existence, is never actually threatened by all this imaginary drama. The true self of the organism, its real source and substance, is never bothered. No matter how much 'I' is believed and felt to be real, it never actually becomes so. It is always just a recurring thought, and a simple one at that.

Functionally, however, the results of this are that the finite organic system is left with an agenda which contains elements which are absolute in nature. And not only impossible to fulfil, but of the highest level of emotional valence. All of a sudden needs go through the roof, and emotions naturally follow.

The system then sets about seeking to achieve these new ends, and is forced to apply its limited resources in pursuit of what is actually an infinite goal. Like trying to swallow the ocean. 'I' is a thought, moment to moment, but because it is believed to **be** self, existence itself becomes contingent on thinking, on subjective activity. Which is a terrible occurrence in a system which is designed to feel good when it is still.

If you observe any organism it is clear that it does not need to fulfil such needs, that it does not even have such needs. It is part of a greater process and ultimately has no distinct existence of its own. It does not live, but is 'lived', by a process greater than itself.

All the functions of organic systems are relational in nature, and an organism cannot fulfil requirements which are beyond its capacities. Thus the inclusion of such absolute need in the functional agenda of an organism creates the foundations for a completely irresolvable problem - an impossible crisis of great subjective significance.

All this happens in childhood as we learn to construct our own self image, and is OK up to a point because the system remains in blissful ignorance of the greater implications. As children we are strongly 'self' oriented, but we are also securely immortal in our own minds. So although the ingredients are there for a substantial crisis, we do not yet have the capacity to put it all together.

But healthy functioning gradually emerges, and 'self' is increasingly seen to exist through time. It is projected into the future, and emotion experienced as a result. Eventually, even though it is culturally withheld, the reality of imminent death becomes evident to the primal mind. And this reality naturally attracts attention and begins a spiral of functional activity.

The results of the complex construction which follows this inevitably leads to an impasse. Ultimate need gradually or even rapidly confronts the reality of ultimate thwart. The need itself is of a valence the system is not even designed to cope with, and with death it is thwarted in absolute terms. The continued existence of 'self' is felt to be absolutely essential, and equally absolutely dependent on the survival of the body. The only thing standing between the system and the dreadful reality of death, is time. And that time is realised to be getting shorter and shorter with every passing second.

No answers are offered by culture to this emerging crisis, for what the child does not realise is that the adults they turn to are just as scared as they are, beneath their well polished denial.

Over time, as capacities emerge, healthy functioning attempts to resolve this dilemma - by seeking to fulfil needs it does not have, and failing completely.

Need fulfilment processes act to find ways through difficult problems. And the core produces tension until they do. So this process goes through all the natural options. First there is action to ensure fulfilment (frustration, or anger), which ultimately finds no leverage. Then the only other option, action to integrate the need into the system as a 'desire producing' tension (grief). But this is not possible either, because of the nature of the need. There is no achievable potential to be desired, and it is simply not possible to integrate an infinite tension into a finite system.

The result, then, is the highest possible tension with the least possible resolution. Fear, and deadlock. Existential fear in fact, the highest valence emotive tension potential in the human system.

Existential fear, or just fear in general, has the power to suspend ordinary functioning at many levels and acquire emergency resources so as to achieve its ends. It eclipses normal healthy functioning and - because of its negative effect - it disables ordinary motive polarities. It cripples normal healthy functioning entirely. Like a country in the grip of an economic crash, everything stops.

The result, then, is a crisis in functioning, an emotive spiral of the greatest proportions originating from the system's own healthy functioning. In this way it would seem that the system has been able to actualise the most powerful and serious negative potential possible, and do so in a way it cannot understand, control, or undo.

And why does this happen, you ask? Perhaps simply because it was there. Evolution does not think ahead, it simply tries a million different things and eliminates the ones that don't work.

If you look at the 'core-functional' gravity of this event, and imagine what it would naturally equate to in 'primary-relational' terms, it amounts to greater potential tension than any real situation could dictate. It results in an attempt to produce infinite emotional tension, and is only prevented from doing so by the system's own failsafe mechanisms. It produces an infinite and endlessly perplexing knot in the deepest seat of the emotive core.

It is very, very serious. But remember, there is nothing actually happening here! This is, in fact, all occurring in a situation of complete need fulfilment in organic terms. At a relational level - objectively - this whole series of events is entirely fabricated on the basis of poor information management. There is no real primary level problem to which this emotive crisis relates.

The power of this potential crisis stems from the fact that it is not related to any natural lack of fulfilment, but because it is the result of a shift at the other end of the functional continuum - need. And for exactly the same reason, it is completely invalidated by culture, and mysterious to frontal awareness. The worst possible thing has occurred, but there is no obvious evidence of anything having happened from the outside looking in.

And all the natural processes within the system - never questioning the existence of 'I' - seem to only make things worse. Like putting out fire with gasoline. Except for the one error which is not even suspected, this entire dilemma is built out of healthy functioning. And it all results in complete functional deadlock.

A terrible situation in the end, everything begins to grind to a halt as systems and functions are recruited to help resolve the impossible problem, but to no avail. There is simply no win, for such is not possible. The system cannot let go of this event, but also cannot function whilst it is active and unfulfilled. This is the primary crisis at the heart of the active conflict I am seeking to outline here.

So - what to do? There seems to be no way out.

Well, at some point in the development of this subjective crisis the organism's own emergency systems put the brakes on it to prevent functional overload. Repressive mechanisms, which are designed to absorb temporary stresses, are brought into play in order to contain this event and prevent it from spiralling further downward toward infinity. The choice facing the organism is either loss of control, or containment. And control is vital to survival.

All this occurs at some point in childhood as all this functioning is emerging, and either progressively or in some deep night time dread, this whole event is taken under and away from conscious awareness. Nightmares may explore it occasionally in an attempt to resolve it and release the effort of perpetual containment, but there is no answer to be found. The system's natural repressive capacities, designed to absorb powerful impact from the environment, become employed to deal with impact coming from within the system itself. And the scope and seriousness of these containment measures should not be underestimated. The system, however, does not realise the origins of all this, or even that need has been altered. So this is all it can do.

Maybe we should summarise then -

The way need is represented within the system is unwittingly modified to include unconditional needs, unconditional needs naturally seek to produce limitless stress in the face of imminent and absolute thwart, and the system goes into emotional overload - leaving no option but to partly shut itself down in order to keep functioning at all. And until the source of this problem is removed, this shut down must remain active indefinitely. And all because of what seems on the surface of it to be such a reasonable and harmless idea - 'I'.

So the system itself consumes this whole event and secludes it away from conscious awareness. Frontal awareness is excluded from this operation, that is the task of the control systems. And the result of this unavoidable occurrence is the establishment of what amounts to a secondary systemic agenda - like a secret government within a government, with its own motives and power.

Adding to the already complex enough native agenda, this dynamic secondary activity has infinite potential for oscillation, cycles and shifts. It is a strictly unconscious agenda with deep emotive foundations and a clear purpose or primary objective. That being the permanent and active prevention of one particular potential. And no small potential, but one which involves almost all the operations of the system.

No particular function is targeted, only a particular outcome or potential spiral of events within the system. The incredible gravity, dynamic nature, scope and seriousness of this containment process - this secondary agenda - are what we are going to be addressing here.

Beyond this point, the containment of existential fear becomes a driving force in life. This profoundly powerful fear is never actually experienced from that time forward, because life becomes completely defined by the complex and sophisticated avoidance of it. It is a life completely dominated by the avoidance of fear, fear so profound that it is never even felt.

However, a primal memory always remains somehow. Some remembrance deep within us, of something having happened, of something lost, but it remains vague and indirect.

Does this all sound a bit far fetched? Would you like some kind of proof?

Well, it's all around you as we'll see. This event and its results are very evident, but simply not recognised as such. It is very easy to see if you know how to look. But the kind of obvious proof we generally seek is evidence at the surface level of life, where this deep subjective crisis unfortunately becomes almost indistinguishable from healthy functioning in how it manifests. It is actively unconscious, so its impacts - whilst very heavy - are always going to be very nebulous diffused. And what this leads to is a situation where you 'just feel bad', but often can't point to anything in particular.

We have three levels we can discuss now concerning the nature and effects of this crisis.

- Firstly the primary origin or cause of this crisis - an embedded belief.
- Secondly, the subjective containments in all their varied forms. All of which occur below the level of conscious awareness.
- And thirdly, the outer relational effects, the demands which containments make on behaviour and our physical state.

We can see how it all becomes hidden and diffused by the time it is manifested at a surface relational level, making it hard to differentiate. But it can be defined and differentiated even at a surface level, provided you have an accurate enough model of how the cause translates into containments, and how containments translate into relational demands. In fact I believe that such a full and multi-level definition of this secondary presence, when added to a comprehensive understanding of native functioning, offers the most detailed and accurate picture of the behavioural potentials of common human state ever produced.

That may sound arrogant, but I challenge you to defy it. Our generally accepted psychological views of the human condition are so inept at addressing the core of human life that they are almost worthless in terms of the practical value they bring to people's lives. It seems blatantly clear that they miss the most significant issue entirely. Leaving them - in my opinion - somewhat inane.

In contrast, I believe the view I am outlining, when it is expounded in full, accounts for almost every lasting paradox or question left unresolved by existing perspectives. And, unlike others, it also roundly accounts for and explains the mysterious and evident lack of integrity in much human functioning.

A closer look

If you want to see what all this means to you in terms you will immediately understand and recognise, then we will have to look at how it is all experienced from the perspective of the frontal conscious persona. We can also address how it all affects the organism as a whole at a primary level.

As we saw in section two, these two levels should be working together. The frontal being the servant of the primary, they should dance in unison. But between these two lies the problem, and they are both affected in different ways.

A brief review -

The primary relational level of any organic system is the ultimate subject of all higher functioning, it is the source and reality of it. Thus, when you boil it down, the native and healthy functional agenda within the human system relates exclusively to that level. The health and relational wellbeing of the organism itself is the point of it all. So this is what we look at when we are addressing the primary level - physical health and relational wellbeing. Good health, and a good situation.

From the frontal perspective, the native agenda is experienced as emotive drives and impulses, which ultimately form the foundations of an active personality and behavioural tendencies. Acting in accord with the emotive influences produced by this native agenda results in positive experiences for the frontal self, and a sense of ease. It simply feels good, and is

supposed to. And provided the demands of the native agenda are fulfilled, the frontal self can be assured of this positive state all the time. In overall terms, it is a fair game.

So what happens with the introduction of this crisis, and its subsequent containments?

At the primary relational level, not much. Primary organic concerns are not immediately affected by this crisis, after all it is essentially imaginary. But the ongoing containments do have effects, because of their transactional demands. Remember, the primary organic level is only affected by relational changes, which is what the native agenda - via the frontal persona - is supposed to produce.

How, then, does this crisis affect the frontal persona, and thereby indirectly affect the primary organic level?

Well, the secondary agenda produced by this crisis can be seen to have two central elements in terms of what it seeks to achieve in contrast to the native agenda with which it must compete.

- Firstly, it will seek to fulfil the existential needs which produce the emotive crisis in the first place, thereby removing the necessity for containment.
- Secondly, failing that, it must somehow arrange for the containment of the processes resulting from the lack of such fulfilment. It must somehow push subjective functioning around so as to become comfortable with things which the system is designed to perceive as essentially unacceptable.

The objective is simply equanimity.

The kinds of subjective containment this agenda can employ are many and varied, and each produces different relational demands or side effects. And it is the side effects which are experienced by frontal awareness, never the underlying event, which is always secluded from view. These underlying containment systems can be very dynamic in the way they operate, changing and shifting from moment to moment to account for different situations. Therefore the side effects and relational demands may be equally fickle in the way they are expressed. In the end however, the result of all this activity at an unconscious level is the discharging of a very complex and dynamic body of relational demand into the emotive stream which feeds the frontal self - demands which sometimes align with the native agenda, and which sometimes don't. But which are always surplus to the actual needs of the primary organism, and completely mysterious to the frontal self. Which is not to say that the secondary agenda does not serve some valuable purpose, just no relational purpose. It does not exist to help the organism relate to the world, but is in fact only animated to save the organism from itself.

So this body of powerful yet unconscious relational demand, along with the native agenda, is what the frontal self confronts as its own emotive foundations in every moment. And which it must somehow seek to fulfil and integrate into a single plan of action. However, because the objectives of the secondary agenda are at crossed purposes to the native agenda, such integration is simply not possible. The two agendas are competing to some degree, not entirely, but in certain respects they are completely opposed.

If we come back to the primary organism again, which is the bone these two dogs are fighting over, we can boil this conflict down in quite clear terms without having to define specific relational level events.

Primary organic functioning is centred around energy and structure. Free energy is the scarce resource, and when it is present within the system - signifies need fulfilment. Free energy is the primary advantage an organism has, and to acquire free energy is the organism's primary directive. Free energy is life. Thus, any overflow of free energy at the primary level is designed to feel good to the frontal self. It is hardwired to feel like bliss. This is what motivates the higher levels.

But here, even at this most general level, we can see the dramatic impact of the crisis I am indicating, and the dilemma faced by the frontal self, because free energy is also the point of integrity around which all subjective functioning revolves.

It is what keeps everything straight and in order. In this way, because the frontal self is attracted to free energy, integrity is always assured. It is a self governing system built with free energy as its mainstay.

And here we see the conflict. In order for the secondary agenda to contain a crisis which is built out of healthy responses and functioning, it must necessarily or implicitly affect the integrity of the system. It must enforce active corruption at this subjective level, and to do so it must **block** or **limit** energy. It must lower free energy levels, and keep them from rising again beyond the point where the suspended functioning might begin to reanimate.

So what we see here is a conflict at the very root of emotive functioning. In a system whose primary directive is to acquire free energy, the call goes out - 'limit free energy!'.

A dire situation.

It needs to be stated that it is not important for the secondary agenda to limit free energy at a primary organic level, but simply to prevent any overflow into the higher levels where containments are active.

So here we can see the essential relationship between the two agendas. A very dynamic relationship. It is the function of the native healthy agenda to meet the needs of the primary organism at every level, and in the process make a profit and generate a surplus - an overflow which the frontal self, at the top of the pile, would experience as bliss. Happiness.

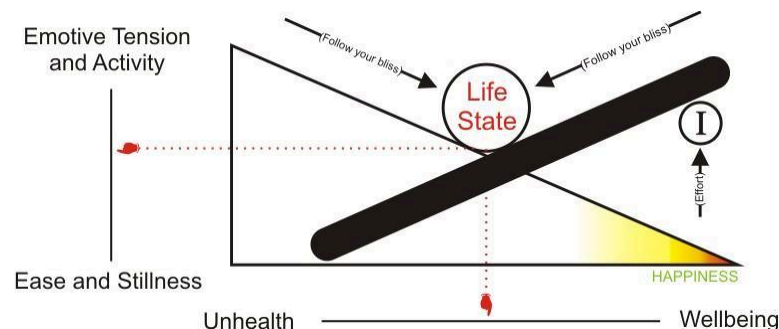
Whereas - the necessary side effect of the secondary agenda is to keep a zero bank balance at all times at the emotive level and above. It must walk the razor's edge between too little, in which case the organism would get sick, and too much, in which case the crisis would reanimate. So although health is allowed, it must never allow any surplus free energy to become liberated in the emotive core.

From the perspective of frontal awareness this profound limitation is experienced as a limitation on feeling. A lack of vitality, a gradual and shifting numbness. Meaning that even when the frontal self achieves its authentic purpose, and meets the needs of the primary organism, the emotional reward is never forthcoming. It is simply not fair. But also that if it achieves **too much** health and wellbeing, it will be profoundly shaken by the secondary agenda which will apply pressure to produce behaviour which will bring things back to a zero balance. Even **more** unfair!

So when you add up all the actions produced by the native agenda you should get a picture of what the organism requires for health and wellbeing. But when you add up the relational components of the secondary agenda you see a wildly varied body of transactions which make little or no sense at all when viewed from a purely organic perspective, because the fulfilment of primary need is not their purpose or origin, but rather the active manipulation and distortion of healthy systemic functioning at a deeper level, albeit for a good cause.

In the end, what the frontal self is confronted with is a mixture of both agendas at every moment in time. It is left in the position of trying to make both agendas happy. It has no other choice. Which results in a curious state of negative equilibrium. Because the more the native agenda becomes fulfilled, the more stressed out the secondary agenda becomes. And the more fulfilled the secondary agenda becomes, the more stressed out the native agenda is.

The strength of each agenda emotionally directly depends on how well the other agenda is doing. The stronger the native agenda becomes, the stronger the secondary agenda must become to compensate and keep balance. Thus, in terms of our ball and wedge, we see something like this-



So instead of a ramp, we see a kind of bowl being formed. And the emotional output of both agendas can change radically moment to moment, depending on where the ball is being pushed. But in the end the choice is either physical crisis or emotional crisis, or a little of both.

There is simply no way out, no third option. There is no way to take the ball lower than the bottom of the bowl. Which makes it an impossible situation for the frontal self. It can either fight and struggle, and thus oscillate wildly, or simply relax and submit to being moderately unhappy all the time. The ideal point at the tip of the wedge - where emotional equilibrium meets physical wellbeing - is simply not functionally available.

This, then, is the fundamental human dilemma. This is what I have been getting to. It is a deep and open emotional wound that simply never heals.

Generally speaking, the frontal self cannot ever hope to integrate all these emotive energies into a single relational stream, simply because they are conflicting and do not fit. It does not realise this however and is not aware of two agendas. It cannot tell any difference between emotional energies based on the origins we are discussing, because it has no way to become informed of such.

Remember, this is you I am speaking of here, your frontal self is what is reading this page. And what I am saying is that you have, until now, been entirely unaware that elements of what you feel and desire are not necessarily part of your own native state. Whole aspects of your life are actually just the product of this secondary presence, and that it is natural that you have

not ever noticed. You will, however, have noticed that some parts of life (elements of desire) create more trouble than others when fulfilment is sought.

So anyway, in this impossible situation the frontal self cannot fulfil its primary duty - to act on emotive impulses. It is required here to act on some emotion and suppress the rest, and must simply make a judgement about which aspects it will be. Which, to the frontal self, is like only having enough food to feed half of its children, and being forced to decide which ones it will starve to death. And to make matters worse, if it chooses a path which represents too much of one agenda, the other agenda will produce deep and powerful pressure resulting in the functional overthrow of the conscious will. The result being an often embarrassing act of compulsion, that being the system in pursuit of balance.

In this case we find ourselves doing things we don't understand, like an invisible hand pushing us along, often re-enacting the same dramas again and again. And, which is most frustrating, especially when we are acting in ways we consider the most positive (thus in too much alignment with the native agenda!). A terrible situation, and a profound dilemma.

The frontal self is left to sail on stormy seas and is without an emotional compass. The more north it sails, the more south the compass points, and the more south it sails, the more north the compass points. The real point of systemic integrity, the real magnetic north, has been disturbed and effectively lost. The system can no longer **feel** its way to wellbeing and happiness.

This dilemma, then, is what defines the 'common state' as I see it. This underlying conflict between two highly dynamic agendas is what defines the fundamental human dilemma. And the natural efforts of the ignorant frontal self, in the face of this conflict, are what define the common life. From the surface of things, the emotive consequences of the interplay between these two competing agendas results in an impossible situation for the frontal self. Both impossible to fulfil, and impossible to figure out.

The real juice here is in the surface details, and I am sure that this is what you want to hear. The million things it explains about everyday life. For it is only when you see how it all plays out in life that you get to see the significance of what is being discussed here, and exactly how much of your life relates directly to this complex. But one thing this short brief sadly cannot do is fully translate all this into something you might immediately recognise in your own life, or in the lives of others. Because the cause of all this happens at a deeper level than what you experience on the surface of life directly. So in order to outline the actual surface relational components of it all, for any given circumstance, I would have to define all the possible relational elements of both the deeper agendas. Because any given action or relational exchange may be the result of many different motive energies.

There is virtually nothing we do which has only one single motive. So any aspect of life you might choose to look at may at some times be influenced by either agenda, or both at the same time. Both agendas are woven through every element of life.

Basically, the functional significance of any relational exchange, at any given point, can be difficult to ascertain. Almost every aspect of life may be used for good or for bad depending entirely on the circumstance.

The healthy native agenda is an incredibly complex dynamic response to ever changing circumstances. And the secondary agenda is a dynamic response to that dynamic response - making it immensely complex in potential.

So defining all of that in a few pages seems a bit of a tall order. An infinite task in fact. The best I can do here is broadly indicate the whole thing and hope you get some idea of what it could all mean.

It is, however, possible to define the different forms of both agendas in core-functional terms in some considerable detail. As well as indicate the outward relational effects of each. Thus giving a fairly good picture of the overall anatomy and potential of the secondary agenda within the system. And details are helpful to indicate the significance and scope of what is being proposed, so with a few examples I will seek to give you a taste of just how big this thing is, and how much it costs you.

THE CONTAINMENTS

The primary event being explained here is essentially geared toward the 'control' of what – on closer inspection – seems to be a perfectly reasonable process. After all it is natural for the organism's symbolic self-references (I, me, etc..) to identify with the body, given that this is their purpose for existing. It is also a natural tendency of our 'change management systems' to accurately formulate future outcomes, given – once again – that this is their purpose for existing, which must of course include the obvious reality of imminent death.

In short, everything that goes together to produce the crisis we are explaining is natural and healthy functioning, all except the one thing that is never questioned – 'I'.

We have already covered all the underlying context and structures that go together to allow this identity formation to have such a devastating impact on the way we function, so we won't go over that again here. But we do now need to examine all the various downstream damage this emerging crisis can result in – including how incredibly dynamic and stable the end state can be.

So how does it work? How can the human system itself act to control or contain such an event, considering that it doesn't even realise why it has occurred? There is no simple answer to this question precisely because the system doesn't ever question the veracity of the 'self' it has manufactured, and also can't easily or believably negate the reality of death, so in the end it simply has no choice but to keep them apart somehow, both cognitively and at a feeling level.

The problems the system (we) then faces as a result are: Firstly, how to manage the creation of an integrated vision of the future without somehow putting the reality of death together? And, secondly, how to formulate healthy identity without somehow identifying with the body?

Neither of these options is very successful, if only because they are both entirely dysfunctional, and the resulting situation speaks for itself. There is simply no way to protect the system's integrity in the face of this dilemma because radical situations require radical solutions.

This leads us into the various forms this distortion might eventually take as our unconscious scrambles to put this emotional fire out. Every type or mechanism of containment this secondary agenda employs ultimately boils down to the same basic actions: Either the active negation of some felt sense of existential need, or the manufacture somehow of some sense of believable existential fulfilment, or a combination of both. In simple terms this means to keep 'I' and 'death' – as felt realities – apart in every moment. Forever.

Here are some obvious examples of the sort of tampering this very ambitious task might involve -

1 – **Symbolic fulfilment structures.**

Need at a physical level is represented in the formation of attachment at an emotional level. Therefore, as this crisis emerges in childhood it naturally displaces into the realm of the current attachment structures: Parents. The results are attachment bonds that become grossly overstated.

This may happen suddenly (as in abusive environments) or more gradually (as in cloistered ones) but eventually the results are the same for all: The child's emotional needs eventually begin to go through the roof, and the capacity of parents to meet such thereby shrinks to almost nothing.

Although it may often be the case that nothing serious has happened in actuality, the subjective experience of the child at this point is that of severe emotional abandonment. Of course, as indicated above, any dysfunctional behaviour on the part of caregivers can obviously make this state far worse indeed, with even small actions then taking on great significance due to the degree of overstated attachment and crisis being faced by the child as they struggle to control their burgeoning fear.

It is perhaps because of this connection that much criticism has often been levelled at parents in the wake of how much trauma many people carry as they exit their childhood years, and in some cases this may have a degree of truth. But although dysfunctional parenting has a significant role here, it is not actually the main player – the underlying crisis is. This is perhaps why some children are able to survive tremendous hardship without it resulting in such trauma or damage. It could be that such resilience is due much more to what was *not* going on in their inner world, than to what *was* going on in their outer world.

Most people are not so lucky. Even in healthy and sheltered situations, for most people the result of this emerging crisis is an inflation of natural attachment bonds to their primary caregivers, at least to begin with. To a child, the caregivers mean everything that is safe in life. They literally mean life itself. And although the caregivers eventually fail to fulfil the impossible emotional demands of the child, strengthening the primal attachment bond still helps the child to cope.

It must also be stated here that if parents do succeed in providing enough security so as to either avoid this crisis arising in the first place, or in fulfilling its emotional demands, that they are probably feeding the child complete bullshit about life, and thereby not doing their primary job of preparing the child for the realities of life (we will address the damage caused by fairytales in a moment).

Overall, the results of this kind of 'interpersonal attachment inflation' are the formation of emotional structures that go well beyond representing the organism's actual relational needs. What we see is attachment founded in pure existential need, which the parents cannot ever fulfil, and which, sadly, the individual can do no better. And yet the primal nature of the infant bond to parents does still allow for a sort of trick to be played, and for a degree of security to be felt, as long as the attachment is singular and massive in nature so as to stimulate the right emotional circuit in the 'baby' brain.

All of which might seem relatively harmless I suppose, except that your parents are actually just ordinary people for the most part, who are themselves struggling with the very same issues. More importantly, what this does produce is a situation where infantile and regressive social traits remain active for much longer than is natural or normal, and even where this pattern can easily remain in place well into later life.

How it normally works is that your parents are like ‘training wheels’ that ideally assist you in learning to ride the ‘bike of life’, at which point they can be entirely discarded. But in this instance, it is as if the linkages that screw those wheels on (emotional attachments) have been massively reinforced and welded on. So what this means is that when it comes time to begin transferring functional attachment (and the emotional energy such directs) over to yourself over time, the result is not a clean sweep.

Normally the assumption of full responsibility for the fulfilment of one’s own needs would result in all interpersonal attachment being displaced from others, and back to fuel drives and functions within oneself. The transfer of such attachment bonds, and the responsibility associated, is what we call the transition into adulthood.

Essentially, the energy and attention we once directed toward our parents (who met our needs entirely) eventually becomes redirected so as to fuel need fulfilment processes within ourselves instead. Beyond this point, such bonds may remain and be cherished, but only in the sense that we may still love a trusty old horse that has been put out to pasture. They may still function as an emergency fallback option in a pinch, or for gentle fun rides for grandkids, but anything beyond that would smack of regression. Yet that is where so many still find themselves, if not directly (in relation to their actual parents) then certainly in relation to their emotional life being dominated by overblown interpersonal attachment, and all the trouble that accompanies such. And this is because the massive attachment associated with this underlying crisis cannot be transferred so easily, for it can only be allocated to something else that functions equally well to fulfil the needs associated – existential needs.

As indicated, parents never actually do this of course, but because of the nature of the primal attachment bond they can be used to provide such leverage ‘artificially’ in the emotive core. They can make you feel safe well beyond their capacity to actually save you. It is simply a loophole in the way we function.

Therefore, what we see here eventually confronts a bit of a tangle-up in the way that attachment is managed in our own system, so as to always maintain and ensure need fulfilment over time. Attachment represents emotional leverage. In particular it represents the amount of energy you will expend in order to protect your connection to the object of attachment. And the reason for this connection is always that the object in question represents a degree of need fulfilment. Therefore, attachment represents need fulfilment. It is quite simple. And so, with the eventual loss of any need fulfilment, if a new one cannot be found then the attachment must either remain in place or be re-integrated via the function of grief and formulated into an active desire. And in the transition to adulthood, the shift is from dependency on someone else, to dependency on yourself. Your attachment (and all the energy associated) is unplugged like an ‘umbilical cord’ from whoever was suffering from such, and used as a ‘power cord’ to support and drive active need fulfilment processes in yourself. Interpersonal dependency thereby becomes intrapersonal empowerment. This is called growing up.

Unfortunately, the needs associated with this underlying crisis are simply too big to be integrated in this way. And what this means is that some of this attachment must either be left where it is, or be contained in some way, or be displaced somehow.

Remember: Not all of the crisis or its resulting stresses are managed via the mechanism we are discussing here. What we are talking about here is just one of many potential ‘containers’ for the overall management of the larger crisis. Overblown parental attachment is merely the first form to arise, and only helped to lessen the fear by offering something ‘safe’ to which to cling. But for most people, as this infantile pattern gradually fails, other systems have to come into play.

The result of this form of containment being displaced into other ‘containers’ (because of a lack of continued symbolic fulfilment) is that the potential always exists for it to be reactivated. Therefore, if an object of fulfilment becomes available somehow, containment elsewhere may well be displaced back to this pattern again so as to absorb as much of the overall crisis as possible, at the least cost. So overall this pattern is just one of the ways the human organism can share this load.

In certain circumstances this mechanism will be busy and in others it will not, but anything that offers a degree of believable security will attract such attachment, along with the energy and attention associated. However, because the needs at the base of such attachment do not actually exist, each such fulfilment process is necessarily symbolic in nature – hence the name ‘symbolic fulfilment structures’.

Such fulfilment mechanisms can only make the organism ‘feel’ safe – they can never make it ‘be’ safe. For this reason, such attachment bonds are always prone to being unstable and fragile, to the point where you might even conclude that they are outright doomed to fail from the very moment they are formed. All of which might sound unfortunate, but this is a very good thing when you consider that they are entirely dysfunctional by definition.

In this way we see the origins of many forms of adult attachment disorders, some of which are so common as to be considered normal, or perhaps even virtuous. Anything that functions to make us feel safer may attract such attention and its accompanying attachment.

As an aside perhaps, and just in order to help you see this pattern for yourself in real terms, we might take a moment to sketch just a few outlines as they commonly appear –

For the most part what we see in those where this distortion remains active is a situation where interpersonal concerns take an overly dominant role in life. For instance, it is a pattern where a person's 'self esteem' is far more determined by 'what others think of me' than by a person's actual ability to creatively and adaptively meet their own needs. And this 'peer focus' is not merely a remnant or the primal fixation the baby had with its caregiver, it is a direct and active extension of the very same fixation, which remains alive and well. Like a massive bit of baggage that the person has not yet learned to carry, that regressive fixation will generally be broken up and foisted onto any trolley that will accept it.

Continuing to seek approval from parents, either consciously or unconsciously, is clearly one tip of this submerged iceberg. A relative value system (rising to the expectations of society) is a symptom also, as opposed to a more absolute values system (I have decided for myself what is right, good, enough.. etc).

Strangely, both of these examples are often seen in the lives of so-called 'high achievers'. In this same vein, a desperate search for attention and fame is also an obvious example of this same infantile pattern, in its widest and most scattered possible form. These are all 'other focused' forms of existence; all variations of living from the 'outside in' rather than the 'inside out'. They are also direct and immediate displacements of energy and attention that might otherwise be deployed in the mode of self-reliance and personal empowerment. In other words, they all dramatically affect your basic creative ability – be that intellectual capacity, social innovation, or basic practical resourcefulness. They are regressive, even infantile, and to the degree they arise they always exist in direct opposition to the achievement of basic mastery in life.

When this pattern takes the form of another individual person, we call the positive symptoms 'romantic love', and the negative side effects 'co-dependence'. And we always want one without the other, but romantic love *is* co-dependence. It is merely a relationship that functions to stimulate the same kinds of 'lovey-blanket' security feeling as the parents once did, and into which such childish attachment may be re-awakened and transferred. Therefore, it can immediately take some of the overall load off other systems that may be struggling to maintain containment, and this will of course feel very good. The practical trouble here results from the attachment, not the feelings of ease and safety experienced. In this instance such attachment is simply massively surplus to the requirements of good and aligned connection between adult people, and unavoidably produces strong unconscious expectations and demands.

Actually, it is lucky that this underlying transaction generally remains so unconscious, because we would never agree to its demands if they were all laid out on the table to see, or if we realised what we were being asked to fulfil as we signed that contract. For this reason, the human unconscious will only displace as much into primary relationships as it can get away with without causing too much trouble. This is why co-dependence can be very slippery to deal with. It can change day to day by the underlying attachment being displaced into other areas of life. It is not an isolated complex, but only one arm of a very mobile octopus.

In overall terms I often think of romantic love as being a 'Mummy' complex ('Mommy' if you are American). It is a regression to the primary attachment bond of mother and child, and only makes you feel safe by stimulating a primal circuit that once meant exactly that – existential security. So we frantically seek security in others, but then loathe the suffocating psychological entrapment that results from the overstated attachment. Or we break free instead, and experience liberation from the burden of interpersonal attachment, but often feel miserable and empty somehow in the process. Essentially, and for as long as this pattern remains active in any way, relationships of all kinds become an unfair game that we just can't win. Paradoxically, the only people who will successfully carry such a heavy projection of personal responsibility are those who are perpetrating the same in return, in which case we see two 'half people' trying to become one 'whole one'. In which case it is important to realise that in forming any relationship what you get is A times B, not A plus B. And one half times one half actually equals one quarter. Two half people do not make one whole one.

It is also the case that those who embody this pattern are easily infatuated by those who do not, if only because those who do not are significantly more actively creative and dynamic and socially fearless. But this is always an attraction that ends up poorly, in that anyone who legitimately represents freedom from this pattern will not even recognise the desperate approaches of those who don't, because they are too busy looking off into the distance at the destination they are heading for, or putting energy into developing their ability to affect change. The only people on their radar will be those who are doing the same things – which for the emotionally dependent cripple are things they have never had much practice at. So this personal empowerment is a state people are often attracted to, but from a disempowered and dependent state they almost always fail to realise that it can only be experienced first hand, in person, and never via any deep emotional connection to someone else, if only because deep emotional connections to other people (in the attachment sense) are the very antithesis of what defines it.

Those who are free of this attachment based dynamic are capable of depths of intimacy far beyond what the fearfully attached state would ever allow for, and therefore find the entire idea of such connections uninteresting, if not repulsive.

This is the puzzle of 'love' in the shadow of this simmering crisis - true love, based on an alignment of complimentary energies that are moving in the same direction. But that entire potential is often completely overshadowed by powerful unconscious drives that often briefly result in massive emotional releases of tension (experienced as ecstasy and levity), but which just as often cause failure (experienced as embarrassment, conflict, heartbreak etc). And what we don't generally realise is that these are two sides of the same thing.

Unfortunately, Mummy couldn't save us, and neither can Fred, or Jane, or whomever we might find to take her place. In this mode, we are looking in the wrong place for an answer, and the results speak for themselves. In its compulsive form we might call this form of containment 'love addiction', or 'relationship addiction'. In any form, it is emotional dependency, and for this reason you will mostly find this particular form of containment pruned down to almost a stump in any typical (so called) 'balanced life'. At best, romantic love makes way for the emergence of aligned co-creation as both parties gradually grow up and begin to dance together in life. But if not, then this sort of stimulated fixation will die a natural death over time, and only ever emerge again briefly in the form of extra-marital affairs etc, if at all. Either way, eventually other forms of containment will need to be employed if massive and increasing emotional crisis is to be averted.

So what about 'Daddy'? Didn't he make you feel safe too? Absolutely! From the perspective of the infant he was a towering giant, twenty five feet tall, and knowing everything (omniscient). He was a benevolent but sometimes stern source of all authority in the child's universe, which he entirely inhabited (omnipresent). And yes, he made the child feel safe. He was the source of all power (omnipotent). By relating to him, you knew who you were, and that you were OK.

So what happens when it comes time to let go of good old dad and realise that he was just another ordinary person like you? What happens to the existential attachments he can, as just an ordinary person, no longer carry? Who can assume such a mantle? Well, nobody can, obviously, except perhaps someone imaginary. But with enough subjective pressure anything is possible via the active corruption of belief formation.

Therefore, perhaps for the reason of fear alone, many people come to believe in God. And any God will do, provided we can manage to believe there is some promise of salvation after death, and provided we don't have to do too much to secure our place there. Indeed, there are many versions of God as an idea, all of them like seeds that have evolved to grow in this particular soil of emotionally loaded human imagination and unconscious dread. Of course, we don't admit our motives openly, but are nevertheless pressed along by strong undercurrents in our unconscious.

Very often, in manufacturing this kind of symbolic fulfilment structure, we are basically seeking to redress some sense of paternal abandonment, in that the original emergence of this crisis did generally have the perceived effect of causing abandonment. Thus, the imaginary recipient of this complex is usually some suspiciously human deity: A God in the form of a personality even, often seeming curiously akin to a 'great father'. How sad and childish it all seems when you look at it, but it does also indicate the degree of force we confront, which is apparently enough to maintain and support such open cognitive and social corruption. Unlike the 'mother complex' which stimulates infant states, this 'father complex' is more akin to an immortality project. Rather than providing visceral warmth and stroking, this form makes you feel safe by more protracted means: By promising you fulfilment for existential need, as delivered in this instance by someone far more aloof. And the result is what could be called 'God addiction' in all its many spurious forms.

However, with the recent emergence of reason and mere common sense, the natural decline of God addiction has left a nasty void in cultural coping systems capable of supporting this kind of attachment based containment. Inevitably, as voids do, this void has been progressively filled by yet other forms of wishful thinking. Collectively, such belief systems account for much of what has been called 'New Age' doctrines and beliefs: A complex body of very disintegrated views with little to unify them except for the one obvious tenet which runs through them all - which is that they are all emotionally attractive in some existential way. As such they too function to modulate how we see our situation so as to allay fear somehow. 'God is not going to save us, the Alien's are!' And if not that, then we will simply 'transcend' the 'physical plane of existence' and leave the body behind!

We could go on, but I'm sure you get the picture. Sadly, almost all such culturally transmitted belief systems seem to more often reflect a need to believe, than any particular factual reality. Most are just unrecognised forms of social hysteria - just weeds that grow in soil left bare after the well-established God tree blew away in the wind of evidence and logic.

In the end, 'symbolic fulfilment structures' are just one form of systemic containment available for the underlying crisis in the human state. They represent just one way of managing existential fear. And hopefully they make some kind of sense to you, in forms you can easily recognise in yourself and in others.

It should also be noticed that each of the examples given here is considered normal and acceptable in our culture, sometimes even desirable. But what if all of this has only been normalised in an effort to pacify people, in a purely blind and pragmatic sense? So think about this as we begin to discuss the possibility of removing the entire edifice later on, think

about what sort of world we might live in if society was not made up of individuals that were so fundamentally afraid, so cognitively corrupted, or so emotionally weak.

God addiction, as just one example, is essentially a deeply cowardly path. Try to imagine a world without parasitic religions and the divisions they inevitably produce, and without the tortures of emotionally dependent and intrinsically dysfunctional relationships of all kinds. And then consider that we have now only touched on one small corner of the entire event we will be addressing here.

Therefore, where is it? There it is, right under your nose, so big you can't even see it. But that's not all. That's just the beginning. One of the reasons it has all remained so incredibly concealed and undefined is that you simply wouldn't ever think to look for something **SO AMAZINGLY HUGE**.

We have only defined 'symbolic fulfilment' here as one isolated function, and whilst we will now continue on to do the same with the others we will now outline, it must always be remembered that in truth they all operate together in a kind of integrated synthesis. The different forms of this overall complex dynamic merge endlessly into each other, overlapping, ebbing and flowing, in a kind of fluid tidal motion. Like objects hanging from a mobile, when one moves, all the others immediately compensate and keep overall balance. If this secondary agenda didn't create 95% of all the suffering in the world, I would even be tempted to say it was beautiful.

2 –

Belief manipulation.

Another main body of potential containment is the active distortion or corruption of our own formulation of 'subjective reality', and the functions that manage such. You will recall that these are all the aspects of our 'emotional reality' that are actually the result of our own mental simulation and augmentation of aspects of actual reality that lie beyond the reach of direct perception.

It may be obvious already that the symbolic fulfilments addressed above involve at least some degree of this dysfunction, in that they rely on believing lots of obviously false stuff, but this corruption also extends much further than that. The potential for 'belief corruption' as a result of this underlying crisis is massive. What we just addressed as symbolic fulfilment structures are just the tip of the iceberg when it comes to screwing up such a delicate system – just a couple of the more obvious forms this might take. But actually there are many more ways to achieve the same basic end that also involve this same sort of distortion, and every element of belief formation is open to sway in some sense – in other words, open to silent and unnoticed corruption by this powerful unconscious agenda.

In particular, we see this sort of corruption emerging not only in terms of manufacturing some sense of imaginary 'fulfilment', but also in believably negating the felt sense of 'need'.

Just as we can manufacture some kind of future for the 'I', so we can also modulate the nature of this 'I' so as to make it less susceptible to threat. It is, after all, just an idea. We may not do this consciously, mind you, but we can unconsciously and increasingly be presented with patterns of thinking that allow us to separate this sense of self from the source of death: The body.

Eventually, we might even manipulate the formation of belief systems so as to perpetually separate these two in our subjective experience of reality. We can come to believe and convince ourselves that we have a 'soul' for instance, some 'vehicle' in which our 'self' or supposed 'spirit' can continue to exist beyond death. And this works well to some degree because repression itself produces a kind of 'feeling-withdrawal' from the body itself, which aligns completely with the objectives of separating this 'I'.

Essentially, the body is seen as the source of death, it becomes the enemy in some sense, and separation is then desired by the secondary agenda. Which is obviously both ironic and problematic given the actual truth of the situation, which is that this sense of self is merely and only one of the emergent functions of the body, and that separation of 'I' and body is therefore never actually possible. The ironic aspect of course being that this projected identity structure was intended to exist with the sole and only purpose to assist the organism (body) in achieving maximum success over time. The whole idea of a soul is akin to a wave trying to jump away from the water from which it is made, yet once again – as an essential part of almost all salvation endeavours – we see this kind of idea promulgating through culture like an epidemic due to the gravity of the need, and the amount of corruption we are prepared to live with if only we can feel a little better as a result.

Overall, belief manipulation is perhaps the most dramatic and unnoticed form or symptom of the human dilemma we are defining here. Silent, but extremely significant, it affects almost everything we do. It directly and unavoidably corrupts our cognitive development by enforcing deliberate hobbling of important functions. It produces emotionally loaded beliefs, assertions and ideologies that themselves produce individual struggle and even war. And this obviously affects the organism's relationship to actual reality, making any clear grasp of actual reality often seem like something of an uncomfortable imposition.

For the weaker minded, who are most susceptible to this form of containment (or for the culturally deprived, who grow up in a weak minded society) we see a general flight into fantasy, and into the realm of subjective reality where we can control the outcomes and determine the rules. All the forms of symbolic fulfilment may in some way be classified as such. Essentially, we see the corruption of the aspects of our perceived experience that are being generated via mental probability and imagination, combined with a withdrawal away from any aspects of perceived reality that are actually real and which might obviously contradict our flight into fantasy.

Perhaps the most striking example of belief manipulation is the general negation of ‘future awareness’. We have seen earlier how hard it is to come by, which means it is very easy for the secondary agenda to negate. Alongside this, what we also see is a narrowing of awareness onto a myopic bubble of local experience, with a deeply loaded aversion toward anything that might point to any greater whole or unified system of which our local experience is just a very small part. And in both cases we see the same basic thrust: A narrowing or limiting or shrinking of awareness, with a heavily defended boundary – a bit like the psychological equivalent of a gated compound. And here we can see that ‘unawareness’ may become as powerful and damaging an addiction as any other.

In this context overall (in a legitimate negative crisis built out of healthy functioning) it can even be said that **positive thinking is dysfunctional**. Seeking to become comfortable with what is not supposed to be comfortable, is repression. As is seeking to turn a bad situation into a good one merely by calling it good, over and over again.

Although there can be dire consequences in relation to actual reality, almost all forms of containment involve or support this kind of belief manipulation in some significant way, perhaps because belief corruption is very easy to create. If we are prepared to close our eyes we can simply ‘make reality up’ to please ourselves, provided somebody takes care of our actual needs somehow. Of all the forms of containment, belief corruption is also very easy on the body. It essentially costs nothing except the sacrifice of cognitive integrity and a bit of ‘self-brain-washing’. But at a relational level it obviously results in a bit of confusion when confronting actual reality and how to deal with it. Just as a Mickey Mouse watch will not always tell very good time, a Mickey Mouse map may not take you where you want to go.

This form of corruption is clearly evident in the telling of fairy tales to children by people who themselves suffered such abuse when growing up. And I’m not talking about stories, or myths, which may contain some element of life-valuable truth or morality. These are stories that embody such serious flaws in fundamental logic that they intentionally support dysfunctional neural development, which then creates alternate routes for the child’s mind other than the natural and healthy paths that might inevitably lead to death and fear as realities to be faced and addressed appropriately. Thus, fairytales allay fear and help the child cope with their emerging existential crisis, but they only do so by corrupting healthy development. And they are almost always told by people who are still themselves suffering from delusions that depend on the same basic flaws in logic. All the forms of ‘belief corruption’ and ‘symbolic fulfilment’ as discussed above may be supported by the kinds of ‘fallacy templates’ created in this childhood corruption. In this light I suppose both God addiction, love addiction, and new age fantasy could all be defined as kinds of ‘adult fairytales’ – all parts of the problem, not part of the answer.

In the simplest terms: The earlier and more powerfully children confront the reality of death, in an honest and natural way, the better their chances of developing a strong and healthy mind will be.

3 –

Core directive leveraging.

Without all the terms we outlined earlier in this book in relation to the various and necessary functions that together make up our own subjective anatomy some of these forms of distortion may not make a lot of sense. But another subjective function that receives a fair old hammering is the formulation of what we called our active ‘core directives’. These are all the various thoughts that function like mechanical parts, and which also act to set our standards.

If you imagine working on a computer as being a bit like using your brain in life, then these are like the aspects of all of that functioning that are more like the applications (unconscious patterns) rather than the content (conscious thoughts). Some of these very deep patterns might even be broad enough to be thought of as something akin to the operating system you are running. The key point being that whilst these ideas recur effortlessly and can act like mechanical parts (hardware), but are actually the result of active thought processes (software).

In many instances these aspects of our thinking processes remain largely unconscious even when they are expressed in very specific forms. Yet it remains the case that in the perpetual attempts our own unconscious makes to unify and integrate these aspects of our thinking can produce certain summary ideas that are both extremely powerful as well as extremely simplified or even globalised. And of all the possible targets for repression or distortion that may potentially line up for the sort of intentional damage we are outlining here, one of these unconscious yet very powerful abstractions stands out head and shoulders above the rest.

Whilst there may be many specific directives by which we define our emotive responses to life, they can all be boiled down and viewed along one clear continuum –

I deserve vs I don't deserve

This basic core directive, this belief, this identity, functions to powerfully modulate your responses (and what you feel) in any situation. Self-esteem as a concept is often maligned these days as a useful term in any serious therapeutic context, but this is largely due to being used in a positive sense as something to strive for, and for that it is pretty much useless. But the underlying reality is that we do indeed have a complex system of interlocking ideas that determine our basic emotional responses to almost every event we confront, all of which can in many ways be viewed like some great equation that can indeed be boiled down to a certain kind of ultimate sum. Therefore, your degree of 'deserve-ability' (if there is no word for it, make one up!) might quite accurately be defined as one of the factors that together establish what is generally termed 'self esteem', even if we are viewing all of that from a slightly different angle here.

Many functional and energetic streams feed back through this simple idea, and its overall state determines many outcomes. It is a very big player. And whilst you might say that this core 'centre of gravity' does not necessarily represent a cohesive or singular assertion, in practice it actually does do this over time, and this is relatively easy to test in any situation. Whilst it may be true that we feel able to assert a high degree of expectation in relation to one area of life, whilst allowing other areas to languish, in general terms such divergence is resolved into a singular and universal level of expectation or demand.

This simple idea, because it is invested with so much emotive power, can make a huge difference to active emotional and psychological functioning if altered. And precisely because it is actually just a thought, but because it also has a big effect on our overall level of assertive response, this is often a great place for the unconscious agenda to apply leverage and thereby assist in helping to contain at least a bit of the overall functioning that has gone out of control.

You may be wondering what I mean here, or exactly how this works, so I'll explain this a bit more -

Imagine a situation where needs are being deprived: A dysfunctional family upbringing, let's say. In that situation, if you internally asserted the idea 'I deserve to be treated with dignity and respect' you might experience much frustration or grief as a result of your situation. The contrast between what you **deserve** and what you **receive** would produce **emotional tension** geared toward change, precisely because this idea is a primary determiner of such response criteria. So in this case you might retain what might be called high self-esteem, but would also experience significant emotional stress. And this emotion would naturally spill out into action and expression in an effort to achieve the desired outcome, which in this instance might just be ordinary need fulfilment.

Such emotion has evolved to be expressed and produce change in this way. That is its purpose after all, and only as adults do we learn to control emotions so well. In many ways, this 'adult' faculty for control is exactly what we are talking about here, along with how much damage it can do if applied too heavily.

So what if, in the same dysfunctional situation, emotional expression was forbidden? What if, contrary to its purpose, emotional expression could get you thrashed to within an inch of your life, or produce even more deprivation? What can be done?

A child certainly cannot contain within them great amounts of active emotive tension without it being expressed in some way, leaving the only other option being to somehow 'turn it down', or even turn it off, and the easiest way to achieve this is to simply alter your expectations of life. In other words: to change your degree of deserve-ability.

So 'I deserve + I'm not receiving' = emotional crisis because it doesn't fit. But 'I **don't** deserve + I'm not receiving' = emotional equilibrium. No problemo.

This is a very easy emotional shift to achieve for a child, or for anyone in that it is a lowering of standards, but it has very serious and far-reaching consequences. It may help you get through a bad situation, but will also affect you well beyond it, if only because such directives form a central part of the system's functional identity. They form part of the definition of who you are, and as such they transcend time, because 'self' as a construct is presumed to be consistent throughout time.

Therefore, the result of this kind of shift (to whatever degree it occurs) is a lowering of the essential personal standards, which from then on function to determine the conditions of life. And as the child grows up, what this means is that they will inevitably create their life to match these ideas. This is why we call this 'passive repression', it is because it is essentially invisible in specific terms and also very easy to generate.

All of which might lead anyone to say the following in relation to becoming aware of any damage in this area: 'they are just ideas, why not just change them?' But this is where the problem lies. Unfortunately, being so passive also makes it very difficult to move once it emerges. Like obesity, it represents a kind of luxurious debt that somehow has to be paid off, but the very weight of it can act to prevent any such movement.

Although they are just ideas, and can indeed be changed at will, they are also the determiners of much emotional process. And what this means is that because these ideas relate directly to self, any change made will immediately be post-dated into the future. Which is good, right? Yes, but it will also be backdated into the past. So ‘if I deserve now, then I must have deserved then, and even though I let all that crap slide at the time, now I’m suddenly pissed off!’

In this way the lowering of these primary self-standards is an easy and enormous repository for the containment of healthy but unwanted emotional process, but also a deceptively costly path to take, in that if ever you are going to move these standards back then all that was avoided will need to be paid back in full. So to leverage them back to a healthy state is not as easy as it may sound, because it inevitably demands that we revisit many very loaded aspects of our own history. It means that the child within us will come banging on our door with many grievances to be addressed and brought to closure. We will have a debt to pay. And some of those can be very deep and serious, which is why many people never have the courage to address such, or even the understanding of where it all comes from.

Anyway, I hope that makes a bit of sense. As it relates to the crisis we are discussing, we all experienced such a childhood in effect, and this is one way our systems can function to actively contain some of the ongoing results. If we don’t expect to be happy, then what does it matter if we’re not? So this kind of damage is like breaking the mast of our little boat in order to avoid the tension that the wind creates as our sail pulls on our rigging. It might be easy enough at the time, but also easy to regret that decision later, in that this lowering of our ‘deserve-ability’ standards dramatically affect the way our life plays out in the long term. It becomes impossible to live a life of passion based on the fulfilment of a dream or vision because ‘I am simply not worthy’, ‘I essentially don’t deserve it’. And not only that, but if I do suddenly experience validation for the fact that perhaps I do indeed deserve it, then this shift will mysteriously cause me a great deal of emotional pain, and likely cause me to forcibly abandon whatever situation has recently supported this idea.

Therefore, what we see here is one of the underlying factors that has people continually recreating and maintaining the same kind of negative life circumstance over and over again, in an endless cycle of emotional entrapment.

The point is: Given the chance, the secondary agenda will drive these standards down as much as it can in order to take stress off other containments, thereby producing a strong and constant downward pressure on core self-esteem. And in transactional terms this negatively affects almost everything we do. We all suffer from this to some extent, and this is where that mysterious force comes from. It is **NOT** a natural part of being human. Self-esteem, in the native human state, evolved under a constant pressure so as to be naturally buoyant.

4 –

Deep process suspension.

We now move onto a far more direct and forceful method of controlling any emotional process that is getting out of hand, and unlike what we just addressed, this direct form is much harder on the body.

As discussed earlier, many subjective functions rely on basic physical realities for their integrity, and for this reason the higher executive levels evolved so as to always seek both depth of feeling, and quality of feeling – together. This is because at a physical level (the level these higher functions are intended to serve) the maintenance of ideal states requires energy, and the result of having achieved this function is overflow – or ‘free energy’.

Therefore, ‘free energy’ and ‘feeling good’ are the same thing, as viewed from two different angles. In this way the system has ensured that the maintenance of ideal states will always be achieved over time. It is like a system where the CEO of a company only gets paid out of the profit the company achieves, rather than the turnover – it ensures the CEO will remain very motivated to make sure everything is working in ideal terms at every point.

However, what this very same situation equally allows for is that almost any higher function may be thwarted if you are prepared to limit the flow of free energy within the system. Specifically, deep emotive processes (the maintenance functions of the emotive core) may be frozen or suspended by either holding energy (feeling) in, or withholding energy (feeling) from, parts of the body. It means that if all you feel is ‘very bad’, then by affecting and sacrificing your own capacity to ‘feel’ freely at all, you can ‘feel nothing’ instead. And also that if you do that, then you will have basically lost the defining thread around which almost all of your internal integrity revolves. You will be able to go outside and stop the traffic, and it will remain stopped because no policeman will ever come to sort it out, because policemen only come if they are getting paid, and in this instance their pay (deep and positive feeling) will have all dried up.

Essentially, if the frontal conscious self is prepared to forfeit a degree of feeling, then integrity may be challenged and many processes stopped in mid flight. Like all forms of emotional repression, what this involves is a functional limitation on energy, a functional limitation on feeling, and therefore a functional limitation on happiness. And with this we come to one of the most fundamental and important things to understand about life and the human state: That to not feel how unhappy you are, is not the same thing as being happy.

I will repeat that just to be sure –

To not feel how unhappy you are, is NOT the same thing as being happy.

This is because happiness is a state that at one level is explicitly defined by a depth of feeling, so to put 'not feel' and happiness together in any sense would obviously be to generate an oxymoron.

In this simple statement we can see almost every form of this disease laid bare, because almost every path it takes leads toward not feeling something bad, with the mistaken idea that this might lead to feeling something good.

So this indicates the HOW of deep process suspension, but not the WHAT of it.

What are these deep processes that are being suspended? What exactly is the traffic that is being stopped?

In the simplest terms, the repression of a natural function is as easy as holding your breath. It is certainly necessary sometimes, even though it is an interruption of a vital need fulfilment function. And just like all other repression, it always involves a slightly uncomfortable or awkward emotional element, in that holding your breath is a bit like swimming upstream in the river of natural tendency. But of course, that is not the main element of discomfort – the larger and ever increasing aspect is the resulting lack of oxygen and the effect that this has on your physical, emotional, and mental state.

Some needs, however, are not so desperate and immediate in nature. Some needs exist far more at the fringes of our ideal organic equilibrium, such as the need to be touched, or the need for sunlight. Nevertheless, even with those, if they are authentic needs then if they are withheld in some way you will always begin to show the signs of deprivation over time, and always with some resulting lack of quality of life.

The point here being that the repression of authentic need always has a cost at the outset, as well as an inevitable downstream cost as the function itself is not fulfilled. But what if the need in question does not exist? What if the emotional system is flying out of control based solely on an illusion of need, rather than a reality of need?

In that case, the resulting state would obviously not suffer the same cumulative and toxic build-up due to deprivation, but if the emotional process itself was dramatic then the immediate costs of suppressing such active processes may still be quite steep.

The method of deep process suspension is very simple. To trap or contain a content you simply turn off the function that is processing it. Like cutting the stereo lead because you don't know how to change the music that is playing – it takes some effort, and it stops the music, but also makes the stereo useless. So in controlling negative feelings in this way, we also lose some of our capacity to simply feel in general, as well as distorting organic functioning so as to put it out of balance.

We lose a degree of vitality in this instance, as well as an unavoidable degree of natural physical wellbeing. Because energy is the primary currency of organic functioning, and because deep process suspension always places distorted limitations on energy flow (feeling), there is always a physical cost to this kind of repression. With deep process suspension, the body suffers. All deep emotional repression is registered in the body somehow. Some forms of it are even very obvious if you are sensitive to what to look for. And you do look for it constantly. It is one of the things we continually scan for as we communicate with others at an unconscious level, which accounts for about 90% of all deep human communication.

What we see here is the opposite of what the emotional systems are generally charged with doing. Normally, what we see is the failure of a function, and the urgent need to replace it, as with a city when the garbage collectors go on strike. But in this instance what we see is emergency repression of healthy but misguided functioning, and this is also something the natural system can do. But it is always temporary in this form, if only because the needs in question are real and cannot simply be ignored for too long. Think of the rubbish piling up.

So this sort of thing would normally be a very temporary option. But what if you needed to intentionally suspend the garbage collection, because the drivers all came down with some contagious psychosis? What if the streets started filling up with hundreds of garbage trucks that were all driving around desperately looking for giant pink marshmallows, whilst ignoring the actual rubbish? If you were going to avoid perpetual conflict and strife, the easiest option in that case might be to simply pay them to stay at home, and then also pay to organise the rubbish collection via some other means. And these two costs are the reason this kind of repression involves high levels of energy to maintain, and why we are destroying the Earth in our mad scramble to regain some sort of emotional equilibrium.

We are now hopefully beginning to see that there are many forms of this potential containment, each with its own demands and costs. We will always carry it where we are strongest. The unconscious agenda will load up the structures it knows can take the punishment. And this one is once again a major player in this game, and one with very obvious physical symptoms associated.

In this instance, apart from the very obvious organic dysfunction it results in as a necessary side effect, the intended result is pure emotional repression. But unlike any normal process of repression, there is no downstream build-up or thwarting of

need, because the needs in question are not actually real (there are no giant pink marshmallows). And what this means is that the overall cost of this repression is not in the ongoing damage done to actual need fulfilment, but merely the costs associated with the repression itself, and of collecting the actual rubbish another way.

Essentially, whilst repression is normally an emergency interruption of a need fulfilment function, in this instance it is as if the repression itself becomes a permanent need, and the costs of such become the demands and functions associated with that need. It is entirely backward in this sense, in that the very functions that are supposed to be serving the organism in various ways, end up directly attacking and subverting it in all manner of possible ways. It is as if the organism suddenly discovers a permanent need to attack itself, and disrupt its own natural integrity.

At a relational or transactional level this often demands the maintenance of physiological imbalance through some combination of muscular armouring, postural distortion, high-energy diet, or low-energy lifestyle etc, just to name a few. And whilst the mid-organs are especially implicated in deep emotional processes (and therefore their suspension), the entire system is always pushed out of balance in some way or other as a result of this particular pattern. And this absolutely hammers the body. This is one form of containment that you can certainly die from, and many people do.

5 – **Artificial stimulation.**

In the wake of the sorts of imbalance we have just outlined the result is often a sense of bleak and arid emotional deadness – an emptiness somehow – a void. And this yearning can make attention restless and set it in search of restoration. All of which is entirely healthy of course, in that there is actually something deeply wrong. But in this instance the very last thing we want is for attention to function naturally, because this might inevitably begin to restore order and integrity, and thereby reanimate this underlying crisis.

If all these various possibilities for ‘dysfunction’ are getting a bit confusing, then a very rough but effective analogy for bringing all of this together might be found in imagining the natural and normal processes of emotional equilibrium as being like a pack of dogs, and that in this instance the system has been forced to bury a big stinky bone that they found and became fixated on, to the point where they forgot all about what they were supposed to be doing.

In this instance what we then see is all manner of attempt to keep these ‘dogs of attention’ occupied or distracted somehow, rather than to continue to heap more dirt on top of the bone as they tend to dig away at it over time as seen above in deep process suspension.

Obviously there would be many options in that situation, depending on just how creative you want to get, in that it is a very dynamic situation. The few that we will be outlining here will be only some of the main options.

Anyway, hopefully you can see how this particular form might work. What we look for in this situation is often some way to keep attention occupied elsewhere, distracted so to speak, so as to make that repression a bit easier to maintain over time. And there are several ways our own unconscious can do this.

First of all, we can keep attention busy perpetually, with all manner of stimulated distraction. We can keep the mind busy, always working, always mulling over something, and never just resting. And of course all of this frantic mental activity requires lots of energy if high degrees of muscular and organic tension are going to be avoided, and what this means is that we become very attracted to the kinds of stimulants that are not so good for the body, but very good for the maintenance of this sort of activity in the mind. Sugar, fat, caffeine, all manner of ‘uppers’, they all fit this role in some way, and thereby allow us to maintain this mental distraction without too much effort (yet still often at great organic cost).

Moment to moment, in any situation of available free energy (which should naturally feel blissful) the system is forced to actively distract attention from its natural tendencies which would begin processes of healing, and which would eventually re-animate the crisis as a result. This is like not being allowed to simply let those dogs rest, just in case they got a whiff of that buried bone and started to search for it as they naturally would. And the resulting state of unnatural agitation is what we generally call ‘boredom’. And anything will do in that instance, anything to keep the mind occupied. Compulsive thinking, chronic creating (workaholism) the list is endless. This could be called ‘distraction addiction’. It consumes energy in the form of stimulated or fixated attention.

Instead of ‘pushing’ attention, another way of doing this is to ‘pull it’ by providing direct mental and emotional distraction. This means anything that might absorb attention so as to provide some sort of escape from your own personal reality, and with this we see the rise of the entertainment industry, with movies, TV, the internet, and video games now embodying some of the largest economic activities on the planet. We can only imagine what the advent of accessible artificial reality systems will result in, as people increasingly plug in and never unplug again. Which is not to say that any of these things are intrinsically negative in some way, it is just to say that they are all open to being employed by this underlying agenda as ways of managing the ongoing containment of this simmering emotional crisis.

6 –
Self medication.

In many ways this form is actually the flipside of the coin we just covered, in that all forms of attention are actually just disturbances and consumptions of subjective energy that would otherwise be experienced as ‘feeling’. As indicated earlier, free energy at a physical level is naturally experienced as emotional bliss at an emotional level, and it is this bliss that is disturbed and consumed in the process of attention and mental activity at the highest level by the conscious self. So instead of merely distracting or consuming this energy as it is produced, the other obvious target would be to adjust the flow of energy, which essentially amounts to a limitation on ‘feeling’.

All the forms of containment we have now outlined involve some kind of distortion of healthy function to be maintained, and all such distortion necessarily involves some manipulation of energy in the system, if only because feeling is the primary integrating thread. So in order to hold everything off balance, the secondary agenda must effectively prevent the healthy system from following its natural tendency toward free energy (and bliss) in order to maintain these balances and controls. And it must do this perpetually, in a very dynamic way. As already indicated, somehow it must function to run the business of organic existence on a zero bank balance, which is an incredible task. Too little energy and the organism will suffer ill health, but any to spare and it will go into a spiralling emotional crisis. So the system must use purge and release functions to control this emotional and energetic ‘cashflow’ as much as possible.

The control of free energy in an enclosed system can be achieved via only three basic principles –

You either limit its production, you discharge it as it emerges, or you pacify it in some way.

For the most part, the various forms of discharge generally take the form of distracting attention, as outlined above, in that thinking not only keeps those dogs occupied, but also consumes enormous amounts of physical energy.

Beyond this pattern of active distraction, there are many ways to put these dogs to sleep. Evolution has loaded certain mechanisms into the way we are made that can be stimulated so as to produce a disproportionate amount of tension release, if only because they relate to behaviours that always resulted in very positive outcomes within the context in which we evolved.

Sex is a discharge of psycho-emotive energy, and can be used to deplete the system of operating tensions. As can physical exercise of any form. Once again, bear in mind that every one of these transactions also has a natural and positive form. Almost any healthy relational exchange can be subverted and used to this end.

At the other end of the scale we see the very deepest option in this regard, which is the control of free energy at its origin or root, by negatively impacting the organ systems into which the entire emotional system is anchored. What this means is that certain organ systems are pressed into a state of stress, normally as a result of overloading them with demand. Once again, this is a trick that works at an emotional level because the possibility of using too much consumption is not something evolution ever had a chance to prepare us for, and so there are no built-in safeguards. Yet the deep tendencies toward valuing any form of high-energy food remain very present at a cellular level.

Therefore, another pacifying option is the consumption of certain types of food, in very specific combinations. Dehydrated food, heavy food, and very high-energy food all have the ability to trick certain brain systems into a state of tension release where they essentially lie down and go to sleep. Conversely, you might also discover that a bit of anaesthetic can assist in putting those dogs to sleep for a while, and thereby lessen the need for such frantic distraction, in which case alcohol might become your poison of choice. Or dairy food of any kind, which if you think of it is simply so bizarre as a concept that it boggles the mind (try to imagine an ape sucking on the teat of a wildebeest?) – but because many mothers substitute the natural feeding of infants with food meant for baby cows, the infant brain becomes tuned so as to associate these foods with security and comfort in a way that can be retained for life. It is no surprise perhaps that such children end up somewhat ‘bovine’ as adults.

These are just a few examples. The point is that all these foods and drinks are essentially employed as emotional sedatives in this sense.

At a more emotional level, we also see this artificial stimulation for a different reason entirely. In particular, what we see (as a result of our ‘capacity to feel’ being so limited) is a constant pressure not only to maintain the imbalances that produce this limitation (muscular tension, organic stress and toxicity etc) but also a constant pressure to want to amplify the emotional sensation of what little feeling remains. And with this we once again see the introduction of stimulants of various kinds, along with all of the deleterious effects associated. We essentially see people trying to make up for depth of feeling with intensity of feeling instead, and this impulse can range from a tendency to reach for the chocolate bar as you walk around the Supermarket, to an addiction to crystal meth or cocaine.

Mostly, what we see in this pattern is the overconsumption of types of food that by in large achieve both of these functions at the same time: They both produce and maintain critical levels of organic stress in organ systems that are heavily involved in the processing of emotion and feeling in general (and thereby limiting the depth of feeling), whilst at the same time providing massive amounts of high energy (so as to amplify the intensity of whatever feeling remains available).

Once you see how deeply the entire organic system is oriented around free energy as an ideal, it is easy to see how using high levels of energy might be a very effective way of applying subversive force without too much resistance. Regardless of whatever form is applied, it is essentially a trick that our system will fall for every time.

It is maybe interesting to note that if you mix all these things up a bit, the resulting 'salad of stimulation' is pretty much a recipe for the average person's 'ultimate night out'. But we also see why a typical night out can take a week to recover from, not to mention how expensive it can be to pay for. By contrast, in the natural human state the 'ultimate night out' would itself BE a process of recovery, and probably a very cheap one. As weird as it may sound, it is actually much more natural to crave perfectly steamed broccoli and a twilight swim at the beach than it is to crave milk chocolate, alcohol, and a movie.

7 –

Physical-organic imbalance.

Due to all integrity in organic systems being so intrinsically linked to the management of free energy, and because free energy comes from healthy organic functioning at a physical level, the distortion of these higher-level functions always ultimately has some effect on basic organic wellbeing. At the end of the day, the loss here is to physical and emotional integrity.

Put another way: Because every form of systemic repression involves a corruption of energetic integrity at some level, and because that integrity ultimately abides in the primary organism, every form of this secondary agenda negatively affects the body in some way.

Essentially, because primary organic functioning is the foundation of all higher integrity, if the system is prepared to sacrifice it at that level, then the maintenance of active dysfunction becomes easier. Like tying up the police, the raping and stealing can then be done in broad daylight.

This is where we finally see the integrity of the human system being corrupted. The entire need fulfilment systems of the organism (via the pressure applied to the frontal self) are operating counter to their primary directive – which is to ensure organic integrity and wellbeing over time. And what this means is that they are running directly counter to the very purpose for which they exist in the first place.

In certain respects, the frontal persona is forced to act in ways that literally attack the organism at the primary organic level. Which is obviously a clear violation of integrity: Like having your own arm for dinner. But in this instance following the demands of this extremely dynamic and complex added subversion is simply what 'feels good' to the conscious self, and it is generally yielded to without question.

The inevitable net result of these activities is ultimately damage to the primary integrity of the organism, which means this agenda represents a systemic conflict of the deepest order: A systematic, active and dynamic corruption of the system – of itself, by itself. It runs counter to the whole process of organic existence. It is a fundamental violation of the process that is life itself. What we see are systems that were developed over millions of years so as to **help**, that are now actively seeking to **hinder** us in order to impose certain limitations on core functioning. Needless to say, this is probably why it feels bad.

In this sense, due to the physical level being so primary, it means that physical dysfunction is the deepest form of the dilemma. It is the very last line of defence for this reason, and used only very sparingly in most instances. But also – precisely because it has the ability to contain or negate so much emotional process – it also represents 'large denomination notes' in terms of 'repression dollars'. If mental activity was ounces of repression, and emotional repression pounds, then physical imbalance would be repression by the ton. It is the principle impact point, and the heaviest load of all.

At this level what we see is obvious systemic imbalance, postural misalignment, organ stress, obesity, muscle tension etc, a whole barrage of possible points at which primary integrity can be affected. Metabolic syndrome, type two diabetes etc - it is not a great leap to imagine how much disease could be directly attributed to this underlying event, for it requires very hard work to maintain such imbalance, as the primary organism is strongly self-regulating and self-balancing. The body is a self-healing system, so in order to overcome this tendency there must be continuous self-medication through diet, ingestion of stimulants, hyperactivity or laziness, a million and one subtle relational exchanges all working together to keep things out of kilter.

Such self-destructive behaviours often appear as compulsive and mysterious, with no other obvious value except that they make you feel better somehow. And if you resist them you often end up confronting an unconscious pressure with the

power to overthrow your conscious will - in which case we see the foundations of the obsessive-compulsive cycle. Once it has done its work of maintaining an imbalance, a compulsion will naturally subside and allow your embarrassed (obsessive) will to regain control again – at least until the next time, which is generally just around the corner.

The Containments: Summary

If we now come back to the ‘dogs of attention’ metaphor as a kind of round-up for all of this, we can begin to see all the various ways our own system might be pushed off balance so as to achieve this one vital function of concealing and controlling the potential of this underlying crisis.

At the risk of stretching the metaphor somewhat, you could do the following –

1. Throw the dogs a Kong (a rubber chew ball that you put a little bit of peanut butter inside) so as to keep them busy for hours without actually feeding them anything substantial.

= Symbolic fulfilment structures.

2. You could pull all their teeth out, and remove their claws.

= Belief manipulation, Cognitive damage

3. You could even breed a smaller or lazier dog that cannot dig very well.

= Core directive leveraging, passive repression, lowered self-esteem

4. You could bury the bone even deeper.

= Deep process suspension, emotional repression

5. You could actively distract the dogs by throwing a Frisbee.

= Artificial stimulation, perpetual distraction from feeling

6. You could slip them a sleeping pill in their food.

= Self medication

7. Ultimately, you could tie the dog up.

= Direct physical and energetic imbalance

So my hope is that you can at least begin to see that a great many of the patterns of behaviour that create negative states (internal) and relational circumstances (external) are not mysterious and enigmatic things. They are the fluctuating and dynamic foundations of something far greater. And if you try to remove them the result will generally be that another of this bunch will emerge to fill the gap and maintain the underlying containment, so if you continue to do that then you will inevitably confront that deeper thing. And believe me, unless you know what you’re up against you simply do not want to do that.

At the end of the day, the resulting common state is a very busy one. Even in paradise, there is little internal rest in this situation. No circumstance can fulfil these demands ultimately, if only because they are structurally conflicted with the natural flow. A need to interrupt a natural process of need fulfilment is a need that cannot ultimately be fulfilled, obviously. No matter what the frontal (conscious) self does, no matter what its achievements, or no matter what relational circumstances it acquires, it can never fulfil the emotional agenda it is given in this situation – not when compared to the native state. There is simply no ideal situation to be found, because the game is ultimately not fair.

The end result of all this is the ‘common state’: A state of quiet discontentment with life, a subtle but profound sense that something is missing or not quite right. And it is a very dynamic and stable situation, which means that if you simply follow your natural emotional tendencies at any point then you will generally only make matters worse.

The very best you can hope for is to find the point of least tension between a state that is bad, and a state that is worse. There is no obvious exit point anywhere in the resulting landscape of possibilities, and not even a signpost to say which direction that exit might be. Indeed, the conscious self is not even aware that all of this has occurred – after all, this is the entire point of all of it. The whole aim is concealment, which means that not only is there a need to conceal what is being hidden, but that the entire process that is doing the hiding must also remain securely unconscious at every point.

So, in the end, this is what the frontal self is up against – the front end of a deeply rooted and dynamic body of negative functioning that simply cannot be resolved whilst the tiny and seemingly innocuous cause remains active and present. The conscious self is then up against a veritable army of unconscious functions working at odds with the native and healthy agenda, and it doesn’t even know it. All of which paradoxically leads to a situation where anything a person confronts that

is contrary to their particular dominant form of repression, or even the event in general (such as this book), is responded to with an immediate and significant wave of either bewilderment, unconscious resistance, or even outright hostility. And this is the saddest part of all – the only remedy the unconscious mind had as a way of managing this explosive crisis has had the unfortunate downstream effect of very securely preventing the actual cure.

On the other side, the collective manifestations of this individual need for avoidance can be seen like poisonous weeds that grow wild in soil that would not otherwise exist. They allow this avoidance to be normalised and even enforced in the individual.

In a bent world, bent people can almost appear straight. People know they are deeply unhappy, but the surrounding environment does everything it can to allow them to think this is normal. The very last thing they want to hear is any message that might disrupt this fabricated illusion, and burst their perfect and shiny bubble of denial.

This is the common state, as reflected in common culture.

HIDDEN RIGHT IN FRONT OF US

As you can probably see the resulting state is a very dynamic one with many downstream consequences that we have not covered here, and there are simply too many potential symptoms of this whole conflict to begin listing in surface behavioural terms. But as you begin to stand back from all this there are certain broader patterns that begin to emerge. And ultimately, in perhaps its simplest rendering, the entire thing breaks down into **three basic streams** in one sense.

The most obvious and almost universal is what could be defined as general ‘energetic dysfunction’. In the simplest terms what this means is the distortion or interruption of natural functioning via manipulations of how energy is managed at many levels, which in turn impacts on physical systems in many ways. In terms of the actual functions being targeted in this situation, they are far too many and varied to be defined, as outlined above, but what we are now addressing is just the overall impact that all of this has on the organism as a whole. And in this sense what we see is essentially a kind of unconscious but relentless and implacable self-attack that is very difficult to overcome or consciously comprehend. This is finally registered in the body itself, as outlined above in the section: ‘Physical-organic dysfunction’.

However, that is only half of the picture in one sense, and here we see the second of our main three emerging. It should also be clearly established here that organic wellbeing is not only a physical state as reflected in the organism itself, but that it has an equal and equivalent environmental aspect. Instead of our ‘state’, you might think of this external context as being our ‘situation’, and this is also directly and unavoidably implicated here. The reason for this is because these two aspects of life flow into each other constantly, in a kind of balancing homeostasis.

Therefore, and as we saw in earlier chapters of this book, the overall wellbeing of any organism could be defined as its physical state over its relational circumstance: Its inner and outer resources combined. And in our modern world, what this essentially equates to is **health** and **money** respectively: Inner and outer energy. Which, as we know, can generally be converted into each other quite easily.

And what this means is that it is not only our physical state that might be the target of deeply irresistible unconscious manipulations, but also our situation. In particular, instead of just discharging or avoiding energy in an internal sense (feeling), you might also find patterns that very powerfully affect the management and avoidance of external energy (money).

Ultimately, whilst money in the modern sense represents organic work in transactional terms, in most cases more money does not do anything but amplify the situation we are defining here. This is almost certainly why – beyond a certain point of basic fulfilment – more money does not make you happier, as you might imagine it would. It is because it cannot resolve this underlying event in a positive direction. But it can certainly be employed by this event in a negative direction, and we see this often. This is why some people find themselves perpetually hovering around a \$0 bank balance – this is merely a reflection of the organism itself being run at a zero balance in terms of feeling. This is also the reason why having more money is something that needs to be gradually adjusted to if it is not going to produce massive emotional crisis. Without alternative forms of containment in place, external energy will almost immediately convert into internal energy and spark off a spiral of emotional release, with the result being emotional upheaval.

So here we see the outlines of the first two of our big three addictions emerging. In the natural human state, energy is depleted by relational demands in the form of work and expenditure. Effort = demand and energy loss. This is obvious I suppose. This is how it is supposed to work. But because many forms of the secondary agenda effectively function to do exactly the same thing (eliminate free energy from the system) they are effectively creating loads on the system exactly equivalent to great amounts of physical work. It all produces a massive load cognitively, physically and emotionally. It is all a sympathetic nervous system response, which means continuous stress.

So what does this state feel like to frontal awareness, to the conscious self?

The common state is simply **hard work**, a continuous labour. It is very hard work for the body, and it can certainly wear you down.

The external relational demands of the secondary agenda are also very demanding, in that they often essentially either eliminate or cost money. The whole conflict has very clear effects on your overall outer circumstances of life, it can essentially determine your entire situation. After all, it is very difficult for this unconscious secondary agenda to keep organic energy levels low if you have too much free time on your hands, and no external demands (eg if you have money) – whereas if you are constantly exhausted physically or mentally, then controlling the whole thing becomes easier. And this is why it very powerfully manipulates circumstances so as to always keep you busy, keep you thinking about things, and keep you occupied. There is seldom any rest in the common state.

Perhaps the main point of what we are now getting to here is that in the broadest and most obvious manifestations we are now addressing, these impacts may not immediately be recognised as significantly harmful due to being so extremely broad and commonplace. They are paradoxically not obvious at all, even though they are all around us.

So if you want to see how this whole thing is playing out in your own life, right now, you might want to glance in the direction of the two most obvious and unrecognised features of this conflict:

Poverty, and Fatigue.

However, not all coping mechanisms are energetic in the negative direction, and the overall imbalances can in many instances be used in a ‘rob Peter to pay Paul’ sense. Precisely because the system is oriented around energy being scarce, an over abundance of resources in certain areas can also paradoxically help to support the secondary agenda, as we saw in relation to the control of emotional states via the massive consumption of high energy food for instance.

In collective terms we can also see this same pattern emerging, as one element of society becomes corrupted by an overabundance of resources, whilst another much wider section suffers economic deprivation. And wherever we see this imbalance emerging we see the third main form of impact coming to the fore as the main form of distortion or damage.

If you can manage to disturb or distort this underlying ‘crisis situation’ not by seeking to contain the results of a lack of fulfilment for existential need, but rather by conjuring up some imaginary fulfilment for such, then the entire problem will appear to go away emotionally, and will thereby require little in the way of energetic containment. In other words, it might certainly be possible to solve an imaginary problem with an imaginary solution, and thereby eliminate the whole thing in some sense. But what this involves, because the needs in question cannot actually be fulfilled, is the maintenance of beliefs which reality does not support, and that in turn involves the avoidance of reality, or at least the aspects of reality that are problematic to your fairytales retaining their ‘salvation power’. Which ultimately still boils down to a degree of energetic disturbance, in that cognitive integrity will need to be suspended over time, which is not possible whilst functions that maintain that integrity remain active and healthy.

Overall, what we see is that another less costly form of containment is indeed possible in this situation, and that it can take many and various forms (we addressed these particular forms above in the sections ‘belief manipulation’ and ‘symbolic fulfilment structures’ etc). But we also see that these forms are not actually as free of cost as they may seem. It is just that the costs are displaced and felt elsewhere in this instance, usually by someone else far away, or by the environment as a whole.

Ultimately, this form mostly places limitations on the other great integrating force within us:

Awareness.

So here we see the other end of energy imbalance: Too much energy. Power addiction.

Money, in this world, is power. And fairytales become easier to maintain if you can control your environment so as to support them. Which is perhaps why certain people and certain cultures focus so heavily on this form of containment (or all the forms that require high energy input to maintain). There is essentially no limit to the power the system’s secondary agenda may potentially seek in its manic flight from fear. And with this we see the emergence of greed as a potent driver in the realm of commerce and in the development of society as a whole.

Therefore, these three factors register the final body-count in this war of imbalance. **Poverty, Fatigue and Unawareness** are by far the most significant and prevalent and unrecognised addictions on the planet. Almost everywhere that you see poverty, fatigue or unawareness in modern life, you are actually looking at this secondary event at work – which is pretty much everywhere.

Overall, we see here a few of the main forms this secondary agenda can adopt, if only in 'core level' terms. And although we can often see particularly obvious examples of any of these, we rarely see just one form manifesting in isolation. Most people gradually develop a kind of balance between many or even all of these types or forms, it just depends on how many plates you are able to spin at once. And the ones we have seen here are just a few. There are infinite forms of this distortion when you examine all the possible elements of life experience this subversive activity can manipulate. Like the various ways you can smash a wine glass, the list is basically endless. Some people may find themselves regressing. In which case it essentially makes them feel good to 'be' a child at times. Or you may be attracted to a really big addiction - a twenty year, full time, attention draining, energy depleting coping mechanism... one that also offers you a tacit sense of continuing beyond death... in which case you may find yourself driven not by the need to be a child, but to have a child.

Or you might become obese, or alcoholic, or religious... or a combination of all these things at once.

I suppose there is an important distinction to make here between the basic underlying functions we have been identifying, and the way any of these might ultimately manifest in terms of tendency or behaviour. I guess you might think of food as an analogy, with meat and veggies and bread etc being akin to the sorts of various distortions that can be driven by this underlying event, which at the surface level can all be combined together to produce a sort of 'hamburger' pattern of behaviour.

Life in general, even without this added underlying distortion, is always expressed in this same way. The underlying dynamics of native need fulfilment processes almost always express themselves at the surface of actual life in the form of complex clusters of various motives and exchanges that simultaneously address many levels at once.

Need fulfilment (thinking, feeling, acting) is like a river into which many tributaries flow. So what we essentially see here is another entire river flowing into the original and natural one, polluting it so to speak. And with that we see the pollution of almost all the major aspects of life.

Close personal relationships are an example of this kind of surface level cluster, and one that is particularly polluted by the addition of this distorting event at very many levels. Your relationship to money is another, or your vocation, your diet, or your basic physical lifestyle in general. If you got really desperate to consume enormous amounts of free energy and attention, I suppose you could even choose to write a book!

Generally in life, this unconscious agenda adopts a very sophisticated and dynamic balance of all potential containments, spread right throughout the system, and right throughout life. It is a complex and dynamic play between both agendas, and it is always moving and shifting. No particular form is inherently preferred by the secondary agenda. The only real consideration is preventing that old bone from being dug up, and any combination will do. Meaning that many of the outer manifestations of it (at a relational level) often reflect several different forms of subjective containment. But we can sometimes also have one form predominating, depending on our circumstances and state at the time.

The final result is a powerful but slippery unconscious agenda that often appears somewhat chameleon in nature. All of which leaves life in the common state - life as we know it - as a complex situation that is always built upon these two separate emotional foundations at once.

For the most part people are not generally aware of their own covert motives, or even aware that massive elements of common human life are broadly pathological. And this was the point of explaining the three main forms above (poverty, fatigue, unawareness).

This entire conflict is so grand in scale - and so widely spread over life - that it remains securely invisible to the untrained eye. The entire secondary agenda is never identified as problematic in common life because it is so seamlessly interwoven with myriad healthy functions. It is, actually, never clearly differentiated at all. Not ever. As far as I am aware, this emerging paradigm is the very first example of capturing it fully, and in a way that does not allow it to escape out some back door.

Therefore, all historical attempts to isolate some particular element of life as being 'the root of human suffering' have always come up short of the mark. As Buddhists did with attachment, and Freud did with repression. And many have done with sex, and money, and greed... you name it. You may even have thought I just did that with the desire for children. But no single function or aspect of life can be isolated as being entirely positive or negative inherently.

Every element of life may, at times, become influenced by this conflict and adopt a pathological form. The only real determiner of 'healthy' is the origin, ie which agenda is feeding a behaviour, and that may change from moment to moment.

So if you wish to define which aspects of life are dysfunctional, and which are not, it is really not so easy unless you have some means of lifting the lid and examining the inner workings of all this as we are beginning to do here. Imbalance is the key to all this distortion, which generally means too much or too little, or at just the wrong time. It can be very hard to identify in behavioural terms, even though the overall effects remain obvious in terms of a frustrating inability to simply and deeply relax and just be happy whilst remaining basically aligned with the Earth and the deeper ecosystems.

In the end it is not what you do, but why you do it that counts: Not *what* you want, but *why* you want it - not *what* you believe, but *why* you believe it, etc. Our own motives are so corrupt that almost everything becomes suspect, and this can be very difficult to assess in any objective way. It is so interwoven that nearly all actions embody some energy from both agendas at all times. This is why we need to go deeper - we need to wander upstream and catch this whole river before it merges with the original one, and then follow that poisoned river right back to its source. This is the only way to truly release ourselves from the impossibly perplexing and complex trap we have ended up being caught in.

It has only survived so long through its ability to remain hidden in plain sight, and through dividing us against each other as a result of the real culprit not being obvious. It has been like an invisible monkey that has been running around a party slapping people on the ass and bumping people's drinks over. But with this broad outline you pretty much have what you need in order to get together and back it into a corner, and grab it by the tail. And once we start doing that, especially together, its days of causing all this conflict and strife will certainly be numbered.

The definition of the containments above is merely a very rough map of what you will generally find if you do choose to embark on that journey together. This is why it needs to be broadly comprehensive. It is because without all the exits blocked, the core event could easily sneak out and you will miss it. The entire collective exploration will become distracted in that instance, as the subversive agenda itself tricks everyone into once again taking a detour away from the core event. It is very sneaky, and common culture has become awash with these phantom 'exit ramps' on the road to insight.

There, then, we have the basic outlines of what we are up against in life. When you stack these various containments on top of the outline we achieved earlier for the originating events that cause all this crisis, what we see is the origins and essential nature of what I believe to be the single greatest obstacle to human happiness and wellbeing by far. In particular, what we see there is something you don't normally see at all, because all of this is intrinsically hidden from view at every point.

And with that, we also immediately see the obvious pathway out of that trap, along with the courage that path unavoidably requires. We essentially need to go boldly toward the very thing that has so many people running in fear, and – with our hands on the collar of those dogs of attention – we need to dig up that old bone and have a good look at it. You need to go uphill, and against the flow of both individual tendency and cultural expectation. This is how it remains so incredibly stable in its current state. The very nature of this situation means that the more you simply do what you 'feel like doing', the more it wins. It thrives on fear and trepidation. But if you can go against this up to a certain point then the entire thing can begin to unravel. The only reason nobody is doing this now is because they don't even know it is there, and the reason for this is because nobody ever went there to have a look. And only a few need to take that journey, this is also an important thing to understand. Most people are not ready for such an adventure into themselves. But a few is all it will take to make their way upstream and poke a hole in the great dyke that has diverted this poisoned river and merged it with our own native flow, and with that the entire thing will begin to unravel for everyone, everywhere.

TRUE NORTH

It is also very important to grasp one crucial concept here: There are no degrees of this event. It might be very easy for you to be reading this and imagining that you only have some very mild or only partial form of what is being explained here, or even that you do not embody any of this at all. That would be somewhat grandiose to say the least, if not outright hilarious. Alas, there is only one basic form of this dis-ease, and it is present (almost) universally in modern humanity.

The reason for this uniformity in scale is that the basic purpose of this event is to conceal a body of functioning that is essentially identical in every different person, and what this means is that it must always bring functional integrity down to a certain common level in order to do this. Therefore, and paradoxically, if you imagine you might be too smart or 'together' to be suffering from all this then you are even more out of luck, because the very nature of it means that the bigger you are, the harder you will need to fall. The entire thing is precisely defined in scale by the low level of functional integrity required to prevent one very obvious process from emerging again, so high integrity is actually a disadvantage in that case. It is basically a 'one size fits all' event, so if you happen to have a huge lump of genius sticking out, then this event will generally just come along and chop it off in its mad rush for control of a volcanic emotional crisis. All of which is to say: If you have been sitting there thinking "that's not me", then all this means is that you likely have one of the forms in which unawareness has come to dominate.

However, the fact that the core event is universal in scale does not mean there are no degrees in terms of how well you might be able to manage this situation. It is a very complex and dynamic state that can potentially be managed in an equally complex and dynamic manner, provided you have the resources.

In this sense we once again see the role of culture, in that it is possible for the collective to record and transmit patterns of functioning that individuals have learned, and thereby to offer a kind of detailed 'recipe' for ideal management of this state. And at the lowest end, what this might allow for is at least the successful containment of this crisis in a very robust way, but at the highest end it might even allow for the recovery of certain degrees of functioning that might otherwise have been

entirely destroyed by this event. And I suppose this might be seen as the most ideal outcome in some sense, which is also reflected in the ideals of common culture.

The final complex synthesis offered by common culture as the 'most balanced lifestyle and personal state' is actually a delicate fusion of careful functional distortion and avoidance mixed with as much recovery and maintenance of healthy functioning as possible. It walks a very fine line between genius and madness, like a tiger tamer sticking his head in the tiger's mouth. It is a demonstration of a certain sort of well-prepared and highly skilled freedom, but it will never be the simple and radical freedom we biologically expected (which would exist naturally if there was no tiger).

Therefore, it is not true that happiness is not possible in the common state. It is possible, at least in certain sophisticated and manipulated forms. It is even possible to maintain a degree of happiness over time, especially for those who have very little natural integrity in certain regards. After all, the purpose of this underlying event was not to diminish happiness. Quite the opposite, happiness was merely a casualty – an accidental bystander in a sense – and this underlying event actually does everything it can to keep it standing where possible. But if it has to choose between being alive, and being happy, it will most often choose the former over the latter.

More to the point, it is the way common culture has allowed this disturbed state to be normalised that creates the most trouble. What this ultimately means is that we might be left in a situation where we are entirely unaware that our state is not actually normal, or that the ideals of common culture are dramatically distorted. We may not be aware of the impact these patterns of collective functioning are having on the Earth as a whole, if only because it is one of the functions of common culture to separate us from such things. In this way the collective state comes to reflect the individual state, in that the collective is also concealing certain important things from itself. In the collective sphere, the 'conscious level' is the media (the 'cultural level dogs of attention' so to speak, the ones that need to always be distracted away from what is actually most important).

The result is that we think this is normal. We imagine that the way we live now is natural and inevitable, rather than being dramatically distorted and dysfunctional (not to mention entirely unsustainable). We are entirely unaware that the ideals we are striving for may actually be the most dysfunctional of all, in that they are actually highly sophisticated variations of a pattern of corruption that is fundamentally and unavoidably damaging. Even if we reach these common ideals, we don't seem to notice that all we generally end up achieving is to displace all of this damage into some other part of the living systems we are part of. All we end up doing in that case is hurting others, rather than ourselves, or harming the planet as a whole. But we don't tend to see all of that because the walls of our gated compounds, and filtered media streams, act to prevent such.

Which is to say: The least costly forms of this containment are not actually without cost – they merely support a myopic lifestyle whilst displacing the cost into other areas of life. They create 'blind spots' and then fill those spaces with pain – usually not your own pain, but the pain that others are experiencing in that instance, because of you. And this pattern is not at all rare. We see entire societies on this planet that embody this flight into opulent self-gratification and self-serving ignorance. It remains an ever-present temptation for anyone who finds themselves in a position of freedom to use that power to support isolation and ignorance, rather than insight and awareness.

Yet some still people manage to fight all of this, and with this we see ground for hope. As indicated, the patterns of functioning we see may not only be geared toward keeping the crisis down, but also toward the recovery of the good stuff where possible.

The one thing that all the outlines above do not offer directly is perhaps the single most important thing of all if we are ever going to be able to securely exit this terrible emotional trap. What we see there are a few versions of negative tendencies and behaviours and emotional states that might manifest at times in this conflicted state, or the kinds of damage we might do to the planet as we seek to find any kind of stable respite from it. It explains why the typical individual generally ranges from being mildly discontent at best, to being a passive and morally myopic lump of over-consuming self-obsession at worst. And whilst it may be gratifying to finally have some kind of underlying validation for exactly why this might be the case, as well as how it essentially works, this does not necessarily chart a very reliable course out of this state. It explains the broken state, but not the ideal state that has been eroded away. It explains the negative, but not the positive that was lost.

Yet if you look carefully enough, all of the details we have now gleaned do actually offer this positive information quite clearly – you only need to turn it all upside down in a sense, and look at it all from another direction again.

To use a metaphor, you might imagine that what we have been doing here is lining up all the thieves who have been stealing the blocks from our own pyramid of integrity, with the result being that we are left with big ugly mounds that are quite flat instead of rising to a beautiful high peak. Beyond this, we have seen how common culture has come to reflect this ubiquitous state by defining this lowered state as 'normal humanity', and thereby largely preventing anyone from seeking more. But in doing this we have actually defined a great deal in terms of what that original integrity might be, as well as what the functions that have been eroded might be geared toward achieving if they were left in their ideal state.

So what do we see there? What is the 'peak' of this pyramid of integrity and ideal functioning? What is it that we have lost? Or, put another way, what is it that we are actually looking to recover? After all, this is clearly a very important question if we ever want to move beyond merely knowing what went wrong – and to begin to put it all right again.

This crucial and defining apex is precisely what common culture has removed from common awareness in its mad flight toward shallow and immediate emotional gratification. We have forgotten who we are supposed to be.

That apex is actually pretty clearly defined here, and even more so in this emerging paradigm as a whole. If we turn all of this damage upside down and put the whole system together again, what we see is a sort of grand synthesis that all converges on one singular function. And that function is:

Effective change management toward the fulfilment of need.

In particular, what we see is that this apex function occurs in direct alignment with the wider processes of life we are only a small but natural part of. And more importantly, what we see is that this process would and should result in fathomless and extremely reliable states of emotional fulfilment at almost every point in its cycle of operation. And this is going to seem just too bizarre to comprehend, to the point where you might imagine that it is fanciful and deluded, but it is also impossible to conclude anything else based on the nature of the systems we have been exploring here.

At a subjective level what we see here is this:

Extremely robust, perpetual, and effortless bliss.

Essentially, what we see as the peak of a fully reconstructed pyramid is a process of profound and dynamic 'creativity' in the sense we addressed in section one of this book. We see awareness expanding without limit. We see the formulation of vast and highly accurate simulations of future potentials along with their associated actions in the present. We see the capacity to adopt paths that may involve significant yet always temporary tension in the present so as to achieve the highest outcome states associated (my definition of what 'creative' actually means). We see moral development based on this same principle, where those paths may not necessarily be deemed higher because of the personal gain associated, but because of the overall gain (not only to your fellow humans, but to the system as a whole, including other animals or ecosystems in general). We see cognition developing freely so as to embrace both rational and trans-rational states, with a particular focus on awareness of complex systems and patterns of change. And on the basis of all of this, what we would see is social development emerging to reflect all of this individual integrity, so as to both reinforce and record any and all positive developments over time.

What all of this boils down to is that the peak of this pyramid of functioning, the great machine that has been pulled apart by this subversive activity, is actually a 'happiness generator'. Therefore, most of all what we would see is a world full of people who were naturally happy in a way we cannot even really imagine from within our current state of subjective entrapment. We would see a situation where what felt good would actually be good for you, and also good for the planet. We would also see broad philosophical alignment between people, and the falling away of all the emotionally loaded and spurious 'religious divergence' we see today.

All of which is important to see for several reasons. Firstly, it is important because - regardless of all the downward pressure - we do actually see a few people reaching upward toward this pinnacle even now. There are people who manage to display remarkable degrees of creativity in this change management sense, and some who even manage to do that in the direction of moral action. We do see very high cognitive capacity at times, even though it is very often emerging due to the profound absence of some of these other factors, but not always. The fact remains is that we do see some people labouring away, stacking their blocks up, even as they are being torn apart again every night as they sleep by an army of unconscious processes. And sometimes they do succeed in recovering a degree of mastery again, in the true human sense. Of course this may often mean sacrificing a degree of happiness in this situation, in that the underlying conflict has not gone away in that case. But for many the recovery of these higher states still remains worth it.

These people are the emerging heroes here. Those who have fought against this storm of destruction are our principal hope now, in that they alone possess the courage and capacity and insight required to unite and truly fight back – especially in the face of these patterns becoming available for the first time. And this is important because without this particular context you may not immediately recognise them. The tensions associated with very significant change management (both the cognitive labour as well as the emotional tension) are toxic in the extreme. They are exactly like holding your breath, as outlined above. And this is where everything indicated above begins to tie back in here: The containment mechanisms this underlying crisis has employed turn out to be the very same mechanisms we would otherwise use (and suffer from to a degree) if we were going to engage in serious creativity.

These 'containment tanks' originally had another purpose entirely, but because they are now full to the brim in the form of all this added burden it means that the original use is no longer available. And this is why people are often somewhat crippled when it comes to producing significant change, or even in recovering the sorts of cognitive rigour to see that such is possible. They simply do not have the capacity to embody or embrace the tensions associated with the paths that such

change might require, or even the courage to look for such paths. They are essentially already too tense, too unhappy, or just too weak and broken down to even try.

And this is what you need to know about those who do have this ability: If they are indeed using these capacities, then they might easily come to appear just like a particularly damaged and screwed up individual. They may indeed be suffering from very significant stress in that instance, not to mention social isolation as a result of going against the very dysfunctional norms common culture dictates. Their genius may indeed be bordering on madness if they are doing this, in that the recovery of these higher functions will often not result in the kinds of blissful emotional states that would naturally accompany such if the underlying crisis had already been released. Until then, such higher development will probably only cause some degree of stress, even as it produces even more stress and tension so as to leverage change toward positive outcomes.

In particular, any one of these functions being brought back into its fully engaged and operating state will inevitably generate a need to displace containment into some other area of the system overall, which will be experienced as somewhat stressful even if it is adapted to over time. But even more crucially, if several or even many of these functional capacities are ironed out and lifted up and connected together, then while the resulting jump in creative potency can be very dramatic indeed, so can the massive jump in subjective stress. In that instance the convergence of these functions (the emerging peak of the pyramid) creates a kind of integrated synthesis that is certainly much more than the sum of its parts in the creative sense. But this restored unity and power also means almost certain failure for the ongoing containment of the underlying crisis.

Needless to say, the intentional restoration of these aspects of your own functioning can be challenging, especially if you achieve more than one at a time. The point being, however: This sort of courage is the key here. The whole point is that going in the right direction will not feel right in the first instance. This is the very nature of this trap. But it is also true that this resistance will give way at some point if you persist, especially if you do that together, and beyond that point there will be a release. Provided the original spark of crisis is identified and addressed then the entire edifice will suddenly fall away and collapse into nothing. And beyond that point the full recovery of creative capacity, along with the full experience of the results of such being experienced as freely blissful, will begin to occur without resistance or limitation.

This potential release point is something we will address in the next section, but for now it is also worth considering just one other implication that becomes clear as this missing peak emerges out of the mist. And this is that the missing peak of our own integrity is also the same peak that all of life embodies, it is a unifying apex, a summary and universal axiom around which all of life pivots. And this has very deep philosophical implications, in that what it means is that (if the shift we are defining here is the state we have historically called 'awakening' or 'spiritual enlightenment') the very highest of all human potentials is only unique to us in the sense that we were the only ones who managed to 'lose it'. It unavoidably implies that all other animals – indeed the entire universe and existence as a whole – are already there. And this will need to be addressed at some later stage, in that there are a great many depths to all the things that this possibility fundamentally explains and resolves.

For now, the important thing is to see that there is first of all a vast and complex system of subversive activity that is tearing down this peak as we continually strive to rebuild it, and also that we cannot let that process win without at least putting up a good fight. What we now see is the exact direction in which we need to be striving, as well as a clear blueprint for both what needs to be built as well as what we might expect to encounter as we do this. We have a definition here of true north, and with that we see the path out of this situation emerging at last. And if we do choose to fight, with all of this awareness emerging, then gradually we might find that the tables begin to turn for us. We might find that insight alone was the key we had been seeking, and that when applied in practice it offers us a kind of subjective 'Kung Fu' in our battle against all this confusion - that instead of fighting what seems like an invisible army of slippery assailants, we might begin to see it all as plain as day. And with that, to begin to really make ground against it.

Most importantly, we see that we need to do that together, not alone. We need the power and insight that only unity can deliver, because only within that context can gradual validation of the paradigm spiral upwardly so as to increase both interest and further development. And of course such an endeavour is bound to encounter obvious resistance from both the average individual person and the collective as a whole, especially in this spiralling form, which is why there is perhaps some need to consider doing this in private (only amongst informed and consenting adults etc).

Of course, any such resistance to mere claims could itself be seen as rather suspicious in this instance, in that if there really was nothing to the claims then nothing would be found upon having a bit of a dig and taking a look. In which case the predictable claim that 'there is nothing there' could not really stand as an obstacle to exploration, but rather an invitation to openly explore without any implied sense of threat or danger. Yet this is not what we generally find, especially as such exploration does indeed begin to unearth precisely the kinds of patterns we have outlined above. So this argument does pretty quickly begin to deconstruct any resistance. But there is actually no need to foist all of this awareness on the timid and sleeping masses, not when just a few can make that trek without all of that distraction and fuss to burden them.

As stable as our situation may seem, both individually and collectively, the underlying and hidden reality is that this entire crisis in every individual is actually entirely dependent on the same crisis remaining in place in all the people around them.

And what this means is that they all stand like dominos, entirely stable in the sense that a domino cannot push itself over, but this also means they are only stable until the dominos around them begin to fall. Which in turn means that once the whole thing begins to unravel, we will all just be able to sit back and watch the show. Like a landslide, it will only happen once.

The point of which is to say - that first domino is all we are talking about tipping over here. You will not need to repeat all the effort associated with reaching that point 7 billion times over. All the rest will take care of themselves, in that the resulting wave of emancipation will simply be unstoppable.

Like making your way into an uncharted wilderness, it is a path that can only be walked once, and that only needs to be walked once. And that is not a path for everyone, but it is a pioneering path that at this point remains open to anyone with the courage to walk it. A great many will follow in time, not on these rough trails, but on highways named after those first few. It is only due to the incapacity of people to confront their own fears and overcome their own conditioned mental and emotional atrophy that we still remain trapped today, and it will only take a tiny minority to produce the small tear in this veil of denial and avoidance that will eventually 'rent the whole thing asunder', as they used to say.

ROUNDING IT ALL UP

So what does this all mean for the organism? What are the functional effects of such containments on subsequent life?

Perhaps we could summarise the entire situation –

Once again we can look at this situation from three distinct perspectives - Primary-relational, core-functional, and natural-subjective:

In *core-functional* terms, then, where this crisis originates and resides, we see a profound degree of conflict and functional subversion. Like a secret government operating within a government, nothing is what it seems. A continual power play is being animated between opposing functions in a constant wrestle for control of systemic activity - a very sophisticated game, with very high stakes. At any one time many aspects of subjective functioning may be shut down or negatively affected in some way by an active and extremely well orchestrated secondary agenda.

In *primary-relational* terms, nothing is happening to actually cause this whole event. Well, at least not in transactional terms. There is no external circumstance to warrant all of the activity happening at the core-functional levels. There is, in fact, no fundamental problem. But many of the demands and symptoms of the purely subjective conflict do flow through to affect the physical level. The eventual relational demands of this conflict are potentially very great, and can therefore greatly affect the primary-relational level. Like fighting off a swarm of imaginary bees, and getting cut and bruised in the process - there are no bees, but the cuts and bruises are real. And these *are* a problem at this level, and can be observed. But for some people this kind of symptom is much more prevalent than for others, depending on how they manage the containment. But in essence, there is no *real* crisis, just an emotional one based on pure imagination.

In this state it could be said that these navigational and motivational systems have become their own worst enemy. It is supposed to be the organism against the world, but by and large it is now the system against the system. The demands of this crisis - and its containment - far outweigh the demands of living in our modern world. So in the common state the human system suffers far more from the inside than from the outside. And this suffering is of a very real and pervasive kind. Especially, at the core-functional level. The valence of potential tension at the core level is equivalent to primary level stress of great magnitude, even though there is no primary level issue to address. This core tension is then modulated by repression and functional distortion so as to appear minimal at the surface frontal level, but the frontal still suffers the consequences of all that repression. Which gives the frontal level this choice - of suffering from emotional crisis, or suffering from repression. Not much of a choice really.

At the frontal level, then, where we adopt the *natural-subjective* perspective, we see a perplexing and confusing situation, the summary of all this conflict and confusion - a bewildered frontal self confronting a situation it can neither control nor understand.

For the organism as a whole, this state can vary greatly depending on the forms of containment being enforced by the secondary agenda at any time. But for the conscious frontal self nearly all forms represent an irresolvable dilemma. It is always caught in the middle of the emotional conflict each mechanism creates. And whilst its natural efforts to resolve the evident tensions it is faced with continue, such efforts are severely hampered by the fact that it is completely ignorant as to the cause of such problems, or that such a profound conflict is even possible. We must always remember that if the secondary agenda is doing its job, then frontal awareness is left completely in the dark.

So what we see from the natural-subjective view is a conscious self caught in the middle. We see a tortured mind, never able to relax or be still. The frontal self is responsible for responding to emotive energies and acting to fulfil them. And now we can begin to see the origins of the problems introduced in Section One regarding the integration of all systemic desire into a seamless vision. For when the frontal self seeks to feel into and collect its desires, and forge them into a single vision or plan, what you get is a body of relational transaction with little clear integrity at all. They don't all fit together, if they stay still at all. And the frontal self has no idea how to deal with this, so it just does its best to manage and keep a dramatically listing boat on an even keel. And for a lot of people this looks a lot more like merely existing, than really living.

The native agenda

The relational program defined by the native emotive agenda can be seen to make obvious sense in light of the organism's functional needs in any situation. Thus, it is easy for the frontal self to embody this emotive agenda in action, and thereby fulfil its own purpose for existing. The native human agenda defines a game the frontal self can win, and win relatively easily in most circumstances. The native agenda is very stable, even to the degree it can be predicted with great accuracy. Thus, if you know what the relational needs of the organism will be in any situation, you will be able to predict the exact actions the native emotive agenda will be likely to be seeking to achieve. And by fulfilling such in advance, you could theoretically avoid any negative emotional tension whatsoever. The fulfilment of the organisms primary level needs and interests is the *ONLY* function the frontal self has, it is its *SINGLE* responsibility.

In this way the native agenda makes sense at every point, from *primary need* to *emotive core* to *frontal action*. The point of integrity for all native functioning is the action which results - that being the purpose for which they exist. So all the pieces generally fit, because the native agenda is addressing actual reality, because all the desired outcomes are transactional, and because all of it relates to a single integrated system - i.e. the organism itself in relation to its environment.

The secondary agenda

But the secondary agenda, that is another matter. The primary objective of the secondary agenda is not transactional at all, but rather a systematic subversion of the healthy functional agenda at a subjective level. The primary-relational aspects of its presence are merely unavoidable by-products, they are not the point. So when you convert the secondary agenda into its action components, when you view it in terms of the transactional programme it defines, it makes very little sense. The relational factors are merely the outer transactions required to support the particular inner functions being leveraged at any given time. Unlike the native agenda, relational transactions are not the point, nor the point of integrity. They are simply the scattered side effects of an agenda which is functioning to maintain its grip on something at a deeper level of the system.

However, because the purpose of that secondary agenda is to subvert healthy functioning at a core functional level, and because such functioning is intrinsically linked to organic integrity at a physical level, this means that the 'outward' components necessary to subvert the 'inner' activity are bound to be contrary to the native agenda. Thus, conflict at a primary relational level is actually not the point, but because of the general integrity of the system as a whole it is completely unavoidable. So in relational terms, in the terms the frontal self understands, the two agendas are not so much completely conflicting, but working at right angles to each other. They can both be partly fulfilled without conflict, but can never both be completely fulfilled at the same time.

The common state

We can now see our situation. With sophistication and refinement, it is possible to manage this state so as to experience a modicum of happiness. There are varying degrees of this whole dynamic, depending on how well it is managed. Some manage to contain it much better than others do, and containment strategies may become developed and habitualized over time into stabilised patterns. In fact, like so many things, both the formation of your identity, as well as the forms of containment strategy you adopt, are highly conditioned by your parents and upbringing. There are many subtle tricks, and with enough sophistication and resources the 'secondary ramp' can be edged further and further down the 'native ramp'. A little bit of every kind of containment, all in moderation, that is perhaps the best we can hope for. Common wisdom seems to want to spread it out, and keep it flexible, allowing patterns to become easy and automatic. But this is a very refined affair, and involves great balance and many subtle demands, like a high wire act.

This thing does not kill you. If you are prepared to be moderately unhappy for the rest of your life, you will be OK in this state. But if you rock the boat, if you are committed to being as happy as you believe you can be, then you will inevitably suffer. And the closer you come to being truly healthy, the more you will struggle. But a degree of happiness is still possible in the common state, and there is much wisdom to be found concerning such.

Unfortunately, it is those with the least natural systemic integrity who prosper most in this game, for they can more easily lie to themselves and live with subjective dysfunction. But even at its best it is never the simple and easy variety of happiness found in the native state. The fulfilment criteria for a deep sense of fulfilment are now far greater, and a great many never succeed in even coming close to meeting them. And even at best, this is not resolution, just containment. It is, therefore, still dysfunctional, just in a very balanced way.

So in the absence of people from whom we might learn such refined containment, we tend to remain quietly unhappy. And without any understanding, we tend to blame circumstances for what we feel. We generally don't even consider looking within ourselves for answers. Because, as a result of this simmering crisis within our unconscious, we tend to be burdened with a deep fear of ourselves. Our culture as a whole also reflects this fear, and produces a strong bias toward a more 'outward' search.

In our typical search for happiness, then, we tend to adopt the common models of what fulfilment in life involves - the cultural norms. So we look for the perfect partner, the perfect occupation, financial security and freedom, the dream house....And where does this get us? Well, sadly many never even get this far. Many do not get to experience the life they want, and therefore never get to realise that it would have made little difference. Instead, they just sit and yearn, and continue to blame their outer state for what they feel. Leaving a perpetual discontent with life and where they are at, and a constant 'what if...?' going through their mind. But what they do not realise is that even if they did collect the courage and commitment required to find outward success, it would not take them where they imagined it would. For reasons we can now understand. Such outward success might actually stand to make very little difference to the real crisis occurring within us. If anything, success can make things worse, leaving us no excuses for our lasting sense of bitter discontent, and nowhere else to run.

So whilst outside (the transactional level of life) is actually the right and correct orientation in the real native state, and may well result in authentic organic needs being fulfilled entirely, people can never find the happiness such should bring, no matter what they do. No outer circumstance ultimately placates this underlying sense of dis-ease. This is how, and why, the closer you get to the real answer, the more stressed out you become, and the more you suffer. It is an irresolvable paradox for the frontal self.

This, then, is the fundamental human dilemma. It is important to realise just how much of 'normal' life is determined by this secondary agenda, and exactly how resistant it is to change and resolution. It adds to life a huge barrage of demand and active fulfilment structures, all of which are generally considered normal. Many of which are even considered 'virtuous', perhaps because of the historical consequences of attempting life without them. In fact, without this secondary agenda, a great many things we presume to be normal parts of everyday life would not even exist. It accounts for about half of everything we do.

People do not even realise that they are in this, or how serious it is. They suffer, but don't really know why. They just don't see it. If only because it is impossibly complex and transparent as it plays out in relational terms. And the surface transactions are what the frontal self is left to figure out and act on, with the resulting lack of emotional fulfilment being what the conscious self experiences as the quiet desperation we call common unhappiness.

The Search

In the face of financial freedom and abundance, many will eventually come to realise that such outer things make little difference in the end to their deeper sense of dis-ease, and have no option but to conclude that the answer must ultimately lie within. We sense there is something 'bad' in there, and don't want to look too deeply just in case. But even in paradise a sense of quiet discontent still pervades, which leaves us with little choice. We must begin to seek happiness in a different realm. And so we begin our 'inner search'.

Of course many reach this point of insight without having to first exhaust their options through finding worldly success. You can just know I suppose, if you are insightful enough.

In any case, the resulting 'search' has many forms and many paths, but ultimately reflects the overall discontent created by the secondary agenda being present in the system. Thus, the search is ultimately for the native human state, free of that agenda. But people are ignorant to the real facts. They do not realise this, or exactly what their search might ultimately involve if they want to truly change things. In fact people are not at all aware that this crisis even exists, all they know is that they feel a longing for something, a deep yearning for to fulfil a lack that they can't quite explain.

Consequently, most view their 'inner search' as one of seeking to acquire something, rather than eliminate something. They see the state they desire as something they must get, rather than something they already embody beneath a complex and active disturbance. And, of course, who is the search ultimately for? Who is going to benefit from whatever is ultimately gained by it all? Well, who else but... trusty old 'I'!

Here, then, we see the backdrop for a million and one things people do to effect change **within** themselves at a subjective level. And with 'I' at the helm we can also see why much of what people do in this regard is completely futile, simply because they do not recognise the inherent conflict in their own motives, and thus end up merely extending the same crisis into a new realm. They inevitably end up seeking to fulfil the existential needs at the root of the secondary agenda, which is of course just another form of it. The motive is correct - the search for peace and higher fulfilment. But the lack of perspicacious understanding results in even more struggle.

I call this the erroneous search. But beyond that there is the authentic search. By that I mean the things people do which actually confront the real issue. And the common 'search' as many express it can often become a mixture of both.

When we look at such endeavours then, we can see countless different processes being offered in what we might call the 'personal growth supermarket'. From psychotherapy to 'rebirthing', hypnotherapy to deep tissue bodywork, diet doctrines to 'chakra' rebalancing, do-it-yourself motivation books to full scale spiritual paths.

For every potential element of dysfunction possible as a result of the secondary agenda, there is an associated remedial practice or school of thought. Some of which are so blindingly partial in their understanding, and so inept in practical terms, as to be almost laughable. In fact some, whilst purporting to be paths of liberation, even function to become further extensions of the secondary agenda by merely offering consoling belief systems and social support. Whereas others, whilst still having only part of the picture, do actually achieve real change, and may even begin to threaten the equilibrium of the two agendas. And of all the approaches, these are often the ones we should worry about.

The ineffectual theories and practices are just plain silly, and require no special attention. But these practices, because they actually work, can be downright dangerous. The main trouble with these theories and practices is that at best they amount to a partial understanding of the problem. That they are often seriously misinformed as to what they are dealing with, or what effects their tampering could have on their overall system, or on particular aspects of functioning they are generally not even aware are connected to the ones they are addressing.

There are, and have been, some real heroes and pioneers in the world of inner change - people who have been prepared to run headlong into the flank of this sleeping beast with machetes blazing. And were they wrong to do so? No. Were they addressing the problem at its true origin? Well, yes, in a sense they were, almost. But here we see the truth in the old adage - "a little knowledge can be a dangerous thing".

As I see it, any approach to personal change can be divided into two: theory and practice.

Any **practice** can only be critically assessed by two criteria –

1. What such seeks to achieve.
2. How it functions to achieve that end.

And any supporting **theory** by one criteria –

3. How accurately, appropriately or fully it defines the other two.

Even with the most powerful and effective practices available today, it is at this third point that they all seem to fail. There is a universal lack of wider perspective being applied. Each isolated approach keeps its gaze securely within its own limited area of life, and thus completely ignorant to the effects they are producing in other areas. And, not knowing the true origins of what they are addressing, each approach is forced to formulate its own ideas to account for it all, and how it works. Ideas which then function to orient the practices, but which inevitably end up fairly erroneous in nature, and thus failing to integrate well with other theories and practices.

Over the years people like Ken Wilber have done a valiant job looking for the common threads, and seeking to bring these diverse approaches together. Which, in some respects, has been achieved. But differentiation of this secondary agenda has remained elusive, and practical approaches to personal change are still suffering as a result from being very poorly oriented. They also fail to broadly agree with each other.

As individuals we often tend to consolidate our containment into one of several main types or forms. Thus, it is natural that a group of individuals all displaying the same affliction might end up believing that their particular form of dysfunction is the root of all suffering, and that their approach is therefore the final answer to human problems. But in reality the best any practice ever seems to achieve is the displacement of dysfunction from one area of the system to another. However, because each approach is only aware of its own limited area of the total human system, they believe they've been cured! But like a hanging mobile, if you play with the balance, the whole thing will simply adjust itself to accommodate the change. Dysfunction will merely be transferred into other areas of the system. And because the system was probably already carrying the load where it was easiest, this displacement will probably result in a slightly worse overall state. The beast will simply roll over in its slumber, into a less comfortable position, and get slightly agitated. Or like a starfish, if you chop off one leg, it will simply grow another.

Do you want some specifics here, to see what I mean? Ok. Let's say you are successful in every way, but that you find you just can't stop drinking. In systemic terms, this could be seen as a behaviour generated by the secondary agenda to keep a lid on this simmering crisis by periodically anaesthetising the functioning of your frontal brain. So what would happen if you simply stopped? Well, an unexplained emotional crisis would happen. But not if the secondary agenda could find another way of achieving the same goal.

Thus, you could create for yourself a symbolic immortality project, and thereby allow both death and 'self' to co-exist, taking the strain off your system. So, for instance, you could shift from being an alcoholic to believing in God. And, it must be stressed, you are believing in God not because such exists, but because you need it to exist. That God is - in this context - as much an addiction as alcohol, except perhaps that it has more serious side effects. At least alcoholics retain some rational integrity, and spend at least some of their time sober. They also generally acknowledge their state and are often trying to recover. But can you imagine the twelve step group - "hi, my name's Bob, and I'm a recovering God addict."

Actually, you wouldn't ever get that. For the simple reason that a critical 'step' in the AA 'twelve step' program for addiction recovery is, surprise - 'to establish a meaningful relationship with God'. And they call that healing. Anyway, back to the story...

Fortunately, however, most practical approaches to subjective change are so ineffectual as to never pose any real threat to the position of the secondary agenda. The very worst they can do is push dysfunction around and upset things a bit. They all miss the connection between surface level symptoms and primary cause, and the mechanisms which provide that connection.

It must, however, be stressed that there is some really good stuff available. Real processes of valuable change and legitimate growth exist. These approaches sometimes do a bit of harm in the big picture precisely because they are doing good in their narrow field. There is much good work done, and much progress made. With good management, life within the common state can certainly be massively improved. This beast can even be pacified and tamed, manipulated and predicted so as to have less negative impact on life.

The well informed will also recognise that a few approaches do address the primary cause as I define it, they do in fact directly address the subjective self reference, this 'I'. But once again, these approaches still do not recognise the relationship of that cause to the surface level symptoms we are discussing. They do not comprehend the mechanisms by which this simple subjective factor can produce so much conflict, nor that the whole thing is ultimately a very practical issue. Instead, they apply all manner of mystical and spiritual significance to their endeavours. We will revisit these again in Section Four.

So whilst there are presently approaches available in common culture to address and resolve almost every element of this whole conflict, every single one misses the essential connection. mostly due to the absence of any cultural understanding of our real subjective anatomy, which is essential in understanding that connection and how it all works.

People simply don't understand what they are really dealing with. They don't understand why, the closer to true health and happiness you get, the worse you feel. Or how it could be, that the better you feel, the more likely you are to be displaying significant pathology.

Before we wind up this section there are a couple of points which may be worth clarifying. The first is that you may have already begun to conceive this secondary agenda as entirely negative in nature. That it is malicious or deliberately harmful. But this is not the case, and does not help in understanding it.

The purpose of the secondary agenda is not to affect primary integrity. In the end, the harm done by the secondary agenda is merely unfortunate. It is not trying to do this, quite the contrary, it is only trying to help. It is, in fact, an entirely healthy response.

It is not pathological as a whole, even though every individual element of it could be defined as such. The truth is that, without it, we could not function at all. We would break under the load. It is merely a reflection of the system itself attempting to control serious problems it does not understand. And it generally does so in whichever way seems to create the least stress possible.

It is all that stands between us and the emotional deadlock which accompanies an eclipsed motivational core. The reality is that the secondary agenda is necessary just to function. Under the circumstances, we need it. Which must be remembered, it is a product of the system's own functioning. Which also explains its power, integrity and sophistication.

Which brings us to the second point, that this agenda is extremely powerful in potential. Powerful because it is the system's own functioning. Whilst the real power of the secondary agenda is not noticed much in life, this is not because it is somehow weak or ineffectual. No, the reason it is not noticed is because it is so very powerful. So powerful that it sleeps mostly. Not that it is heavy or slow or somehow lumbering. It is lightning fast, fluid and instantaneous. Deeply habitualized,

automatic and unconscious. It so powerfully establishes the limitations it requires that we all simply learn to unconsciously live within the bounds those limits prescribe. It is an amazing adversary for the frontal self. You really don't notice the limitations surrounding you until you challenge them, and this is something you simply learn not to do.

So, for the most part, the secondary agenda remains passive, having securely fulfilled its purpose. This is why you generally can't see it. It is because you generally don't ever challenge it. And we don't challenge it for very good reasons.

Unlike the conscious mind, this agenda has the full resources of the entire system at its disposal. An army of unconscious functions. And it can easily out-gun the frontal self. It is primarily fuelled by processes charged with containing the greatest emotive/energetic crisis possible in this system. Existential fear is the 'atom bomb' of inner warfare. Thus the secondary agenda cannot be out-willed. There is no emotive agenda more powerful or capable of achieving such. There is nothing the system can desire that is more positive than existential fear is negative. So this agenda is not generally noticed in life **not** because it is weak or ineffectual, but because it is so powerful that it **always** gets its way. It is so powerful that it generally sleeps passively. Like a massive resting beast, the most it will do is stir occasionally if events disturb it. Dynamic and slippery, fluid and rapid, it will occasionally turn in its sleep and adjust itself to gradual change. It likes stability and consistency.

So what if you do confront it? What if you wake it up and back it into a corner by seeking to address several or many elements of its active containment? Well, in that case it will eventually stand up and fight in that case. And my perception of this is that it is a very foolhardy thing to do, unless you know exactly what you are really up against. My prediction is that you would certainly lose such a fight. This agenda is bigger, faster, and more powerful than the frontal self. And because it is unconscious, it already knows what the frontal self is thinking before it even thinks it. And even if you succeeded in overcoming this agenda, the result would inevitably be the reanimation of the crisis beneath it, which is even worse.

My belief is that very few people have seen this thing in its full fury and walked away. Our suicide statistics can perhaps vouch for that. Silent, powerful, invisible, it is an incredible adversary. The perfect enemy, perhaps simply because it is your very own incredible system you are ultimately confronting.

But some people do confront it. People with courage and commitment to being truly happy are all eventually led to this point. This confrontation is unavoidable, because you simply cannot be happy whilst it exists. The more truly healthy you become in this situation, the more emotional stress you will experience.

Overall then, in the absence of full understanding, the consequences of such inwardly oriented efforts are often less than desirable. If only because, for the most part, to directly assault active elements of the secondary agenda is simply a recipe for suffering.

The bowl analogy still applies, and this is like being in a hole and trying to dig your way out. Any success at all will inevitably result in a mysterious and uncontrollable emotional crisis. So if you challenge it, you'll get to see it alright. And the harder you push, the harder it will push back. The secondary agenda will simply retreat into other areas of the system if it can, and adopt one of many alternative forms. But if you are fully committed to being unreservedly happy in life, and chase it without mercy - giving it nowhere to run - you will, I believe, live to regret it. If you survive at all. The unconscious can apply massive pressure to the frontal self. Which is why 'personal growth addicts' often end up creating more crises than they solve.

My advice on this point is this - Do not go Tiger hunting with a pop-gun. Because if you do, then you're just asking to suffer.

So what would happen then, if you could somehow define truly healthy functioning, the real and ideal concomitants of native happiness, both inwardly and outwardly, and sought to achieve those? In other words, if you could isolate only the native agenda, and if you acted solely on that towards the achievement of optimum systemic health and relational equilibrium? Effectively, to push the ball in the direction of wellbeing. This is what you would do to really piss this secondary agenda off, and make it work hard to retain control. So what would happen?

Well, the result would be a growing emotional crisis and a series of powerful behavioural counter responses. Responses all designed, in some way, to achieve the same end - the containment of an existential crisis. However because that objective is strictly unconscious, the frontal conscious self would simply experience this as a series of powerful emotive tensions and impulses - as very strong desires and aversions, and would experience dramatic stress as a result if those were not followed.

Healthy functioning, subjectively, happens in what could be described as 'spirals' of activity. Emotion directs attention toward objects of interest, either negative or positive. And attention, by directing awareness toward such, produces emotion.

So this is how things work -

The mind, via attention, is always searching for things of relevance to the organism to look at and assess. Further emotion is generated if something significant is discovered which needs to be addressed. Which has the effect of further fixating attention on it. Energy and attention working together. This sets in motion a kind of functional spiral of events which may enlist or consume many systemic operations before it is over. A kind of frenzy occurs, and the end result is change. That being the alteration of whatever attracted attention in the first place, at which point energy and attention subsides and moves on in search of other concerns.

All healthy functions within an organic system can be seen in this way. In fact, as we have seen, the system as a whole can be viewed as such a spiral. And one healthy spiral can lead to another, which can lead to another.... ad infinitum.

This is how integrity is maintained. In this light we can see that the potential the secondary agenda is functioning to contain is also just that - a functional spiral. A healthy spiral in fact, a self initiating and sustaining subjective event which has the capacity to continue growing in intensity and valence without any obvious limits. Like a little whirlwind that can begin anywhere in the system, but which can spontaneously gain power and momentum and start tracking across the inner landscape, attracting more and more resources until it becomes a thundering tornado, growing and growing and destroying everything in its path.

In this way we can see that the main function of the secondary agenda is to nip these small emerging spirals in the bud. Which is why it can seem quite stable and quiet at times. It is because it keeps spirals from ever getting away and out of control, and thus never has to confront the full crisis head on. And the secondary agenda does this primarily by directing attention away from the things which can begin to attract energy. Death, primarily, especially as it relates to 'I'. But any little event can begin a spiral which can then reconstruct these issues and attract serious energy. And this is what the secondary agenda must avoid. Otherwise, it must grow in strength and intensity itself, and move to head off a healthy spiral which is already up and away and moving fast. And this can be very messy.

In this way we can see that the secondary agenda is also essentially a spiral, or a series of spirals. In fact I guess you could say it is a series of strategic counter-spirals. Sometimes big, sometimes small, depending on the activity present within the system.

So this is what we encounter when we head off in a direction which supports the restoration of too much healthy functioning within us. Healthy functioning means free energy and attention. Energy and attention which, if all is OK, is experienced as bliss by the frontal self. Happiness. But this is energy and attention which can also begin to restore integrity and dig up any stinky old bones. So the secondary agenda is merely acting to control these little spirals, but the result is that we cannot even experience a little of the bliss we might otherwise enjoy. It is simply unfortunate, not deliberate.

The results of too much health, then, would inevitably be a series of intensifying emotional disturbances as spirals confront counter-spirals in a game of ever growing seriousness. And, eventually, if you continued to exhaust or frustrate all the secondary agendas mechanisms and impulses, the result would be the reanimation of an embedded and well anchored functional spiral with a licence to kill. At a certain point this reanimated crisis would gain sufficient momentum to become autonomous and rogue, and the secondary agenda in its typical forms would be powerless to stop it. A full blown existential crisis would emerge, chasing its own tail at ever increasing speed and intensity - like a machine which eats all hope - a pain generator. And the results of this? Well, the same as when it first occurred. A head-on crash, an impact. The valence of stress would eventually lead to an automatic deep level control of activity. Things would simply begin to get shut down and turned off, and the secondary agenda would return to adopt its most primal and powerful form. The oppressive dictatorship. Shutdown, depression. This is what happens whenever an irresistible force meets an immovable object: Suffering.

So in the face of too much inner health, both the growing crisis and the frantic containments reach such a high level of intensity that the overthrow of the conscious will becomes inevitable. Unstoppable. In fact you don't really have to worry about the crisis getting fully out of control, because this never actually happens. The system would not allow it to happen. It is too dangerous. So paradoxically, all you would achieve by truly positive action is to give more power to the secondary agenda. In the end, resistance is futile.

We can see now that the secondary agenda is not resistant to change at all at a surface level, that it is very dynamic in fact, but that it is extremely resistant to deep resolution by surface leverage. If only because the real source of potential crisis remains active all along as the very subject of the whole search for happiness.

So you can fight it, or you can relax. You can go within, or go without. You can be stupid, or you can be smart, but you will never resolve this crisis by force. Every path you can take, every answer you can hear, every approach offered, **NONE RESOLVE IT**. It is very very resistant. All potential answers eventually share the same errors, they are all merely extensions of the very thing they are seeking to overcome. None contain an understanding of this secondary agenda, thus **ALL** are guilty of the great fallacy I spoke of in the introduction to this work. There are many different approaches to life in the common state, but all display the same fallacy. Which is to say, none distinguish the secondary agenda as a whole, nor seek to address it as such. Even the best paths remain firmly stuck because of this.

Our entire modern culture is inept in this essential sense, they all miss the source, and thus all fail to resolve the core dilemma. Our culture is, therefore, merely a collection of coping strategies, some better than others, each producing many different states of internal activity and potential, but none reliably finding their way free of this impossible trap. Even the best does not significantly disturb the foundational elements of this presence.

None make it, most don't even get close. We blame everything, anything, for our persistent unhappiness - but never blame the real cause, nor seek to address that. Primarily, I believe, because no one has ever defined the real problem in practical terms. But I believe an understanding of the nature of the problem may change everything.

Perhaps now you can see why I feel driven to this work. A view which proposes the potential resolution of this complex represents such a dramatic divergence from common culture that it cannot be overstated. It represents a radical departure from current views and options, and defines a strikingly divergent path to any currently adopted. A path which cannot be compared to any other, one which signifies not just another alternative amongst many, but an alternative to all others. Our entire culture embodies only one path, and this view indicates a radical second potential.

So this whole concept undercuts the foundations of common views at such a profound level that it is hard to fully grasp. Little remains unchallenged. It is, in practical terms, a completely different view of happiness and where it may be found, based on another whole understanding of the true underlying nature and origins of common unhappiness. The implications are **HUGE**.

Follow feelings, then?

Perhaps now we could come back to the question we have been asking from the very start – Should we follow what we feel? Should we allow deep emotional processes within us to flow toward their destination? Should we be influenced by our deeper desires, or should we suppress them?

If we look at the function of conscious awareness, we can see that the ultimate responsibility of the frontal self is the formulation of practical philosophies of life, of realistic strategies for living and being happy. It is an ambassador for the organism as a whole, the captain of the ship. So the frontal self, in fulfilling its function, must formulate practical strategies and plans of action. It defines the stance we will take, the path we will walk, and the philosophical view we adopt. All of which govern the process of our life.

In the end, every theory or philosophy of life comes down to what we do. We may not think of ourselves as philosophers, but practical philosophies are compulsory, we all have one whether we like it or not. Everyone must adopt a view for themselves concerning certain core things in life. And one of those things is desire. We must all decide what desire means for life and how we live. And our stance in this regard obviously impacts heavily on our experience of the human state, and on our degree of happiness.

So what about desire? What do desires relate to? Is happiness the fulfilment of desire, as so many believe, or is it not? Is growth defined by following, by connection and submission to desire?

We have seen that in the native state this should be so. That yes, we are actually intended to follow what we feel, and that such impulses should take us to where we need to be. Which is why it feels good. But what about in this, the common conflicted state?

So should we follow what we feel, and submit to emotive process without reservation? Well, in this situation, it would seem not. At least not completely. Sometimes following what you feel is good, and sometimes bad, and it is not possible to clearly distinguish the two.

To seek to fulfil the requirements of the healthy native agenda, in the face of this secondary agenda, is simply an impossible task. For although such is healthy, and to some degree you cannot be happy if you don't, it could get you into some big trouble. The more native fulfilment you achieve, the greater the demands of the secondary agenda become, and vice versa.

And if you allow all your own deeper emotional functioning to enter its own natural healing process, you will inevitably re-animate the smouldering crisis beneath, and inadvertently plunge yourself into a very real existential crisis. Resulting in emotive stresses you can only begin to imagine.

Anyway, your system will not allow you to do this easily, that's what the secondary agenda does, it prevents exactly that. This is why you already avoid this, because it feels bad. Remember the diagram above - It is basically pointless to try and escape this situation using only emotion as your guide, for your destination will never be the bottom of the ramp, but always the centre of the bowl.

There are simply no real limits to the potential demands of this secondary agenda in response to positive change. It is a bulldog guarding something it knows you will want. The system realises that repression costs a degree of happiness, and that you will naturally seek to resolve it over time because of that. But it can never allow this to happen in this situation, because the negative consequences functionally are far worse than any positive emotional gains. In the end, chronic unhappiness is always better than a full blown existential crisis, for at least the organism can survive chronic unhappiness.

So it is a tricky one. We should follow what we feel. That is natural and healthy. But doing so will probably not help, and may only make things worse.

We can see now the real reason why we do not abandon ourselves unreservedly to the fulfilment of systemic desire as discussed in section one. Because the ultimate result of such is merely an amplification of this underlying dilemma. To seek to move the ball to the positive end of the natural ramp inevitably produces emotional crisis, overthrow of will, and cyclic oscillation. The obsessive-compulsive cycle. Struggle.

You could say - 'If this secondary presence adds a massive body of surplus desire to the system, why not just actively negate the dysfunctional desires?' Repress them, and express the healthy ones.

Yes, but how do you differentiate them? And how, without suffering in the process? Healthy desire will simply produce healthy change, and that will inevitably just produce even stronger dysfunctional desire to compensate, until will is overthrown by the pressure. So this is not a way to achieve less unhealthy desire, but more!

The answer, then? Well, there is no answer. We have the choice to either repress elements of desire, and thereby suffer as a result, or embrace desire fully and thereby suffer as a result. And, worst of all, we don't even realise this is the case. An unfair game, this is the common human state. A hopeless situation really. Neurosis, the affliction of the masses, has often been defined as the pathological maintenance of hope.

The Global Collective

If we turn our attention to global culture we can see this conflict there as well. What we do not generally understand is that the polluted river we call human civilization is a natural reflection of the 7 billion odd polluted tributaries which flow into it. And that it is pointless to seek to address this pollution at the point where it flows into the sea of our collective destiny. We must each eventually look in the mirror for answers.

Global culture reflects this crisis exactly, in every detail. Because whilst the subjective effects of this individual struggle are dramatic, the relational effects are also extremely significant. Especially over the long term. And this is where we see it pour into the collective.

As individuals, the net effect of this presence within us is that it adds a vast body of relational need to our agenda, massively surplus to actual requirements for authentic happiness. It doubles the amount of items on our emotional shopping list every day. Literally, it makes us consume things. Food, objects, experiences, entertainments, ... you name it. We just can't get enough. Which, when you multiply this by a few billion, begins to explain some things about our global situation. The happier we are, the more the planet suffers.

This struggle is consuming the planet as we search for outer fulfilment to saturate this endless and impossible emotional need. We are all doing our best, but we - individually - are also the final cause of a growing global crisis. We never recognise this, however, and love to point the finger at others.

The question has to be asked, then, how much of what we see as culture and civilisation is founded in this bed of dysfunction? How much is simply there to help people cope? How much culture is actually just pathological crap? Well intentioned, but misled? Well, quite a lot it would seem.

Culture has a way of recording social inventions and institutionalising them in many forms. As we saw, with sophistication and refinement, the containment of this crisis within us can certainly be managed in many different ways, provided you are prepared to pay the cost. Thus, as will always happen in response to need, sophisticated and refined coping strategies have emerged over time. Complicated templates and social patterns have arisen to be fed by this crisis within us, and to offer people some respite from their struggle. These, once again, are the collective expression of the secondary agenda. They exist to keep us pacified in our panicked state. Over millennia these strategies have had time to be refined and communicated. They are cultural coping strategies, functioning in very dynamic ways to facilitate containment in the individuals which choose to adopt them.

There is massive pressure for us to believe in things which offer hope, and if we look at our culture we can see that there is an enormous body of belief this has produced. What we see are whole belief systems with very substantial and subtle psychological levers, designed to provide a sense of existential security, but which clearly have no bearing on reality as we now understand it. Belief systems which have allowed social cohesion in tough times, but which have no legitimate 'truth'

value whatsoever. Religions, our cultural mainstays, are all guilty of this to some degree. Some more than others. And we can see how this has affected social values, our views of what is important in life. And we all suffer from this being the case. We can see why there are currently belief systems that people would kill or even die for. This is why. Because they are as much addicted to these ideas as a junkie is to heroin. They cannot cope in life without them.

Most mythic-literal religious forms probably began as real and valid experiences of human potential, as real processes of transformation and change. But have since become massive edifices of dead wood serving dysfunctional individual and social needs by merely offering consoling belief systems and social cohesion. They are merely part of our deep cultural denial of death. Often, they actually do more to prevent individual happiness than promote it. Unless you are looking for a comfortable prison, that is.

So you are looking at everything I have said here, and you are thinking - "things aren't really that bad?", "I am pretty happy!"

And I would say, open your eyes. You simply do not recognise what is right in front of you - in yourself, and in the world around you. You have gotten used to it, because it has always been there. Thus, you cannot even imagine what things might be like if it was gone.

Unhappiness, depression, addiction, behavioural disorders, organic dysfunction[disease], co-dependence, crime, economic patterns, pollution, starvation, oppression, suicide, religion, WAR....

How much ecological damage was done in pursuit of completely unnecessary gain last year? How much social dysfunction, crime and war occurred on the basis of overflowing anger and emotionally loaded belief systems? How much obsessive power addiction keeps the wealth of the Earth in so few hands? How much Prozac was sold and consumed in the world? How much compulsive addiction remained untreated? How many people were treated for behavioural disorders? How much illness and disease was caused by purely avoidable self destructive behaviour? I could go on, and on, and on....

But in the end, you are the proof of this. Why do you struggle through a book like this, with all its mind bending complexity and heavy content, and manage to keep your interest? Why, in the most affluent and resourceful situation in recorded human history, are you that unhappy? I'll tell you why. Because, no matter how you try, you simply can't shake the feeling that there is something more.

The truth of what I am saying here is simply self evident to anyone honest enough to look hard in the mirror. But it is not only the courage to embrace just how dark the current situation is that matters, but also the vision to look beyond all of that.

It has been stated that we are the most destructive and troubled animal on the planet. That we are a plague, a blight, a cancer. But could it be, as Jean Houston has said, that rather than being a cancer, that we are the neurons of an emerging global awareness? That Gaia is coming of age? And that this conflicted state does not reflect who we really are, but that it is merely a symptom of our own subjective dilemma, a glitch in this awakening process?

What if this dilemma was not a native part of who we are, a conflict which is not necessary. In which case we may be standing on the threshold of an enormous potential, both individually and collectively, if we can only figure out how to pull that pin in ourselves.

So that's it in a nutshell. The dilemma I have outlined here is what has been presumed to be an inherent element of human life. But if what I have defined here is correct, then this is not so. It is a conflict of epic proportions. A profound and dynamic conflict with sweeping consequences. Which would perhaps be easier to take if we realised it was happening, but we don't. We are tied up by our own ignorance and fear. We don't even see it, and thus it continues to exist and flourish as we suffer. And although we all feel it, because we don't see it for what it is, we never even stop to consider that there might actually be a practical way out of it, or what that potential might mean in our lives.

SECTION FOUR

Nothing at All

As we now come to what we might do about all this, I need to make clear that we will not be offering practical solutions here. Not to say that none are available, just that the nature of what we are defining here is somewhat dangerous territory, and that before I go ahead and give my own summary of what can be done, others had better first have a chance to assess and confirm it as reasonable. The last thing we want is people heading off unprepared into a wilderness not yet well charted or heavily populated. And most certainly the last thing we want is for anyone to attempt such on their own. If there is one thing emerging now it is the first opportunity ever to employ the significant power of unity, and the security that a more collective and supported approach may provide.

Of course, this is what everyone ultimately wants to know - we all ultimately want to know what we can do about it. But because development in that sphere will be so rapid and experimental, the most I feel comfortable with beyond these basic maps is to offer whatever commentary I can regarding these practical applications as they emerge. This is all still very much a matter of 'don't try this at home'.

That's the whole point here: the development of secure social contexts. It is basically a construction hangar for exotic flying machines. It must remain completely open-ended and evolutionary in nature, meaning that it will continue to change constantly, forever moving in the direction of further complexity and refinement. Which obviously cannot happen on a printed page.

For the moment, however, there remain many things we might already be able to say with a fair degree of certainty, and many implications we might explore. So what follows is essentially just a somewhat random series of notes and musings on where all this is leading, at least as far as I have explored it this far. In time no doubt much more will become clear as all of this emerges from the mist.

First of all, we could begin here with some kind of summary, just to capture the overall anatomy of what has emerged in the previous pages. So here you go...I'll do my best. This is going to be the whole thing in a few brief pages –

The Ocean in a Teacup

The basic picture is this: as a result of our recent advancements in intelligence (imagination in particular) we inadvertently caused what could most accurately be termed a 'software conflict' in the way the human brain functions in relation to its very purpose for existing. The result of which was a modification of the subjective perception of need at a level beneath that which produces emotional tensions, far below the level available to consciousness directly. The subjective result of an increase in need is precisely equivalent to a decrease in fulfilment, so the result of this is massive emotional tension is an effort to correct the imbalance.

Emotion is a homeostatic process responsible for maintaining stable need fulfilment over time. All of which amounts to the management and dynamic allocation of emotional attachment, so as to direct energy through the production of strategic tensions. Change management, ideally toward the organism's highest possible benefit. Basically, what we need went up, and we freaked out because the way it appeared to us is that our fulfilments suddenly went way down. So far down, in fact, that we couldn't even embrace the emotional tension involved.

The basic outlines of emotional responses to change are – in order of seriousness –

1. an effort to protect or recover a particular need fulfilment that is in danger of being lost (typified in the most extreme for as anger).

2. the more serious but equally functional and necessary process of relinquishing a lost source of need fulfilment, and the acquisition of another; and if another is not available then the integration of the need into the core emotional system in the form of a loaded emotional tension which will over time act to drive behaviour and attention toward its renewed fulfilment at the earliest possible juncture (the role of grief in general, and the production of desire as part of that system).

3. The stalling of these two functional systems in a situation where need is potentially thwarted in such a way that it threatens to damage the organism, and where neither of the first two options are available, resulting in the globalised escalation of tensions to the exclusion of all other functions, until one or other of the other two paths is taken and the fulfilment of need is restored. This is fear.

Emotion, just like many other organic processes, occurs as an event spiral in response to a stimulus. Need directs attention, which produces emotion, which further directs attention, which produces more emotion...until action is taken and change occurs to alleviate the source of tension or restore need fulfilment. At which point it all subsides.

As an aside, it is worth noting the positive end of this spectrum of motivation – it implies a basic functional hierarchy, with body at the base, emotion in the middle, and mind at the top. With the body calling the shots. Which also happens to be the order in which these structures emerged, and it makes perfect sense. But it also implies an ideal situation in which physical need is fulfilled, emotional tension is relaxed, and mental activity is thereby quiet. Not an emotion, this potential is a state. This, I will posit, is the necessary and logical consequence of any such motivational structure. And in our case, we call this state – happiness. And it is not a curious or enigmatic phenomenon, nor is it normally fleeting or shallow. Happiness, complete and utter happiness, is the normal everyday state of being for our species. It has a day job.

So where the hell is it?

This is what we have been trying to explain. So back to the story..

Fear is the greatest of all emotional tensions, and existential fear is the greatest of all fears.

The important thing in explaining the range of emotional functioning here is to indicate the kind of mishap that occurred within us to produce the event I have been seeking to describe. It is all the result of an unfortunate but inevitable meeting of two equally supported modern ideas about life, which result in the production of unbridled existential fear in a way that spirals upward and has no obvious resolution or exit, thereby effectively overloading emotional functioning by removing all functional polarities.

Death is the issue, in particular relation to the way we as humans erroneously conceive the idea of 'self'. And in order to understand this, and the basic anatomy of this event, you first have to understand that you are at present looking from this frightful delusion rather than at it, and that it is inevitably going to be a bit uncomfortable at first. The assertion is that your 'self', the thing or entity or being you presume yourself to be, is in fact an illusion of mind. Which can be a bit much to digest at first, but hopefully you can entertain the idea at least as a possibility to consider. It has staggering consequences, and explains so very much.

To see this error in context, we can also detour for a moment to once again summarise an essential element of behaviour that is truly unique to human beings, and also the unintentional source of the problem I am indicating here.

All animals are motivated by emotional tension, but only those produced by the mechanisms of instinct or conditioned response. And as they do such they are effectively choosing from an infinite number of possible futures in every moment. But they do not envisage these futures as we do. They can't. Their behavioural tendencies are genetically transmitted from one generation to another, or learned as responses to particular stimuli.

We are the only animals who have developed or discovered another much more sophisticated and adaptive process by which to generate emotive tension and thereby determine action and change. We use imagination to imagine futures, based on the past. The brain is, most accurately, a probability generator. In particular we supplement our direct perceptual experience with an enormous and perpetual context of imagined reality beyond. We also use this supplementary overlay to provide meaning to direct perceptual experience. And it is on the basis of what we imagine we are experiencing that we feel what we feel.

It should be noted that this imaginary aspect of our experience of life is so vast and unnoticed that we do not even know we are doing it. We are not supposed to know, that is kind of the point. To doubt it would be to lessen its effectiveness. But when you look at this it is very simple to see that the imaginary elements of our present experience of life include all of the past, all of the future and most of the present, including the meaning of what we are directly perceiving. Any aspect of 'imagined reality' that is actually just a thought, but which we respond to emotionally as if it was actually real, we call a 'belief'.

And this simple and quite obvious outline immediately solves a great debate about the nature of reality, which we won't go into here in depth, except to say that for humans there are actually two realities. There is 'actual reality', to which we must relate, and then there is our own manufactured 'simulation of reality', which is supposed to help us do that by being as accurate a representation as possible. And it is, by and large, a huge success. It is the reason we are such a dominant species - a massive breakthrough.

So one of these realities freely exists as an external cosmic event. The other is just a dream effectively. But the point is that we experience emotion based on both. Actually, we experience emotion based on the dream mostly, which is influenced and updated constantly by actual reality (unless you are psychotic, and this connection has broken down. In mass form we call this – 'religion').

This tremendous advantage leaves us uniquely placed in relation to other animals in our bounded environment of the earth, but also uniquely vulnerable in a way no other animal can be. Because it opens up the very real possibility, indeed the certainty, of very real emotional process occurring solely on the basis of unrecognised error.

Obviously the detailed mechanics of all this make all the difference, but we do not have the space here for such. Needless to say, in our case an error small in nature but epic in effect resulted in an emotional process of unbridled force and magnitude, and in a way that could not easily be stopped. All animals have the ingredients for existential fear, but we are the first ones who have been able to fully bake the cake. And once that is done, nothing can stop it, because we do not recognise the crucial error at its very root.

In order to begin to elucidate the nature of 'self' – the delusion at the root of this crisis – you need to go right back to the founding principles of life itself, and the boundary between organic and inorganic structure, the boundary between order and chaos. You need to understand that all living things are predestined to recognise this boundary and preserve it, like a battlefield in a war, as a crucial part of being alive. But what this does not express is the actual underlying unity of all things.

This is an understandable but ultimately shallow and erroneous conception, a parochial and biased stance supported by evolution, but never factually valid. Who you truly are, in fact, is likely much bigger than you imagine, or can imagine. So vast that in this form you can probably never know that, but can only ever merely be that. And imagining you are something smaller does not ever change what you truly are, it only changes your own limited experience of existence. It only means you are trying to fit the ocean into a teacup, and that the teacup will become very stressed as a result. So when you say 'I', or 'me', you are actually referring to what?

Have you ever seen that 'entity'? Can you look at it now, and find anything?

It is a trick, you are merely referring to an idea, a functional point of reference which represents the overall organism, which is itself always in a process of change and exchange with the environment, and therefore never actually a distinct 'thing' at all. Any more than a river is a thing. It is made of new water in every moment. It is an open ended process.

It is a very hard idea to embrace. And it seems very metaphysical at first, a fluffy and almost spiritual thing to consider. But its real and dramatic practical effects are astounding in their proportions, and magnified a thousand times by the time they are felt as pain and suffering in daily life.

It is also so simple if you think about it, and it explains so very much. The idea of 'self' is not ever something we are being, but always something we are merely doing. 'I' is a belief. Nothing more^{3}. It is an activity of mind, in particular it is an activity of the human mind, because other animals likely cannot achieve it in the same way we can. It is, however, eternally fascinating as an idea to the human mind. It is a perfect monkey trap (a monkey trap is a gourd with a fruit inside it, with a hole big enough for the monkey to get its hand inside, but not big enough to pull out whilst it is holding the fruit. Monkeys do not have an instinct to let go of the fruit, even when confronted with danger, and so remain trapped by their petty attachment even to the point of their eventual demise).*

It is hard to imagine life without a strong sense of self, it is hard to imagine not being in possession of 'I'. But what I am saying here, is that this is already the case. No matter what you do, or no matter how much you believe it and feel it to be real emotionally, that never actually makes it so, not even for a moment. Which is important to understand because what you do tend to feel, when you do formulate your identity in this way, is a great deal of existential fear. The body actually believes it, it feels it as if it is real, and instead of openly embracing the wider event of which it is a part, becomes like a river trying to hold onto all of its water. It becomes incredibly afraid, so afraid that life itself becomes entirely defined by an effort to avoid fear.

Existential fear is a noise so loud that nothing else can be heard, and so in terms of functioning everything stops. And it doesn't stop there, it tries to keep going...infinitely. It is interesting, if you think of all the things you could do to stop feeling scared, you tend to discover that you are already doing them.

The other thing to understand about this situation is that the needs in question are not actually real, they are imaginary, but that they are felt to be real – just as real as if you were watching someone cut your anaesthetized leg off with a chainsaw. This fear has all the accompanying chemical and electrical activity, because it is in fact real fear.

The result of this is deadlock, and – eventually – necessary repression. It means there is a very negative emotional experience possible, and that you have generated this purely with your own mind. Repression is a healthy adaptation of a complex system, it allows an organism to effectively 'store' negative events or at least delay the restorative responses to impacts and release them later when it is safer. Shock is an example. It is like holding your breath when you swim under water. Nothing more mysterious. And there are a great many forms of such delay possible in our case due to being so incredibly complex. But the one thing to remember about all repression is that it is temporary, and costly. Like a coiled spring. We have adapted to the emotional expression of need being suspended at times, but evolution has also ensured that this suspension always be released, and we have tension systems in place to ensure this.

^{3*} See the empirical works of Prof. Thomas Metzinger for example.

Consciousness is intrinsically inclusive and integrating, I would posit that this is in fact its primary purpose or function. And therefore that it is a necessary ingredient in the operation of many important functions. Awareness is a unifying nexus. But there are a great many functions within the operations of the nervous system of an organism which do not require executive attention, which therefore do not ever need to become conscious. This is the reality for most activity – and the nature of the unconscious mind. It is distracting and inefficient to cloud the executive with mundane operational details, and so consciousness is also intrinsically a product of exclusion, meaning exclusion of as much ‘autopilot functioning’ as possible is normal and healthy. But not everything is able to be dealt with automatically or out of habit, and the aspects of functioning requiring executive attention are designed by evolution to be passed up through the conscious threshold as a disturbance of attention.

This is conscious thinking, and we generally imagine we are the ones ‘doing it’ spontaneously, but it is in fact something ‘being done’ for us by myriad underlying processes. So, and which is the point, certain important classes of information are destined for conscious attention intrinsically, and repression of such is difficult and costly to maintain over time, like holding a beach ball underwater. And the systems in place to police such integrity mean that every bit of repression ransoms a bit of potential happiness. This is what ensures every bit of repression is only very temporary, and that authentic human need is thereby always fulfilled and never abandoned or overlooked by the systems responsible for maintaining such.

And here – once again - we repeat a summary truth, often overlooked in the way we tend to approach life, and which we will find repeated many times here, in many ways –

To not feel how unhappy you are, is not the same thing as being happy.

These are two completely different states, actually they are at the opposite end of the feeling spectrum.

The result, however, of the situation being described, is repression. The survival of the organism comes to depend on its capacity to repress the very real emotional products of a completely imaginary event, and somehow keep functioning as normally as possible. So the only cost to actual need fulfilment in this situation is due to the natural systems for such being distracted by this activity, or damage to the organism as a result of such activity. But the damage caused within the emotional and mental systems of the organism is extreme.

In the wake of the emergence of this event, what arises is effectively a fully fledged secondary functional agenda which exists in direct and dynamic response to the native agenda and its efforts to maintain optimum health and wellbeing. The depth and power of this secondary operation far outweighs that of the native agenda due to the level of threat posed by what it is acting to control or contain. In normal life the worst thing that can happen is real existential fear, and this is also the result of this ‘imaginary’ event not being avoided. Meaning they have equal emotional power, that there are now two pilots in the cockpit. But the nature of these two agendas is quite different.

The outcomes or practical objectives of each are very different, even though at the emotional level they are the same and cannot be distinguished. The other main difference is that the secondary agenda, including all of its activities and the very fact that it even exists, is expressly and intrinsically unconscious by definition. The conscious pilot can’t see the other one, and doesn’t even know it is there. This concealment is actually its main function, and it has the full resources of the unconscious mind at its disposal, with support at the deepest level. And this is why conspiracy theories abound and flourish, because this one is real, and right under our nose.

Apart from the effects of this being the case, the most important thing to realise about it is its profoundly concealed and disorienting nature. This event is entirely hidden from consciousness, is extremely polymorphous and equilibrating, and is pandemic. It is universally present in modern humanity. And this has had the effect of obscuring and disturbing the native functioning of the human system so profoundly that discerning it amongst the noise has become almost impossible without a very clear primer. Consciousness, in this case, is always looking from this event rather than at it, and thereby remains forever trapped by and subject to it. It is extremely concealed, hidden in plain sight. It is the one thing that will never be discovered by common human consciousness, because the implication is that common human consciousness is being actively steered away from such at every moment and in very powerful terms. Actually, effectively at the threat of death. It is an amazing situation.

These two agendas, the native and the added, together provide a very detailed and dynamic model of human behaviour with clear predictive ability. But you will not find this by looking in the hardware, you cannot see all this under an FMRI scanner, because it all occurs in software terms, as complex and dynamic interplay between structures which are being merely projected by the hardware. Looking for this in the hardware is like fumbling around all over the screen or in the projector at the movies looking for Clint Eastwood. He’s not there.

At the conscious level, then, because we suffer if we don’t follow what we feel, what we see is an irresolvable dilemma. Positive emotional states are the result of organic wellbeing and integrity being upheld by conscious action. But in this case we have another entirely separate agenda working with different objectives, but with equal determination of emotional states.

So are the deeper objectives of these two agendas at odds? What is the relationship? This is important to know because it exactly defines the emotional output of this system as a result. Meaning that if this is essentially conflicted, that emotion will be essentially conflicted to the exact same degree – producing an intractable dilemma for consciousness to try and perpetually solve.

The relationship is this: The secondary agenda is charged with containing and avoiding just one functional potential, but a big one, and an obvious one, and one which becomes more and more obvious over time. And because this potential is entirely constructed from normal and healthy cognitive and emotional functioning it does this by subverting, as subtly as possible, normal and healthy functioning.

This is much easier of course if a person does not have much functional integrity to begin with, in which case ignorance is occasionally bliss. But the more sensitive and intelligent you are, the more this agenda has to work to keep that functioning down. And if you will not be held down, if your functional integrity is simply too strong, you will effectively go mad. This is why it is said – genius borders on madness. This is Chopin.

The net result of this agenda's operation is the diminishment of 'feeling', due to feeling being the primary integrating factor in the way our system works. We are motivated toward both depth and quality of feeling, and thereby through the enforced evolutionary correlation between feeling and structural integrity the system ensures its own optimal functional wellbeing over time.

Feeling, then, is like the police force, as well as the pay clerk. It is the justice system, as well as the incentive scheme. It is the single thread from which this whole hanging mobile of emotion and need fulfilment is supposed to be suspended in order to swing freely and in balance. And so inevitably this is where the secondary agenda must ultimately act. In order to wander around raping the integrity of healthy functioning, it must to that same degree tie up the police that would otherwise prevent such.

The result is a limitation on feeling, which is a direct and extremely dynamic and unavoidable limitation on our capacity to be happy. This is not the intended outcome, it is simply an unavoidable result of the way we are made, in the wake of a need to subvert our own integrity in order to prevent an even worse outcome. It would seem, given the option between happiness and survival, the human organism will choose the latter almost every time. I say almost, because as a result of the very event I am defining, suicide is actually quite common.

So these two events are not directly opposed, but dynamically equilibrating around a certain fixed point, different for everyone depending on how much integrity needs to be subverted. And whatever this fixed point happens to be for you, nothing will move it - nothing healthy or functional anyway, or at least not very far relative to your true and easy potential for happiness that would otherwise freely exist.

The everyday dilemma this creates at a surface (conscious) level is intractable and immensely complex. These two agendas are impossible to differentiate in emotional terms, and so in mental terms also. And the secondary agenda has no particular form, it is merely and always a dynamic response to the native agenda and its operations and choices. But one thing is for sure – it is very hard work.

To see the possibilities for subversion you need only understand natural functioning and how disturbing that might look at a behavioural level. And when you do see this, you also see just how much of what we do this accounts for. The actual forms of behaviour potential in this situation are hugely varied, but can be seen to have certain basic or main patterns which are quite different from each other functionally, and which can sometimes appear in isolation. These different major forms of containment account for far more of the difference between people than any intrinsic human qualities, and between which we see much conflict as we fail to recognize the common underlying event. Wars are fought across such divides, precisely because someone with a different coping mechanism poses a direct threat to our own, especially if we do not recognize our own as such. By challenging our own form of collectively denied coping they effectively threaten us with existential crisis, which is effectively tantamount to holding a gun to our head.

These different forms of coping can be displaced and moved around, however, in a kind of tidal motion. We see this in conversion, when an alcoholic becomes born again for instance. Or when someone in emotional crisis becomes stable but obese, or vice versa (obesity is not an eating disorder, it is an emotional disorder – you are basically as fat as you need to be in order to feel safe). But the core of this event is never touched, and remains beyond the reach of surface action. It has a profound degree of stable equilibrium.

Its job is to hide something, and to keep that thing hidden, and it does that by distraction and subtle or gross hobbling of healthy functioning that might otherwise put this back together. It has to keep the dogs of conscious attention from ever again getting a whiff of this stinky old bone, because if they do it will be a frenzy of activity, and eventual crisis. The weight of the resulting crisis in structural terms is beyond our capacity to sustain, and the result of such is either renewed forceful containment (repression), or psycho-emotional collapse (insanity).

We obviously and understandably prefer repression. And our entire culture has come to reflect this process, and the dilemma underlying it. And anyone who so much as points in the direction of breaking our collective trance is immediately banished. But what this avoidance overlooks is the potential implied in turning this incredible event squarely into the fierce mirror of collective awareness. This has a solution. We just haven't been able to discover that because we have not been prepared to dig up this old bone and examine it closely enough. It simply remains there, as a blind collective dread.

This quite simple concept, and its very complex extensions, splits almost all longstanding arguments about what is and is not healthy human behaviour not down the middle, but sideways.

Almost no aspect of human functioning is intrinsically negative under this view, it is the imbalances created here that can make them so. This second agenda has access to every level of behaviour, internal and external, and can co-opt any function as part of its operations. And it does this in the least damaging way possible for the most part, if it is allowed to achieve its subversive aims in peace. It will apply the most sophisticated and subtle means possible if it can. Which means that it is almost impossible to define any action or behaviour as intrinsically dysfunctional, because it is often merely a matter of timing that makes it so, or context, or degree. The subversive agenda will apply minimum leverage to maximum effect. In the end it is the outcome of the subversions that is dysfunctional, which is very difficult to isolate or define.

The result of this at a conscious level is a profound yet very pervasive lack of integrity in the functional polarity of our emotional foundation. Our emotional compass, which is what we use to navigate toward happiness, is set spinning and we are effectively lost at sea. The top of our pyramid of self, our defining passion or truth or vision, and the emotional supports for such, are effectively lost. We lose the ability to know what we really want. And in this sense, we lose ourselves. For, in a very real functional sense, if you do not know what you want, you do not know who you are, and so your ability to relate in a powerful way to others in the joint creation of such is severely diminished. The wolf-like leaders we were born to be become sheep-like followers. We become incapable of recognizing our true potential even when it is standing right in front of us. In one sense our own true passion or calling can become one of the most threatening things we might ever encounter. And with the loss of meaning comes the associated loss of creative power – two sides of the same vital human coin.

What we see is that as people desperately seek to maintain their emotional state at a bearable level, that they end up effectively attacking their body in the process - and the earth, and each other. The result is a distinct negative equilibrium, extremely fluid but also very stable. And in an effort to resolve the dilemma of being unhappy, presuming of course that the conditions for such are not already present in spades, we CONSUME. We do everything we can to get more, have more or become more in a frantic effort to find meaning and fulfilment. All of which is completely futile and redundant.

No matter how many games we ever win, the secondary agenda will never allow us to score a lasting emotional point. This is modern humanity. We become insatiably hungry, driven to distraction in an effort to understand and fulfil a yearning we cannot even define – an itch so vast that we can't actually locate it in order to scratch.

However, and even if we are not directly aware of it as such, this latent and underlying agenda does still make us extremely susceptible to manipulation and control by anything that happens to support it. It is because of this that this secondary event defines the form of much emerging culture, much more than the native human drives. So anything that functions to offer any kind of subversive leverage, even if it is clearly a very bad idea, will tend to become part of a kind of emotional black economy. They gain mass appeal almost immediately. For instance, the entire global drug trade.

People who make money by 'feeding the beast' in this sense are the very definition of what it means to be a social parasite, but in the world as we see it today - with this beast still running around untamed - not having a conscience is still a very good way to stay ahead of the crowd. So the only way to put such antics to an end once and for all will be to give them nothing to feed - to take that beast around the back of the shed and quietly shoot it in the head. It is the only truly compassionate option we have available.

What we see here is obviously very rough in its outlines, but in its full and detailed form we have a highly predictive model of human functioning which cannot be discovered empirically through the examination of the physical structure. It is the great secret of human life. The implications of this central emergent event are vast and sweeping, and predicts many important things that we would never otherwise assume naturally. The human brain, which is a very expensive piece of equipment organically, has actually ended up actively working against the organism in a very dynamic and stable way. It is quite a revelation. And it does this by subverting systems and functions, which happen to include the very same ones which produce the potential we call – happiness.

The box it came in –

Beyond that, however, the model which defines such – the basic framework of foundational understanding – is also significant in and of itself, in that it also explains many other unrelated aspects of life quite by accident. Including why this framework itself has not previously been made available in any collective sense. The core of what people need to know about life itself and about being human – the essential crux or hub or unifying kernel of our most relevant and practical operating worldview – has been deliberately withheld. We did, in fact, withhold it from ourselves.

Which brings us to this – By far the most dramatic prediction this elusive model makes is that under just the right conditions the entire second agenda might fall away. And this, given the scale and depth of the problem it represents, is by far the most important thing to know about being human. By some order of magnitude.

So, if this is possible, why don't we see that? Actually we do. But even if we didn't, that would be no proof of the nonexistence of the potential. Before Rutherford nobody had split the atom, but it was obviously always possible, and is now so common as to be considered mundane.

The potential indicated here may even occur accidentally at times, and yet not often be recognised as such, or interpreted appropriately. It has certainly never been transmitted between people effectively, likely as a result of such misunderstanding. But even in its few obvious appearances throughout human history it has left huge impact craters. Buddha for instance, we can assume.

If this is basically true (and due to the structure of this it is either basically true or basically not) then it means we have up until this point in time completely overlooked the one solution that stands to make the urgent resolution of all other downstream problems unnecessary, and the one singular problem that is significant and dynamic enough to make all other solutions effectively futile. Because many of the things we are trying to enforce as behaviours at a collective level are actually automatic in the wake of this realisation. Because the individual negative equilibrium of this event, if not relinquished, it will always only compensate for any advancement or shift in the overall collective centre of gravity. Basically, seeking to address individual problems at the level of the collective is futile, in just the same way as addressing the individual problem in downstream terms is futile. All of those eventual symptoms are the equivalent of the oak, when what you really need to get right back to is the little acorn. You need to be able to follow the whole thing abc to the source, and this is what the emerging anatomy here finally allows you to do. It allows you to fathom the connection between all the eventual symptoms and the singular ultimate cause.

So what does removing it imply?

Think about it: This secondary subversive event and its originating sparks are all completely unnecessary and redundant. It is all made not from what we are, but from something we are doing. It is all activity and imagination at its root. Effort based doing. And the results of simply stopping doing it, if you collapse the entire equation in all its complexity and grandeur, are nil. It ultimately amounts to nothing at all.

Like a tree, however, if you simply prune it at a surface level it will only interpret that as an opportunity to grow. It is not that simple. It requires a deeper approach, and the application of specific relevant understanding. It represents significant challenges actually. But it also represents an opportunity beyond anything we have ever faced before, or ever will again.

The overall thing to see is that there is a deep or intrinsic integrity to the way we work, and that this has been profoundly disturbed. And that as a result of this disturbance, we are not only out of alignment with ourselves in many respects, but also with the Earth as a whole and the entire process of life of which we are a part. It disconnects us from life, it makes us imagine we are separate. Which sounds terrible of course, but it also indicates a solution of equal magnitude and significance – that is we can once again liberate and thereby restore our underlying state, that the intrinsic integrity we will find there will already be in direct alignment with the Earth. We won't even need to try, it is already there.

It is a very potent circumstance. What it basically means is that in finally resolving the individual's deepest subjective dilemma, that not only are they once again reconnected to themselves in a way they could only have dreamed about, but that they are also reconnected to the Earth in that very same stroke. They thereby step back into their own heart, and in the same instant step back inside the great circle of life. It is a great coming home, in many more ways than one. And I'm sure this sounds all very profound, but I do not mean this in any spiritual sense. It is simply the case that the operation of this secondary agenda displaces our own core drives to be dramatically out of natural alignment with our own underlying pattern, which can lead us to forget that we are actually part of a far broader event - that we belong here, and that we already know the song that all other life on this planet is singing. So whilst we often feel abandoned by life, it was actually us who did the abandoning, and so for this disruption to fall away can lead to a deep restoration of connection in that sense. A connection that was already there, but which was merely obscured.

Another of the ways this is expressed is in the difference it makes to collective organisation. The underlying integrity restored is common and universal, whereas the various forms of individual disturbance are endlessly scattered and diverse. What this means is that there is far more difference between people in terms of the way they break, than the way they come back together again.

The effect of this is a kind of natural alignment you simply do not see in common culture, except where people all happen to share the same addiction. All of a sudden we school like fishes and flock like birds, without even having to be taught how. And not only in the wake of the restoration of energetic integrity, but even before that – simply by having such a state as our implied and shared goal. The paradigm itself can produce this alignment.

So for the Earth, the emergence of such a potential will be like coming up for air at last – not only will there be an ever increasing number of people who can directly feel and dance to the deeper rhythm of life as a whole, but they will also be working together in a way not previously ever seen. And once this has begun, it will continue unabated until the entire system is once again restored to equilibrium. It is not only an individual realisation – the entire world will ultimately awaken to the reality of this underlying connection. It was never lost, it had only been obscured from view.



Here we stand, then, in the common state. We play the game as best we can, but we are up against a problem we just can't overcome. And this is the real problem we face in life, not how well we play the game, but that the game is not fair. Something keeps shifting the goalposts. Often unaware of our real motives for actions, we are moved by forces we cannot see or understand. Life becomes a strange struggle for peace and contentment that ends up making little sense. We cannot even see the trap we are in, and are powerless to affect it. Something seems missing, but we just can't figure out what it is.

There are obviously many potentials for change in the common human state. People naturally seek a better state, but every form of the common state leaves us in a similar place emotionally as we have seen. Lasting happiness remains elusive even in the best of circumstances, and we can now understand why. However, gradual progress can be made if we begin to isolate the real source of our struggle. Looking within, we may slowly unwind some of the knots and conflicts to recover our own sense of inner flow, feeling, and integrity.

This process can take many forms, depending on the forms of the particular dysfunction being undone in each case. Each person manufactures for themselves a unique dilemma, a unique identity formation, and a unique form of containment for the resulting crisis. But in restoring systemic integrity, no matter what form it all takes, we inevitably end up confronting the same underlying factors every time. All roads lead to Rome, all forms of containment lead to the same underlying crisis – an active existential agenda. This is what we all uncover as we dig deep within ourselves looking for final peace and harmony.

If integrity is enforced over time, then the gradual uncovering of this dormant agenda is unavoidable. And the emergence of this underlying existential crisis tends to shift the focus of attention as it begins to manifest itself as a search for fulfilment. This agenda must either be fulfilled, or contained somehow. And since containment is no longer an option in the face of returning integrity, the primary task becomes the fulfilment of it.

This process is relatively commonplace and easily observed amongst those who commit themselves to any serious path of personal change. This is often defined as progress even, this crude evolution of personal yearning. From physical wellbeing, to psychological balance, to spirituality. And the final result is that the 'inner search' eventually becomes the great 'spiritual search'.

Simply because of the nature of the common state as we have now seen it, if you are seriously committed to being happy, then all paths lead to this point – spirituality, the last bastion of the true seeker.

There often appears to be a kind of ladder being climbed. But is this really progress, or simply another by-product of the same old dilemma? Could this be merely another form of it? Just the fallacy, the confusion of the secondary agenda with the native state, perhaps in its highest form?

Yes, I believe so. That, still presuming the problem to be an absence, this whole 'search' is still looking to 'get' something.

We generally have no grounds for presuming the presence of a distinct negativity, so as we restore our own internal integrity over time the result is that this process naturally becomes the search for final fulfilment - and in particular the fulfilment of the secondary agenda. So we might feel better in some senses, as we 'progress', and as we learn to once again breathe and stretch and flow, but we inevitably end up assuming another heavy load that often comes to dominate our lives.

All this is now very understandable. We are simply not aware of what is happening. The motivation is correct, we are just looking to be happier. But is this really the most appropriate solution? We have now seen that there is nothing particularly 'spiritual' about the problem, and thus, probably nothing particularly 'spiritual' about any real solution. In fact the real solution is probably right where we would not expect it to be. But off we go, seeking something else - to find or connect with some 'spiritual' state in which all will be well. To move beyond this place of torment into one of freedom and clarity. And the Ashrams are full of people seeking something more in this sense – people clustering around 'gurus', or anyone who seems to 'have' it.

And exactly what is it that they are seeking to achieve? Ask people this and you will get many answers, depending on the path being taken. There are many ideas and ideals – generally some state of peace and clarity, but always something to 'get', something to 'achieve'. Moksha, Enlightenment, Freedom, Satori, Nirvana....it has many names, but one thing seems to be quite clear: There is great hope invested in the belief that there is indeed 'something else' - something above or beyond this common human state in which we now live.

And for whom? ..one must ask. Who is going to 'get' this wonderful state, this realisation, this release?

Well, 'I' am, of course. Perhaps you can begin to see where this is all going to lead. Perhaps you can see how and why this 'search' generally becomes just a further corruption of beliefs as consoling worldviews are adopted, or as some other form of fulfilment or containments are adapted to. But what about this 'something else'? This mythical state that keeps recurring in seemingly every culture and wisdom tradition throughout the ages?

I believe we can now begin to gain some idea of what it could be.

So is there really something else? Yes, I believe there is. Something significant? Yes indeed. This potential is the topic of this entire section. Specifically, the potential of removing this active secondary agenda altogether, in its entirety.

We have seen how the common state appears stable and consistent over time, even in the face of much change. It is this stability that gives the common state the appearance of one single cohesive mass, rather than two separate events. But this fallacy is not just the confusion of the secondary agenda with the native human state. The other side of this error is that it completely overlooks the fact that there is another option entirely.

Overall, a worldview based on this fallacy has no choice but to presume that "this is it", that the common state is all there is. That there is no alternative. And the fact that very few individuals ever succeed in finding any alternative also doesn't help things.

However the radical potential we are discussing is nothing new. People have probably been finding ways out of this dilemma for as long as they have been getting into it. But I believe it can also be demonstrated that it has also been very misunderstood historically, even by those who have realised it. Misrepresented even, and the consequence of this is that it has never been able to be reliably transmitted between people. Meaning that those who stumble upon it seem to be left powerless to bring it to others.

I believe this is entirely understandable, however, when you examine what actually occurs, and how it might naturally be perceived from the perspective of frontal awareness. As we will see, what it is, and what it feels like subjectively, are two very different things. And it is certainly not an intellectual realisation. In fact it seems patently clear from listening to many self styled gurus – you obviously do not need to understand it in order to have it. Presuming they do in fact 'have something' that is. For the moment I will give them the benefit of the doubt.

Anyway, this is a situation that leads to much confusion, especially when it comes to telling others about it. And the way this potential appears in the context of the 'fallacy driven spiritual search' is therefore equally confusing. It is sorely misunderstood.

Nevertheless many individuals, having realised 'something' in themselves, set themselves up as 'guru' or 'master' and set about 'bringing this' to the world. And following the paths these gurus prescribe becomes the goal of many lives.

Many seek to experience or achieve this 'mystical' state. There is a global industry built around this search. It is an enormous enterprise, 'enlightenment' is big business. People go to sit, and to listen, and are always presented with a choice. Their ordinary life, or this other state. This potential is wholeheartedly sold to them as an attainable thing. The teachers and gurus speak of it, they advocate it as being the only answer. But what is it? And how do you 'get' it?

There are many answers to those questions, from many different views. Some say 'be still', some say 'enquire as to the nature of self'. Some say 'let go', 'surrender'. Some say 'address the body', others say 'address the mind'. But whatever they say, none of the answers given seem to be erudite or perspicacious enough to consistently produce realisation in the listener.

In many cases what they offer could not be defined as strictly incorrect, but merely so lacking clarity as to be defined as practically useless. Often, they may as well just say- 'Umm? Don't know really'. Because for all their talk, they never actually deliver the goods. A teacher is ultimately judged by their students, and in this game their hit rate is astonishingly low. Meaning that the choice they speak of is not really a choice at all. It is empty. For they are not really offering any practical alternative, just charging people money to talk about it.

The sad fact is that there is no practical choice at present. Regardless of whether it is actually possible, being confronted with this potential is like going to a shop where nothing is for sale.

One way many 'spiritual masters' seem to get around their lack of penetrating insight into what they are advocating, is to appeal to paradox. Many books pertaining to the spiritual quest leave you with this frustrating paradox, introduced as the highest of spiritual truths –

'There is nothing to get. You are already there. The search is itself the problem....'

You see this again and again, almost every major wisdom tradition has a form of it. And is it true? Well, yes, in a sense it is, but **not** in the obvious sense. It does, however, function as a convenient way for 'gurus' to sidestep the uncomfortable realisation that they do not actually know how to get what they are talking about. They simply say "You can't get it!" And this is supposed to be edifying. Whereas, in reality, they are simply using this metaphysical loophole to pull their own neck out of the noose of embarrassment.

The obvious contradiction here is that those who may say this first of all claim to 'have' something, and also that they once 'did not'. Thus tacitly implying something to 'get', by the mere admission that they themselves were once not 'already there'. Thereby implying that there are in fact two specific states being discussed. The very fact that they stand up and speak implies this. Otherwise, what are they offering? And that they claim to have moved from one to the other tacitly implies the existence of a distinct process of transition. A process, like all processes, with a beginning, a middle and an end. So, surely this can be explained.

'Where is enlightenment then, and how do I get there?' 'What is it?' Students are discouraged from asking this question by 'realised masters' using spiritual gobbledegook which goes round in circles. Not because there is no answer, which there must be, but because the gurus themselves simply do not know it. They don't really understand, in any meaningful sense, exactly what happened to them, or what its real significance is. All they have is their own subjective interpretation, leading to mystical and overly cosmic or spiritualised **guesses**. Some may – if pressed – say that there is a shift, and that it can happen, but that the most effective way to reach that point is not to 'perceive' the issue in terms of 'getting'. And whilst once again this could be said to be true, I do not believe this to be good enough. If there is another state to be had, then there must be a way to have it. Everything else is just excuses.

So all this is very frustrating for anyone seeking a better state. If I am 'already there', why am I still so damned UNHAPPY! And if I can't 'get' it, then what hope is there?

So are these 'gurus' charlatans? Opportunistically preying on the genuine good intentions of those who seek something more in life? No, I don't think so. At least not necessarily. They could often be well intentioned, after all what they are espousing is real. It is simply unfortunate that they have no cultural paradigm with which they might better account for what they have experienced. They are simply not well informed about the nature of what they are selling. Which is perhaps connected to why so few actually succeed in reproducing it in others.

I believe the cultural fallacy I have been indicating has a great role to play here. And it would seem that even the potential of finding release from the secondary agenda does not correct this error. This is why it is so misunderstood. People can't explain it because they naturally presume it to be a *presence*, that they *got* something, like some kind of 'peak experience', but that it remains somehow. And it would certainly seem possible to relinquish the whole complex outlined in Section Three, thus giving the appearance of 'finding' or 'achieving' the resulting state permanently. Even to subjective awareness this is what it might seem like, which naturally leads to a similar interpretation.

So what is it, then? The resulting state is very simple, and how can you explain it?

The obvious answer is that it cannot be meaningfully explained in terms of what it **IS**. It is simply the native human state, free of this added conflict. It can only be accurately defined in terms of what it is **NOT**, and that is never understood. As we have seen, far from being simple, the common state is immensely complex, and has never been adequately defined before. At least to my knowledge. But only a comprehensive understanding of that disturbance can adequately explain the state which results from its eventual absence.

Nothing else qualifies. You simply cannot understand the nature and significance of the native state unless you understand the common state by contrast. The native state is a simple thing, but the common state is **not** a simple thing. So the native state cannot be explained in positive terms, as being the common state with something added, and does not need to be. That can only lead to even more errors.

The native state is simply what's left in the absence of the disturbance. It is the disturbance which must be explained, and which **can** be explained, as we have seen. So as simple as the realisation may be, explaining it is not. And this is where we have fallen short of the mark.

The answer is very simple, but only makes sense in light of the problem, which is very complex. And the resulting state cannot easily be explained in terms of what it is, but perhaps more appropriately, what it is not.

In the end, we can see how defining the nature of what is negated in this realisation is no mean feat, and how the lack of such understanding has led to serious and persistent deep level misconceptions in the way this potential is approached. I believe it is the absence of this essential context which is the root of much struggle and error. Which is why I am driven to write.

So perhaps we could begin again, and take a fresh view of this potential. To examine it from the perspective of what we now know about the common state and the underlying conflict being addressed.

Positive Orientation

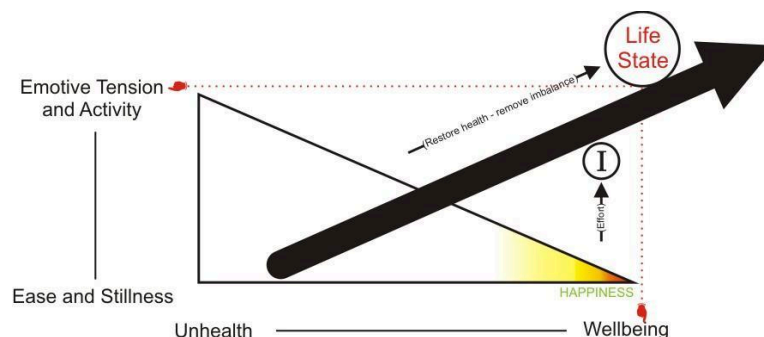
The first thing to remember is what we are seeking to achieve in addressing this conflict. What is it that has been lost? What is it that this whole complex dynamic has taken from us? We must not become fixated on the negativity and forget what life is all about. If there is one key, then this is it. That whilst there is a significant negativity to be addressed, the positivity is the only answer in the end. We must never lose sight of that no matter how much attention the negativities might demand.

This positive focus is important because whilst the removal of this complex is the central issue here, it is also very easy to become fixated on manipulating subjective limitations and forget why we are doing it. So we must always look beyond our situation and history to the future we desire.

What we addressed in section one about desire does in fact apply to the native state, and the native state is our destination. A positively oriented approach IS the answer, signified in the creation of an integrated vision of what you truly desire in life, and a tacit commitment to that being achieved. Only this singular positivity, because it defines where you want to be, will confront you with all your true obstacles. But also, only your true obstacles, and nothing superfluous.

That is the essential orientation then, so do we just head off with this positivity in mind? Do we go straight for the stated goal? No. This is, after all, what we are already doing, playing right into its hands. We must examine our own motives and define a path which aligns with the integrity of our true native state. We must recognise the two different agendas, and observe the influence of the secondary. We must be able to discern, and this is where insight and understanding is essential. This is what we have never been able to do. The confusion of these two elements is exactly what the fallacy is. We must somehow be able to discern the true concomitants of health and wellbeing, and support only those. And the underlying agenda must be recognised and addressed. Because if we do not account for the secondary agenda, we will simply confront it.

What if we do this, then? What happens? If we support the native agenda alone? Well, as we saw in section three, we will confront resistance from the secondary agenda. With 'I' at the helm, the result is inevitable displacement of the containment being threatened, or overthrow of the will. The tension generated by the secondary agenda will simply rise to match the positive movement, and will eventually force that movement back.



So to simply apply a positive agenda whilst 'I' remains incumbent will confront inevitable overthrow and struggle. Thus, whilst a positive orientation is the first thing to remember, we must somehow address this secondary complex directly. Which means that the process we are discussing is a movement from where we are (the common state), to where we want to be (the native state), by addressing the primary obstruction (the secondary agenda) in the process. From A to B, via C. Because if we do not address C, then B remains impossible.

Therefore, in concert with a positive orientation, we must directly address the secondary agenda. So what does this involve? Well, the essence of that agenda, as we have seen, is that our systems have been somewhat shut down or distorted so as to safely accommodate a crisis produced by an erroneous self reference- 'I'. But now we wish to remove all this distortion. Which seems to suggest that we must therefore first remove 'I'.

Relinquishing 'I'

So what about this 'I'? This is a very strange subject to even consider, but it seems that this aspect of our mental processing is actually nothing more than an effort, that it is not an entity but rather and activity. So how hard can that be if it is – after all – just a belief? Can we not simply negate that? Can that be done? Well, yes. And is it difficult? Well, yes. Why? Because it is far too easy.

Let me explain, at least as far as this emerging view defines it –

'I' is an activity of mind, moment to moment, as are all the containments of the loaded crisis. This entire agenda is surplus to requirements. It is all activity, including 'I'. We are doing it. All thought is an *activity* undertaken by the body within its own functioning. Often, however, without deliberate conscious intention. But set on automatic or not, it is an activity nevertheless.

The thoughts which constitute identity are a dynamic cluster of such activities. They are things the body is *doing*. And thus, all the disturbance which flows from them could be said to be things the system is doing to itself, for without the subtle activities at their source, such conflict would not arise. So 'I' is an effort which is the source of much more effort. And we can, if we wish, simply stop doing it.

It all comes out of nothing, and can simply resolve back to nothing. There is actually no I, and no problem. So if we simply negate the whole shebang, what would happen? Nothing. Nothing at all.

The common state is simply the native state with an added disturbance. So what do we get when we return to the native state? What do we get that we have not currently got? Nothing! The thing which characterises the native state, in contrast to the common state, is not a presence, but an absence. In particular, the absence of this agenda and its source thought.

So what kind of process is this? What is it seeking to achieve exactly? Simply the absence of certain activity. And what do you get that you haven't already got? NOTHING. An absence. Not a doing. The entire agenda comes from nothing at all. So what do you get when you add it all up? Nothing at all. And this agenda is certainly something worth removing.

There is, it would seem, truly nothing to get. But a very particular nothing, the absence of something in particular. Simply what is left in the absence of these systemic activities. It all resolves to nothing at all. The entire agenda, and all the activity which occurs on its behalf, has no actual substance whatsoever, and can simply be relinquished and forgotten.

What does it take, then, to relinquish these things? How hard could it be? Well, it is very easy. It is too easy! That is the point. There is actually nothing, in relational terms, standing in the way of this, and it is not dangerous. Quite the contrary. This isolated movement is in fact (contrary to common perception) very simple, the easiest path, which gets easier.

Such movement gradually spirals and revolves around effortlessness itself. The native system is entirely geared up to move toward such, so much so that to avoid it you have to forcefully hold it back. That is what the secondary agenda does, and why it is so busy. And in this way we can see the nature of the active containments in the system -

All the elements of the secondary agenda are generated out of energy itself. And all inevitably seek to negate energy itself. Thus, they are set up to maintain their own negation in a very equilibrating manner. They both consume energy, and prevent it. If not in the form of containments, then in the form of the search, which consumes massive amounts of functional capacity in pursuit of an impossible end. The whole thing costs an enormous amount of effort and energy, and for no ultimate gain whatsoever. Quite the contrary, at considerable cost. And there is no real size limit to this agenda, it will take on the valence of whatever energy it confronts.

So movement toward the positive is truly very easy. Effort is gradually relinquished and functional capacities liberated and made available. You could, I suppose, say that this would take some enormous amount of figuring out, that it was not something you could just trust and leave to happen, if only you were not in charge of the most integrated and sophisticated energy accumulating system ever encountered. This is why all containments are active, and why all require effort and energy to maintain. Because they have to hold strong healthy functions back perpetually.

So if those subversions are relaxed, a positive spiral begins. Not only because of the effort and energy this relaxation releases, but also because of the increasing lack of general opposition to open healthy functioning.

So without the need to support these massive and immensely complex subjective efforts, positive functioning is remarkably simple - automatic even. It's mostly a matter of NOT doing something! What does free energy feel like then? **Ease. Effortlessness. Surrender.** That's what free energy equates to.

Free energy and attention is EASE.

So responses to free energy are responses to things being too easy, to there being no demands, inner or outer, to respond to. This is also contributed to by the naturally spiralling nature of positive functioning, it is itself naturally equilibrating toward some ultimate point of effortlessness and simple functional integrity. This is exactly the natural spiral of healthy integrity and ease which the secondary agenda has negated by its presence.

There are possibly many ways to functionally negate 'I' as a cyclic belief. An obvious method would seem to be simply to look for it, to make it the object of attention rather than the presumed subject. The 'Atma vichara' or 'Self enquiry' as prescribed by Ramana Maharshi and the advaita vedanta school of philosophy. That of turning attention back on itself by enquiring within oneself- 'from whence does 'I' come?' Or, more crudely, 'who am I?' But there are no doubt many possibilities. They will all have the same basic theme however, that of feeling into or becoming aware of this thought and

how we are actively generating it, and then relaxing that subtle effort. So some degree of subjective manipulation is required here. A deliberate relaxing and relinquishing this particular chronic activity.

Is mind the problem? No, only problematic mind is the problem. Many approaches use this as a premise, and it is correct in a sense, but not all mind. The absence of the 'I' thought is not the realisation. This happens all the time. If this were so then meditation would be the answer, which it clearly is not. The point is in making that absence securely achievable, even the dominant habit or tendency, thus allowing the containments to be safely removed.

So it is very easy, but precisely because it is so easy, and results in the relinquishment of even greater systemic efforts, the absence of the 'I' thought confronts resistance and is automatically re-asserted. What happens? Energy! 'I' is not the problem we suffer from, but the containment of the crisis it produces. And these are set up so as to automatically respond to energy, and negate it. These are what the organism really suffers from.

Can we do this then, negate 'I'? Yes. It is nothing foreign. It is always within our power, given that you are actively producing it. If you imagine the process of attention as being like pointing a gun, then this 'I' is always at the end of the barrel. This end. Likewise with all the active functioning which has resulted from this thought being ever-present. It is not foreign, just forgotten. The organism made it, so it can unmake it! It survived it then, it can survive it now! If it did not make it all, then who did? If we are not in control of our own subjective functioning, then who is?

This is something only we can do, which nobody can help us with or do for us. But it is also something which nobody can prevent us from doing. You could be chained to a wall in a dungeon, and you could still do this. This is within our power always, at the very root of all attention and thought. It is actually very simple, but has profound results, and these results are what we confront as resistance.

So is that negation an answer in itself? Once again, no. It is a key, however, for without it we cannot even begin. The entire secondary agenda, its desires and its containments, are natural and healthy functioning on the basis of 'I' being the case. But 'I' is not actually the case at all.

However it is not 'I' that hurts us, for it is never real, but the functional consequences of its being believed. The containments and the existential quest are what hurt. What they cost in energy, or do to energy. 'I' is just a thought, moment to moment. A belief. An activity, an effort. Completely harmless in itself.

Somehow, then, we are seeking to effect the removal of these energetic blocks and the active agenda beneath them. Not the 'I', but the systemic consequences of it being believed. The active negation of this primary thought is merely a condition of such removal. With that out of the way, we are then free to restore healthy integrity without the threat of active existential crisis. So 'I' is just the spark, it is the fire we want to put out. But we must first address this little spark, so that new fires do not continue to appear.

So negating 'I' is the relinquishment of a body of subjective effort. And we need to be able to do - or 'not do' - this reliably somehow. But surely relaxing an effort must be easy, so why is this difficult or problematic? Why is it hard to maintain?

The reason is that the underlying secondary agenda is highly automated and unconscious in nature, and deeply habitualized. It operates in a very equilibrating and dynamic way.

Imagine this -

In a state of primary need fulfilment in which all authentic relational organic needs were being met, the only subjective activity and thinking would be active on the basis of 'I'. The secondary agenda would still be busy either trying to figure out some way to find fulfilment, or busy trying to actively contain the emotional results of the lack of such fulfilment. This is the common state as we know it.

Now it is in this situation that we are applying our positive orientation toward the restoration of integrity, which is going to make the secondary agenda even more busy as it tries to limit the energy which healthy functioning naturally produces. An emergence of an active crisis seems inevitable in the presence of 'I'.

So added to this, we adopt a strategy which functionally negates the 'I' thought so as to eliminate this whole possibility. Which seems perfectly reasonable. However, the removal of this central identity formation is like pulling the kingpin. It almost immediately results in the collapse of all this subjective activity, liberating much energy from the task of active attention and into pure feeling. And of all the forms of energy the secondary agenda is set up to negate, it is this form which is primary: Free feeling energy in the highest levels.

This is the energy which naturally begins to restore suspended functioning. Thus, the negation of this 'I' thought ends up stimulating a response from the unconscious containments, which use feeling limitation as a primary containment mechanism. And the immediate response of the automatic secondary agenda is to distract or disturb this released energy with the production of mental activity and attention. Thus activity (and 'I') is automatically re-asserted.

So if you negate the 'I', it simply bounces back. It is re-asserted strongly. But this is exactly when you know you have hit the mark with this process.

The function of the 'self enquiry' is not to 'see the self'. The fact that there is no self there is the reason you are doing it. The point is simply to liquidate all emotive and cognitive activities being generated on the basis of this subjective illusion.

So - stillness, nothingness, is the point. To liquidate energy into stillness. When you have hit the mark, there is a release of energy in the body, pure feeling energy. And does this feel bad? YES!!! There is a strong reaction to this, especially if there is already too much energy present as a result of healthy activity. Because it is an immediate threat to the repression of actively suspended deep emotive processes, and many other elements of energetic dysfunction.

This energetic response is what prevents the possibility of even a single moment of conscious experience without mental activity, thus leaving 'I' permanently incumbent. So that even without the presence of 'I', the secondary agenda is still equilibrating, if only because it is largely composed of suspended processes which are kind of frozen in stasis, which were established in the fervent belief that 'I' is real, and which are designed to animate automatically in the face of certain conditions. The secondary agenda is deeply rooted, and does not simply vaporise when its source of sustenance disappears. Like any living thing, it takes time to die.

This is all a bit like having your legs frozen by frostbite. There was pain up to a certain point, but then they were just numb. You can't use them, but you can't feel them either. They don't hurt any more. This is the common state. The secondary agenda keeps us away from pain. But now, if we want to recover our true natural potential, we must begin to thaw them out. We must first remove the source of the cold (I), and begin to restore healthy warmth and circulation. And is this pleasant? What do you think? It is the right direction, but it hurts like hell. For in seeking to resolve all this activity into nothing with deliberate inactivity, we must uncover and confront an active existential crisis.

In the common state we don't experience the consequences of 'I' fully. We only experience the impact of containing such. Numbness. But when functioning returns we get to experience strong automatic responses, strong warnings that going in this direction is dangerous, and that we should stop. This positive spiral is what the secondary agenda is set up to negate. Thus we strike loaded habitual resistance. So is it difficult? Yes, in several senses it is. Because, strangely, we must get into it in order to get out of it. And because it is so easy, because effort and struggle are the established habit.

Effort is our habit, thus the essential practice could truly be described as a kind of deliberate 'anti-effort'. So, strangely, in this situation, it requires effort to stop effort.

How can we ever hope to manage this permanently then? If it requires constant effort, and confronts more and more resistance, surely we will simply lapse back into the same old state in time. We just won't be able to keep it up? But with this, we reach the crucial element to understand.

The Balance Point

There is a point when this resistance can become lessened, and deliberate anti-effort becomes unnecessary. A point in the 'thawing out' when the worst is behind you, when it becomes less painful to go forward than go back. And at this point, everything changes.

Perhaps this will help to explain -

All functioning is defined by the economics of energy. Efficiency is the axiom of all organic behaviour. We remain in the common state simply because it is the easiest place to be. We do not push the ball up the side of the bowl because it does not feel good to do so.

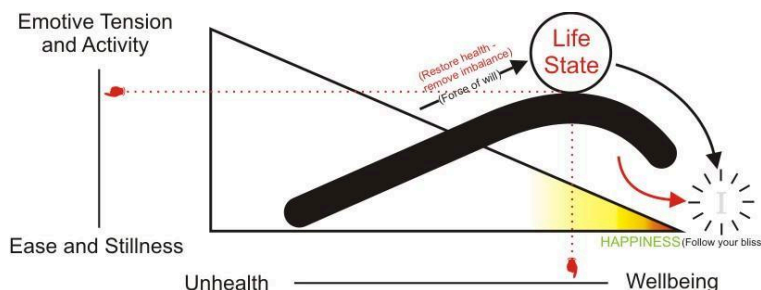
These feelings and emotional tensions represent underlying energetic realities. In the common state, as we push toward the positive, there is simply more systemic resistance to free energy than there is attraction to it. So the resistance wins. Remember, the second principle of change from section two - energy always follows the path of least resistance. This is what defines functioning, what defines emotions, and behaviour.

So we can push the ball up the hill all we want, but sooner or later it will just roll down again as we let go. After all, we are looking for peace and happiness, and upwards toward emotive tension and effort is clearly the wrong direction in that sense.

Little do we realise, until we have been there, that there is a far easier option, albeit on the other side of a somewhat difficult hill. That in the absence of the 'I' thought, whilst the loaded resistances are still present, they become finite and residual rather than active and aggressive.

This is what we don't see, that there is a point at which positive functioning, geared around free energy as its axiom, recovers its vitality and integrity in an upward spiral of health and wellbeing. And at the same time, in the absence of 'I',

the secondary agenda can enter a downward spiral toward collapse and final resolution. That there comes a point at which the balance tips. Beyond which point both the relinquishment of 'I' and the assertion of a positive orientation become the path of least resistance. THIS is the realisation. THIS changes everything.



Just 'let go' they say - the final word from those who have realised the truth about themselves and about life. 'Surrender!'

There is nothing to get. 'Relax'.

We can now see how this is entirely correct, but also how it is almost worthless as an injunction, and in practice. This is what we have been missing, the essential factor.

To 'let go' only applies beyond a certain point, and that point is what has never been clearly defined, nor how it might be reached. The balance point is not about any particular element of the secondary agenda or the native state. No single element is the answer, not even 'I'. It is all about the heart of the human dilemma, the equilibrating core, the energetic centre of gravity which perpetuates it at its root.

The secondary agenda and its containment mechanisms are entirely healthy in response to 'I' being real. It is possible, as we have seen, to negate any isolated elements of this presence, including 'I'. But if you negate an element of it, it just comes back again, or displaces into another form. If you negate 'I', it comes back, because 'I' is a product of attention. Attention is a product of stress, and the energetic consequences of negating 'I' causes stress. Thus it is a self perpetuation loop. Attacking its arms and legs is pointless.

But reaching the balance point changes all of this. Prior to this balance point, by definition, all progress toward integrity requires a degree of active anti-effort in opposition to the system's tendency toward effort and will. Beyond the balance point, however, effortlessness becomes naturally re-established as the organic axiom, and all functioning again revolves around that. The positive spiral of functioning continues to clean up mess in the form of residual resistance mechanisms, but it is now the dominant force. The absence of the 'I' thought, the absence of ALL thought, becomes the normal state in the presence of natural need fulfilment. The system regains the capacity for stillness, it has returned to the simple native state.

So when do you stop? Never! You don't! In many senses the essential 'practices' associated with what I am indicating are simply a definition of ordinary healthy functioning in the native state. It is just that at the beginning it will have to confront and liquidate a series of automatically loaded resistances by testing our capacity to achieve a normal potential - Stillness.

The 'self-enquiry' is something mechanical we do to negate 'I', but beyond the balance point 'I' simply does not arise automatically. So this is not a temporary shift. We learn to live there.

So they say that surrender is the answer, and we can see how this is correct, but only beyond the crucial balance point, over the brow of the hill. To simply let go and surrender within the Dilemma is to submit to permanent bondage. The Bowl!

This balance point, and the energetic continuum which defines it, is what has been missed. It is the essential point which defines this 'realisation'. It is merely, and simply, a practical energetic transition. The point is to know and account for what to expect along the way.

The positive process continues as these latent resistances resolve and fall away. The secondary agenda is like a climbing plant which has grown up and strangled the human tree. And hacking away at it doesn't help, it just sees that as pruning, as an opportunity for further growth. But passing this balance point is like cutting it at the root. It does not remove all the tentacles, but does not need to.

Beyond that point it will all simply wither and die over time without further effort. No matter how it is achieved, passing this point is truly the only way out of the fundamental human dilemma. It is the only final solution to the unhappiness of the common state.

So, under the circumstances (the common state), the only thing which can lead to natural effortlessness, is deliberate and sustained anti-effort. Like a stop button on an outboard motor. You have to push it long enough to allow the momentum of the engine to wind down sufficiently. If you release it too soon, the engine will start again immediately. You will have gained nothing. But keep the pressure on, and beyond a certain point of inertia you may release this activity and the engine will not restart. Thus, in the beginning, we are only doing manually what would naturally be automatic, and which will become automatic again at some point. So at first it involves conscious effort (anti-effort), and has immediate negative results emotionally. Thus, the balance point is defined by both of these factors eventually becoming reversed. Effortless and positive. 'Enlightenment.'

The final key is the removal of opposition to energy in the system, for this is what defines the balance point. In order to affect this transition we must remember what we are seeking to achieve here - the positivity we are seeking when viewed in core-functional terms. The presence of negativity (containments) is in fact best defined as the absence of the positivity. The negating of which is best achieved by the assertion of the positivity likewise.

This is what ultimately defines progress toward the direction of the balance point. A two part process. Negate the negativity, and assert the positivity, simultaneously. It is this relationship which has been overlooked in both directions. Some seek to negate 'I', but ignore the energetic elements of the agenda it has produced. Others hammer away at the energetic elements but never suspect their own motives or the 'I', leaving it active and present. So from each end they miss the connection between cause and final relational symptom. And neither will ever hit the mark. Because neither will ever reach the essential balance point.

In subjective terms, the positivity can be ultimately defined as happiness itself. Happiness itself is the primary repression. Only that signifies the restoration of primary integrity at the highest levels. Only happiness itself signifies true progress in relation to the energetic balance point. Happiness = energy and attention at the highest level. It is the highest expression of the positive orientation. Which means that in the end, the only true practice for happiness itself, is happiness itself. Happiness is the only true therapy. Happiness itself is the final TEST and transformer. There is no substitute for happiness in this practice. The only practice for true deep and lasting happiness is happiness.

Negating the 'I' thought, via whatever mechanism, is not the qualification. Feeling is. Freedom is freedom to feel. To feel without limitation is to effectively remove what we have been calling the dilemma - when feeling can be present, openly and without limitation, and when no resistance can be found. When stillness resides without stimulation.

Freedom is usually associated with going, with doing. But true freedom is the freedom to **not go**, to **not do**. To be still, and feel without limitation.

So - how many things stand between you and happiness? Only happiness will tell you.

Can you see what I am saying here?

If you want to see what's stopping you being happy, then you must **be happy**, and **find out**. There is no other final test.

False realisations -

There are clearly many potentials here for what could be called 'peak experiences' or temporary states. If you roll the ball up the hill, and then let it go again, it will roll back into the bowl. And this is pointless. But the experience of letting go, the freefall experienced, is exactly the same emotionally as what is experienced beyond the balance point. However, in this case it is not accompanied by positive relational integrity, and is also very temporary. But the same feeling of bliss and surrender results. And so, many have experienced moments of great clarity, and have interpreted this as being some kind of preview for 'enlightenment'. And in a way it is, but it is pointless to seek it in whatever actions produced this experience, precisely because when it happened they were heading in exactly the wrong direction. They were on the wrong side of the hill.



The primary-relational view –

Is this possible, then? Such a dramatic transformation at such a deep level? Given what we now know about its basic nature and anatomy? Yes, it would certainly seem so. In order to make sense of it all, we can once again take several perspectives.

Firstly, we can see what is really going on in actual reality, the primary-relational view –

There is no real problem. The human condition feels bad because of our own limited and distorted experience of it, which is what informs our perception that there is a 'problem with life' which must be solved. This is a belief we often extend and apply to existence as a whole. But this is our own doing. It is an illusion of subjective captivity. Understandable, but inaccurate. There is actually nothing to do. Objectively, in actual reality. What they say is true. There is nothing to get. You

are already there, at least in this sense. You are never going to be any closer to 'God' than you are right now. This is it, just this. This is all there is. No matter how much you believe in 'I', and act from that, it is never actually real. Nor is the existential crisis which results from its being believed. And no amount of suffering on the basis of pure delusion will ever make the universe a bad place. There is no real problem. There is only an imaginary one.

But to say that there is nothing we can do to affect unconditional reality, is not the same as saying that there is nothing we can do to affect our own state. Because our troubled state is not the result of actual reality, but predominantly the result of our own subjective activities. And our subjective experience is one of massive functional limitation and structural conflict. Once again, like frantically fighting off a swarm of imaginary bees, and getting cut up in the process. There are no bees, but the cuts and bruises are real.

The point is that we do actually have a problem. Not the bees we are fighting off, but the fighting itself.

Briefly again –

We have an active and loaded agenda operating within our systems which is seeking to achieve certain ends which can simply not be achieved. It is seeking to fulfil needs we simply do not have, and we are suffering in the process. And this whole process is being actively suppressed/repressed by the system itself because of the combination of its power and its incapacity to be fulfilled. There is simply no room in the china shop for this kind of dancing, so the system has bound its own arms and legs up to limit movement. We would be fighting these bees much more ferociously if we were not so bound up and emotionally tranquillised. And all of this IS a problem, THIS is what we suffer from. We do not actually suffer from a lack of fulfilment of the needs this agenda is seeking to fulfil. For these are not needs we actually have.

The result is a dynamic limitation on happiness and vitality. Struggle and despair. Not relating to actual reality necessarily, but to our own subjective construction of reality, and the way we actively generate that. And only **we** experience the dramatic and pervasive consequences of our own subjective delusions. There **is** something wrong with existence, but only for **us**. There is no fulfilment for our existential needs, if only because we do not actually have any. So it is not that we must do something to fix things, but because we are already doing something to create all this disturbance, we are free to identify that activity and to simply stop doing it.

So we are unhappy, but we are unaware that we are unhappy by our own doing - that what we suffer comes entirely from within us. We fail to recognise this, and the connection between 'I' and surface symptoms, or the mechanisms between, and that this entire agenda comes out of nothing at all.

It is a storm in a teacup. There is no cosmic drama. Only we suffer from the results of our delusions, as well as those other beings who are dependent on us. In reality, we really are 'already there', and there truly is 'nothing to get'.

However, we can say this only in this particular sense. Our conscious perception of all this is a little different. And to see that we must adopt the natural-subjective view, the perspective of the frontal self -

The natural-subjective view –

The frontal self is in charge of this whole circus. The 'hill' which defines the balance point is ultimately one of emotive tension as experienced by the conscious frontal self. When the ball stalls and rolls back, it is the frontal self which has buckled under the pressure.

The frontal operating persona is responsible for defining action. The key to the whole process, then, lies in making it easier for the frontal self. If we want to steer a horse, we need only steer its head, and the rest will follow. The head, in this case, is the conscious self.

So, as it relates to this particular transition, we strike one main problem -

How to get the frontal self to choose a course of action which will have to transit this 'zone' of high stress? And it is very real stress. The emotional valence of what is encountered toward the balance point is extreme. This is why this potential is almost never found by accident. Because it simply feels wrong. It is because true progress feels worse and worse as we push up the hill. There is very real fear on the way out.

This period just prior to 'enlightenment' has traditionally been called the 'dark night of the soul'. And there have been many explanations as to why it is like this. But I believe we can now see exactly why. It is simply the death rattle of an agenda which has ruled the system with an iron fist for many years. It is just that in order to overcome it, we must first of all confront it.

Another strange and paradoxical thing is that this whole process must somehow be made to appeal to the incumbent 'I'. It must be invited to its own execution, as it were, in such a way that it actually turns up! And how do you do that? Well, fortunately, the primal emotive core which believes 'I' to be real is very stupid. You simply need to tell it that it is not real, and it will believe that likewise. It is the emotive core which you are seeking to emancipate, and it is very selfish. You need merely explain the benefits to be gained, and 'I' will be served up on a platter. However, this can be a very confusing time for the emotive core, a very real identity crisis. The right kind of environment is of great importance in this respect.

So even in the absence of 'I', we are reawakening functioning that was suspended in the midst of great crisis. Things certainly get worse before they get better. The process will eventually confront great existential fear, and we must relax and apply profound understanding. We must understand that it is all a paper dragon. There must be a clear understanding of what to expect, of the kinds of very strong desires and aversions, the powerful processes saying "something is wrong!" And this is where we see a lot of wasted effort. All this is what Joe average is quite unaware of, he/she just wants to be happy. People head off in the right direction, but it feels bad, and so they turn back in fear. Who knows how many brave people have come so close, but not quite made it?

We can now begin to see the strange and seemingly contradictory nature of this transition. How it is both profoundly easy, and profoundly difficult. We can see why this process is an incredible feat in one sense, and very ordinary in another. We can see that the fear encountered along the way is both real and unreal at the same time. It is, paradoxically, an entirely safe path - but also one which demands and requires an awesome degree of real courage.

So that is the subjective perception of the 'zone' through which we must travel, but what about the resulting state? What is the subjective experience beyond the balance point?

In many ways, this whole transition can be seen as almost identical to any typical deep process transfer of attachment. These transfers happen all the time, and we hardly notice unless they are dramatic, or unless they get obstructed somehow.

We generally only worry about losing an object of fulfilment if we do not have anything to replace it with. This is what causes us to seek to get back what was lost, or to integrate the loss as an active desire, which will apply pressure to find new fulfilment over time. But if another fulfilment is immediately present, and it costs no more than the one which was lost, then transfer of attachment will be easy and immediate. There will be no emotive tension involved, because need fulfilment was not threatened or thwarted. If the new fulfilment costs a little more, then there will be a slight winding up of tension in the system as the emotive core chastises the frontal self. If it costs a little less, there will be a release as a reward for the frontal self. But either way the transfer can be immediate, like when you win lotto. There is an immediate release of tension in the emotive core according to the amount of need fulfilment the wind-fall represents to the core.

We think we are making choices, but we are mostly just responding to core emotive pressures based on pure economics. From the conscious perspective, all we know is that some things feel good, and that some things don't. Thus, we get attached to some things, and become averse to others. And need fulfilment, because we are organisms, is always perceived to be a relationship to something - some object or relational exchange.

The subjective perception of this particular transition, then, is generally in alignment with this. As we have seen with the spiritual search, we are generally looking to 'gain' something. To 'get' whatever it is that we want. So the subjective perception of this realisation is that of being a transfer of attachment to an object of fulfilment. From the conscious frontal perception, this is experienced just like any other transfer of emotive attachment. And the object of this, the ultimate transfer? It must be an amazing thing, what could it be? Well, not quite what you expect actually.

This process is not actually a transfer. There is actually no object of fulfilment found. This entire agenda is resolved to nothing. It is a negation of the entire agenda, not a fulfilment of it. This is why the system cannot understand it, because there is simply no precedent for such a dramatic positive shift at an emotional level with such little demand at a relational level. So this is a seriously different view to any normally adopted by any typical form of 'search'. It is not what we expect. Not a fulfilment of the agenda which drives our search, but a negation of it.

For millions of years we have been programmed to associate great results with great effort. Evolution expects significant gain to cost significant action. This kind of solution is never even suspected. And questioning the reality of the incumbent 'I' is also never considered. The whole idea is counter intuitive, right where you would never expect it, right in the heart of the most profound surrender. It is right there, in the most obvious place. But we just don't see it. The entire dilemma is something we are actively doing, thus we need merely stop doing it.

So the secondary agenda does not get fulfilled, it gets gone. And what has it all come from? What is its ultimate substance? Nothing. The entire crisis and all of its associated containments ultimately just dissolves back into nothing at all. Like a rice bubble in your mouth, you chew it up but don't get to swallow anything. Nothing. Simply the absence of something. That's all that's left. In this case, the absence of certain activities of mind and emotion and action.

However, with no way to possibly understand what is happening here, the general subjective perception is that 'fulfilment' was finally found for the existential agenda. That the attachment found a home at last. Like falling in love, the emotive core

literally bonds to this object of fulfilment. A deep love, a profound attachment, resulting in fathomless bliss and affection. For this is the subjective experience of it. Somehow, something has been able to fulfil all these needs, and cost nothing at all. To offer more emotional fulfilment than any relational state or worldly circumstance ever could. Ten times more, for no relational change or cost. This is what it feels like, and it is natural that it would be interpreted this way. Unfortunately, this perception also tends to support the fallacy driven search.

And what is this 'object'? It has been given many mystical names throughout the ages by those who have touched it, defined as the 'true source or nature of being', the 'final substance of Self', the 'ground of purest awareness', the final resting place of the 'Atman'- The Mirror Void, Emptiness, Nothingness, Peace, Tranquillity, Stillness, ...and many ancient names with similar connotations. Some mystical emptiness that escapes all language and definition. And finding or connecting with this becomes the goal of the fallacy driven search for 'enlightenment'.

But it is in fact just nothing. Just plain old everyday nothing. The needs were never there, and thus were not fulfilled. This nothing is simply nothing! So this is the ultimate object of emotive attachment, if you viewed it as such. **Attachment = cost over gain relationally.** And this gives everything at an existential level, it fulfils all such agenda's requirements, and costs nothing at all in relational terms to be maintained. So the result is a profound attachment bond which anchors the realisation. It anchors effortlessness as the primary demand, and stillness as the primary object of attachment. So on this, its final journey at the helm of an emotive agenda, 'I' finds everything it has been looking for in its own true nature - nothingness. All the primary attachment generated at the foundations of the existential agenda are collected up and fulfilled in this single rapture. And is that nothingness something 'ultimate'? Something 'mystical'? No. The reality of 'I' is simply nothing at all. That is its substance. So what it finds is not some 'mystical void' at all. Nothing is just nothing. Just plain old everyday nothing.

We now have some idea, then, of how this shift manages to be so permanent, and what stops the whole thing from just coming back. Simply because the destination is a much better place to be. And because, as the ball moves toward the positive end of the wedge, the emotive core gets to experience a very distinct polarity in functioning. It gets to see and feel the consequences of its options. 'I' = crisis and pain. No 'I' = no problem, peace. And the emotive core is very selfish. In subjective terms this is a release of unprecedented magnitude, and the emotive core isn't about to go out of its way to undo it. And it really would have to go out of its way. It is probably even more difficult to get back into this dilemma than it is to get out of it. You would have to really want to be in it. So there is not only a hump or hill separating these two states, but also a distinct height difference. Remember, in the models I am employing here, height means stress. And the native state is FAR LESS stressful than the common state. But the hill which separates the two is FAR MORE stressful than the common state. Unfortunate but true. This is what prevents us from simply rolling toward a better place. This very stable 'bowl' dynamic is the common human dilemma in a nutshell.

PICKING THROUGH THE WRECKAGE

At this point we have pretty much laid the foundations for understanding the typical human state, both in terms of what might be wrong with it, but also what might be done about that. And if you have been able to even broadly grasp some of the implications of just the very broad outlines offered, then you will already realise that we could now begin to unpack even just a few of its basic implications endlessly in a sense, they are just so deep.

In the end it is either basically correct, or basically not. There is very little middle ground either theoretically or practically speaking. And what this means is that people will tend to have only one of two basic approaches to all of this. They will either embrace curiosity, or fear. Which, in other words means that they will either decide to look at this underlying issue more deeply, in a rational and curious way - or they will simply decide to dramatise that very thing further as they throw up their hands in denial and avoidance. Which is, of course, not any kind of challenge - that is obviously just further proof. And yet, ignorance will not recognise ignorance as being ignorant, I suppose that is one of the things that makes ignorance ignorant in the first place. It only ever looks good from the inside, but from the outside it just looks like ignorance, or perhaps even just cowardice.

In any case, this is one part we cannot determine. The way people will react to this awareness appears to simply be defined by the degree of integrity they have managed to maintain over a lifetime, all of which results in a kind of summary tendency, a bit like a piece of wood that has become waterlogged over time - in the end it will either sink, or it will float.

For those who basically float (the only people we need to concern ourselves with here) there will be a basic thrust toward further exploration and insight over time, a kind of unavoidable itch that needs to be scratched, as one bit of information that makes sense leads naturally to the next bit, etc. And eventually they will be left facing the summary fork in the road that defines this entire situation, which is that there is either a profound possibility for individual and collective change that is standing right in front of us in a sense - or there isn't. There is really no middle ground in this sense. And if there is, then all of a sudden we see a dramatic shift in the moral landscape we tend to inhabit, along with grounds for profound unity of vision between all those who have become aware that this possibility exists.

Basically, the game is on, and the path is set. Which means that the adventure of a lifetime has begun. And with that, assuming that all of this stands up to scrutiny, there is really little point in seeking to offer any kind of meaningful closure here, in that we are now only reaching the beginning in that context, not the end. There is a huge amount yet to cover here, with most of what has been outlined thus far only having been necessary to bring people up to speed as it were, and with all of the really important stuff yet to come. But all of that must now be reserved for a far more engaged and collective exploration of this territory, and in completely different terms. All I have been doing here is just setting the stage for that conversation to begin in earnest.

Therefore, perhaps the best I can do now is just to offer a few of my own musings in relation to all of this, as we begin to step back from it at this point and let the dust settle a bit. Just be aware that the real conversation, if ever there is going to be one, will necessarily involve you personally in some direct sense. Due to the very nature of what is being proposed here, the only true exploration of this subject matter occurs not on any written page, but directly within yourself, and especially in dialogue with others. So that is where you will find all of this, if ever you want to find such.

In the meantime, I can only offer a few of my own random observations, summaries, and impressions.

Two states

What we see here, then, is effectively two quite distinct human states. Very different, both very stable. As different as coal and diamond - same stuff, different organisation. A situation which seriously alters the foundations of almost every attempt we have made to define what is 'normal' human behaviour. And it solves many longstanding debates about what should be considered acceptable or even possible in human terms. Because many of the rules which apply to the common state simply do not apply to the native state. They operate very differently. Almost as if they were different organisms. So there is much to explore here about what is innate to humanity.

The difference between these two states is not immediately evident as we cross the balance point which separates them. Because at that point we are generally being swayed by strong turbulence (desires, aversion, pressure, crisis in fact). But over time there is a dramatic divergence. The same patterns do not apply. But the balance point is not some great leap. And is often a point of highest stress. Not a change in the weather, but in the climate. The eternal winter finally breaks, not with summer immediately, but in the midst of a powerful storm, beyond which there is a gradual emergence of spring.

So this is the potential I am discussing. From the common state to the native state. And it can be defined. Every transition is a process, with a beginning, a middle and an end.

So can people really change? Yes. Experiences can and do change people, both for better and for worse. Yes, even dramatic or fundamental change is possible.

So can it happen? Yes. Even without much understanding, for the exceedingly brave.

Without understanding however, there are many misconceptions. And these need to be tidied up a bit. Concerning particularly what this potential is, and what it is not.

The resulting state, then? It is nothing like the common state at all in terms of the subjective experience of it. It is a state swooning in bliss, deep in feeling, displaying clear and reliable integrity.

How can we explain this, what have we gained? NOTHING. This is simply the undisturbed native state, free of conflict. Nothing whatsoever has been achieved. We have simply stopped achieving the active and self generated disturbance. We have relaxed it, relinquished it.

You don't 'get' it, then, in the sense of acquiring something. It is nothing you add to what you have. There is nothing about it that is not already present. It is an absence. Just plain old peace! Ordinary, nothing added. Simply an absence of frantic inner activity. Really nothing special, but also a very marked contrast to the common state.

So what is the principal difference between most people and someone who has made this particular transition? It is that all the active or suspended processes of desire and attachment in the typical person - whilst fully active in the native person - are actively anchored in the singular and appropriate fulfilment structure - Nothingness. Those in the native state are completely in love with this, absolutely attached, fully embraced. This is their most significant single defining characteristic. The whole subversive agenda has been completely consumed in this fixation. They have fallen completely in love with nothing at all! So what can a 'realizer' do that an ordinary person cannot? NOTHING.

It must be recognised the significance of what we are discussing here. The secondary agenda is huge and sweeping. It is a massive limitation to natural subjective functioning. If you could package this realisation and sell it for one million dollars each, what would you get for your money? Nothing at all.

But would it be worth it? HELL YES. Every dollar.

So the most striking aspect of a realiser's character is hard to pin down. Precisely because it is not a presence, but an absence. It is not something they do, it is what they don't do. There's simply something missing. This emptiness is their residing quality. Their realisation is simply that they have stopped realising the creation of imagined subjective identity.

Thus, when this occurs, 'I' becomes realised as merely an optional function, rather than a self existing reality.

No Panacea

The common human dilemma is a problem only in that it is a negation of something positive. That is the thing to be focused on. If we become too focused on the negativity, as we have done in this entire work, we risk throwing out the baby with the bathwater. You can have this realisation and still not have an integrated vision. It simply removes the cage, but does not make the bird fly to freedom. There is a potential of removing the protagonist, but not re-establishing what was lost. 'Enlightenment', or whatever you want to call it, is no panacea. It is not everything, it simply shoots the wild animal which has been loose in your living room. There is then the rest of life, and the clean up must begin. The animal is dead, but there is still shit on the walls. This transition does NOT make you a virtuous person, just a happier one. The native state is still a process of change and growth. Life goes on.

However, in the end, the same rules cannot be applied. The integrity of these two states cannot be compared. What is possible for the native state is simply not possible in the common state. They are two completely different events, and we must expect different things from each. Not so much in terms of their capacity to do things, but to 'not-do' things. States of stillness and peace which are so normal in the native state are simply impossible in the common state. And the energetic patterns which define life over time are significantly different.

Follow what you feel in the free native state?

It is generally considered healthy to accept, honour and integrate the full spectrum of our tendencies and real nature. This is considered wise and balanced, and the overt goal of much therapeutic work. We should embrace our demons, and thereby form a healthy and rounded self image. But is this really wisdom, or simply caving in to life as defined by the common state?

So back to this one again. Should we follow what we feel in life, and allow our own deep emotive processes to flow? As we saw in sections one and two, yes. And then in section three, certainly not. So what do we see now that we have the whole picture?

Well, it's really quite simple. You are crazy if you follow your feelings without reservation in the common state. It will get you nowhere. Just struggle and strife. To live with passion in a cage is simply to repeatedly throw yourself against a cold hard wall. But in the native state all this is different. This is what is gained. The return of primary energetic integrity, life becomes a fair game once again. There is still a mess to clean up, but by and large the system actually works.

So should we follow what we feel? In the free native state, ABSOLUTELY. It's all down hill from there. You are then free to follow your bliss. In the end happiness will take you home. As it should be.

Therefore: in the common state, no, but in the native state, yes.

However, the transition between these two states is another thing again. A third consideration. What happens during this period?

Well, the unfortunate or paradoxical situation here is one of the things which make this transition so tricky emotionally. The native state is our destination, thus we need to be focusing on following what we feel. On happiness, for that is what ultimately signifies progress toward the essential balance point energetically. But because of the nature of the hill we must climb as we progress, things get worse and worse in some senses. So if we actually do follow what we feel in this context we would turn back toward the bowl!

This is why it is almost NEVER found accidentally. Because it 'feels' like the wrong way - it feels bad, so people turn back. But the right direction does feel bad! This is exactly what makes the common state self enclosing. So the sad fact is that whilst following what you feel is ultimately correct in the native state, you will never find the native state using only feelings as a guide. This is a paradox which may have no answer. It is something we may simply have to understand and learn to account for.

So this transition demands great emotional fibre and strength of character. It demands commitment and vision. Because it demands that we *not* follow what we feel in the short term, in order to follow what we feel in the long term. As with all seriously creative activities, we must be able to face fear head on, and learn to delay gratification, not by repressing desire, but by feeling and containing it.

What about desire then? Well, it would seem that there are three distinct relationships we must adopt toward it, depending on where we are - the common state, the native state, or the transition between them.

In the common state we should selectively repress large elements of what we desire, simply because they are patently dysfunctional and unhealthy. We must cut off from it and close it down.

In the native state we can fulfil desire openly and without reservation, provided we do so with integrity. We can open to it and fulfil it, flow with it and let it guide us. Embody it.

But in the transition state we must be open to it, as in the native state, but not follow it, as in the common state. If we repress it, we will never recognise or anchor the native state. But if we follow it, we will never make it up the hill.

This embodiment is the principal demand of this transition. It is the key. But to be full of active desire which we are not acting on is a definition of unhappiness.

This is the 'zone'. And this is why this transition, in its raw form, involves a degree of tension which most people are simply not accustomed to. And it is only by getting together to understand and penetrate the very deepest foundations of what is experienced during this transition stage that we stand to emancipate humanity from its current entrapment in the common state. To be able to either bypass, or insulate people from, this wall of emotional torture is the recipe we now need to be learning how to cook here now that the anatomy of this situation has become clear. This is the entire game now.

Inner or Outer?

Common culture tends dramatically toward the outward in its search for happiness. And this is another simmering debate going on in our culture about life, one we have touched on a couple of times during our travels here -

Does the answer lie within, or without?

Once again the answer seems simple. Attention and energy should naturally flow outward into the world of relational exchange. The mind is not designed to examine itself, in fact we appear to be the first animals to securely develop this

self-reflexive capacity. It is not how the system is supposed to work, it hurts to do this. So attention should naturally reside in the world. Relational exchange is the answer. That is the very purpose of mind after all. The answer lies outside us. But I am speaking of the native state here, not the common state.

As it turns out, it is fortunate that we can turn attention back within ourselves, that our minds can bend back far enough to see. Because if we couldn't, we might stand no chance at all of returning to the native state. You see, in the common state, the answer does lie within, but only because the problem lies within.

So attention should be naturally outward flowing, but there has arisen a problem within, which means that this must be addressed and resolved before that outward flow is once again established naturally. So is turning inward the answer? YES! In the common state. Because in the common state the outward flow has been obstructed, and that obstruction comes from within.

However, this inward turning action should never be interpreted as something virtuous in and of itself. It is merely a necessary evil.

Many, driven by the pain and struggle of the common state, seek escape from life and turn inward seeking such. They seek this great mystical emptiness, final release for the worldly bonds which bind them. But this is a huge mistake! Surrender is not surrender into nothing. Only the crap dissolves to nothing. The reality of the organism is relational life, and this is what it returns to, free of this huge weight. It is released into creativity, activity, the body, and life - a roaring river of action and relational exchange. Not 'salvation', not 'release' from the body. No, release INTO the body!

So those who believe it is 'spiritual' to go and sit in a cave somewhere have sort of missed the whole point. The final answer is to regain what has been lost due to the presence of this secondary agenda. To really live.

Happiness is the only final answer. To live life fully.

However, the stillness we must find in this process does demand a certain quietude, and this may require a situation of peace. One profound moment of stillness. So the process we are discussing is from A to B, via C. The positivity is the point, but the obstruction must be cleared for that to occur freely. So point C is to transit the balance point.

What are we seeking to achieve then? What is the goal of 'practice'? Simply a single moment of stillness, nothing more. You don't even have to stay there. Just get there once.

This is not mental stillness however, it is a complete clearing of the emotional decks, the equivalent of rebooting your computer. All your programs need to be shut down before you do it.

Subjective activity is naturally sporadic, it is event based. Spirals of activity arise on the basis of demand, they do their work, and then resolve again back into free energy. Thought subsides back into its primary state - feeling. But what the common state amounts to is one or many processes which were once begun, but never closed or put to rest. So even when needs have been met, there is no stillness possible. All these activities remain frozen in stasis.

'I' is an activity. The emotional agenda flowing from 'I' is an activity. And the containments of that agenda are all energetically loaded. It is a bit like having music playing that you don't like, so you play louder music over the top of it. But every time you stop, you hear the music you don't like again, so you keep playing loud music. But they say the most beautiful sound of all is silence. And this is what we cannot have in the common state.

This, then, is what we must find.

So how can we be sure we have cleared the decks of suspended processes? With just a single moment of true stillness.

With all authentic needs met prior, all active efforts can be relaxed. If authentic needs are secure, no matter what comes up, it can simply be felt into and relaxed, relinquished. It is all redundant. This is just the clearing of redundant baggage. Like rebooting your computer when the programs become corrupted, as I say. All activity must consciously cease for just one moment in time. Just once. This spontaneous and complete conscious stillness is what the native state can do, that the common state cannot. The healthy system is capable of this, the conflicted system is not. It is a normal capacity in the native state. Just look at a cat after it has been fed.

Death is a remarkable metaphor for this process. For it literally requires nothing of us. Emotive stillness = ease. Complete and deep release of effort. It is entirely 'hands off'. And it is not dangerous! We do this all the time, every time we enter deep sleep. Only this time we are awake when we experience it.

In the transition from the native state to the common state it is no use aiming for the balance point, for we will only fall short. The balance point is just somewhere on the way to this place of stillness.

This should be our destination. One moment of stillness. The end of the wedge. When we get here, we are necessarily out of the trap. And only then are we free to decide what else life has to offer. The balance point just happens somewhere along the way. We must find the bliss in the energy, and the way to do that is to be completely still. Just once. Mind is all about achieving something. So it is safe and appropriate to simply relinquish it all if needs are met.

This is a capacity worth having.

How much struggle can the mind produce? Relax it and find out. How can it hurt, if needs are already securely met? What possible harm could this do? After all, we are not 'doing' something, just 'not-doing' something. And we already do this for many hours every day when we sleep. So we are not seeking to suspend activity, but to feel into and relinquish all active programs or unfinished processes. Just once. A remarkably simple process.

When do you 'let go' then? How do you know when you have reached the balance point? You don't! You do not need to let go. Resistance and struggle is an inevitable part of the process. The closer you get, the stronger the desire to just let go. Letting go will just happen at some point of fatigue along the way to one moment of stillness. Simply because what you are letting go of, is activity. So just go for the stillness. All the rest just happens. Letting go is not something you do. It just happens to you along the way.

Humour

A good joke is commonly described as an artificial build up of tension, leading to an often sudden shift in perspective associated with a release. Laughter is very similar to crying, it is basically the same physical action. They are both associated with deep emotive processes. In the case of laughter – a transfer associated with a release of tension. With common humour we generally build ourselves up, in order just to let ourselves go and experience the fall. We do this by jumping to a transcendent position, and looking back at the same thing from a new position. Humour is a transcendent state of being.

With this in mind, we could even say this -

This whole thing, the common state with all its artificial tension and stress built out of nothing, the native state lying hidden beneath, and the transition between them with its sudden realisation and release....it is a joke! It is just a fucking JOKE! The joke of a lifetime.

The final answer to life's biggest problem is not what you expect. That's what people say when they finally realise.....No, no it couldn't be! It couldn't be just that! Not that simple... and then they start laughing hysterically. They laugh for days, weeks, even months. Deep laughter, from the heart of life. But there is perhaps nothing more sad than a truly funny joke that nobody ever gets.

The Bigger Picture

With some appreciation now of the two potential human states, and what the transition between them may demand, we can turn our attention once again to the implications of all this at a cultural level. In section three we briefly examined the impact of the common state on the way culture emerges and functions in general, and we can now extend this once again to look at what this dramatic alternative could mean to human society as a whole.

In many ways, the human collective acts just like the individual organism. It is a closed system, and operates in a very similar way, displaying many of the same characteristics. Perhaps because it is ultimately just a group of individuals, and therefore merely reflects the functioning of its constituent parts.

So how does everything we have addressed thus far relate to the collective? How does it play out? And what could it all mean?

Once again, let's start with the problem, the culture defined by the common state –

There has always been much talk about 'one world'. People use the term 'humanity' as if they are speaking of a single body or group. But take a look around. We seem to be terminally divided as a species, scattered and fractured into parts which never seem to fit together.

At a collective level we see many efforts to find some common ground between people, to unify humanity into a single body or voice. Looking for things on which we can all agree. Some point of common reference, a single shared vision. We all intuitively sense the power and freedom which would come from such unity, and many have sought to find ways to realise that potential.

Every new level of psycho-social development over time has brought with it new hope. New forms of worldview, and new potentials for understanding and finding common ground. And progress has been made. Reason and science, proposing a singular reality, were our most recent great hopes. But even reason has failed to achieve this unity. So why? Because it is not valid? No. I believe this is simply because reason, in the form of science, has consistently failed to address humanity's true subjective problems. It has completely missed the most significant single issue facing mankind, perhaps due to its outward turning bias toward everything objective. It has therefore continued to confront problems it cannot solve, and has also failed to be adopted universally. Mythic-literal belief systems (more primitive and erroneous worldviews) still abound. Meaning that whilst some alignment is often found, even in the face of great diplomacy and compromise, deep conflict and discord often remains insurmountable overall. Efforts to find simple unity of vision have failed time and time again, leaving a situation of quiet despair. We simply don't seem to be able to bring ourselves together in any truly unified way.

Does all this sound familiar? In the individual, the 'frontal self' is the function responsible for meeting the emotive agenda defined by the conflicted and confused organism, and which suffers from being given a task which is simply not possible to fulfil. We saw how the formation of desire has become inherently conflicted. A state which reflects the underlying energetic conflict within the system. And a state which leaves the organism with little or no chance of ever finding any point of relational fulfilment.

Here we see a very similar thing. At a collective level, those in charge of governing collective change confront the same thing, in very similar terms. The structure of politics directly reflects the way functions are elected within the individual organism. In fact many elements of these two systems can be compared. Leaders of government are the individual functions which make up the 'frontal self' of the 'collective organism'. And like the frontal self of the individual organism, they are destined to squabble and scrap over agendas they do not even understand. Of course, they do not realise this, either in themselves, or in relation to culture. But they suffer from it in just the same way as the frontal self suffers in ignorance of the real problem it confronts.

Just like the common human dilemma at an individual level, I believe this situation is not intrinsic to who we are. That this is merely another reflection of the common human dilemma. The same thing at a wider level. Very real, but not innate. It is simply that the individual components of society are dynamically conflicted at a deep level, and that the practical agenda this produces is naturally reflected at the level of social organisation and change. However - and this is the point - trying to impose order or integrity whilst this remains the case at an individual level is simply pointless. There is a direct connection here. After all, there is no collective without the individuals which make it up. There are, in fact, only individuals. And under the circumstances as we now know them to be at an individual level, an integrated vision for the world, accepted by all the world's people, is simply a pipe dream. We don't know what we want at a global level, precisely because we don't know what we want as individuals, and for exactly the same reason. Because integrity of vision must come from integrity at the core, and the core of the collective, is the individual.

Energy

If we look beneath the surface of collective functioning, beneath the surface of politics and power, once again we see the same basic factors. Just as with the individual, all collective functioning is oriented around the accumulation and management of energy. In collective terms this is economics. In the individual, need fulfilment equates to energy and resources, and the systemic currency which represents such is free energy and attention - 'feeling'. In economic terms it is very similar, energy and resources are the basis of our economies, and the systemic currency which represents such is obvious - money. These two, money and feeling, reflect each other directly.

Just as we saw that the individual conflict revolved around energy management, the same can be observed at a collective level. And here we see the dilemma for the politicians and statesmen. Like the frontal self of the individual, they are charged with facilitating economic prosperity and collective wealth. But if they ever actually achieve this they end up producing great stress in the population. We all think we want to be rich, to have energy and resources to burn, but this is not the case. Poverty and fatigue are at least partly things we actively generate ourselves, albeit unconsciously. They are both products of our own unconscious agenda. Common culture is designed and generated to support the common state. And if you upset common culture, you upset the state of those depending on it for their delicate equilibrium.

Too much positive functioning at a collective level has the same effect as in the individual, and we have seen where that can lead. So what happens in the individual when there is too much energy? Too much health? As we have seen - CRISIS. It is exactly the same for this 'global organism' made up of a few billion such beings. In the individual we see the obsessive compulsive cycle in response to too much energy and integrity, at the collective level we see the endless cyclic oscillation: depression - war - boom - depression - war - boom.....simply a reflection of the underlying common state of every individual which makes that collective what it is.

I believe it becomes obvious now why a point of unity or integrity remains elusive. Because just like the individual, the collective does not primarily suffer from any particular absence, but from the presence of a distinct negativity. And just as we saw, to seek to impose positive functioning in this situation, without first addressing the source of resistance, is effectively futile. Just like there can be no outer-relational solution to the individual dilemma. We may seek to impose some

integrity by force or coercion, but in the end there can be no political solution to this problem. Simply because the problem is not actually at the political level. It is far below that level in the hearts of those who elect and overthrow leaders. The issues faced at the collective level are merely symptoms of a deeper problem, and will never be resolved until they are addressed at source. That is, in the individuals themselves.

So we search for unity and agreement and action initiatives to effect much needed global change, but nothing ever actually happens. Simply because no amount of political action will ever solve the underlying problems facing humanity at this time. This is why the UN remains perpetually hogtied by its own member states. Simply to stop it from doing more damage than good. Remember the ball in the bowl. Well our entire human culture is in that same bowl, which means that too much positive change produces mysterious crises and political overthrow. It can be very dangerous.

Free Energy

Energy resources are a good example of this. At present, energy is scarce. And our current global economy revolves around this scarcity. Thus, if we want energy, we must all pay for what we require. And this cost is presumed to be one of the primary limitations to global prosperity. If energy was free and we did not have to rely on fossil fuels, we could simply fly food to Africa endlessly, pump water from anywhere to anywhere, and immediately reduce greenhouse emissions by 95%. Energy is the principal scarcity which accounts for much suffering and limitation in the world.

Consequently, there is much talk of the potential for producing 'free energy' in some way. Like 'cold fusion', some mechanism or process by which energy might become effectively limitless, and virtually free. And is that possible? Yes, it may well be. Many believe it is probably only a matter of time.

So wouldn't that be wonderful! Limitless energy! Imagine that! Many proclaim it as the answer to all our problems. But can you see the implications here? Common culture is the way it is, precisely because we need it to be that way. For energy to become free would incapacitate any mechanism by which the masses are keeping themselves poor and fatigued. And you might think that is a good thing, but it is most certainly not. Those mechanisms, just like their subjective counterparts, are serving a vital function in the face of significant negative potentials.

All of which means that we are in exactly the same situation collectively as we are individually, and that some of the most positive potentials paradoxically pose the greatest threats. In this case, however, the unfortunate situation is that the single most significant positive breakthrough in our near future - free energy - could easily produce a global crisis. A disaster even. Because the result would eventually be a liberation of energy at an individual level, and thus the animation of an unstoppable surge of addictive consumption as billions of people suddenly plunged into existential crisis. Even in our present dampened state, we are consuming the resources of the planet at many times their sustainable rate. So to take the brakes off in this way would be like turning up the temperature on a pressure cooker, and something would eventually have to give.

This is just one example of many. With a few obvious differences, the overall pattern is just the same. Positive functioning produces crisis. This is the common state. We ultimately confront the same issue then - that we must first address the real source of our struggle, for only then will we be free to fulfil our natural potential at a collective level.

So at the collective level we see the fallacy once again. But we do not suffer from the absence of something, but the presence of something. The fallacy says that something must be absent. Some say that we do not have the technology required to organise ourselves better, and they therefore seek even more sophisticated models and organisational strategies. Whereas others say that we have become too technological, and that we should return to the earth, to a simpler life. But neither of these is the case. The potential is already there for the kind of global integrity we are seeking. But just like our individual state, our real potential is being actively disturbed. And there is no answer whilst this situation remains. There is no political solution to our global problems, because they do not come from political sources.

True social alignment and integrity cannot be imposed, at least not for long. For there is no primary level integrity to support it. So global culture as a whole, when viewed as a single organism, is in the same common state as defined above. Because common culture reflects the common individual, and always will. Which means that if we want to see what is really wrong with the world, we ultimately have no choice but to look hard in the mirror.

So this is the hard answer. If we want to change the world, we must first be prepared to clean up our own backyard. Because the only final answer to collective problems is individual change. In particular, the only final solution to all of our major issues is this individual realisation, and the profound personal transformation implied.

The fallacy driven view of collective humanity is forever condemned to chase its own tail in search of integrity, because it is a view which presupposes that the fundamental unit or denominator of social fabric must be the common state - i.e. a being in functional crisis. It presumes this to be normal and inescapable. But the possibility of reducing the common state back to the native state offers an entirely different view of global potential.

So surely this realisation, when it starts to become more prevalent, will be received with great enthusiasm by common culture! After all it would seem to be the solution we have been seeking, and to be entirely healthy and thoroughly benign. Well, that would be nice, but can you really picture that? No, just as the return of healthy integrity in the individual system stimulates residual tensions to arise, the same will no doubt happen at a cultural level.

Social Resistance

There are many elements of the individual human dilemma which have become firmly institutionalised as part of our global culture, and the emergence of healthy elements will necessarily disturb the equilibrium of the status quo. They will no doubt generate significant resistance over time as they progress toward the recovery of true global integrity.

This movement will inevitably confront strong emotionally loaded belief systems, and will even polarise culture - because, as a potential, it is so dramatically divergent at such a deep level. And it is worth studying this, if only because it will help us to see how this potential, when realised in individuals, will be reacted to by common culture in general. This will naturally be resisted and even deeply feared, even though it is completely harmless. Which means that the unfortunate consequence of any culture founded on this potential will be significant resistance, especially from the most dysfunctional elements of global culture. And this is to be expected. In some ways it simply confirms the validity of the potential itself.

Two Paths

At a personal level, the implications of the possibility I am discussing here, because it indicates two distinct functional states, mean that every person faces a dramatic choice. And people do not like having choices thrust upon them, many feel safe in their stable negative equilibrium. But there really is a choice here, and we may not be able to avoid confronting it.

At present, most people do not even realise there is an option, they are simply resigned to life in the common state. But I believe this is all about to change. The second less common path is currently only an overgrown track which very few have the courage to travel, but with sufficient social support and insight, it could be about to become a highway. And the implications of this at a social level are somewhat dramatic, to say the least. It is a very dramatic choice, especially one you recognise the social significance of what is being proposed here. The secondary agenda, and the common state in general, is very different from the native state. And you don't generally see tadpoles and frogs hanging around together.

There is a clear choice we will all confront as this potential becomes accessible – We must all decide whether to remain in the common state, or to seek a life beyond it. And you must decide, for there is nothing in between.

The fundamental human dilemma does not simply resolve itself spontaneously, at least not very often. It generally demands clear commitment and deliberate intention. It is no doubt the harder path in the short term, but the higher path, and by far the more rewarding path. But you may say you are not sure, that you are not committed to either, and that you don't want to choose. But that lack of commitment or clarity is itself a decision. If you are not for it, then you are against it by default. Your destination is one or the other. You are either committed to moving beyond the common state, or you are not. There are two distinct paths here, and we are all travelling only one of them. For you are either in the common state or the native state, and there is nothing in between. You can choose any version of the common life, or you can choose this. You are in the dilemma, or not. It is one or the other.

As this choice expresses itself in social terms then, we see two distinct paths emerging. A path, as I am using the term, is defined not by its origin, as much as by its destination point. So the arising of this potential at an accessible level in global culture will no doubt polarise society to some degree. This seems unavoidable. There are two paths indicated, and not all will choose the same one.

So we seem to have just about two of everything! Two realities, two agendas, two states...and now two paths. In teasing the native from the added we seem to have cleaved life down the middle. Which in the end has left us with this choice, it is one or the other. Two paths resulting in two states, two states which are very different indeed.

So can these two states coexist? What are the social implications? What kind of culture does the native state support? Well, the biggest obvious differences seem to be energetic, and philosophical.

Common culture is set up to support the common state. But the culture which becomes naturally possible with the native state as its common denominator will not function in the same way at all. An entirely different cultural structure becomes available. And in some senses these two cultures are as different as chalk and cheese. They are very different in many ways, and in some ways, not compatible at all. Not a conflict necessarily, as much as a divide. A gap in understanding, and in values.

The shift to the native state is not just a belief system, but an energetic transition with deep functional implications. And whilst this transition has massive significance subjectively, it also has great practical significance. Relational integrity is

returned, which means that on a transactional level, where people meet, the two states are not very compatible. The things which are easy and natural for those in the native state, will inevitably perturb and threaten those in the common state. Simply because they are natural and healthy. You tend to become what you meditate on, and being exposed to this way of being means that it will be very difficult not to begin to vibrate to that other frequency.

Such would naturally begin to shift your own common state toward healthy functioning. You would get your ball pushed up the hill, not intentionally, but inherently, unavoidably. So this will be very uncomfortable to be around if the native state is not your destination. Because for the common state, this is a recipe for crisis and stress. You would get all your 'buttons pushed'.

We even find this kind of stress between people in the common state who have slight differences in the way they manage their own containment. Gym junkies vs couch potatoes etc. But here we are talking about a huge difference.

The philosophical differences are also quite important. Because such will inevitably define whether this potential is viewed as positive or threatening. The ideals associated with the second path - to make the native state part of your goal in life - define a very different value system to that commonly adopted, and a very different style of being. We see two very different basic approaches to life in general, two quite distinct paradigms or worldviews.

The whole idea proposes an entirely different view of what is important in life, and how to get closer to that. Traditional value systems simply go out the window. It changes the rules of the game. It is another playing field altogether, and this will no doubt pick up some resentment from many 'winners' when they realise where they are placed along this second continuum. It may be very hard for someone with ten million dollars in his bank account to accept that the bag lady sleeping under his car may potentially be closer to this realisation than he is! And that could well be the case, after all, the primary difference between the common state and the native state is almost entirely subjective. And those who are most stable and relaxed in the common state are probably nowhere near the balance point.

The response of common culture to this potential, if it is not understood, is likely to be some degree of reservation, if only because it represents such a dramatic change, and because people are afraid of change. Especially deep personal change. The transition from one functional state to another is, or implies, massive disturbance of the under-structure of life, and those who choose it must be prepared to relinquish all the functional remnants of the secondary agenda. Which means significant disturbance of the status quo. So there is much to lose in the transition to the native state. It is a radical re-formulation of the underlying core levels of your life, and will unavoidably impact on relational surface structures. It's like changing the foundations, with the house already built.

It is perhaps easiest to observe the impact of a second choice at an individual level. This level of social interaction serves as a kind of microcosm of what we are discussing at a broader level, and it is also one most people are intensely interested in. So I will take a moment to briefly address the social implications of this realisation at an intimate level.

Close Relationships

All our relationships with others are based on contracts, whether they be spoken or unspoken, conscious or unconscious. We like people if they play our game, and they like us if we play theirs. There is always a mutual transaction, and over time familiar patterns emerge which result in deepening trust and commitment of energy. And it is these deeper connections I want to address here.

The foundation of any committed relationship is familiarity. The basic contract is –

I am **this**, you are **that**, let's do **x** and **y** and **z** together!

This is the basis of any connection or shared vision. When you enter into a co-creation of any kind, you bring to the table your own individual desires, which are then woven in to become part of some larger vision. And people will only invest energy in a connection with you if they feel they know who you are in this core sense. So it could be said that in some sense, by forming a commitment, you are promising to be who you are. To remain the same. For what defines a person, over the long term, is what they want. Desire is what defines change over time. And this is where we see the trouble emerging – Change.

Generally speaking, change is antithetical to stable connections with others. Especially deep level personal change. You can change your hairstyle, no problem. But you can be in for big trouble if you change your fundamental values or aspirations in life. For these are the things we bank on in each other, the things which truly define us in the social sense.

So in some ways, deep personal change is very threatening to the social fabric. If we do not remain who others have known us to be we are often perceived to have violated trust, to have abandoned others in some way. Such change can seriously rupture our connections to others, and they will inevitably protest. It is natural that others will seek to push us back and keep us the same.

You might think that trouble would only result from negative change - changes which place you further apart from someone. But really, any change is disturbing. The whole suggestion that people change is somewhat disconcerting to us. We usually try to avoid this fact because of the emotional implications. Interpersonal relationships simply and innately abhor change. But change is a reality. People change at different rates, and some even try not to change at all. But it happens anyway. People are always changing. Change is a universal constant. To believe that you do not change is in some sense to be about as lost as you can be.

So what is the answer to this? How can we prevent natural change from eroding our connections to others over time? Well, it would seem that we can't. Change is a fact. The only thing we can do to protect relationships over time is to understand and accommodate change. We must be prepared to continually reinvent our relationships, in full awareness that who you are today is not who you were yesterday, or whenever you last came together and shared your truth.

So the key to surviving change would seem to be to find people who are going to be growing or changing in the same direction. But which direction is that? To be sure of that you would have to both know your destination point.

So how can we know where someone else is heading? How do we know how their path is going to progress, or if we are going to grow apart over time? Well, in the common state, it is not easy. The scattered integrity of the common state is what makes lasting connections very difficult to maintain. None of the lines are straight, and people often do not really know where they are heading. The very best you can do is to seek some common destination point, and see where you end up over time. But if that destination point is somewhere inside the common state, as it is bound to be, you will inevitably be destined for eventual struggle. For there are many potential variations and destinations within the common state, and **none** of them are worth realising. The only stable point is in the centre of the bowl, in an unhappy place. Which means even that place is not really stable, because we will eventually seek something more, making the likelihood of both proximity and trajectory over time small indeed. So the unfortunate net result of the common state, in social terms, is that if you find someone at close proximity, someone you immediately like, that you will very likely grow apart over time. In the common state, trajectories cross and then usually diverge. Even with a clear common vision, sooner or later one or both of you will realise that the common goal of your connection is not worth reaching, at which point your paths will diverge. Or you may head off again in another direction together, exploring unhappiness even further.

In fact this pretty much sums up most primary relationships or close connections in the common state. For we are motivated by two agendas, not one, and we tend to choose people for reasons we are often not even aware of. We are often as much motivated by the secondary agenda as we are by the native. Even more so perhaps. The secondary agenda is very powerful, and a massive proportion of our relationships are structured to support its requirements.

Overall, we only choose people who are compatible with our own style of containment. Because they help us feel good about our sad and lifeless existence. Because they function to support us in our artificial happiness. Because they help us to contain the crisis we are seeking to avoid, or somehow make it easier to carry. And this is a huge factor in all personal relationships. As already indicated, romantic love is almost entirely sourced in the secondary agenda. It 'mysteriously' makes you feel great. If only we realised what was going on underneath to produce that effect.

Ultimately, the secondary agenda displaces massive energy into our connections with others, at many levels. All of which creates trouble in some way, as it is all surplus to healthy connections with others. This agenda so powerfully influences our behaviour in relation to others that we don't even realise it is happening, or why we keep having trouble with others. And these patterns and underlying rackets can be refined over time to become very complex and deeply rooted relational dysfunction. One of the reasons we often can't see this in ourselves is because we have often done it our whole lives, having learned it from our family of origin. Many powerful forms of relational dysfunction are trans-generational, and come from the past like dominos falling. And with the weight of many generations bearing down on us, it can sometimes be difficult to stay up straight, even when we become aware of it. The secondary agenda is always pushing for us to succumb to the temptation of involving others in our own subjective dramas. And our families teach us how, some more than others. All this is what makes people 'dysfunctional' in the interpersonal sense.

If we could examine the way our cultural and family programming has affected our transactions with others, we often see 'games', 'rackets' or 'scripts' we are playing out without even realising it. Like any other area of life, many personal transactions can be sourced in dysfunction. Even quite serious dysfunction at times. And if this is a strong tendency for us, then if others don't play these 'games', or support our particular 'racket', then we hate them. In that state we only tend to like people who will let us use them, who let us control them to suit our own emotionally loaded agendas.

Many common social institutions reflect this stuff. Normal, in terms of common culture, is not necessarily healthy. The common game, the common social contract in general, is largely dysfunctional. Society, in its typical form, is relatively sick.

In this context we can now begin to see the potential impact of the realisation I am speaking of at the most primary social level. Our entire social structure, especially our intimate connections, are arranged specifically to support only the common

state. And the native state is most certainly not the same as the common state. Up close and personal there are massive differences. The transition from the common state to the native state is a radical deep level change.

So what we see, with the introduction of this second potential, is that many life paths will become defined by such. That the destination of their lives will alter radically from seeking a potential within the common state, to seeking a life beyond it. And that this will inevitably create great social stress at the most personal level.

Those who choose the native state will gain great alignment and integrity with all who choose the same. Those who choose the common state will retain whatever alignment they have with others who choose the same. But between those who choose the native, and those who choose to remain in the common state, there will emerge a great chasm.

Which means, in the terms we have just defined, it is difficult to believe that a connection founded in the common state, and chosen on the basis of common state emotive foundations, could ever survive such a radical transition. And even if it could, that it may well have to be relinquished during the process. And this is what will cause social friction and resistance. It is simply socially disturbing.

When any two people choose different paths here you will confront a fundamental difference in worldview, and in energetic integrity. They will no longer have anything in common, and shared vision would be impossible over time. Each would become more and more perturbing to the other, which means that this whole potential will be disruptive to existing social structure as a whole as more people find it.

Just like the individual organism, we will no doubt see immediate resistance to the emergence of elements of positive integrity within the 'social system' we call human civilisation. Simply by becoming available, this potential will confront people with a choice, and that very fact will polarise culture. It is to be expected. And just like the individual system, the substance of this resistance will ultimately be found to be nothing at all.

This cultural response will probably not be of the active kind however - not the result of people having this potential thrust upon them in some zealous way by 'believers'. Quite the contrary, **belief** is not required in the presence of realisation. This potential does not produce proselytising zealots, simply because there is nothing to believe in! It is not a doctrine, but an organic potential. It is not a social phenomenon, but a personal state. And you do not need to sell it, for it sells itself. It does not require advertising or promotion.

In this regard, we can refer to the old adage - 'Those who know, don't say. Those who say, don't know.'

A culture based on this realisation would have an inherent appreciation and understanding of the common state, and that there are two choices. The very realisation itself is that there is nothing to get! So how can you sell that? This state is not idealistic, but realistic. And it has no political agenda whatsoever.

Native culture is very benign and peaceful inherently. Native culture has no interest in confronting the status quo, but will simply seek the space for itself to exist amongst it, in harmony with it.

No, just like the return of healthy integrity in the individual state, native culture will be disturbing because it is so positive. So the resistance native culture will inevitably confront will not be at an overt or political level, but more at a grassroots level. Because it will confront common culture with a potential they both want intensely on one hand, and are intensely afraid of on the other. So whilst it is very unlikely that you would ever find this potential being imposed on anyone, it does remain unavoidably disturbing to the common state for many more subtle reasons. And these are what will no doubt stimulate some response.

Once again, just like the individual state, there is actually nothing to fear. The initial form of this cultural emergence will necessarily be oriented around understanding and facilitating the transition, and this will define its most visible characteristics. And because that transition involves some degree of stress and emotional upheaval, there will likely be much misunderstanding about it in those watching from afar. But the lasting characteristic of this culture over time will become the state which results.

So is all this dangerous? Either at a personal level, or to culture as a whole? No. Only the response to it is what causes stress. People are simply afraid, especially of themselves, and this will no doubt define many actions. But this potential, or the culture which may emerge as a result, is not actually dangerous at all. It is not a threat because of what it is, but because of what it is not. It is not fake, it is not shallow, and it is not cowardly - but in a world that is all of those things and more, this might inevitably stir up a bit of misunderstanding and resentment.

Why not?

Does it all sound a bit dangerous? A bit too radical? Maybe so, but stop for a moment and consider the reality of this whole potential, and the view I have outlined in this book. It is an idea which explains many lasting paradoxes, is scientifically

compatible within an evolutionary paradigm, ecologically responsible, and which - in the process - does not deny subjective realities. Quite the contrary, it takes a shot at applying a practical and de-mystifying approach to a very significant human potential which has been well documented throughout history, but which has also historically defied rational explanation. And it explains away much misunderstanding and myth along the way.

A good theory not only explains a subject matter, but also functions to explain away all opposing theories. In terms of both mechanism and motive, I believe this work does that. It explains what people believe, and why they believe it. It defines exactly how sophisticated containment strategies have developed over millennia in response to strong and continuous social demand.

Forget the theory, what about the practice? What harm can this process do, in *your* rationale? In the end, what this work ultimately prescribes simply cannot be faulted, even if the theory was entirely wrong. It is an idea which supports physical health, social integrity, emotional equilibrium, mental stillness, developmental fulfilment, peacefulness, serenity, equanimity, self empowerment.....

The surprising practice it suggests can hardly be construed as anything but benign. The objective of the process defined here is simple and easy, and completely harmless. Just promote health and wellbeing, and be still. Just once. Very simple.

So why is something so simple, so difficult? Do it and you will find out! Do you have a better explanation? If there is nothing there, it shouldn't be a problem. What possible harm could it do? If I'm wrong, then it will be easy, won't it! So what is there to worry about?

There is simply no harm to be done if it is not true, and great potentials to be realised if it is. So there is really nothing to lose, we can only gain. For what harm could it do? If there is nothing there, then it won't hurt.

But if it is right? What if there **is** something there, and it turns out to be what I have defined? Well, then you will have risked nothing, and gained everything. In that case I'll send you the bill!

Integrity

As we examine the human collective it becomes more and more clear how accurately it reflects the individual human state. In some ways it can truly be seen as a single living system, or even as just a small part of an even greater system – the ecosystem. And when we examine the potential for widespread realisation of the native state, and what this might mean for culture as a whole, we begin to see a very similar pattern emerging to the one we saw in the individual - that humanity as a whole, in the way it organises itself, is in this same conflicted bowl. And that it also expresses resistance to the emergence of healthy functioning just like the individual. But what is not generally understood is that an entire cultural system may potentially face a similar potential to that seen in the individual - that over time, with sufficient individual realisation, islands of healthy social integrity may begin to appear in an ocean of global conflict and struggle. And that these may grow and merge to eventually become continents, that the continents may ultimately connect. And at some undefined point along the way, it may become noticed that something strange has occurred. Where there were once islands in an ocean of pain and suffering, there now seem to be isolated lakes in a landscape of social integrity. That humanity as a whole may well find its own balance point, and that all this may take is a certain critical mass of individual realisation.

If a sufficient proportion of humanity was to recover native functional integrity, an entirely new organisational potential may spontaneously emerge, delivering us into a true 'new age' - a culture which functions very differently to common culture as we know it today. A collective realisation, based on individual realisation. The 'enlightenment' of a planetary civilisation as a whole.

If we view our situation in this light, we can see that it is not only the individual who faces a choice, but also humanity as a whole. That there may well be two paths for Earth itself, and that this crossroads may be approaching.

The New World

In any living system, cells subjugate aspects of their own autonomy. They surrender a degree of their freedom. But this is not slavery, and they do not surrender their innate selfishness, for this is all done for personal gain. It is simply that the cell has a better chance to survive and prosper in a harmonious relationship with other cells. It is a win-win situation for all.

Just so with individuals in any organic collective. True global integrity will ultimately demand that each individual works in some kind of alignment with a wider plan and agenda. That they sacrifice at least a degree of autonomy, for commensurate gain overall.

We would all probably do this if we knew what the plan was, or exactly how our actions might have an effect. So feedback is the key, a direct association of sacrifice and payoff. The structures which provide this feedback in an organism are

sophisticated information networks, nerves and chemical signals. So what are the collective social equivalents? What are we going to need if we are ever going to begin to operate as a single unified body? Information networks, and a management system which people trust.

So we need a medium of information exchange, and do we have such? Well, yes, we do. At least such is emerging at present. And what about a management structure? An executive function which embodies the will of the masses, and directs collective change accordingly. Yes, we already have this capacity also.

We already have everything required in order to actualise the unity of all humanity. We have more than is required. There is in fact nothing wrong with the structures of government we already have. The problem is simply not at that level.

At the moment, the unfortunate situation is that these management functions must, at least partially, act to prevent social will from being expressed. Like the conflicted frontal self of the individual, these management functions of government are caught in the middle. They must, in order to secure the best interests of the individual, often act in direct defiance of the individual's wishes. Like the frontal self, they are forced to repress. There is no choice.

So we all look at politics with disdain and despair, and wish someone would simply clean it all up. But the sad fact is, that in this present state, the utopian vision of everyone having a fair say in the way things work would simply never succeed. Because the will of the common person is not the answer to global problems, it is the cause! That is what the politicians are busy confronting as they seek to implement positive change with integrity. The common person is simply not sufficiently informed or qualified to be involved in that level of decision making. Simply because the common person is as much influenced by the secondary agenda as they are by the native one. But if we ever find ourselves in a position where the common individual can be trusted, and there is alignment between them, then the systems and structures already exist to immediately forge that individual will into unified global action. It is all there just waiting for us to catch up.

Social Equity

In terms of resources and wealth distribution, there is also a great difference between common culture and native culture. And here we see another factor of common culture which reflects the underlying imbalances of the common state. That the bulk of the decision making power in the world lies in the hands of very few. Wealth is not proportionately distributed amongst people, and that those with the most resources, make most of the decisions.

Some would say that this is natural and appropriate. That this is the case because these are the people who have proven themselves capable of managing such power and resources. And this may be true. But it could also be argued that power corrupts, and that with sufficient resources you can effectively protect or shield yourself from reality. That such power can and will inevitably be used to rise above the problems of the world, rather than be used to find solutions to them. And this is what I believe does happen at present, if only because, just like for the politicians, the other option is futile. Even if all the great financial powers in the world committed all their energy and resources to solving humanity's problems, they would only make things worse.

Once again, a liberation of free energy in a closed dysfunctional system - crisis. So the fact that the wealthy use power to divorce themselves from the world is natural and unavoidable in the present situation. You would do the same, because the alternative is virtually pointless.

How, then, might native culture differ from this? Well, with the distribution of resources in a natural social structure, the upper tiers would consume their fill, and the overflow would cascade down. Like a pyramid of champagne glasses being filled from the top. Naturally, in the native state, there is simply no need for energy or resources beyond the relational requirements of the organism. The cup floweth over naturally.

In the bigger picture this creates a naturally equilibrating system, and also a fair one. A circular dynamic which tends naturally toward equality and fairness, whilst also retaining motivation by rewarding effort. Higher achievers still float to the top, but all are filled, provided there are sufficient resources. The higher are guaranteed first fill, that is all. Greater security. And still get to define their own take. They can freely define their own pay. But because they are not driven to endless consumerist frenzy by a powerful secondary agenda, they are more likely to only take what they need. This is self-balancing and healthy. Self regulated, not imposed. Energy comes from the whole, the higher have greater control, and take all they want. But they don't want or need it all. In this way all are assured the best chances of being filled.

What never happens in native culture however, is higher accumulating resources surplus to requirements, whilst lower levels remain wanting. This is only the present case due to the relational effects of the underlying common dilemma. The dilemma produces an artificial situation emotionally and functionally, an insatiable hunger which cannot easily be satisfied. It is a very demanding load to carry.

In common culture the natural cascade of resources is thwarted by a failure of individuals to emotionally recognise the natural limits of their own requirements. No matter how much they get, they remain unhappy, so they always want more.

This is what many call greed, but it is not the case. This is just the common state. So it is as if the sides of the wine glasses grow with the fill, and never flow over naturally distributing wealth. The energy flowing from the whole merely accumulates and is trapped at the top of the structure in a way which, rather than equilibrating, generates more and more inequity. But this is entirely reasonable under the circumstances. The social preaching around this issue, that the rich should give to the poor, is simply delusional whilst the common state remains prevalent. Just as we saw in the individual, healthy integrity cannot be imposed by force. Just so, the natural cascade can never be imposed, it must be realised naturally.

Great individual change allows for different social organisation. In the current situation, because of the underlying common state, the options at the social level are similar to those in the common state, a no-win. We either submit to a naturally occurring iniquitous social arrangement (capitalism), or attempt to impose equality on a system that does not tend toward equity, which requires force (communism). The traditional models and track records of capitalism and communism merely apply to the common human state and common culture. And the view that they reflect humanity's only two social options is just another expression of the great fallacy. In common culture as we see it today, because of its non-equilibrating nature, the best elements of both communism and capitalism remain functionally incompatible with each other. But the natural cascade, based in native culture and individual integrity, is a third potential which embodies the best of both. It sees the social ideals of communism achieved with the natural freedom and motivation of capitalism., and in a completely unenforced or imposed manner. It is all just natural equilibrium and trust, based purely on wider understanding and personal realisation.

So is it that we don't have the technology? No. Do we still require further social development in order to gain the capacity to act in unity? No. The only reason we struggle to find unity and a common vision is that we are trying to impose it on a system that is fundamentally conflicted at the deepest level. But we already have everything we need. And there is no force or coercion required. Information + realisation = integration.

You cannot impose integrity on the common state, but in the native state, you do not need to. It simply emerges naturally. It is a fundamental solution, it would still be worth pursuing for its collective effects even if it made no difference whatsoever to individual happiness.

Automatic Integrity

We have seen how there is little natural alignment between people in the common state, and so we might presume that a return to the native state would allow us to create alignment without obstruction. But it is easier than that. Core alignment is natural in the native state. It does not need to be imposed. There is simply automatic deep level integrity and common vision.

Let me explain -

If you break a wine glass, it will break differently every time. This is like the common state, we all have a different form of unique containment. But no matter where you start from in the common state, the destination point is the same for all - the native state. The native state is common to all, and is the same for all in its core energetic nature. We share the same structure, the same needs, the same primary organic integrity. So whilst in the common state we tend to scatter to the wind, in the native state we recover our natural social integrity. We once again flock like birds, school like fishes...and we don't even have to try. There is easy alignment at the deep level. Deep level integrity not displayed by the common state. Something entirely new to look forward to.

To see this more clearly, we can return to the level of close personal relationships. If you want true alignment, to experience the power of true shared vision, then you are crazy to look for it within the common state. You need merely find this potential in yourself, and then find others who have done the same.

This integrity does not need to be created or even found. It is already there. This is what the common state disturbs. So if you are seeking true alignment with others you need merely choose the second path. And how do you do this? How do you find that potential? Well, you simply find a philosophy which supports and advocates it, and apply it to your life. Because even before you make the transition, to make the native state your goal produces great alignment with anyone else who is doing the same.

And how do you find others of like mind, and of common vision? How do you know if others are going your way, without getting everyone you meet to fill out a questionnaire?

The same answer again -

Find a philosophy which supports and advocates this potential, and the rest will just happen. Simply because the objective of such a philosophy is singular and common to all, and because the transition it advocates restores common core level integrity in those who choose to make it their path. Thus, the closer these people get to their stated ideal, the more they have

in common with others doing the same. Not uniformity, but core alignments. Common ground, synchronicity, understanding, appreciation, wavelength. True natural alignment based on the pursuit of common core integrity.

The individual transition from the common state to the native state, whilst it may never be easy or comfortable, is about to become more accessible, perhaps simply on the basis of better understanding. And the first emergent philosophy accurate and powerful enough to reliably facilitate it will inevitably achieve profound social status. Like a lightning stick, it will become a focal point for the emergence of an entirely new cultural form. Such a paradigm could be the spark which lights the fire of global awakening. In fact, more than just a spark. The fact that it must deliver this potential reliably makes it more akin to a box of matches.

Is this book such a view? Hardly. No single person will ever produce the kind of sophistication and depth such an institution might need to embody. No, what we require is the mighty Oak. But we have to start somewhere, and I have done what I can to plant this little acorn. Maybe together we will get there in the end.

Do you ever feel as if you were born on the wrong planet? Do you look on with amazement at the blinding stupidity of mankind's endeavours? The lack of vision and foresight? Well, I believe that this is just the part of you which sees the way things could be. The part of you which senses the potential we have for unity and common vision. That is the part of you that senses the possibility of integrity through insight and understanding, not through force or imposition. Free and open alignment. We can see now that no United Nations dictum will ever produce the kind of collective unity required to forge a common destiny for humanity, for that kind of integrity can only come from the ground up. We must address the issue here, in the only place we truly can - ourselves. This is collective change with no political agenda, based solely on individual change.

So who is going to save the world? YOU ARE! No one can do this for us, but conversely, no one can stop us from doing it.

Making it Possible

I hope by now you are beginning to see the potential significance of what I am proposing. What it could all mean, not just for you, but for the Earth as a whole. So where does this all leave us, then? What can we do to bring this potential into being?

Well, all roads lead to the same point. The common state is the problem, and the native state is the answer. Both individually, and collectively. Which means that the only final answer lies in understanding and facilitating the individual transition between these two states. It seems strange that it could all come down to this. That almost every insurmountable problem or conflict the world faces could be overcome in a single sweep if we could only answer this one single question. Which makes this the greatest single question facing humanity and the Earth -

How can we facilitate this process of transition? How can a person more easily traverse the 'zone' without such stress that their will is overthrown, and they turn back? What methods, preparation, or cultural support might this require? In short, how can we make this potential more accessible?

This is a vital question because, as it stands, many will never make it. They might accept the idea in time, enough realisation will see to that. But it does not matter what people believe. It is the realisation which is significant in the end, and that is where it will get stuck - many will not make the key transition. As it stands, and without all of the bridges and handrails we might eventually set up based on a more collective approach to all this, that terrain is simply far too rough.

Traversing this 'zone'

This, then, brings us to the heart of the issue. Understanding this process, the transition between the common and native states, is the essence of the challenge we face. We must learn to facilitate this transition in more effective and efficient ways. And to also become clear about exactly what it is, so as to avoid potential misconceptions.

The key to facilitating this process is in forming a conscious initiative which will not be overthrown along the way. The natural-subjective view applies here. The conscious perception of this process is what matters, and that perception is unfortunately very different from what this process actually is. There is no real danger here, but reality is not the concern of the frontal awareness.

This process feels very dangerous, and that is what matters in the end. Conscious will is the determiner of action and change. And conscious will must inevitably confront strong unconscious pressure as we approach the balance point, and it is the balance between these two which defines success in the transition. Too much resistance, or too little forbearance, and there will be an overthrow of will, and a turning back. This is natural, and must be accounted for somehow.

At present, with little understanding, very few are finding this potential because of this fact. Because when inefficient, this process may potentially generate great stress, and therefore require great courage and commitment. This is the current situation.

But is this necessary? Is there really no better way? Is there not a way to understand and lessen the potential emotional stresses associated with this transition?

Well, of course there must be. This whole potential has never been seriously addressed in any reasonable way, at least not in the terms I am indicating here. This is a shame perhaps, but also a great opportunity. There is a whole new field of rational enquiry to be pursued here, and there is much gain to be made.

We are just a system like any other. We may be complex, but this is not exactly rocket science. In fact if we had put even one tenth of the NASA budget into figuring out this single problem, they may have already put the UN out of business, because we might actually be on the way to sustainable world peace by now.

So what can be said? What can we do to make this transition easier? Well, in this book I wanted to lay the foundations by sticking firmly to 'what' this potential is. The 'how' of this potential is another whole issue again, and all that may have to wait for the next edition - or more likely some process of direct and ongoing collective exploration - as there is a lot to address there. But figuring out the 'how' is the ultimate point of all this theory. It defines the task we now all face together, and there are a few obvious points I could indicate just to get the ball rolling –

As stated, the key to a successful transition is in the balance between will and resistance. Which means that there are two main factors to address. We can either support the formation of will throughout the transition, or somehow avoid or eliminate aspects of resistance.

In the current state of things, the only option has been to somehow muster incredible will to overcome the dramatic resistance being confronted. But this does seem to be the lesser of the two options.

To augment the formation of strong will is to confront emotional opposition with brute force. This can be effective if there are no other options, but it is also a very high stress answer. The resistance is emotive pressure, and powerful will is even more emotive pressure, making for a very high tension transition.

But what about the other option? Can we not eliminate the resistance somehow? Are there really no ways to lessen it so that the transition involves less confrontation of strong energies? Well, yes, there probably are. In the end this process will probably always involve a bit of both, but there may be great room for improvement here.

It seems reasonable to work on this end first, to focus on lowering the likelihood of emotive resistance, because that is what ultimately makes this potential more accessible. To find ways to increase frontal will-power alone may make this potential more reliable, but also more demanding emotionally. And the mere reality of human nature means that the more will, determination, commitment and fortitude this process requires, the less people will be capable or willing to choose it. Therefore, before we start loading people up with hi-tech 'climbing gear', we might be better off to see if we can make the 'hill' a bit lower and easier to climb. In the end we may still ultimately need to use both brains and brawn, but I believe we will achieve the best results if we do so in that order.

So there we have it –

Finding a solution to the problem of reducing subjective resistance to this transition is the 'holy grail' of our time. If you can figure that one out, you might just change the world.

So what can we know? What are some of the most obvious factors involved here?

If we first of all look at lowering resistance, there are a few things which stand out as important factors. The first of those is increasing efficiency by removing any unnecessary obstacles or loads associated with this transition.

These are a few which come to mind-

- To avoid structural conflict and resistance during the transition, separation of the two agendas at every level is necessary. We must never use motivation sourced from inside the secondary agenda in order to remove the secondary agenda. For this will obviously always fall short of the mark. We must be able to differentiate the two agendas functionally, assert one, and negate the other. Understanding is the key. Only the native agenda has the power to overcome the secondary agenda. The secondary agenda will fall away, and must be free to do so and not get entangled with the other. If any structure or relational exchange in your life relies on motivation from the secondary agenda, and that thing is not open to change, then your attachment to it will function to oppose the transition to the native state. This is implied. In the end we must simply submit to losing whatever will be lost, whatever is an aspect of the secondary agenda. So it is altogether best if surface levels of life can begin to be clearly differentiated as much as possible, so that

the secondary agenda can fall away cleanly and without complications. For reasons of mere efficiency, many surface aspects of life generally comprise a complex mixture of both agendas, such as established relationships etc. And these things can be difficult to differentiate because they are neither a white sheep or a black sheep, but somewhat grey. So although we may not wish to condemn them as entirely negative, they can also represent significant resistance if they remain fixed and rigid. They do not need to be relinquished, necessarily, but they must be permitted to change as the secondary agenda falls away. And it must be understood that this change will intrinsically violate many unconscious contracts you have established with others. There is simply no way to avoid this. We cannot have freedom as well as our addictions, it is one or the other. We must do what we can to prepare our lives for the state we desire.

- In order to improve efficiency further, we can find or create a situation in which unnecessary demands are not placed on us. This transition cannot easily be made in the context of ordinary life. It is simply too demanding and upsetting for stable outward appearances to be upheld. We must find a safe place to do this.
- We can clearly formulate our goal or objective. Which is not the balance point, but beyond it. There is no value in the 'zone'. There is no point hanging around at the top of the hill, no value in going half way, or even part of the way if you're not going to cross the mark. You must decide before you set off, and if you are going to do it, then just open up and do it. Don't hang around in the 'zone'. Hit the mark without reservation. There is no point to stay in this transition zone, there is no value in it, no virtue. Forget the 'zone' altogether, just decide where you want to be, and BE THERE. If you cannot commit to this, then don't even bother. This is not something you can 'try'. You either do it, or not, for there is nothing of value in between. In the words of the great Yoda- "Do, or do-not, there is no try".
- If you are 'deep process' blocked, you will confront that as perturbation. This transfer is the single most significant 'deep process' your system will ever experience. Nothing in the native continuum can produce such a dramatic shift. People are naturally afraid of deep processes in themselves. There may be real and authentic bodies of repression backed up behind this dam, and these will also move toward closure as integrity returns. So if any elements of systemic dysfunction can be resolved prior to this process of transition, you will save yourself some distraction, and prepare yourself for what it will demand. Because it involves a great degree of subjective change and deep emotive process. And if you are locked up emotionally and can't flow, you will simply never make it. Basically, if you are not capable of real feeling, real anger and real grief, you will potentially stall and get stuck as your system works to clear the way for change. Which, in the end, means that you will spend longer in the 'zone', and be more likely to roll back. The secondary agenda is founded in attachment. Repression of emotion is repression of potential attachment. So for that attachment to become active and animated again, but to have no fulfilment structure to cling to, is the cause of the stress associated with this process. But in order to be relinquished and resolved this attachment must be active and fully embodied, thus opening it to change, i.e. not held or frozen in suspended process. It must all be on the table, so to speak. Thus, the ideal state for the final transition is one in which all functioning is operating in a healthy way, belief formation is clear and accurate, the body is free of organic dysfunction, emotions are open and flowing. All of which means that the secondary agenda will have been displaced somewhat, and will be active as very very strong desire. Desire is attachment to something not present, and is supposed to generate emotional stress. That is its function.

Bridges

In the end, the activation of strong desire or aversion is the source of the primary resistance associated with this transition. So what can be done to lessen the impact of this negative potential? Well, there may be many mechanisms capable of achieving this. There are certainly forms of fulfilment which might function to give this attachment something to hang onto during this process, and thus act to lower stress. Provided it doesn't obstruct the process, anything that makes a difference will do.

What we are talking about are existential fulfilments, things which make us feel safe, and which we can cling to as we traverse the difficult zone. A kind of 'bridge' over troubled water. Like fighting fire with fire, a false fulfilment for a false need. Traditionally, this seems to have been a role played by many gurus and 'realizers'. In the historical mould of devotional relationship, the guru themselves have often offered themselves as such a bridge. And this is actually quite valid, but as we will see, also tends to suffer from some inevitable and very serious abuse.

The principle behind this is simple – If a 'disciple' has sufficient belief in a 'guru', convinced that they are divine, a source of life or salvation or 'enlightenment', then this belief can actually function to allow that disciple to approach the balance point with minimal stress. It is amazing what you can grow in bullshit! The entire secondary agenda can be released and activated without any problems, because a fulfilment structure is there waiting, ready to receive it - the guru themselves. Such belief is, of course, entirely unfounded and dysfunctional. The guru is just a person, but if this childish delusion can be upheld and maintained, it can paradoxically function to give the guru a chance to use this dysfunction to achieve some good. Provided there is sufficient integrity, that is. It is a way of putting the devotee's dysfunctional credulity to good use. And this could really work. There is even evidence to suggest that this has worked well in the past, with many forms of traditional spiritual practice reflecting this template.

But is this valid now, in the modern western world, as a reasonable method of transmission? No. Even if there were any individual realizers with sufficient integrity to withstand the rigours of such a process, the western mind is not at all suited to this kind of devotional path. In historical terms, in magical or mythic level cultures, it has been good enough to say that 'the end justifies the means', but this will no longer wash. The reality of this devotional path is that it involves necessary

deception on the part of the guru, and delusion on the part of the devotee. And if the guru is not intentionally deceiving the devotee, then that is even worse. This means they actually believe they are what they claim to be, which makes them patently psychotic. It is not a good look. Overall, this whole model involves a significant potential for abuse.

So what is the value of a 'realiser' to a 'seeker'? Considerable, actually, as we may see. But not in this form. As far as I am concerned, if a 'master' cannot tell you in practical terms exactly what 'enlightenment' is, and exactly how to get it, then you are being ripped off. Move on.

In the end, the answer is not dependence, but self-empowerment. This transition does *not* necessarily involve any imbalance of power between realizer and adherent. It does not necessarily involve a realizer at all. It should be the goal of any emerging culture here to deliver such self empowerment through self understanding, and in the process put all gurus out of a job. After all, gurus can only exist in a culture of struggle and pain. It is simply not in the devotional guru's interests to produce realisation. If everyone got it, then who would 'boil their eggs' every morning? If you catch my drift. It really is a great racket if you can swing it.

Advice then? Avoid this like the plague.

So what about other bridges? What else could function to attract this body of desire during this transition? Well, many things could. Any form of symbolic fulfilment may achieve this quite safely, provided upholding it does not demand too much. And provided it can be freely relinquished when the time comes to fold the entire complex, and let it resolve into nothingness. But any object that functions to capture this attachment, just like a guru, is necessarily dysfunctional. After all, how can something which functions to fulfil existential needs be healthy? You don't have any such needs. But some things can function to achieve this, albeit dysfunctionally. And may, therefore, be used as bridges in full awareness of their nature. Once again, we can use these things, without them using us.

So is there an appropriate and healthy 'bridge' over this 'zone' - one which does not involve some degree of delusion? Yes, perhaps there is.

The subjective perception of the transition is what matters. As we discussed earlier, the entire process must, paradoxically, appeal to the incumbent 'I'. The path must be made attractive. And without any awareness or belief in the outcome of such action, this is almost impossible. Like lancing a boil, the process is not 'nice', only the outcome is positive. But it is positive beyond all expectations or previous experience. So why do we not have the same bodily urge when confronted with the possibility of the native state that we do when confronted with our more addictive pressures? Well, the only reason for this is that we have never experienced it. So if only you knew! If you had any real appreciation of this potential, energy would rise up in you as you came close to anything offering it. You would easily liberate energy sufficient to effect the realisation, even with resistance. You would - like a compulsive gambler walking past a casino - experience very powerful will, based on very powerful attraction.

If only you had already experienced it. But you haven't. And this is the catch 22. Here we see one of the essential functions of the emerging culture - To accurately represent the reality of this potential in a way which is both realistic and believable. To simply offer direct 'object referral' for the reality of this transition and its resulting state. Not hyperbole, reality. Because what we see is that, with enough support to allow it, the destination of the process of transition is the only truly appropriate and healthy bridge over the 'zone'.

Mere knowledge of, and belief in, the native state is itself the answer, even before you get there. And the same belief, that it exists, is also the origin of ideal motivation and will. Therefore, as the secondary agenda is animated and attachment becomes active, it can be captured and forged into a single body of active desire. A desire for that state, the native state. Meaning that before the native state is even reached, it can become the focus of great systemic desire on the basis of mere belief. However, in this case, this belief is not false, and is not merely a mechanism by which to manipulate ourselves. And it does not fall away in time.

This is a belief which, if it is upheld, has the power to deliver exactly what it defines. In which case it might best be defined not as a belief, but as 'faith'.

That really would be the most hilarious thing, for faith to become a scientifically embedded reality. For what is faith in the end, but a belief which, in the believing of it, becomes a reality.

Such beliefs do of course exist. You have to have faith in order to take a single step, you have to believe that the ground is still going to be there. And on the basis of this faith, the step becomes a reality, and we move.

So when all is said and done, it could be faith, if applied in the right context, that may provide the final answer. Faith in this particular definition of course.

Desire is only stressful if we do not believe it will be fulfilled. It causes no stress if fulfilment is believed to be under way and imminent. So in this process of transition, if you believe you are not going to make it, then you probably will not.

Because the stress resulting from that belief will be too great. This single belief has the power to either negate or animate the entire secondary agenda.

This potential must be taken into account. The success of this transition must not be left subject to such a small and random factor. It must not be a fragile thing. And all this requires, I believe, is understanding and the right cultural support.

The point is to understand and secure this belief, in full awareness of the factors which can act to erode it. It is a self fulfilling belief structure, which means it is circular and self spiralling. If you believe you won't make it, you won't. If you believe you will, you will. And any little bit of evidence in either direction could start a spiral that results in either state. So we confront a crossroads. A choice. And we must be able to account for the fact that we are starting off in the common state, and will therefore very likely confront evidence that the native state will not be realised. And you must be able to believe you will, even in the face of whatever evidence to the contrary. You must realise that you will confront such evidence, and that such is normal and not to be concerned about. It must be understood that the process will go through certain stages and apparent holdups, and that this is also normal. You will get there in the end, this must be the key assertion. It is normal to feel like you won't, and doesn't mean you won't. You must understand that such a belief does not represent the truth, even when you act on it. You must expect to be knocked back, and not let such knocks begin a negative spiral of events. We are not aware of our motivations until we threaten them. Resistance should be valued. The more you confront, the more you get to see what you are freeing yourself from. It's the last time you see them!

Both beliefs are true, if you choose to believe them. This is literally one of the very few situations in life where this can be said, where we can face such a choice, where what we choose to believe can actually change the actual reality we experience. A very strange situation indeed.

To leverage this simple belief to the positive could be the final key to easy and accessible transition to the native state. And the best way to achieve this is to be immersed in a culture of understanding and support. The impact of a realiser, by their mere presence, is significant in this regard. In the confusion and disorientation of the transition to the native state, they can be a valuable beacon. So use a realiser if you can, but do not let a realizer use you. Take advantage of anyone prepared to give you time and energy, but do so with full awareness of what you are doing and why - in full awareness that the realizer is just another ordinary person.

Perhaps the most powerful combination, however, might involve the ultimate trick. Romantic love, in the overblown and emotionally attached sense, is a direct and obvious manifestation of the secondary agendas attempts to control existential fear. This is why it can be so dramatically devastating and confining in the context of real life, especially when it comes to the creation of the life of your dreams. Of all the things that hold us back, our primary relationships are by far the greatest. Like sparrows tied together can't fly. But such overblown attachment is only detrimental, or even noticed, to the degree misalignment exists between the two people. And of course misalignment does always exist in the common state because what both parties really want is to exist in the common state, even if they don't know this. So the best we can generally hope for is to find someone with common forms of additions, or at least compatible ones. And if we do, then we are free to apply our big emotional umbilicus to them without too much confinement as a result. But that is very rare. For the most part our massive need for emotional security drives us to compromise, and we take a path beneath our true potential. And we also tend to ask the same of a partner – that they stay the same, and that they thereby do not violate our unconscious emotional contracts. Which of course implies that you are asking them to put your own happiness above their own, because if they are not as happy as they can be then change is a given. Such is codependency, otherwise known as 'romantic love'. It is one of the most insidious and dangerous and disempowering forms the secondary agenda can take – like heroin, it feels good precisely because it is a false high.

Not all deep connections between people are of this nature however, and this is what I am coming to here. Whilst in the common state such connections might be seen as one of the most profound obstacles to gaining freedom, in the common endeavour to achieve such it becomes the ultimate boon. Deep connection, especially the radical bliss of romantic attachment, can be used intentionally and entirely respectfully as a kind of pole vault stick. It can be engaged with complete awareness, and with impunity in terms of any harm that attachment might cause, because the implied goal is so integrated and singular, and because it produces such profound alignment of energies. You can literally use each other as a bridge.

This is, in different language, to use each other intentionally as a doorway to God – which happens to be the very definition of the highest form of yoga: Tantra. The goal of tantra is not sex, it is spiritual enlightenment.

Subjective technology

We now begin to see some of the forms and functions which any emerging culture must necessarily adopt and develop. The function of such a culture must be to facilitate this transition for its individual members. And how can it do this? Who knows? There are a million potentials here that haven't even been thought up yet. What do you get when you cross Hatha Yoga with Macrobiotics with Atma Vichara and the Rubaiyat of Omar Khayyam? You just never know!

I believe this potential gives substance to many traditional claims and practices, although not in the theoretical terms they often employ. That this may be all they have lacked in some cases, the wider chassis or framework. The critical missing element. And that in the future, within a new theoretical framework, there is tremendous potential for current modalities of personal change to be synthesised and fitted toward this common objective.

We have a new chassis here, on which any number of methods or technologies might be hung to work together in harmony toward a single common destination. The potentials are endless, and exciting.

I have heard it said that we are approaching the limits of science. That we have all but exhausted the capacity of objective reason to discover anything really new or significant. But I personally believe we haven't even begun yet. The greatest technologies of the new millennium will almost certainly be the subjective ones.

What will happen when such alternative cultures begin to appear? Who knows? If 'object referral' is the key to leveraging the essential belief which lowers the stress of the transition, as well as stimulating the will required, then such culture could.....well, you tell me! If you were surrounded by twenty close friends who had just made this transition, and they were all laughing and smiling and saying it is great, would you be afraid? Maybe not. Could you easily deny the reality of the native state as a realistic potential? Maybe not.

Such a situation might even make realisation inevitable. It is even conceivable that at some point of critical mass this potential could begin to be spontaneously transmitted, like a wildfire. I don't know.

So whilst we have spent this entire book seeking to explain that fire exists as a possibility, and that what we really need to do is get together to produce matches that anyone can access and use, in the end even those might not ultimately be necessary beyond a certain point, if only because the cascading release of all this underlying pain and struggle might simply become freely self-sustaining at a certain level of heat, like a kind of unstoppable wave of socially transmitted emancipation. The native state as we have been defining such, aka spiritual enlightenment, might simply become so ubiquitous as to be virtually unavoidable in any practical sense. I mean, you only need to hang around someone who has reached this state to understand what I am pointing to here - like a tuning fork you inevitably begin to harmonise to their frequency before too long. And in the future this deep frequency of energised equanimity might be coming out of every wall, and echoing down every hallway.

WHERE TO NOW?

It becomes clear now that we still face some very real issues which must be resolved, but also that these issues are not insurmountable. In time, if we can pull together, who knows where we might end up. Just think for a moment of the significance of widespread realisation. What if we could raise the odds by even double? Imagine!

It is entirely probable, I believe, that there will come a time when this process is even commonplace, well refined and culturally supported. And that all this might take is sufficient understanding in an accessible form – a new social paradigm.

All of which is hopefully enough as a basic outline to give you some sense of what we are discussing here, and its general implications for us all. But just in case you would like more, I will finish off here by examining it all from a few different vantage points just to show you its real scope and extension. There will be three of these brief snapshots.

1. The Stolen Heart

It is not for me to tell you that all this is true, you can come to that conclusion on your own. But one thing is for sure – if it is true, then certain things can be presumed with a very high degree of certainty, and some of those are very dramatic, and also very close to home.

For instance, what this proposes is a situation where another completely distinct approach to happiness is available, an approach which has almost no relationship to the one we presently adopt in our daily lives. It opens up an entirely new possibility, and in the process completely changes the rules of the game. And you cannot have both. Either this is basically correct, or the common path to happiness is correct.

They cannot both be right. There are either two stable equilibriums (2EQ) available, or there are not. And if there are, then a view which robustly explains them is probably more likely to be more correct or complete than one which does not. And also, if there are then the path to true happiness might actually be in the direction of very high tension in the short term, so as to finally be released into a state of almost zero tension as a result. Such an insight would change everything you know about happiness, and where it might be found.

The most significant thing this view tells us, if it is correct, is that the common approach to happiness is intrinsically self-defeating and enclosed. It implies that the natural process of following what you feel, and doing what is expected of you by common culture, basically has zero chance of realising a stable and happy state that exists in harmony with the wider process of life on the planet. It is structurally impossible.

A summary of which is this: if what I am defining here is the actual situation we find ourselves in, but if you do not realise this, then the path you naturally take toward happiness will remain perpetually frustrated and tiresome. You will never rest.

So if we jump now to the subjective or personal view of all this, we see the confusion this all causes in our conscious daily lives. This underlying conflict, this invisible dilemma, is the deep foundation upon which all common values, conventions, institutions, expectations, etc, all rest. The deeper emotional potentials this pandemic event defines are the foundation of our entire civilization. This means that the implied denial, and all of the patterns of complex dysfunction associated, are all considered completely normal.

Actually, almost everything that people do consciously is an effort to resolve this underlying dilemma. But all that inevitably occurs within the unconscious confines that dilemma defines.

For instance - why do so many relationships fail? It is because people are forever seeking to use them to fix this issue. They are basically getting together imagining that that can solve an emotional problem which does not originate in relationships, and which cannot be solved there. And the same is true of money, or fame, or any other socially reinforced emblem of hope. They are all things we suck on in the absence of real food, they make us feel better somehow but do not actually ever satisfy the underlying emotional need. Not really.

We chase hope endlessly. There are always reasons we are unhappy, ways of justifying it to ourselves, and culture very powerfully and subtly reinforces the concept that it is always just around the next bend, or just over the next hill. We come to live in an expectant future that never actually arrives.

In many ways we are in a collective trance. We manipulate our bodies and minds so as to adapt to any situation. But 'synthetic happiness' is not real happiness. To stimulate the reward centres of the brain is not the state of happiness. That is only one small element of a much deeper event. True happiness is a fathomless organic event which is ultimately part of a much deeper event again, which is itself connected to the universe as a whole. Directly connected. It is part of a greater symphony of alignment with the processes of life as a whole.

Therefore, nothing replaces authentic happiness. Because only authentic happiness is connected to the organic world in an integrated way, far beyond the bounds of the limited organism. Authentic human happiness intrinsically dances to the deeper rhythm of life on Earth, because it was programmed by evolutionary imperatives to do so. To be happy in any other sense, in any sense that is not aligned with this deeper process, is not to be truly happy. And to seek happiness in any manner of synthetic or manipulated way is about as lost as you can possibly be. That is to miss the whole point.

Happiness is a symptom of a far deeper set of necessary conditions, and to seek the emotional component on its own is natural under the circumstances because that is what has been stolen from us, but to do so in some stimulated or manipulated manner is like tugging on green fruit trying to get it to ripen. It ripens from sunlight, which your tugging hand is blocking.

The human heart is a singularity, that is its function. It represents the sum of all emotional ground, as the pinnacle or peak of integrity such represents. To touch someone's heart is, in this sense, to change their life in a way that corresponds to this underlying emotional ground within them. But another way to touch someone's heart is by changing not their life, but by offering them the power to change the form of this emotional foundation. We presume this is fixed and intrinsic, but it is not.

The primal singularity of the heart was effectively taken from us in this event, that is the primary implication of this view at the deepest level. And this also sums up this situation in a nutshell. There is a duplicity imposed on the human heart, making its function as our compass in life somewhat moot. Its majesty and sacred alignment have been lost, diminished, exiled. And the result is that there is an inherent conflict whilst these underlying structures remain stable and unchanged, and these produce a situation where happiness is not necessarily excluded, but dramatically limited and made incredibly complex to achieve in any stable or lasting way relative to our native capacity for such.

The human heart is actually seeking two different ends simultaneously, and those ends are at odds. The human heart has, I suppose you could say, been stolen. It can, in this state, never find its way home. To follow what you feel is the only path to happiness, because it is the heart which defines such. But in this case to follow what you feel leads only to confusion and struggle, and as a result we end up going in endless frustrating circles.

To see this lost underlying alignment we need to look deeper, but it is not that hard to discern. In particular we need to look at energy once again, but this time from a more subjective angle -

Energy is the basic currency of all life, a plant always grows toward the light etc, it is the fundamental transaction for all organic events. Surplus energy, then, is extremely good. It is the very definition of organic success and wellbeing. So what better to use as a motivational polarity?

Emotionally, what we see is the equivalent of free energy – feeling. In particular, depth and quality of feeling, together. Thinking represents a disturbance of this deep feeling state, as driven by emotion. Emotion generates attention, and thus disturbs us into action by removing a degree of positive ‘feeling depth’, which we then naturally want back. So, most accurately, surplus energy is represented at higher functional levels as ‘free energy + free attention’. In particular, as undisturbed feeling, or ‘bliss’.

What we see, then, is that the integrity of subjective functioning is held together by feeling. And feeling, in its most positive and deep form, ultimately represents energy. This is why we are attracted to positive feeling states. It is not an accident. We should be attracted to them, that's how we work. But what this also means is that the inevitable and almost unavoidable function of the subversive agenda we have been charting must resolve down to a single unavoidable injunction: ‘limit free energy’. Which is in direct opposition to that of the native agenda, which is: ‘get free energy’.

The brain is – in this case – actually working in direct opposition to its very purpose for existing, which is to support the wellbeing of the organism of which it is a part. Not entirely however, because it is only targeting surplus energy here, due to that alone being the currency of emotional integrity. So the business of organic life can go on as normal, provided it never makes an emotional profit. It is an amazing situation. So in this situation we actually survive very well, and prosper even, but not emotionally – because surplus energy is also the currency of happiness. We are thereby set on an endless treadmill of consumption in search of the emotional finish line, which is now forever placed beyond our reach for reasons we can't see or understand.

The strange thing, however, is that this ‘low energy’ situation is inverted when you move your view to outside the organism. Like a seesaw, what goes down inside goes up outside as we try to balance the overall equation somehow. The limits imposed by this event are purely subjective, and therefore directly affect happiness and internal depth of feeling. Depth is what being human is all about, and this situation limits it profoundly, but we soon forget we ever had depths of feeling we have lost. But a yearning still exists in this case, some deep and abiding sense that there is much more somehow, but we just can't find it. And so we consume as we follow this nebulous yearning, and try to find this ever-elusive state.

Outside, however, in the world of relationships and external transactions, the demands of maintaining and limiting the impact of this internal event mean energy is consumed at massive levels. And this is because energy conservation is also

intrinsic to the way we work, because we evolved in a situation of extreme scarcity. There is simply no precedent for endlessly abundant resources in our history, we are not organically prepared for such. And what this means is that with high enough energy consumption it is possible to suspend the integrity of this system.

Imagine it this way: like a bent water pipe, all dented and crushed, its integrity is damaged. Which blocks the water somewhat. But if we simply add more pressure we can still get the same output at the other end. We simply increase energy to offset damaged integrity. The emotional system can be put out of kilter so as to distort its integrity, which ultimately amounts to the physical systems being held off balance permanently because they are connected. But if you still manage to pump enough energy in the end of it the outcome at the other end can be roughly the same.

This situation is akin to the integrity of the economy being damaged, but having it propped up by mass injections of funds by the government. Which in economic terms is bad because those funds are always limited. But what if those funds were not limited? We could maintain this situation indefinitely, and the actual economy might never need to be restored to a healthy and sustainable state. This is what I mean about the relationship between external energy and internal integrity. Integrity relies on scarcity as a fixed circumstantial invariant. And when that connection is lost, integrity can be overridden.

It's like having a bucket with a hole in the bottom. Quite a big hole actually, and happiness being how full your bucket is at any moment. We have this secondary event ripping gaping holes in the bottom of our emotional system. So we tip water in the top frantically, and at alarming rates, in order to maintain some sense of emotional equilibrium. And sometimes we even feel happy, but it is never the natural and easy happiness we are truly capable of. So, effectively, this situation creates a bottomless waste pipe down which we tip endless amounts of energy.

But it has to be asked – is there really endless energy to waste? For a period of time it can seem like that, as populations spiral out of control in a mad frenzy to fill these leaky buckets, but just like the economy being propped up, in our case a limit will inevitably be reached. We just don't see the connection, but we are starting to feel the rumblings of doom. In this case we spend endlessly and beyond what is natural, because our culture gives us all a free credit card with the Gaia Bank. We take this massive surplus energy from the Earth, and as a result we feel OK. We are able to balance the emotional damage maintained by the subversive agenda, most of the time, at least within acceptable limits.

So what happens when that bank collapses, when there is no more money, no more water for your leaky buckets? It should be noted that if that bank collapses, then we're all totally fucked. The Earth is our only life support system.

On the one hand we are consuming energy at a massive rate in order to bypass the results of damaged energetic integrity, and on the other hand we are discharging energy constantly in order to prevent it ever manifesting as free energy and attention at an emotional level, and thereby awakening a simmering crisis. It is madness.

The only answer in this situation is to fix the hole. And the point of everything I am saying here is that this hole has, until now, been presumed to be normal. But it is not. And it can be fixed. And fixing it is a solution so deep that it changes everything. To fix this unnecessary hole in the emotional integrity of every person on the planet would immediately and dramatically change the entire trajectory of human civilization. And it would do this overnight. To fix this hole is also the best feeling you will ever experience, and it is permanent. You simply fill your bucket once, and it stays full.

Some people imagine worlds vastly different from the one we know, where things are very much different, and these worlds offer us escape from the reality in which we actually live. I too imagine a world very different from this one. But in my case that world is real. It is this very same world.

This is no fantasy. The common path to happiness, and the culture which supports such, is the problem not the solution. It's one or the other. The only way to truly change the world is to touch six billion hearts in a profound and irrevocable way, and that is precisely what this possibility would seem to be offering.

2. The Deep End

There is tremendous social power locked away behind this dam, and the dam is becoming more and more fragile by the day. Once it starts to breach there will be a feeding frenzy, and further exploration of this territory will be automatic and rapid. Which will bode well for the individual, but also for the group.

In social terms, any paradigm capable of differentiating these two agendas is a recipe for immediate depth as its singularity inverts the primary reason we remain so socially shallow. And depth is what being human is all about, that's precisely what makes us different. Depth of feeling, depth of thought, and in particular depth of sharing. Common culture is profoundly dishonest. It is a bullshit competition. Nobody is talking about what is really happening. This is the one thing you are definitely not allowed to talk about at parties. And as a result everybody imagines that they are the only ones who suffer this. But cultural awareness changes all that immediately, and not only by giving licence to explore yourself in new terms, but also licence and means by which to share that process with others. And it does this by providing language, and maps of what to expect as you begin to brave these wilder reaches together.

It is an adventure. Sharing with others is itself part of the way we work. We are social creatures. And the absence of this crucial knowledge from culture has left us isolated and alone, disconnected and disempowered. Collectively enforced denial is part of the containment of the very thing we are defining here. And so the restoration of intimacy is healing, because as you show others and expose yourself openly, you often find things out for the first time yourself. To share is to grow.

It is also how we learn. Shared knowledge is far more easily retained than its private counterpart.

This idea is the antidote to collective denial in this sense, and all the shallow facades associated. It is, as time will show, the emergence of a completely new form of human culture. Therefore, it is an extremely divergent cultural form to what we know, and clear thresholds need to be established to enable you to know which one you are in at any time. And, obviously, nobody should ever be dragged across that threshold against their will, and should always be allowed to leave immediately if they do not enjoy the experience. The deep end is only for those who can swim, or who want to learn.

It is all an invitation to the deep end of the pool, away from the crowded shallows – a restoration of the natural and intrinsic healing power of the human collective. It is a licence to be real, and to finally cut all the crap. Actually, it is a licence to put all the crap up on the dinner table, and stop pretending it isn't there. It is an acknowledgement that the problems we face are actually much deeper than we realise, but also that if we face up to such with honesty and courage, that the potential solutions such an approach might bear are equally profound.

To openly talk about an issue which fundamentally consists in denial is not the beginnings of a journey to some bright new world, it is itself an affirmation and acknowledgement that this new world has arrived – that it is already here.

3. King of Beasts

There are thousands of significant implications to unpack as this idea ripples through our conception of the world and our place in it, but the final one I will address here is what this tells us about the wider cosmic context in which we find ourselves. Which is this: because the subjective entrapment we experience is so watertight and self-enclosed in our case, we have not had any opportunity to notice that it is not actually natural. And as such we have naturally projected our own persistent sense of barren dissatisfaction outward onto the universe as a whole. We imagine in our myopic view that the whole cosmos is equally devoid of feeling and depth. But this is likely not so. Only we suffer, and that diminishment is quite severe, as people find out immediately when this fog is finally lifted.

We are the only ones who experience the fruits of our own delusions, and suffer the direct emotional consequences – although many other species also suffer deeply in the wake of that, as we trample them to death in our mad stampede. But ultimately the problem we suffer from is an imaginary one. It is only real emotionally, but on that front it is very real indeed.

What this implies is that if that complex process of delusion and denial was let go, and if the resulting state is what we have previously called 'spiritual enlightenment', then such a name is probably something of a misnomer. The resulting state – as majestic as it may be relative to what we presently experience – is nothing more than the background state of all existence.

The implication is that the overt and highest goal of the most revered spiritual traditions on the planet is nothing but the ordinary state of existence for everything except us. Everything in the entire universe already exists in that state, except modern humans.

'Un-enlightenment' is the epic feat, that is what makes us special, our very capacity to imagine that something else is going on. I'm sure, if there is anyone watching, that we are the butt of many a cosmic joke.

We are clinging to a rock in the middle of a great and purposeful river, with the water piling over our heads as we struggle to take a breath. We are the victims of our own fear. If we simply let go we will soon discover that we do, in fact, float - that we are part of something much bigger, and that in the end we need only surrender to our own true nature and calling, once that is freed from the snag we have been hooked on. But we do need to first understand, then go back and unhook ourselves, before we can go forward. This is why understanding is more important than realisation.

Essentially, we don't trust the universe because we feel bad. If everything felt great we would have much less reticence, and much more faith. This, then, is the possibility that stands before us now, as we finally breach this fortress wall. Every being in the universe is 'spiritually enlightened', except us. Even cabbages are happier than we are. The answer is all around us, we just can't see it. No matter what you do in this lifetime, death will take you back to that regardless. It is all a temporary nightmare from which you will eventually awaken. But you could choose to find it in life, and through this human frame experience that state with a depth and clarity almost unbounded in its capacity for bliss. We are happiness machines gone wrong. And if we were the only ones to emotionally suffer from this then that would be tragic, but the fact that we are causing so many other beings to suffer as a result of our own pain is truly despicable. This is not our planet. We share it.

One of the characteristics of the common state is a kind of blindness to what is obvious. Along with death, we tend to repress awareness of anything negative, of threat in particular. This becomes normal and acceptable. We do, both collectively and individually, turn our faces away from threat, and hide behind walls of false security – like a pilot not looking out the cockpit window. We avoid uncomfortable reality, and simply hope it will go away. From earthquakes, to ecological damage, to disease, we put it all out of our minds. But we simply must look, before it is too late! And the means by which to achieve this is precisely what is emerging here. A very brave and intelligent few will open it up for everyone.

We have taken the reins of this planet, and have usurped our position in the great chain of being. Spend five minutes alone with a big cat and you will be educated. We are not the King of Beasts. Yet we have effectively eliminated all the beings higher than ourselves in the food chain, we have beaten them, and they have surrendered.

We do not now need to extinguish them. These beings are all our cousins in the great process of life. We emerged alongside them, spend time with them and you will remember. They are part of us, and we are part of them.

The common human state, with its overblown sense of self-importance, makes us a blind and barbaric species. But this is not our planet. We share it with millions of other species. Some of which are far more beautiful than we. It could be said that some are even more intelligent, for how do you measure intelligence? We are the only species that does not seem to be able to live sustainably, or in harmony with the vital context in and out of which we arise. Yet this is not our native state, we have been duped out of our birthright, and led away from who we really are.

The point being: another entire possibility now lies open to us, and we can now choose to follow that breadcrumb trail home.

Extinction of species is natural, that is a normal and healthy ecosystem at work. As a normal matter of course, about fifty species become extinct each week. But at present we are losing more than five hundred species a day. Why? Take a look around you. Perhaps we will wake up in time.

In the end, if we are going to claim privilege, then we must also be prepared to accept the responsibility this brings. Can we not learn to respect the fact that we are part of a greater process of life, and that if we are ever going to survive, we must re-embrace the Earth? The collective realisation I have been indicating is no panacea, it is simply the removal of what is obstructing collective progress and equanimity. We will still be left with the real problems, many of which are the direct result of carrying the imaginary problem with us for so long. The same as the individual level, we will then be left to clean up the mess, and work toward our natural potential. We must return to the Earth, to Gaia, and learn to listen again. Evolution was not for us alone. We are not special. We are merely powerful and selfish, partly because of our own delusions.

Summary

What does all this mean? It means that no matter what you do from a typical conscious perspective, the problem lies deeper than that. Your very motives are conflicted. You cannot get what you want, and that is not because it is being withheld, it is because what you want is itself dynamically conflicted. It is like wanting your food both plain and spicy. Even the best chef cannot surmount the contradiction in your request. If you just relax, if you just follow what you feel, you will never find the happiness you truly seek.

There is another whole possibility, but it requires strategy and awareness and may always involve a degree of tension to realise. But this tension will also come down in time, making it easier and more accessible. Who knows how easy it might become if we all get together on it, which we will do in time. This will, in due course, inevitably become the defining technology of our species, given that it stands to solve the defining problem we have faced since before we first walked out of the trees.

Our entire future will be spawned here, with the birth of a process of upward development that will never cease in its sophistication and complexity and artful delivery. It will become art, perhaps even our most beautiful art, in that it stands to touch our hearts so deeply, and redirect our collective future so dramatically. We will be deconstructing it for centuries to come.

Through this art we will not ascend to higher consciousness. We will come down from our narrow wooden tower of pain, and finally realise that the highest form of consciousness is simply consciousness itself. The ground level is our true home. Nevertheless, that simple state will – from the conflicted and shallow place we find ourselves now – still remain so far beyond what we presume to be normal that if you have never been there, then it is almost impossible to comprehend.

If all of this is correct, then when you find what you have been looking for, you simply won't believe how close it was, or that it could have remained so hidden right there in front of us all along.

EPILOGUE

An Open Invitation

I'm not going to end this on a philosophical note. The surprising and perhaps disturbing thing about this work is that it certainly does not, like most such ideas, ultimately peter out into some fluffy and whimsical distraction which leaves you temporarily entranced, but ultimately right back where you started. This is not entertainment. The only thing this event needed – which it has never had – is some kind of collective awareness and collaborative effort. And this is also the one thing the target of our attention will not tolerate. As soon as even small islands of awareness and cooperation begin to emerge in this sea of enforced ignorance, we will see the beginnings of the end for this unfortunate stage of human history.

This is just a beginning, then, not an end. This is just a spark, and you are just a twig. Which might sound insignificant until you realise that what we really need now is a forest fire. If you like the idea of that, then do your part, whatever you feel that may be.

Actually, I always know when someone truly gets this joke. It is obvious, because they are no longer sitting down. As soon as people truly see this, and recognize just how much of the pain they have suffered came from this, and also how much of the struggle in the world originates in it, they simply can't remain still.

Therefore – understand it, and share it carefully. For the first time this has the potential for collective power: use it wisely.

So what does this take? Simply do the work. Nothing else is this. At present there is no awareness of all this in the collective. None. It is completely absent, and this absence has been its only power. Because without this we are lost and scattered, forever chasing our own tails. But with it we are unified and powerful, and our true enemy comes clearly into focus at last.

The capacity to see this is an emergent property, to half see it is not the same thing, any more than half getting on a horse can give you an experience of what that must be like if you do it properly. When you are halfway to this view, you do not see half of it, you see none of it.

The only view which is capable of looking at it is one able to functionally separate the two agendas. And this is the very first time this possibility has emerged, but simply reading a few books will not cut it – you will need to examine all of this in the context of your own life experience until it becomes clear to you in real and concrete terms. You can't fight what you can't see.

So if this is right, then all that we see is essentially worthless in this sense – everything, all of common culture. So the last thing we need now is more of the same, in any form. This is why understanding this is a far more significant achievement than realising it. Who knows how many people have realised this over time. But because they didn't understand it, they failed to make it accessible to others.

“Give a man a fish, and he will eat for a day. Teach a man to fish, and he will eat for a lifetime.”

In the end, the final truth is this: because of the way this subjective event blinds consciousness to its own existence and nature, until you are looking at this problem, you are always only looking from it. In which case you are forever only part of the problem, not part of the solution. You cannot fight what you cannot see, and you cannot see what you will not look at.

When a problem is based in denial, then to look at it is not just a preliminary step, it is – in a very real sense – the final answer. And this is why what must come next is as much about courage as it is about brains, because the more you look, the smaller it gets...it's like dragging a vampire out into the sunlight. That sunlight, in this case, is collective awareness.

In terms of even its immediate implications for humanity, this is bigger than anything we have seen before, or anything we might have ever predicted, or anything we will ever see again. There is a very big problem, and that is the good news because it has a solution. If – that is – we can bear to look.

We are truly very fortunate. This is all we need. It explains so much, it explains almost everything, and as it sweeps across society at a grass roots level it will alter the trajectory of civilization permanently. It will lay down the foundation stone of true human culture at last, which – when it originally fell to Earth – appears to have landed standing up on its thin edge, tenuously balancing there and leaving us very little room to build. And as it does come down at last I suspect it will not only give us a lot more room to move, but also crush a lot of that stinking rubbish that has grown up in its long shadow.

This is coming, and it is huge. This is the only game now, although it might take some people a while to realise that. But great care is implied – for even tremendously positive change can produce great upheaval if it is not managed and interpreted well. We should at least try to be ready for it.

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